



SOCIOLOGY FOR UPSC

Notes that Make You Achieve **300+ Score**

CHAPTER WISE NOTES OF COMPLETE SYBLLABUS

PAPER 2

Our UPSC Topper's with Highest Score in Sociology



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310 Marks



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Preface:

These notes are an all-in-one study material for Sociology Optional aspirants. Meticulously crafted, these notes are a rich compilation of Sociology thinkers and their theories, concepts, and real-world examples, born from a deep passion for Sociology and extensive experience teaching. These notes have been refined over the years and influenced by feedback from top rank holders. The content of these notes is not just a comprehensive coverage of the syllabus but also a single-point resource designed to meet the evolving needs of the UPSC Sociology exam.

These notes stand out for their emphasis on crafting Sociology Frameworks and KEYWORDS, proving excellent to ace Sociology optional papers 1 & 2.

Each chapter thoughtfully covers a range of Sociology scholars and theories, intertwined with contemporary examples, making the study not only informative but also engaging. These notes are made such that the content is easy to retain and can be effectively reproduced in exams.

What makes these notes invaluable are the exclusive FRAMEWORK and KEYWORDS for the Mains exam, helping aspirants to retain better and score high marks.

Suitable for both beginners and seasoned UPSC candidates, these notes are an all-in-one companion, promising to elevate the preparation of aspirants aiming for 300+ scores in the optional paper.

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A 1

Perspectives on the study of Indian Society

Syllabus

1. Indology (GS. Ghurye).
2. Structural functionalism (M N Srinivas).
3. Marxist sociology (A R Desai).

Indology

- Started as **Orientalism**.
- Gradually, uniqueness of India realized, thus, Indology was born.
- Literally speaking **Indology** is the academic study of the history and cultures, languages, and literature of the Indian subcontinent
- The Indological approach--> assumption that historically, **Indian society and culture are unique**.
- Also, because assumption that **Indian society is continuous** and that this 'contextually' specificity of **Indian social realities could be grasped better through the 'texts' rather through western ways of studying it**.
- Therefore, **Indologists use ancient history**, epics, religious manuscripts and texts etc. in the study of Indian social institutions.
- It is seen in the works of S.V. Ketkar, B.N. Seal and B.K. Sarkar. G.S. Ghurye, Louis Dumont, K.M. Kapadia, P.H. Prabhu and Irawati Karve.
- Initially, Sir **William Jones** established the **Asiatic Society of Bengal** in 1787 and also introduced the study of Sanskrit and Indology.
- Emphasis is on **understanding the society, rather than reforming**.

GS Ghurye

- **Father** of Modern Indology.
- Highlighting dynamism of Indian culture, that it's unique.
- G.S. Ghurye called "doyen of Indian sociology".
- MN Srinivas says that *"Nothing disguises the fact that Ghurye was a giant"*.

3 aspects worth inquiring into:

1. His **own role** in promoting sociology as a subject- wrote 32 books, provided new theoretical perspectives, new researches on diverse topics, was a nationalist
 2. **Institution builder**- Bombay university Sociology deptt, Indian Sociological Society 1952, its mouthpiece "Sociological bulletin."
 3. **Batch of sociologists** he mentored- MN Srinivas, Irawati Karve, AR Desai, K.M Kapadia, IP Desai, MSA Rao
- He completed his doctoral thesis under WHR Rivers - topic- "Caste and Race in India" (not religion).



- Indian society presents a vast melting pot of many cultures, religions, values- Ghurye wanted to **explore the long unification and synthesising process through which the society passed** and has come to this level.
- Exploration of the **process of cultural unity through** ages, is the main thrust of Ghurye's writings AR Desai, K.M Kapadia, IP Desai, MSA Rao.

GS Ghurye - Distinctive Approach

G.S.Ghurye's approach is distinctive from other Indological approaches for the following reasons:

1. **Sanskrit + Vernacular** - Ghurye uses Sanskrit text exclusively to explain Indian society and culture.
 - Extensively quoted from Vedas, Shastras, epics, poetry of Kalidas.
 - Also made use of vernacular literature- used Bankim Chandra Chatterjee's literature and other Marathi works.
2. **Diffusionist method**- Being a student of Prof Rivers he uses the method of diffusion to understand evolution of caste in India and cultural synthesis of Indian society.
 - Ghurye was initially influenced by the reality of diffusionist approach of British social anthropology.
 - But subsequently he switched on to the studies of Indian society from indological and anthropological perspectives.
3. **Methodological pluralism**
 - In the application of theories to empirical exercises or in the use of methodologies for data collection he was **not dogmatic**.
 - He seems to have believed in practicing and encouraging **disciplined eclecticism** in theory and methodology. That is, choose methodology according to the situation.
 - Examples:
 - **Field survey**- "Sex habits of the middle-class people in Bombay" and "Mahadev Kolis"
 - Also used **historical and comparative methods** in his studies which have been used by his students also.
4. **Theoretical pluralism.** (Inductive + Deductive)
 - Basically, interested in inductive empirical exercises → his theoretical position bordered on laissez-faire.
 - Ghurye's flexible approach was born of his faith in intellectual freedom which is reflected in the diverse theoretical and methodological approaches.

Examples: Even when he conducted survey type research, he ventured into generalisations on the basis of scanty information and unrepresentative evidence-- e.g. in "Social tensions in India".

GS Ghurye - Major Works

Whole range of his works can be classified into 6 broad areas.

- Caste
- Tribe

- Kinship, Family and Marriage
- Culture, Civilisation & Historical Role of Cities
- Religion
- Sociology of Conflict and Integration

Caste

- Ghurye's approach is called **Attributional Approach**. Because he emphasizes attributes of the caste.
- Book- "**Caste and Race in India**" → combined historical, anthropological and sociological perspective to understand caste and kinship in India caste tribes, kinship, family, Marriage, culture, civilisation, cities, religion, conflict & integration.
- Tried to understand caste from historical texts, combining it with field work and cultural perspective
- He studied caste system from a historical, comparative, and integrative perspective.

Emphasizes two important points:

1. The kin and caste networks in India **had parallels in some other societies** also.
2. The kinship and caste in India **served in the past as integrative frameworks**.

Six structural features of caste system as follows:

1. **Segmental** division
2. **Hierarchy**
3. Lack of choice of **occupation**
4. **Privileges and Prohibitions**
5. **Commensality** → Food hierarchies in caste – Kacha food, Pakka food, raw food.
6. Restrictions on marriage.

Besides the above characteristics, Ghurye laid particular stress on endogamy as the most important feature of the caste system. Caste hierarchy maintained through **endogamy**.

Tribe

1. Works on the tribes were general as well as specific. - "**Mahadev Kolis**" and "General book on STs in India"
2. At that time **majority** of the established anthropologists and administrators were of the opinion that the through "**Isolation Approach**" separate identity of the tribes is to be maintained at any cost.
3. **Isolation not possible, tribes already Hinduised:** Ghurye, on the other hand, believed that separate identity cannot be made as **already most of the tribes have been Hinduized after a long period of contact with Hindus**.
4. It is futile to search for the separate identity of the tribes. They are nothing but the '**backward caste Hindus**'.
5. Their backwardness was due to their **imperfect integration into Hindu society**. The Santhals, Bhils, Gonds, etc., who live in South- Central India are its examples.
6. Led to a **fierce debate between G.S. Ghurye and Verrier Elwin**.

7. **Elwin in his book Loss of Nerve** said that tribals should be allowed to live in **isolation**, whereas **Ghurye** argued that tribals should be **assimilated into Hindu castes**.
8. Ghurye also **highlighted the positives of assimilation** - Under Hindu influence, the tribes gave up liquor drinking, received education and improved their tribes and improved their agriculture.
9. In his **later works of north-eastern tribes**, Ghurye **documented secessionist trends**.
10. He felt that unless these were held in check, the political unity of the country would be damaged.

Kinship, Family and Marriage

- The relationship between caste and kinship is very close because **exogamy/endogamy is largely based on kinship**, either real or imaginary, and the effective unit of caste, **sub-caste is largely constituted of kinsmen**.
- To Ghurye, there are **3 types of marriage restrictions** in our society, which shape the relationship between caste and kinship.
 - These are **endogamy, exogamy and hypergamy**.
- **Exogamy** can be divided into two parts:
 - Spinda or prohibited degrees of kin
 - Sept or gotra exogamy.

Culture, Civilisation & Historical Role of Cities

1. Idea of **rururbanization** (rural + urbanisation) securing the advantages of urban life simultaneously with nature's greenery.
2. During colonial times, the growth of metropolitan centres altered the Indian life. **Colonisers inverted the previous pattern**.
3. The towns and cities were no longer the outlets for agricultural produce and handicrafts but they became the major manufacturing centres.
4. These centres used rural areas for producing raw materials and turned into a market for selling industrial products.
5. Thus, the **metropolitan economy emerged to dominate the village economy**.

Therefore, the urbanization started making inroads into the rural hinterland in contrast to previous pattern.

Civilisation and Culture

There are two conflicting views about the growth and accumulation pattern of culture.

1st view - Independent Growth of Culture

- Any community culture grows quite independently of similar events happening elsewhere or **predominantly with reference to local needs and local situation**.

2nd View - By Diffusion

1. **Culture grows by diffusion**. A single invention or discovery is made at one place and ultimately this cultural trait diffuses throughout the world.

2. *Ghurye had a strong faith in the power of man to preserve the best of his old culture, while creating from his own spirit of new culture.*
3. Acculturation is then, Best of own + best of others.
4. Concerned with the process of **evolution of Hindu civilization**, which has been termed as a '**complex civilization**'.

By Diffusion:

5. He said, the process of **acculturation is more relevant than the process of diffusion.**
6. He thinks that the **challenging task for a sociologist is to analyse this complex acculturation process in India.**
7. In his analysis of caste, Ghurye refers to how caste system was developed by the Brahmins and how it spread to other sections of the population.

Religion

Religion (Centre of Cultural heritage)

1. Ghurye thinks that **religion is at the centre of the total cultural heritage** of man.
2. It **moulds and directs the behaviour** of man in society
3. He **wrote six books** to bring out the role of religion in society.

These 6 books are:

- **Indian Sadhus (1953)**
- **Gods and Men (1962)**
- **Religious Consciousness (1965)**
- **Indian Accumulation (1977)**
- **Vedic India (1979)**
- **The Legacy of Ramayana (1979)**

Indian Sadhus

1. Indian Sadhus (1953 and 1964) → Sociography of the various sects and religious centres established by the great Vedantic philosopher Sankaracharya and other notable religious figures.
2. Highlights the **paradoxical nature of renunciation in India.**
3. A sadhu or sannyasin is supposed to be detached from all castes, norms and social conventions, etc. yet strikingly enough, since the time of Sankaracharya, the Hindu society has more or less been guided by the sadhus.
4. Most of them belonged to monastic orders, which have distinctive traditions.
5. The **monastic organization in India was a product of Hindusim and Buddhism.**
6. The rise of Buddhism and Jainism marked the decline of individual ascetics like Viswamitra.
7. **Indian sadhus have acted as the arbiters of religious disputes**, patronized learning of scriptures and the sacred lore and even defended religion against external attacks.

Sociology of Conflict and Integration

Three books of Ghurye, known as his '**triology**' in this field, which are relevant in this connection.

These are:

- **Social Tensions in India (1968)**
- **Whither India (1974)**
- **India Recreates Democracy (1978)**

He cites **5 sources of danger** for national unity:

1. The Scheduled Castes
2. The Scheduled Tribes
3. The Backward Classes
4. The Muslims as religious minority groups
5. The linguistic minorities

How cultural unity is there in India?

When asked how cultural unity is there in India, he says that it is indirectly a result of *Brahmanical endeavours*.

- He writes that **all the major institutions of Hindu society originated among the Brahmins and gradually they were accepted by other sections** of the community.
- Though **Ghurye calls it process of acculturation, it was basically a one-way flow**, in which the Brahminical ideas and institutions infiltrated among the non-Brahmins.
- It is the background of such an approach that Ghurye analyses the problems and prospects of Indian unity in contemporary India.

Criticism of Ghurye & Indology

Criticism of Indology

- Mainly **Brahminical** Point of view is written in the texts.
- It ends up **ignoring Sub-Altern**.
- **Ignores Tribal** History.
- Different Indologists give contradictory explanations.

(e.g. Colonial vs Nationalist Indologists)

- Religious Texts **Represent a Value** (Different from the fact)
- Mainly considers **Hindu Culture as Culture of India**.
- **Field studies** reflect that Indology doesn't explain the **present-day situation** (eg. Dominant caste, sanskritisation).

Criticism of Ghurye

- **Caste**: Brahminical Point of View.
- **Tribe**: Integration or Assimilation is a value loaded concept.

- **Armed chair** theorism
- **SCs, STs, OBCs, Muslims** as a threat is not acceptable as they widely participated in INM.

Indology in Contemporary Times

Wendy Doniger

- American Indologist
- Book
 - **The Hindus – An Alternative History**

DP Mukherjee

- **Marxian** Perspective on Indology (**Marxology**)
- Dialects of Indian History

Johannes Bronkhorst

- Concentrated on the **history of Indian thought** and published on a wide range of topics, including.
- **Indigenous grammar** and linguistics
- The **interaction between Brahmanism, Buddhism and Jainism** and their philosophical schools and religious practices.

Important Book – Greater Magadha (2007)

William Dalrymple

- Award-winning histories of the **interaction between the British and the Mughals** between the eighteenth and mid nineteenth century.

Arthur Llewellyn Basham

- Basham was one of the first **western historians to critically gauge the impact of Swami Vivekananda** from a global perspective.
- His well-known **comment about Vivekananda** that “**in centuries to come, he will be remembered as one of the main moulders of the modern world**” is quoted frequently in appreciations and tributes of Vivekananda.
- Most popular book is *The Wonder that was India* – “most widely used introduction to Indian civilization”.

Ram Sharan Sharma

- Focused on **early Indian social structure, material and economic life, state formation and political ideas** and the social context of religious ideologies.
- Laid stress on the **elements of change and continuity**.
- Methodology rests on a **critical evaluation of sources** and a **correlation between literary texts with archaeology and ethnography**.
- Unravel the **process of class formation**, and **social implications of the material changes** in the Vedic period and in the age of the Buddha on the basis of literacy and archaeological sources.
- Sharma **applied the tool of historical materialism** not only to explain social differentiation and stages of economic development, but **also to the realm of ideology**.

- His **investigations into the “feudal mind”** and “economic and social basis of tantrism” are thought – provoking, opening up new lines of inquiry.

Content Analysis

Apart from texts Official data, Histories, Mass Media also being analysed.

Eg. – Analysis of TV Serials – Presents Primacy of Traditional Roles, family.

Texts from across the languages, Monuments, Script being deciphered.

Issues that can take help from Indology

- History of Caste System
- Joint family as a Value
- Caste – Race Parallel
- Ayodhya Issue
- Ram Setu.

Structural Functionalism

Studies particular functions that are performed by an institution or object for maintenance of Structure.

Tries to explain the various social forms found in tribal societies in terms of their contributions to social cohesion.

This perspective focus on the understanding of the ‘ordering’ and ‘patterning’ of the social world.

It Asks Certain Basic Questions Like

- How did various institutions or customs originate?
- How does it fill in the broader context?
- How does the part relate to the whole?

A.R. Radcliffe-Brown’s Perspective

Regarding this perspective, A.R. Radcliffe-Brown says that:

- The **total social structure of a society, together with the totality of social usages**, constituted a functional unity
- It’s a **condition in which all parts work together** with a sufficient degree of **harmony or internal consistency**
- That is, **without producing persisting conflicts** which can neither be resolved nor regulated.

- It treats **changes as a slow, cumulative process** of adjustment to a new situation.

Understanding Structural Functionalism

- Its explanation consists essentially of **pointing out how the different types of activity fit on top of one another**, and are consistent with one another, and how conflicts are contained and prevented from changing the structure.
- The structural-functional perspective **relies more on the field work tradition** for understanding the social reality so that it can also be understood as '**contextual**' or '**field view**' perspective of the social phenomena.
- The important followers of this perspective are **M.N. Srinivas, S.C. Dube, McKim Marriott, I.P. Desai, D.N. Majumdar and others.**

Application on The Study of Indian Society

- Let us now discuss the **structural-functional approach** adopted by **M.N. Srinivas, S.C. Dube and McKim Marriott** in the study of Indian society.
- WH Wisers Jajmani System also used the perspective.
- It is believed that relevance of Structure Function increased after welfare economy Policies in India.

MN Srinivas

1. **Initiator:** M.N. Srinivas is to be credited for **initiating** the new line of **structural-functional analysis** in sociological and social anthropological research in India.
2. Inductivism - Srinivas had initiated the tradition of **basing macro-sociological generalizations on micro anthropological insights.**
3. **Theoretical and Methodological Perspectives**
 1. Moved from western textbooks or from indigenous sacred texts to "**direct observation, field study and field experience**".
 2. **Field study of Coorgs** between 1940-42:
 1. Rites in terms of worshipping Rivers (Ganga, Kaveri in Coorg)
 2. Coorg Study revealed similarity in religious rituals.

Coorgs – People of the place Coorg

1. **Functional unity** was explained by explaining the **interaction in ritual context** of different castes of Coorgs, mainly Brahmins (priests), Kaniyas (astrologers and magicians) and Bannas and Panikas (low castes)
 2. Studies of caste, religion (1952, 1959, 1962, and 1966) highlighted not only their structural functional aspects, but also the dynamics of the caste system in rural setting.
-
4. **Introduced new concepts**
 1. Proposed conceptual tools like '**dominant caste**', '**Sanskritization, westernization**' and '**secularization**' to understand the realities of inter-caste relations and also to explain their dynamics.

2. The concept of 'dominant caste' has been used in the study of power relations at the village level.

MN Srinivas – Important Works

His work can be arranged and studied under the following heads –

1. Social Change
2. Religion & Society
3. Study on village
4. Caste
5. Dominant caste

Social Change

- Srinivas attempted to construct a macro-level analysis using **a large number of micro-level findings** on the processes of 'sanskritization', 'westernization' and 'secularization'.
- He gave the concepts of **Brahminization, Sanskritization** (Religious + Secular), Westernization (Primary, Secondary, Tertiary) and **Secularization**.
- **Study of Coorgs**: Sanskritisation – Case of **Anticipatory Socialisation** – Generally inter-generation – Followed with rise in Secular mobility.
- **Study of Rampur (village)** – Dominant caste. That is, when entire group gets mobility (Sanskritisation) it leads to creation of Dominant caste.

Religion and Society

- While studying the Coorgs of South India, he formulated the concept of '**Brahminization**' to represent the **process of the imitation of life-ways and ritual practices of Brahmins by the lower-caste Hindus**.
- The concept was used to interpret changes observed through field study
- It **later led to a higher-level concept, 'sanskritization'**, Brahminic model as frame of reference had limitations (copying of life ways and rituals of other higher castes also).
- Book- Social change in Modern India (1966)
- Though referring **mainly** to the processes of **cultural imitation**, has a **built-in structural notion**, that of **hierarchy and inequality of privilege and power**, since the **imitation is always by the castes or categories placed lower** in social and economic status.
- **Sanskritization**- It is the process by which a '**low**' caste or tribe or other group takes over the custom, ritual, beliefs, ideology and style of life of a high and, in particular, a '**twice-born**' (dwija) caste.
- The sanskritization of a group has usually the effect of **improving its position in the local caste hierarchy**.
- **Westernisation** - It was a **change** resulting from the contact of **British socio-economic and cultural innovations and ideological formulation after independence** to deal with the question of religious groups and minorities.

Study of Village

1. Srinivas considers **village as the microcosm** of Indian society and civilization.
2. It is the village, which **retains the traditional composition of India's tradition**.
3. Srinivas was **concerned with the spread of Hinduism**.
4. He believed **Hinduism was being spread by the process of Sanskritisation**. He curiously **did not take up why masses of Hindus still lie in low castes** or no castes.
5. He was **not fascinated by Hinduism in its holistic form**. He looked for it in the caste system.

Rampura village- Dominant Caste

- He conducted the study of **Rampur- a Mysore village** - which gave him the concept of '**dominant caste**'.
- The study has been contained in **The Remembered Village (1976)**.

Views on Caste

1. He showed how **castes are interdependent** in villages by his study of Rampura Village.
2. Srinivas has extensively talked about the **social evils of the caste society**, he **pleads for change** in caste system and **discusses westernization and modernization as viable paradigms** of changes.
3. **Srinivas views caste as a segmentary system**.

Every caste, for him, is **divided into sub-castes** which are:

1. **Segmentory** - The unit of endogamy;
2. Whose members follow a **common occupation**;
3. **Pollution and Purity**
4. **Commensality**
5. Whose members are governed by the same authoritative body, viz., the **panchayat**.

Keyword - SOPCP

Dominant Caste

He first proposed it in his early papers on the village of Rampura.

In Rampura village there were **many communities**- Brahmins, peasants, untouchables.

Peasants hold lands, and although they are **lower in hierarchy** than Brahmins they **hold considerable power** over them in the village.

Six attributes:

1. Sizeable amount of arable **land**
2. Strength of **numbers**
3. High place in the **local hierarchy**
4. Western **education**
5. **Jobs** in the administration
6. **Urban** sources of income.

Of the above attributes of the dominant caste, the **following three are important:**

1. Numerical strength
2. Economic power through ownership of land
3. Political power

Criticism of MN Srinivas

Criticism

1. **MNS's views come across as Upper caste views only -**
 - a) For him, Indian traditions are those, which are manifested in caste and village.
 - b) His traditions are **hinduized traditions and in no sense secular ones.**
 - c) **The construction of sankritization and dominant caste put him closer to hindutva ideology of cultural nationalism.**
 - d) More elitist or presents only upper caste view.
2. **Yogender Singh** criticizes M. N. Srinivas on the ground that **his structure functionalism** is a manifestation of **objective idealism** (a preconceived **notion that India changes at a slower pace** in comparison to west)- rather in India change in really fast.
3. **Maitri Chowdhary** considers that M. N. Srinivas theory is **conservative** as it **cannot understand the changes experienced by Indian social institutions** under the influence of **globalization** and **feminist movements**
4. **Anand Chakravarti**- MNS is **silent on class, factional politics and different kinds of political manipulation** persisting.
5. **Y. Singh** - Indian society has in the past and is still rapidly **changing** of many factors (**Islamisation, Westernisation**), **villages no longer microcosm of India.**
6. **Gail Omvedt**: Reflection of **Brahminic ideology** than value neutral sociology. Caste as a product of culture is shared by all Indians is absolutely unacceptable.
7. **Gail Omvedt** - MNS doesn't explain **why Dalits couldn't become Dominant caste inspite of numbers.**
8. **Ghanshyam Shah**: **Dominant caste** nothing but **class mobilization.**
9. **Yogesh Atal**:

Dominant castes have different meanings at different places.

There are often **Multiple Dominances.**

Example -

- i. At **Village** level - Family dominates
 - ii. At **State** level - A caste dominates
 - iii. At **National** level - various Dominant castes
10. **RK Mukherjee**: Presently **in capitalist India, Urban areas** make the structure of society, villages are a were recipient of the structure made.
 11. **Does not explain mobility experienced by non-Hindu communities.**
 12. **Difficult to say what constitutes a dominant caste** when there are **so many sub-castes.**
 13. **Dipankar Gupta**: In Gujarat, **KHAM, MY** - various **groups came together as a power faction to overpower dominant castes.** (KHAM overpowered Patedars).

Do add Standard criticism of Structure functionalism-

- a) Status Quoist
- b) Teleologies
- c) Ignores Conflict
- d) Tendency to Generalise (Empirical Anarchism)

Marxist Sociology

Radcliffe Brown – History distinguished from sociology.

Wilhelm Windbenrd & Henrich Rickert:

History ideographic (dealing with individual facts)

Socio nomothetic (dealing with abstractions, generalized facts).

Marx & Marxists

- This is unacceptable. History lifeline of society.
- Society subject matter of history
- They complement each other
- They are Interdependent.

Noted Indian Marxists

DP Mukherjee (Marxological)

RK Mukherjee (City Studies)

IP Desai, AR Desai.

They gave an alternate vision to Indological perspective and str. functionalism.

Marxist Idea / Thought

- Societies Develop through **dialectics**.
- Indological perspective gives only history, structural functional perspective discusses only present.
- Marxist view studies the process of **development and evolution through history**.
- Social institutions understood through **Dialectics + Economics**.

Marxist Methodology

How do they do it -

Marxists collect historical data and look at the socio-historical development at different points of time.

Marxist Ideas Applied

Daniel Thornier – understood agrarian class structure

Kathleen Gough – highlighted class – caste nexus.

IP Desai – Joint family in agrarian societies of Economies of scale & DoL.

Berman – Jajmani exploitative for kamins.

AR Desai

- He **rejects uniqueness** of Indian culture.
- Considers that **history of India should be interpreted from economic perspective** to understand the birth, growth and rise of Indian society.

AR Desai Important Ideas

On Birth of Caste

- Aryan invasion destroyed primitive MOP.
- Indigenous were subjected to separate residence. Beginning of caste.
- Aryans thought themselves as superior, called themselves Brahmin.
- Different indigenous tribes got their names from the totems they worshipped.
- Their occupation was rigidified by Brahmins.
- Texts were written by the dominant caste to rigidify stratification, eg Rigveda which says – B-Head, K-Shoulders, V-Legs, S-feet. (Use Cultural reproduction – Pierre Bordeaux)

On Buddhism and Jainism

- Scholars see them as progressive anti-brahminical movements for egalitarians soc.
- He says Buddhism and Jainism simply offered some space for explanation of existing dominant culture and looked for patronizing from ruling class making Hinduism stronger and seeing Buddha as one of the avatars.

On Classes in India

- 2 Classes – Masters and Service.
- Service Class morally and socially bound to offer services to master class.
- The relation is dialectic economical relation, comparable to slavery in west.

On Feudalism in India

- Largely different from European.
- Indian feudalism came from above (by Emperors or British), while in Europe the feudalism came from below.
- It means that a lot of minor chieftains, feudal lords collectively determined who would they support for Kingship.
- Indian feudal lords were already chiefs or kings.

- Normal people had no ownership of land they tilled.
- Rent in the form of taxes and services offered.
- Therefore, loss of political, social and economical freedom by masses.
- **Capitalistic MOP** - Colonialism brought railways, roadways, diff tenure systems, Bureaucracy, legal courts, police system, cash transactions, thus, starting Capitalistic MOP.
- Machines produced, cottage industries shut, peasants lost right over agri land and forced to grow cashcrops and indigo.

On revolt of 1857

It's primarily Capitalism vs Feudalism:

- Clash between rising capitalism and declining feudalism (represented by diff feudal communities).

On Indian National Movement

- AR Desai is **critical of national and liberal historians**.
- Many **ex-feudal lords got into industry** under British.
- **Emergent industrialists and Middle class started eyeing a position** in admin, politics, police etc and started a mass mobilization against British which they called INM.
- "The so-called national leaders like Gandhi and Nehru adopted policies not to wipe out class inequalities rather they preferred to glorify nation in the minds of all in order to receive support from the hungry and speechless masses in India, so as to transfer the power from the hands of external colonizers to internal colonizers".

Therefore, **democracy came in India without**

- **Democratic participation**
- **Economic freedom**
- **Political freedom**

On Contemporary Policies

- He is **sceptical of New policies** as they **profess False Consciousness** like Governmental policies like Land Reforms, Reservations etc.
- He sees it as **a conscious design of dominant group to glorify the segmentation** amongst the culturally, politically and economically deprived sections of the society.

Conclusion

- Desai attempts to understand poverty, illitracy, backwardness, **marginalization of masses in India as a product of economic history** driven by **conscious ideological constructs**.
- To him INM, **Development policies are all populist measures** by govt to ensure that **True Class**

Consciousness and Polarisation of society never occurs.

Criticism

- **Andre Beteille** – Exaggeration of eco history to fit into Marxist theory. Other bases of stratifications like caste & political mobility are ignored.
- **Andre Beteille** further says that there are indicators that highlight that development is happening.
- **Y Singh** – Marxian theory never looks for alternatives to social change. Highly skeptical of everything (govt policies, mass media, popular movements etc.).
- Peasant and farmer movements in different parts of the country sign of democracy, never seen in history.
- **Gail Omvedt** – Marxian theory sees only 2 polarised classes. Whereas in India the degree of inequality experienced by all classes is not equal. Dalits are immensely suppressed, and are worst victims of inequality.
- **Jyoti Basu**: Biggest folly of Marxist studies in India is to ignore castes & religion. (equating caste as class is invalid in India).
- Urban areas are witnessing large swathes of Middle – class, contrary to what Marxists Predicted. (Use Dahrenderf's 5)

Other Marxist Approaches To Study Indian Society

Ranajeet Guha's Subaltern Sociology

- The **history of India should be re-written from a mass perspective** than from the (current ruler) govt's perspective.
- Empirical evidence indicates that how **subaltern groups have exhibited resistance in different parts** of the country at diff times.
- Eg tribal movements, caste movements, peasant movements etc.

What is Subaltern Sociology

Read this and see what's portrayed here:

Kishwar Chowdhury from Bangladesh wowed the judges of the recently-wrapped *MasterChef Australia* season 13 with her *panta bhaat*, a simple, poor man's dish popular in the eastern region of the Indian subcontinent. Chowdhury also presented this dish the traditional way, with side dishes of a home-style aloo mash and sardines fry.

- In **postcolonial studies and in critical theory**, the term subaltern designates and identifies the **colonial populations who are socially, politically, and geographically excluded** from the hierarchy of power of an imperial colony and from the metropolitan homeland of an empire.

Antonio Gramsci's idea of Subaltern

- Antonio Gramsci coined the term subaltern **to identify the cultural hegemony that excludes and displaces specific people** and social groups from the socio-economic institutions of society, in order to deny their agency and voices in colonial politics.

- Subaltern, **meaning 'of inferior rank'**, is a term adopted by Antonio Gramsci to refer to those groups in society who are **subject to the hegemony of the ruling classes**.
- Subaltern classes **may include peasants, workers and other groups denied access to 'hegemonic' power**.

Subaltern Studies

- Subaltern Studies emerged around 1982 as a series of journal articles published by Oxford University Press in India.
- A group of **Indian scholars trained in the west wanted to reclaim their history**.
- Its main goal was to **retake history for the underclasses**, for the voices that had not been heard previous.
- Scholars of the subaltern hoped **to break away from histories of the elites and the Eurocentric bias of current imperial history**.
- In the main, they **wrote against the "Cambridge School" which seemed to uphold the colonial legacy – i.e. it was elite-centered**.
- They **focused on subaltern in terms of class, caste, gender, race, language and culture**.
- They **espoused the idea that there may have been political dominance, but that this was not hegemonic**.
- The primary leader was **Ranajit Guha who had written works on peasant uprisings in India**.
- Any other **history merely reconstructs imperialist hegemony and does not give voice to the people – those who resisted, those who supported, those who experienced colonial incursion**.
- According to the Subaltern Studies group, this **history is designed to be a "contribution made by people on their own, that it, independently of the élite"**.
- They did this by **establishing a journal out of Oxford, Delhi and Australia and called it Subaltern Studies to write a history against the grain and restore history to the subordinated**.
- In other words, **to give the common people back their agency**.
- In other words, proponents of subaltern studies suggest that we **need to find alternate sources to locate the voice of the subaltern historically**.
- **Elite records, like those at the home office or foreign office could still be used, but you had to read them with a different pair of lenses**.

Relevance

Obviously, the introduction of subaltern studies, like all of our theories we've encountered this term, has **tremendous political repercussions**.

In a society like Great Britain, that **claims to operate as a "Commonwealth"** yet **sees racism around every corner** as well as the **desire to keep out the blacks** who cause all the problems, the **writing and mapping of a history of previously silent groups creates an undercurrent** throughout the society.

Subaltern history will help to lay bare:

- Previously **covered histories**
- Previously **ignored events**
- Previously **purposeful hidden secrets** of the past.

Ranajit Guha's Approach

- According to Guha, the subaltern **historiography focuses on the peasants and tribal movements during colonial period in India** as it has been overlooked by the dominant mainstream elitist historiography.
- **Such historiography emphasises the role of the individual leaders or of organisations and institutions** as the major force during the freedom struggle.
- Subaltern studies analyse the **"binary relationship" of the subaltern and ruling classes**, and thus study the **interplay of dominance and subordination** in colonial systems, most notably India.
- Guha in his article entitled **"Some Aspects of the Historiography of Colonial India,"** argues that the **historiography of the Indian nationalism was dominated by these elitists who were the colonial and bourgeois nationalists.**
- This type of historical writing gives the impression that the **Indian nation and the consciousness of nationalism was an achievement of only the elites.**
- On the other hand, the elitist perspective of history writing portrays their articulation and **uprising as the law and order problem.**
- The one sided perspective considers **Indian nationalism as the response of the charisma of certain elite leaders.**

Criticism

- **Dipesh Chakrabarty** ("postcoloniality and the artifice of history" in representations) suggest that it is **really impossible to fully break from the western narrative.**
- Indian sociologist **Vivek Chibber** has criticised the premise of Subaltern Studies for its **obfuscation of class struggle and class formation** in its analysis, and accused it of excising class exploitation from the story of the oppression of the subaltern.
- Feminist scholar **Gayatri Chakravorty Spivak** cautioned against an over-broad application of the term the subaltern.

"Subaltern is not just a classy word for "oppressed", for [the] other, for somebody who's not getting a piece of the pie. ... In post-colonial terms, everything that has limited or no access to the cultural imperialism is subaltern – a space of difference. Now, who would say that's just the oppressed? The working class is oppressed. It's not subaltern".

Conclusion

Inspired by Gramsci and by her political-pedagogical activity with Adivasi tribes, Spivak asks **not only whether and how subalterns can be represented by intellectuals, but also what the intellectuals can learn from them.**

'Learning to learn from below' thus represents a central strategy in **Spivak's later approach to subalternity, which opens up space for the 'subaltern contamination' of hegemonic discourses.**

Anand Chakravathy's Hegemonistic Domination

- It is against class domination.
- Under-class is a body of people who are subjected to various forms of deprivation.

- He says that **politics, judiciary, police etc are controlled by same class** and for **underclass to rise** and get human rights and other economic and political rights **it will need support from urban intelligentsia.**

Ashok Rudra, Pranab Bardhan

Follow Althusser's theory of ideological state apparatus, which **does not track history of inequality but focuses on genesis of inequality.**

Pradeep Sarkar

LPG era = neo-colonialism

(for explaining poverty and marginalization in india)

All in all, **India from past to present is a dialectic of:**

- Poverty and Prosperity
- Empowerment and Powerlessness

Some Fodder Material on AR Desai

- Worked under GS Ghurye.
- Major Book – The Social Background of Indian Nationalism.
- A fresh view on “India” level problems.

Fame – 15th All-Indian Sociological conference.

- **27 points emphasizing non-existence of Marxist methodology in Indian sociology.**

7 Broad Contemporary Ideas

1. **Constitution** – Bourgeoisie. Leadership capitalistic. Slogan of socialism is a hoax to confuse masses.
2. **State** – Though preaching science, revivalist and popularizing old religious philosophies. Naming India Bharat. (To be quoted in Secularism) That state's symbol still talks of religion, Dharma chakra as national symbols etc.
3. **Culture** – Idealistic and religio-mystical philosophies re-inforced by ruling bourgeois to dominate.
4. **Development** – Book: India's path of Development, 1984. Weak Indian capitalist society can't resolve eco, pol, socio, educational, cultural problems of India.
5. **Crisis** – Present society will deepen eco, pol, socio, cultural crises.
6. **Capitalism** – Under capitalism not possible to liquidate mass poverty, unemployment, illiteracy, ignorance, reactionary caste, feudal institutions.
7. **Socialism** – Only Socialism can end crisis. By changing Constitution – giving right to work, removing private property for transformation of Indian society.

A 2

Impact of Colonial Rule on Indian Society

Syllabus

- a) Social background of Indian nationalism.
- b) Modernization of Indian tradition.
- c) Protests and movements during the colonial period.
- d) Social reforms.

Social Background of Indian Nationalism

(SBIN)

Perspectives on Indian Nationalism

Nationalists

Nation always existed, Urban Middle Class seeking reforms

Marxist, Sub-Altern

- Nation was imposed by Middle Class
- An outcome of western education

Different Theoretical Strands to Study SBIN

Nationalist Perspective

Promoted by Ranade, Pt. Nehru, NK Dutt, KN Pannikar.

- Indian Nationalism product of urban English educated middle class seeking reforms in social institutions.
- Promoting territorial integration
- Stimulating mass minds

Nationalists consider Congress and Indian National Movement integral for rise of Nationalism in India.

Marxist Point of View

AR Desai

Opposite to the Nationalist view

- Economic Mode of Production (MoP) influenced the political superstructure and mobilization.

Indian Nationalism can be studied in 5 distinct phases.

With each phase social base broadened.

- AR Desai writes - Prior to British, Nationalism was absent in India as people lived in dispersed villages
- Earlier rulers including Mughals did not touch village autonomy and were thus not revolted against.

AR Desai's 5 Phases of Indian Nationalism

5 phases

- 1800 - 1850
- 1850 - 1888
- 1888 - 1905
- 1905 - 1920
- 1920 - 1940

First Phase (1800 - 1850)

Introduction of British & related beginning education, policies etc.

- Peasant suppression
- Rise of intelligentsia
- Reform movements
- Narrow social base of nationalism.

Intro of British brought

- A large body of tax collectors
- Middle-men
- Police
- Disinterested bureaucracy
- Cash Transactions
- Thus, peasant started to get suppressed.

Rise of Intelligentsia

- Also, rise of Intelligentsia product of modern education imparted by British.
- Raja Ram Mohan Roy & others pioneers of the concept of Indian Nationalism.
- They initiated socio-reform and religious-reform movements. Nationalism had narrow social base.
- Arya Samaj, Brahmo samaj, etc beginning to operationalise.

Second Phase (1850 - 1888)

Aggressive destruction of indigenous industry & related consequences 1857 revolt.

Revolt of 1857

- Peasants & dethroned feudal lords led to the revolt of 1857
- Religious reasons as well
- It was a war between declining feudalism & rising capitalism.

- Colonial infrastructure consolidated
- Colonial powers consolidated.
- Expansion of rail, ports, telephony etc.
- Introduction of British goods destroyed indigenous industries.
- Rise of:
 - Mass poverty
 - Debt trap
 - Forced eviction.
- Peasants in different parts supported by dethroned feudal lords led to 1857.

Third Phase (1888 - 1905)

- Indian Bourgeoisie encouraged middle class to protest in order to project their interest.
- Rise of Indian National Congress.
- Rise of various trusts.
- 80% of products consumed in India of British origin, monopolising manufacturing and marketing.
- Indian industries absolutely collapsed.
- Very few (12) Indian industrialists remaining.
- They organized revolt to protect their class interests.
- Funded, encouraged, patronized Indian middle class to organize protests against British.
- Rise of Congress and acceleration of Indian Nationalism.

Fourth Phase (1905 - 1920)

- Mobilisation of Peasantry in countryside
- Rise of Kisan Sabha movements.
- Landless peasantry mobilized by Indian leaders driven by socialistic inclination revolted against zamindars/intermediaries.
- Movement in countryside uniting peasants of different languages, different regions.

Fifth Phase (1920 - 1940)

- Mahatma Gandhi bridged the gap between different classes.
- Thesis (Indian Bourgeoisie), Anti-thesis (Indian Proletariat) then Synthesis (Both together)
- Rise of Mass movement.
- He articulated concerns of peasants and supported concessions to Indian industrialists.
- Asked zamindars to support INC.
- Therefore, Bourgeois interest got glorified in INC agenda.

- And has been so ever since.

Reactions or Criticisms to AR Desai's idea of SBIN

Reactions/Criticisms

1. **Ramachandra Guha** – Gandhi was not a bourgeois leader but a statesman who understood the importance of masses and mobilized them into INM.
2. **Y. Singh**: It seems more of an ideology than reality.
3. **Beteille**: Forced empiricism to fit into Marxist methodology.
4. **MN Srinivas** – Diversity in India is not its weakness but a balancing force.
5. Lack of empirical data.

Andre Beteille – What India needs today is a responsible and reflexive state concerned about Social Equity and Social Welfare.

Relevance Today

- Sub-nationalism articulated through separatist movements. These movements unifying people on the basis of culture, language, territory. Sub-nationalism is unifying people.
- Return of **Hindu Nationalism** a new challenge to secular and democratic state of India.
- Therefore, Nationalism becoming pathological as well as **promoting unity**.
- **New Forms of Nationalism** – Cricket, Scientific, War, Disaster unifying nation

Also, can analyse the SBIN as follows

- **Women**
- **Caste**
- **Tribal**
- **Religion** (some believe it led to Partition)
- **Rural-Urban**

Do mention Role of Diaspora

Modernisation of Indian Tradition

Defining Modernity

Modernity is ADAPCO

- Ascription VS Achievement
- Diffusion VS Specificity
- Affectivity VS Affective neutrality
- Particularism VS Universalism
- Collective orientation VS Individual orientation

Or also, you can write that it is **Rationalisation in PEST**

- Overall societal process which brings about **social change in norms, ethos, values, culture, structure and function** of the society.
- This **influences all facets of society**.
- **Weber**: It is a historic process with its roots in Renaissance, rise in democracy, growth of nation states, expansion of markets.
- Saint Simon, Simmel: It's a **19th century product** with increasing secularisation, industrialisation, bureaucratization.
- Theory of **modernisation not unique to India** and various studies.

Features of Modernity

- **Normative**: Norms changing
- **Individualisation**
- **Social phenomenon**- Transforming MoP, RoP, Political Participation

Various Point of Views in India regarding Modernity

- Nationalist
- Marxist
- MN Srinivas
- Gurnar Myrdal
- Louis Dumont & Andre Beteille
- Y. Singh

Modernity has been taken as a frame of reference by various thinkers.

Nationalists' Perspective on Modernity

Nationalist thinkers such as Ghurye and Mukherjee, RN Sharma, Utpal Dutt

- Effective **instrument for development** of Indian society.
- They were **sceptical of colonial attempts**.
- **Synthesis should be there** between tradition and modernity.
- **Mahatma Gandhi**- "While **rejecting on modernity**, indicated that man in India should **be open to diverse thoughts**, without compromising with his potential Indianness".

Vivekanand- "Synthesis between western materialism and Indian spiritualism"

Arya Samaj- English and Sanskrit was taught in schools. **Judicious mixture** of Indian values and western thoughts.

- Conclusion- It is **never an attempt to evolve** (we are not bad), **our process of modernisation is unique** and specific to India.
- **Tradition and modernity co-exist** in India.

Summarising Nationalists' P.O.V.

- Synthesis be there between Tradition & Modernity.

- Uniqueness of India shall be preserved

Marxist's Perspective on Modernity

Marxist School

DP Mukherjee

- Modernity in India accelerated during British rule
- Modern trade, education, liberal thinking, growth of Indian middle class
- But our modernity is different from west (which came by Industrial revolution), which has come without industrialism
- Middle class in India engaged in transforming politics.
- But confused, due to Modes of production not emerging as it is aspirational, want work but means not available.

Marxist P.O.V.

- Middle class with education formed, and has no MoP (no industrialisation), only politically active. Became agent of modernity & spread the idea of independence to ensure self - rule.

But this is criticised by AR Desai

- Modernity is a **colonial construct**
- It has destroyed weavers, handicrafts, village industries, independent guilds.
- New market centers have evolved selling foreign goods. Work is done for accumulation of wealth.
- Various classes have formed- Industrialists, landlords, middle class, industrial workers.
- They all have different interests and feel depressed; so they start participating in freedom struggle to get personal freedom.
- So **Indian modernity is largely influenced by segmentary interest of class than the collective interest of masses.**

Y Singh contradicts

- This theory does not have much empirical evidence.
- It is more of an ideology than facts.

Marriot and Milton Singer's Perspective on Modernity

Little & Great Tradition

- Robert Redfield conceptualised it in Mexico.
- Singer & Mckim Marriot used it in India to study Social changes.

Theory of Orthogenetic and Heterogenetic change

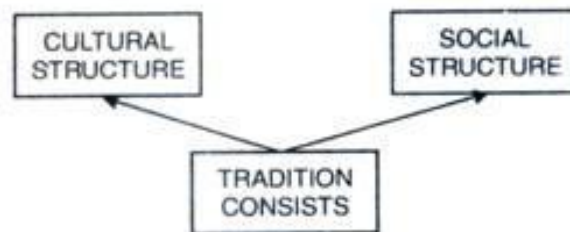
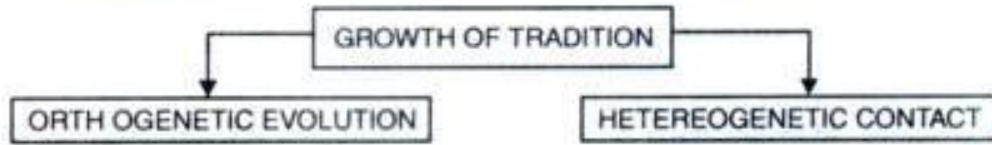
Which concludes

- In India is present "**Indianisation of modern tradition**" than "modernisation of Indian tradition"

Milton Singer & Marriot

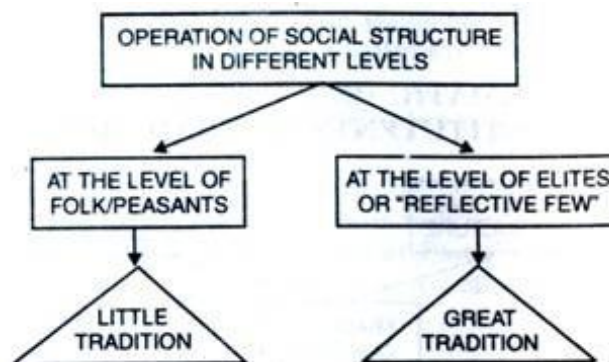
- **Orthogenetic** (indigenous change) & **Heterogenetic** (imported or because of contact with other tradition) changes impact the tradition of a place.

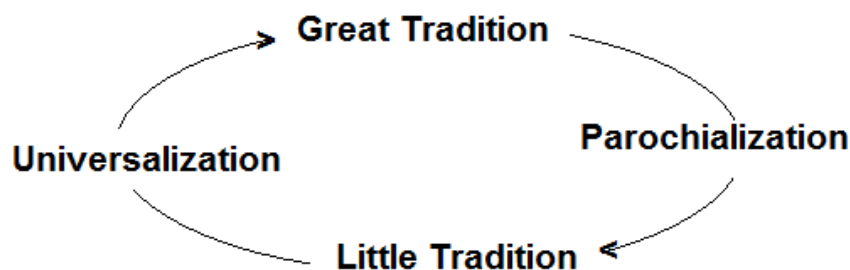
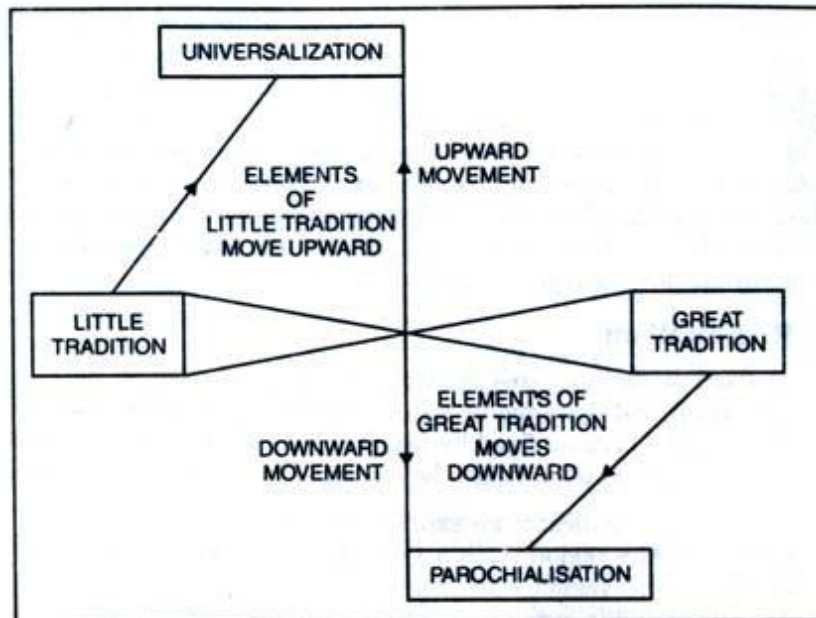
Schematic Presentation of Growth of Tradition



The tradition consists of two structures : Cultural structure and social structure. The entire tradition does not remain constant. It grows constantly. Robert Redfield, while conducting his study on Mexican communities used this type of model. So, he used those two concepts 'Little tradition' and 'Great tradition', in Indian society.

The whole of the tradition grows in two stages :





Little Tradition	Great Tradition
• Tradition of Folks & Peasants • Tradition of illiterates • Local version of textual knowledge • Moulds the roles according to local settings • Local versions of epics with local examples for easy comprehension of folk people. • Low culture - Folk culture • Not <u>scrutinised</u> • Changes made to meet traditions at village level • <u>Desanskritisation</u> occurs as local priests mould the great tradition according to their needs.	• Tradition of Elites or Reflective few • Tradition of Literates • Textual or '<u>Shastriya</u>' Tradition • Decides role of caste system, education, priests, teachers. • Ramayana, Mahabharata major source of Great Tradition. • High culture • Popular culture • Classical culture • Up for scrutiny • Basis of Universalisation.

Parochialisation & Universalisation

Parochialisation

- Some elements of great tradition circulate down to little tradition.
- A new tradition emerges
- Example, veil by Rajputs adopted from Islam.
- Go-varadhan (cow- Protector) became Gobar Dhan (People started valuing cow dung)
- Holi's transformation to Hola – Mohalla in Punjab.

Universalisation

- **Element of Little tradition that have become part of Great Tradition.**
- Example: Rakshabandhan was earlier Saluno festival in UP (Precursors to Raksha Bandhan).
- Chhath Pooja of Bihar, being celebrated in Delhi.
- Ganesh Mahotsav of Mumbai being celebrated across India.
- Lohri of Punjab

Contemporary Relevance

Because Of

- Globalisation
- Migration
- IT
- Also, Globalisation is becoming Glocalisation.

Milton Singer's conclusions

- a) This type of **interaction** in relation to little tradition and Great tradition is **reflected in different areas** like village community, caste system etc.
- b) It **creates a common cultural consciousness** among Indians.
- c) The common cultural consciousness has been formed by **certain processes and factors such as sacred books, rituals** etc.
- d) Interaction between Little tradition and Great tradition **helps in cultural continuity in the face of modernisation, westernization** etc.

Contradicted by SC Dubey

Marriot and Milton Singer Contradicted by SC Dubey

- Social Change in India is **not always synchronic**.
- Though tradition influences modernity, but there have been **examples where modernity has absolutely influenced tradition**.
- It can be seen as **Brahminical tradition is slowly disintegrating** under the influence of urban class consciousness

MN Srinivas's Perspective on Modernity

MN Srinivas

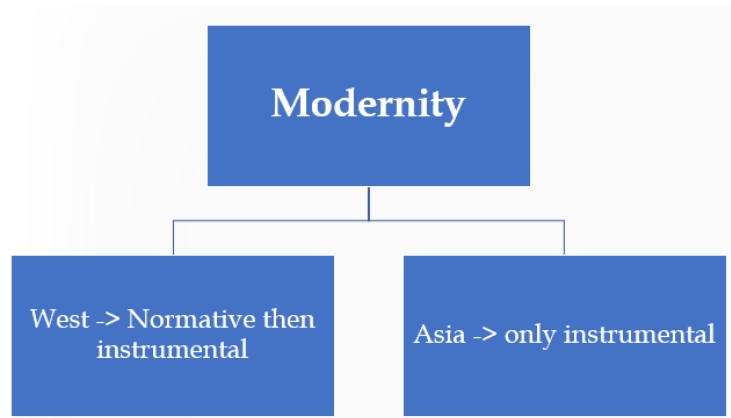
Both orthogenetic (Sanskritisation | Hetrogenetic (westernisation)

- Modernity is a value loaded concept- (assumed to be a good thing always)
- So he calls it a concept of westernisation.
- Under influence of west new technologies, new institutions and new ideologies are introduced in India- resulting in mutual coexistence- E.g. Sanskritisation and westernisation co exist as ways to gain mobility.
- Westernisation (modernity's name in India) & Sanskritisation both ways for Social Mobility.
- **Thought Extended by Rudolf and Rudolph** - they think in India, change can come w/o violence.
- Caste co exists with democracy. Caste with its numbers get elected. So it co exists in society.

Gunnar Myrdal's Perspective on Modernity

Gunnar Myrdal

- There is a distinction between modernity in West and Asia.
- Modernity comes through 2 ways -> Normative, followed by Instrumental.
 - Normative- Ideas come first
 - Instrumental- Institutes come next.
- But in East only instrumental.
- Nehru- "Modernity in India should be through social institutions"



Louis Dumont's Perspective on Modernity

(Contradicted by Andre Beteille)

Louis Dumont: Cognitive Theory

- India is a classic example of hierarchy, where modernity is not acceptable in absolute form
- Various tradition institutes like Brahmanical supremacy and commitment to task based occupation, social distance between caste stand in the way of modernity
- Distinction between homo hierarchicus and homo equillous.
- India hierarchical.
- Traditional institutes won't let modernity come & make Homo Equillus.

Louis Dumont: Criticised By Andre Beteille

- Change derived by both internal and external motivations.
- Indian culture was never a central culture- different at different places.
- Different dynasty at different places-Jainism and Buddhism introduced at different places.
- Mughal also came, after that Britishers.
- Cultural contradictions at different times led to cultural amendments--> modernity.
- Public and private spheres both were amended.
- So adaptability of people is really high
- Diff. Traditions at different places. People very flexible change both by internal & external motivation.

Y. Singh's Perspective on Modernity

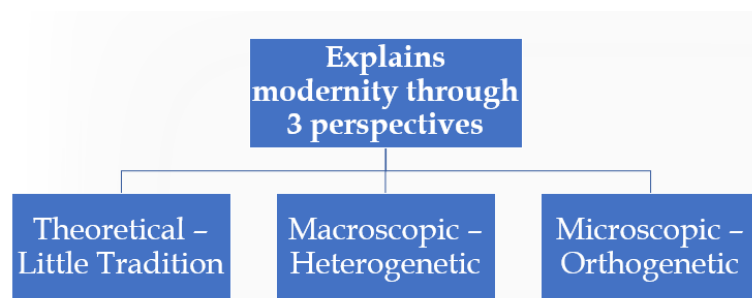
Y Singh

Most famous book- "Modernisation of Indian Tradition"

He contradicts all approaches to modernity on 3 grounds, precision, objectivity and integration (IPO)

Criticises all on

- Precision
- Objectivity
- Integration



MODERNIZATION

SOURCES OF CHANGE	Cultural Structure		Social Structure	
	<i>Little Tradition</i>	<i>Great Tradition</i>	<i>Micro Structure</i>	<i>Macro Structure</i>
HETEROGENETIC CHANGES	Islamisation Primary-Westernisation	Secondary-Islamic Impact Secondary-Westernisation or (modernisation)	Role-Differentiation New Legitimation	Political Innovation New Structures of Elites, Bureaucracy, Industry, etc.
ORTHOGENETIC CHANGES	Sanskritisation or Traditionalisation	Cultural Renaissance	Pattern Recurrence, Compulsive Migration or Population Shift	Elite Circulation, Succession of Kings, Rise and Fall of Cities and Trade Centres

TRADITIONALISATION

Y. Singh's Paradigm - Modernisation of Indian Tradition

Sources of Change	Cultural Structure (Abstractions)		Social Structure (Reality)	
	Little Tradition	Great Tradition	Micro Structure	Macro Structure
Heterogenetic (from outside)	1. Islamisation 2. Westernisation	1. Secondary Islamisation 2. Secondary Westernisation	1. Role differentiation (joint F -> NF -> JF) 2. Castes, subcastes, etc 3. New Legitimisations (village, caste, power)	1. New Political institutions 2. New structures (Bureaucracy, Industry, Elites)
Orthogenetic (from within)	Sanskritisation	Cultural Renaissance (Buddhism, Jainism, Bhakti Movement)	1. Migration 2. Population shift 3. Pattern Recurrence (JF -> NF -> JF)	1. Elite circulation 2. Succession of kings 3. Rise & Fall of cities 4. New Trade Centers

Theories borrowed

Singer's:

- Little tradition and great tradition to explain orthogenetic and heterogenetic changes.
- Buddhism, Jainism, Bhakti etc. introduced changes at the micro level and slowly they expanded to macro level: This process which is from micro sphere to macroscopic changes it is orthogenetic change.

Conflict between 2 Great Traditions

- **Rise of Islam** in India led to **conflict between 2 great traditions**.
- So, **Islam started conversions** to strengthen its little tradition ways.
- But **Hindu people** had great admiration for **Sanskritic ways**, so paradoxically it led to **change of Islam**.

- (Another similar example is of S.E. Asia which witnesses relatively milder type of Islam, it could be due to the influence of Buddhism).

Appearance of Caste in Islam

- Because of 2 Great Traditions in conflict (Hinduism and Islam),
- Islam converses to strengthen its little tradition but got changed as castes developed in Islam.
- It also culminated in separation of 2 nations.

Heterogenetic changes

- With regards to heterogenetic changes he makes a list of changes encountered by Indian society under the influence of modernity.

Heterogenetic changes - PESTL Analysis

From outside sources, affecting macro institutions like in Polity, Economy, etc.

- PESTL modernity leads to **value modernity** (which is individualism, achievement based, rationality, secularism and liberty)
- Y. Singh → **Different people adopting change differently according to their needs.**
- **Different places are impacted differently** by these factors. People adopt to forces to modernity selectively depending on their needs and expertise.

Criticisms of Y Singh

Irfan Ahmad, a political anthropologist in his obituary to Y Singh notes:

- Singh's Modernisation of Indian Tradition (MOIT) integrated the existing frameworks or arguments rather than make its own.
- MOIT has an antagonism toward Islam and Muslims, by treating Muslims as alien to India.
- Using the terms 'orthogenetic' and 'heterogenetic' for internal and external changes respectively, Singh branded Islam as heterogenetic, fixing in the minds of many that Muslims do not belong to India.
- It, thus, casts Islam outside the body politic of India.
- Singh depicts Islam as exclusivist, intolerant and Muslims as 'colonisers and conquerors' (MOIT's 1986 edition p. 25, 60, 63, 64).

Irfan Ahmad further writes that Singh's perspective has impacted and in turn is impacted by similar views, for example:

- **Shyama Charan Dube** in *Indian Society*, published in 1990 (p. 27) describes Muslims as 'Islamic invaders.' He writes six pages to Islamic invasion and not even one page to colonialism by the British who are described as just 'came to India.'
- **Iravati Karve** (1970), regarded as the first woman sociologist of India, also depicted **Muslims as external and inimical** as follows: 'The Mohammedans have been in India for about a thousand years. They created the first breach in the cultural unity of India. ... They have left terror and destruction in their wake' (Racial Problems in India p. 45-46).

- A survey, conducted by **Common Cause and Lokniti-Centre for the Study Developing Societies**, found that **every second Indian police person** thinks Muslims are “naturally prone towards committing crime”.

JPS Oberoi notes that Indian & Western modernities are same.

1. In his book "**European modernity**" - Indian modernity and European modernity comes from the same principles- by **rejecting religion** (Indian modernity does not come selectively).
2. **Dalit movement can be compared with Protestant movement**

Hinderances To Modernisation In India

Y. Singh:

1. Status Quo orientation
2. Caste: Divides during movements (KK Sarkar)
3. Joint Family
4. Orthodoxy, Superstition : Sea travel considered bad
5. Religious belief (Karma Theory)
6. Elites

Post-modernist Thought

Avijit Pathak

- Followed the theory of Habermas
- Modernity is forcing people to follow a
 - Universal pattern of growth- Economic and political
 - Universal pattern of thinking- liberty, freedom
 - And "capability to develop their culture distinctively"
 - E.g. Endogamy getting support from computer revolution, loyalty to family still appreciated global.
- Modernity becoming uniform across the world.
- **Giddens** – High modernity (extreme specialisation even to live daily)

Study Indian Culture in 4 aspects

If these are changing, then modernity can be believed to be happening

- Hierarchy – Gradation of people, according to Age, Caste, Gender.
- Transcendence – Karma, religion etc.
- Holism
- Continuity.

Protests and Movements During the Colonial Period & Social Reforms

Social movements in India not only protest and dissent but also reform and reactionary (like socio-religious and freedom movement).

Causes of Protests And Movements During The Colonial Period

MSA Rao – Underlying cause is Relative Deprivation.

Ghanshyam Shah and TK Oommen – protests are ongoing process of change

In India, significant number of protests during Colonial rule. Due to:

- Policies of expansion
- Exploitation
- Interference
- Land reforms policies causing relative deprivation
- Alienation
- Discontent

Important Protests And Movements During The Colonial Period

Tribal Protests

- | | |
|--|--|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Sanyasi, Santhal• Ho• Khasi• Munda• PagalPanthi etc. | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Indigo• Deccan• Pabna• Champaran• Kheda etc. |
|--|--|

Agrarian Unrests

Characteristics of these protests

- Localised.
- Against local zamindars and landholders.
- Never directly challenged British rule.
- Colonial rule also brought modern education, exposure to the world, rational thinking. Formed the basis for Social Reforms.
- Reformers – RRMR, IC Vidyasagar, Vivekanand etc. causing general awakening of the masses.
- These reforms backbone for transformation of Indian society

Consequences of Protests And Movements During The Colonial Period

- **AR Desai** – without these social reforms rise of freedom movement wouldn't have been possible.
- **Y Singh** – S. Reforms an important role in transforming Traditional India into Modern India.
- **TN Madan** – Social reforms Indianised the modernity.
- **MSA Rao** – compares S. Reform programs to protestant movement for 2 reasons.
 - They restored the cultural pride and confidence
 - It unified the people and exposed the exploitative nature of British rule.

Therefore, protests were the manifestation of the survivalistic needs of the masses.

- MSA Rao adds: Spontaneous protests were supplemented by organized protests at a later date with the emergence of organized leadership.
- These movements encompassed not only economic but also social, political and ideological aspects.
- Eg. – Swadeshi and Boycott movement, home rule league movement, NCM, CDM, culminating into Quit India Movement.

Q. The main objective of socio- religious movement during the colonial rule in India were reforming and synthesizing Hinduism. Write any two such important movements. (2017)

Answer:

- When the British missionaries started spreading Christianity in India, they also started criticizing various social and religious practices prevalent in India.
- The missionaries were attacking Hindu's caste, custom, creed and religious practices and Hindus were suffering from these evils too. The need to reform social and religious life was a commonly shared conviction.
- **Since most of the social practices were influenced by religion, social reform would have no meaning without religious reforms.**
- It was fifty years of English Education that greatly affected the minds of educated Hindus. A new attitude towards religion came up with the superstitious faith in tradition, beliefs and conventions symbolizing the medieval age being replaced by the spirit of inquiry. This spirit of inquiry made them aware of the decay in the Indian society. Some were in favour of going back to the past for remedy, others advocated for western thoughts, while some others for adoption of good of both sides.
- The reformers, taking their stand on reforms on rational lines, claimed to be the leaders of the community.

They occupied the place of the pandits and were convinced that the state of the Hindu society had rotten, that needed great and radical changes and without these changes the whole social fabric stands in danger of giving way and burying the nation down in the debris. They were having remedies: ready, patent and infallible.

- The **revivalists pleading for reform on national lines** opined that any change in social customs and institutions of the community could only be introduced under the shadow of revival.

Some of the important names included:

Raja Rammohan Roy and Keshab Chander Sen singled out idolatry and the worship of multiple gods and goddesses as issues which deserved top priority in any reformist agenda.

Pandit Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar and Behramji M. Malabari committed their lives and personal fortunes to the emancipation of women. Jotirao Phule, E. V. Ramasami Periyar and Bhimrao Ambedkar identified caste as major hurdle to social progress.

Causes That Led To The Need For These Movements:

- The **deplorable condition of women** also agitated the reforming mind of the 19th century.
- **Lack of Education**
- **Position of Women**
- **Ignorance and backwardness** of people in the society
- Extremely **dehumanized and marginalized people**

Hinduism not only responded to this by giving rise to multiple attempts of self reform, primary among which were the Arya Samaj of Dayananda Saraswati, the Brahmo Samaj or Raja Ram Mohan Roy, and the Ramakrishna Mission started by Swami Vivekananda.

Another cry of reformation came from Mahatma Gandhi and his campaign against untouchability. All these movements denounced caste-system and sought to cleanse Hinduism of social-evils in light of the wide-spreading Enlightenment ideas and Christian missionary work

Impact of These Movements On The Indian Society:

- Created socio-religious consciousness among Indians
- The impact of the efforts of these reformers was most evident in the National Movement. A large number of women came out to take part in the freedom struggle.
- The religious reform movements instilled in the minds of Indians greater self-respect, self-confidence and pride in their country. These reform movements helped many Indians to come to terms with the modern world.
- People became more conscious of their identity as Indian. It was ultimately responsible for their united struggle against the British in the freedom movement of India
- These social reform movements arose among all communities of the Indian people. They attacked bigotry, superstition and the hold of the priestly class.
- They worked for abolition of castes and untouchability, purdah system, sati, child marriage, social inequalities and illiteracy.

These reform movements also had certain limitations: -

- It affected a very small percentage of the population, mostly the educated class.

- It could not reach the vast masses of the peasantry and urban poor who continued to live in the same conditions

Discussed below are two such movements:

1. BRAHMO SAMAJ

- It was in the year 1828, a prominent socio religious movement in the name of Brahmo Samaj was founded by Raja Ram Mohan Roy, who is also considered as the "the Father of Modern India."
- He believed that it was only the reforms in religion that could lead to social reforms.
- He always emphasized that all human problems must be solved in human ways.
- The social problems in India were only due to inhuman practices. He condemned religious sanctity attached with social evils.
- It was one of the first attempts of Indian society to reform Hindu society.
- It was the first modern religious reform movement which interpreted the Hindu scriptures and traditions to establish the universality of Hinduism and Brahmo Samaj as the convergence of religions.
- The foundation of Brahmo Samaj led to spread of faith in one-God.
- Brahmo Samaj was an Indian theistic Church open to all irrespective of caste, creed and culture.
- As "One - God Society" it propagated the belief in One God, denounced all forms of idolatry and polytheism.
- It introduced religious and social reforms that promoted unity and tolerance among various religious denominations.
- After Raja Ram Mohan Roy, the important leaders of the movement included Debendranath Tagore (Adi Brahmo Samaj) and Keshub Chunder Sen (Brahmo Samaj of India).
- Today the Samaj is known as 'Sadharan Brahama Samaj'

ARYA SAMAJ

- Swami Dayanand Saraswati founded Arya Samaj in the year 1875 with the aim to reform Hindu religion in north India (The use of Hindi language in which he wrote and preached made his ideas accessible to the people of Northern India).
- He considered Vedas to be infallible and rejected all religious thoughts which were in conflict with the Vedas.
- His aim was to establish a Hindu missionary movement to bring all the Hindus back to the one-fold under the banner of Veda.
- It was a revolutionary social movement showing the falsehood of other religions and the purity and scientific background of the Vedas.
- Arya Samaj condemned idol-worship, animal sacrifices, pilgrimages, caste system, child marriage etc. and claimed to be a universalistic church.
- It fought untouchability and the rigidities of the hereditary caste system and promoted social equality.
- Arya Samaj also had a major role to play in the national movement as it inculcated a spirit of self-respect and self-reliance among the people.
- The role of Arya Samaj was commendable in promoting education among the masses.
- Some of Swami Dayanand's followers later started a network of schools and colleges called D.A.V.

(Dayanand Anglo Vedic) in the country to impart education on western lines without compromising on the Vedic teachings.

- They encouraged teaching of English and modern science along with Sanskrit and Vedic education.
- One of the criticisms of Arya Samaj has been that although it became a success among orthodox Hindus, it did lack a universal vision.

While the religious movement like Brahma Samaj, was an earnest effort to recast Hindu religion into a new form in order to meet the requirements of the new society, all Arya Samaj aimed to do was to revive the love for the nation through its reliance on its past scriptures and glory that was clouded by the western influence.

The common feature that they all shared was the urge to transform the existing social and cultural conditions, ranging from irrational religious practices and rituals to the oppressive state of women's lives

B 1

Rural And Agrarian Social Structure

Syllabus

Rural and Agrarian Social Structure

- A. The idea of Indian village and village studies.
- B. Agrarian social structure - the evolution of land tenure system, land reforms.

A. The idea of Indian village and village studies

Historical Idea of Indian Villages

Since centuries village as a socio-cultural unit.

Their sustainability, exclusivity matter of historical, colonial, social delight.

Mentioned in Vedas as-

- Pur
- Gram
- Van (Jungle)

In Puranic texts – Potential hierarchy.

Also mentioned by Kautilya's Arthashastra that Gram's appointed leader should pay taxes to Pur's king for protection

1. Pur – Elites
2. Gram – Commoners
3. Van – Tribes

Other historical accounts (between 7th and 12th century) talks of different kinds of villages

- One caste One village
- One caste Many villages
- Many castes One village
- Many castes Many villages

Therefore, interlinkage between caste and villages was greatly established.

Subsequently entry of Islam and Christianity made villages multiethnic and multitasked.

Colonial rule – Systematic study started.

Colonial Idea of Indian Village

- People refusing to modernize, white man's burden.
- **Sir Henry Maine** – Indian villages have no historic parallel in west.
- Village self-sufficient, little republics.
- Rulers come and go, villages self-sufficient forever.
- **Metcalf and Munro** – Endorsed this.

B. H. Baden- Powells

Three volumes of The Land System of British India (1892)

Therefore, colonial scholars developed an **ETHNOCENTRIC** (WH Sumner/Eurocentric) understanding of India, that:

- Despite poverty, backwardness, orthodoxy, commitment to classical religion, diseases, natural disasters, people of India refused to change and are, thus, **WHITE MAN'S BURDEN**.

Issues with Colonial Idea of Indian Village

- They discussed village level conflict and regional variations of villages in terms of both structure and culture, the categorical and conceptual thinking about villages **remained fixed on harmony and wholeness**.
- This **directed attention away from internal politics and conflicts** at village level.
- Also, **aspects of inequality, patterns of wealth distribution and divisiveness** remained **unattended**.
- In the later decades of the nineteenth century, we also find **several emerging problems of famine, riots, land alienation and violence** in the rural economy which deeply troubled the colonial masters, **shaking their somewhat simplistic understanding** of village India.

Anti-Colonial Idea of Indian Village

O'Malley and Grigson

Early colonial scholars had a pre-conceived notion about Indian villages, they were not able to observe **vibrant village life**.

Anti-colonialists observed –

- Struggle for power in villages
- How economic conflicts get resolved
- Caste and culture operating to integrate

Karl Marx

- Gave **Asiatic MOP**.
- India has a MoP similar to primitive communism.
- There is common labour and fruit.
- However, one has to pay taxes to kings for protection.

- He believed, political and economical autonomy of India are being **demolished by British land tenure system**.
- Transformation **from classless India to feudal and then finally capitalistic**.

Contemporary Idea of Village

Andre Beteille

- The village was not merely a place where people lived; it had a design in which were reflected the basic values of Indian civilisation.

Gandhiji's Idea of Indian Village

- Though Gandhiji was **careful enough not to glorify the decaying** village of British India, he nevertheless **celebrated the 'assumed' simplicity and authenticity of village life**, as being representative of Indian-ness, an image largely derived from colonial representations of the Indian village.
- For Mahatma Gandhi, **India's soul lived in her villages**.
- He imagined that **every village would be a republic or panchayat, self-sustained** and capable of **managing its own affairs (Gram Swaraj)**.
- He however **also admitted it as being a dream**, hence not practical in reality.
- For **B. R. Ambedkar**, village was '**a cesspool of factionalism and den of inequity**' due to the practices of **caste system**.

General Features of Indian Villages

Indian Village Studies identified certain general features:

- Self-sufficiency busted – Andre Beteille
- Unity present
- Diversity (both inside & outside villages) (SC Dubey)
- Identity (source of identity) (MNS)
- Reciprocity (Jajmani) (W.H. Wiser)

Remember the keyword – **SUDIR**

Village

- Important source of identity to its residents.
- Reciprocity (Interdependence) implied that though village social organization was hierarchical, it was the '**interdependence**' among different caste groups that characterised the underlying spirit of the Indian village.

Social Structure of The Village: Caste

The Caste System

- While **caste** was a **concrete structure** that guided social relationships in the Indian village, **hierarchy** was its ideology.

SC Dube study of Shamirpet village

6 factors that contributed towards the status differentiation in the village community

- Religion and caste
- Landownership
- Wealth
- Position in government service and village organisation (legal rational)
- Age (traditional)
- Distinctive personality traits (charismatic)

Quick Points about SC Dube

- Dube's book **Indian Village**, first published in 1955.
- An attempt in understanding the Indian society through **structural-functional** perspective.
- The nature of study was **interdisciplinary**.
- The study was conducted at the village **Shamirpet**, located at a distance of nearly 25 miles from Hyderabad.
- The village had a population of 2,494 including 340 Muslims and 19 ethnic groups belonging to Hindus.
- The field data were collected from **historical, geographical, political and sociological perspectives** on different aspects of **social, economic and religious practices** of village in India, which reflect **an integrated picture** of the village.

SC Dube - On Village Autonomy

He observes:

"No village in India is completely autonomous and independent, for **it is always one unit in a wider social system** and is a part of an organized political society.

An individual is not the member of a village community alone, he also belongs to a caste, religious group or a tribe with a **wider territorial spread** and comprises several villages.

These **units have their own organization, authority and sanctions.**"

SC Dube on Caste and Inter-caste relations

- All the **castes** are **endogamous**.
- There is a **permanent social distance** between them.

- In general, people on higher level refuse food from those on a lower level.
- **Occupation** of each caste is **monopolized and sanctioned by religion**.
- Dube found that persons belonging to **different castes are united by common values and obligations**.

SC Dube – Interaction between Hindus and Muslims

The **Hindus and the Muslims constitute two distinct groups**, who retain their **own socio-religious identities**.

SC Dube – Women and activities

He observes women in terms of **five activities**:

- i. Domestic work
- ii. Agriculture
- iii. Festivals and ceremonies
- iv. Birth, marriage and death
- v. Village administration and politics.

SC Dubey

The Caste System

- **SC Dubey** found that **Caste homogenized** the culture and the Hindus all over India accepted this classification.

DN Majumdar

The Caste System

- Caste divisions determined and decided **all social relations**.
- Most scholars saw caste as a **closed system**. (caste = closed) ,
- Also, varna $\neq$ caste

MN Srinivas

The Caste System

- At the local level caste was **radically different from** that expressed in the varna scheme.
- **Mutual rank was uncertain** and this stemmed from the fact that **mobility was possible** in caste.
- Attempts to claim a higher ritual status through, what Srinivas called **sanskritisation**, was **not a simple process**.
- It could **not** be achieved **only through rituals** and life-style imitation.
- The **group had to also negotiate** it at the **local power structure**.
- Sanskritisation gave mobility but through **secular** status first then ritual status.
- First, acquire secular status (land, wealth, govt. service) then you'll get ritual status.

Concludingly

The Caste System

- However, a large majority of them viewed **caste system as working within the framework of jajmani** system and bound together different castes living in the village or a cluster of villages in enduring and pervasive relationships.

Social Structure of The Village: Class

Land and Class

- Land relations to them reflected the **same patterns** of hierarchy as those present in the caste system.
- **Srinivas (Twin hierarchy - Land or Higher caste)** - There was a certain amount of **overlap** between the twin hierarchies of caste and land.

Oscar Lewis: Rampur Village

- Primacy of Land
- Underlined the primacy of land over all other factors in determining social hierarchy in the village.

Social Structure of The Village: Gender

Data on Gender

- Village studies were **not** completely “gender blind”.
- Further, accounts of **man-woman relations** provided in these studies were largely based on the data collected from male informants.

Limitation of Researchers’ Gender

- Most of the **anthropologists** themselves **being males**, it would have been difficult for them to be able to meet and participate in the “**private**” life of the village people.

Adrian C. Mayer

- **Importance of Village well**
 - The village well provided a **meeting place** for all women of non-Harijan castes, and the opportunity for gossip.
- **Twin DoL**
 - There existed two bases of division of labour in the village, namely **Caste, Gender**

SC Dube

- After caste, gender was the most **important factor** that governed the division of labour in the village.
- **Masculine and feminine pursuits** were clearly distinguished.

MN Srinivas

- There existed **Gender Differences**
 - Male work is considered more important than Female work
- Male are **controlling Female Sexuality**
- Two sets of **occupations** were not only **separated** but also seen as **unequal**.

- The dominant ‘**male view**’ thought of **women as being ‘incapable of understanding** what went on **outside** the domestic wall.
- **Polygyny** and **concubinage** were both evident (concubinage is cohabitation without being legally married).

Depressing Views of Villages

Not every thinker, sociologist or anthropologist agrees with the general opinion of **village India as an idyllic social reality**.

Dipankar Gupta while writing for EPW in 2005 presents a **Depressing view of villages**.

Hopeless Disenchantment

- “The village is shrinking as a sociological reality, though it still exists as space. Nowhere else does one find the level of **hopeless disenchantment as one does in the rural regions of India**.
- **In urban slums there is squalour**, there is filth and crime, but **there is hope and the excitement** that tomorrow might be quite different from today.
- **Rarely would a villager today want to be a farmer if given an opportunity elsewhere**.
- Indeed, there are few rural institutions that have not been **mauled severely from within**.
- The **joint family is disappearing**, the rural **caste hierarchy is losing its tenacity**, and the much romanticised **harmony of village life is now exposed for the sham** it perhaps always was.

Dr. B.R. Ambedkar

Village a cesspool of degradation, corruption & worse

Dr. B.R. Ambedkar’s Analysis of The Indian Village

- If anything, it is perhaps B.R. Ambedkar’s analysis of the Indian village that strikes the truest of all.
- That **village India was able to carry on in spite of all** this in the past was because there was **little option for most people**, rich or poor outside the confines of the rural space.
- He writes that the village was nothing but **a cesspool of degradation, corruption and worse**.

Why Do Village Studies Now?

Apart from **Industrialisation**, one of the main agenda for the new political regimes was the **transformation** of the “backward” and stagnant agrarian economy.

For **balanced development** it was necessary to know the intricacies of the village life so as to ensure better:

- Planning
- Implementing
- Monitoring

So that **scarce resources** could be put to use judiciously.

Methods Used in Village Studies

Participant Observation

- Use of “**participant observation**”, a method of data collection that anthropologists in the West had developed while doing studies of tribal communities.
- The “participant observation” method was seen as a method that **understood social life from within**, in terms of the values and meanings attributed to it by the people themselves.
- The method of participant observation also **provided continuity** between the earlier tradition of anthropology when it studied the tribal communities and its later preoccupation with the village.

Approaches Used in Village Studies

- MNS: Structural Functionalism
- SC Dubey: Inter disciplinary
- MC Marriot: Culturology
- Andre Beteille : Weberian
- AR Desai, DP Mukjerjee : Marxian

Sociological Approaches To Study Villages

- Village studies in India remained influenced by American Anthropological tradition of **ROBERT REDFIELD** and British Social Anthro tradition of **AR RADCLIFFE BROWN**.

FG Bailey, MSA Rao, Martin Oran studied Caste in different villages.

Andre Beteille – Social Stratification in village Sripuram.

Kathleen Gough – Class Structure in Kumbapeti

FG Bailey – Power and Politics in villages of Orrisa

AM Shah – Family and Kinship Jahanabad Gujarat

TN Madan – Rituals of Kashmiri Pandits

Tulsi Patel – Gender Discrimination

Amita Baviskar - Resistance to governmental policies, changing food habits etc.

IP Desai – Some aspects of family in Mahua, Gujarat

MNREGA -> Jean Dreze, Ritika Khera

New areas: - Effect of Globalization, Reproductive voting Behaviour, Politicisation of caste.

Dipankar Gupta -> Caste in Elections (2000)

Concept -> AJGR, KHAM, MY. (Caste Chemistry)

- **Milton Singer** - Little tradition and Great tradition and **Mckim Marriot** - Universalisation and parochialisation show **interlinkage of the village with the larger social world**.
- They say that **culture and civilization are not in contest** in India like in Europe.
- Therefore, they coin the term **INDIANISATION OF MODERNISATION**.
- **Willian Wiser** - American Sociologist - Elasticity in Jajmani reln.
- **AM Shah and MN Srinivas** - Challenged self-sufficiency using empirical data.

Village Studies

Indological Perspective (Textual)

- GS Ghurye (Attributionist) → Attributer of caste, Dynamism of caste, Kinship, etc.
- Louis Dumont - Structuralist
- KM Kapadia → Family, Marriage, Kinship
- Irawati Karve → Kinship system

Anthropological (Field view)

- MN Srinivas → Structural Functional
- Mckim Marriot → Culturology (emphasised Rural - Urban Continuum)
- Andre Beteille → Weberian (Rural Power Structure) (Stratification)
- SC Dubey → Inter-Disciplinary (Multi - tradition for Social change)

Important studies

Pro-village Studies

- SC Dube - Indian Village
- MNS - India's Villages
- Mckim Marriot - Village India

Can India be studied using village studies?

Shortcoming of Village Studies

Criticism of Village Studies

- **Upper caste hindered Andre Beteille's** interaction with lower caste
- **Gender hindered Lila Dubey**
- Louis Dumont - criticized MN Srinivas for studying both caste and village.
- Village studies overshadow the primary source of inequality which is CASTE.

- Andre Beteille says that village studies help know the truth without personal bias.
- **Y Singh** – studied 6 villages in UP – **studying history of change is necessary** to understand reality comprehensively.
- Village studies are **Incomplete** in themselves.

Marxists urge us to Study Urban Centres:

- **AR Desai** – Village study take you **away from the empirical truth** of socio-economic **genesis**.
- **RK Mukherjee** – Village is **land of small farmers, petty traders, wage labourers** who are exploited by feuds (and bourgeois) living in urban centres, so it is important to study urban areas.

New Dimensions of Village Studies

- Social Movements
- Social Dynamics
- Political Dynamics
- Gender profile
- Demographic studies etc.
- Voting Behaviour
- Impact of social scheme
- PRI

Some Data on Villages

- 2021 data says that rural India has around **65 per cent** of total population.
- For the first time since independence, 2011 census found out that **the absolute increase in population is more in urban areas than in rural areas**.
- **2011 Census**: The growth rate of population in rural areas of **Empowered Action Group (EAG)** States is nearly three times that in rural areas in non EAG states.
- It is for the first time that **significant fall of growth rate is seen in the rural areas of EAG states**.
- **EAG states**: Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Bihar, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh and Orissa.

Some important take aways from some important Village Studies

Sociological Approaches to Study Villages

- i) **S.C. Dube's Indian Village** (1955) was the **first full length study** of a village, Shamirpet. It devoted one full chapter to the nature of changes coming in rural life which include **increasing economic ties with the city** of Hyderabad, even for social groups like the washerman.
- ii) **McKim Marriot** in the study of **Kishan Garhi in Aligarh district** of Uttar Pradesh (1955) gives an elaborate description of **interaction between the people of different villages**.

He talks about how castes of Brahman priests, barbers, potters, carpenters, washermen and sweepers who live in Kishan Garhi go out to **serve hereditary patrons (Jajmans)** in some fifteen other villages and **derive**

about one half of their income from these outside patrons. Traders, wage workers living in Kishan Garhi regularly traveled many miles Village India of the country side to other areas.

- iii) **M.N. Srinivas** in his study of village **Rampura in Karnataka** (1955) observes how **World War-II brought increased cash for the dominant** landowning **Okkaliga** caste with wartime rationing and shortages, which **encouraged black marketeering**. The profits of the wartime were used in different ways, as village was electrified, two rice mills were set up, bus lines were also started which made contact with Mysore City much easier.
- iv) **Kathleen Gough's study of Kumbapettai village** (1955), situated in the Tanjore district of Tamil Nadu, describes **how dominant Brahmin groups migrated to towns for education** and employment and the **immigration in Kumbapettai of lower castes** from the neighbouring and less fertile areas was responsible for Kumbapettai coming in **contact with the wider economic system**.
- v) **M.S.A. Rao in his study of Yadavpur** (1974), a village situated on the fringe of **Delhi**, observed that **growth of the city of Delhi created diverse opportunities** of urban employment in sectors like **gardening, dairy and poultry farming, trading, transport, etc.**

B. Agrarian social structure - evolution of land tenure system, land reforms.

Land Tenure System - What is It?

- It identifies the ownership of land
- It identifies the relationship of the owner with the cultivator.
- Terms and conditions under which land is land is leased to the tiller.

Land Tenure System

Vedic Period

- State ownership limited
- Common ownership of land

Land Tenure System

During Muslim Period

- Assessment of land revenue became more systemized and standardized.

Land Tenure System

During British Period

System of assessment and collection varied according to states and administrative convenience.

It elaborated:

- Who is the owner?
- Relation of the owner and the cultivator
- Terms and conditions

3 Mains Systems Used by British

Ryotwari System

Important Points to Remember:

- Independent single tenure.
- Started by Sir Thomas Munroe, 1820, Madras.
- Occupant is tenant of state (state is owner of all land).
- For 20-30 years.
- Revenue as rent and not tax.
- Eviction in case of non-payment.
- Seen in Assam, TN, MP, Gujarat, Maharashtra.

Mahalwari System

- Joint village ownership.
- Villages known as Mahals.
- Co-sharer selected to take liability on 5% commission.
- For 30-40 years.

Zamindari System

Also known as Permanent Settlement System

- Importance of landlords/intermediaries.
- Outcome of permanent settlement established by Lord Cornwallis in Bihar in 1793.

Why – British reluctance to deal directly with the peasants, also wanting to create a force of loyalists in the form of Zamindars.

Who – Zamindars to be Revenue collecting officers (they were not owners)?

Real proprietors became tenants.

State to get 10/11 of rent.

Zamindars further leased out (outsourced).

Long chain of middle-men.

What is a Peasant Society?

Peasant Society

Daniel Thorner:

Peasant = Kisan

Robert Redfield:

Peasant Society – “Peasant society and culture”, 1956.

3 Important Features of Peasant Culture

- Highly **reverent** attitude towards land.
- **Agriculture** as noble, ideal, best job.
- Industrious attitude, dignity to labour.

Other distinct Features of Peasant Society

- Family primary unit of social orgn (generally Joint, whole family works).
- Land main source of livelihood.
- Distinct culture and **daily schedule** (than landed aristocracy).

Remember the Following

Always remember the following about the Peasant Society:

- Peasant culture is of **obedience** and **subordination**.
- Peasant in de-facto **possession of land but not owner**. Aristocracy politically awakened and denies peasantry its rights.

Sorokin – Rate of **social mobility** in peasant society is relatively **poor**.

AR Desai – **Indian National Movement** started as a peasant movement. **Jajmani** a crucial feature of peasant society.

Orthodox & Traditional Peasantry

- Production for self-sustenance only.
- Land sacred.
- Not willing to migrate.
- Belief in old techniques.
- Economically poor.
- Low standard of living.
- Highly influenced by traditions and keep passing it.
- Religion important.
- Superstitious and blind faith in religious texts.

Peasant society is thus an agri-based tradational society with highly reverent attitude towards land.

Land Reforms and Their Social Consequences

Land Reforms

- Major policy for **rural development** designed to **break old feudal socio-economic structure** of rural India.
- Impetus to **modernization** of Agri **production** and **productivity**.

Objectives of Land Reforms

Always remember the **4Es**:

- **Equality**
- **Efficiency**
- **Effectiveness**
- **Economy**

Stated Objectives of Land Reforms

- Improving distribution of **ownership**
- Agri **modernization**
- Modernising **irrigation**
- **HYV** seeds, **pesticides**, **fertilizers**, etc
- Improving **land use**
- Abolition of **intermediaries**
- **Tenancy** reforms
 - Fixity of tenure
 - Rent regularization
 - Ownership rights
- Land **ceilings**
- Agrarian **reorganisation**
- **Co-operativisation** of agriculture

Consequences of Land Reforms – In Numbers

- Because of abolition of intermediaries, 20 million tenants direct contact with state.
- 6 million hectare of fallow land distributed to landless and marginals
- 7.7 million tenants given ownership rights
- **Shift** in the **occupation of the lower cates**.
- **Decline** in **migration**.
- Generation of conflict due to legislation.
- **Naxalism** – Bihar, UP.

- **Labour Movement** – Andhra Pradesh.
- Eviction of landless **labourers**.
- **Shortage of manual labour** at the time of sowing and harvesting in Pb and Haryana.
- Increase in **absentee landlordism**.
- These land related policies **did not touch adversities of tribal**.
- Agrarian movements **used in politics and terrorism**.

Let's also try using FMCG RCR

- **Family** → Nuclearised to evade LR.
- **Marriage** → Increase in conspicuous income.
- **Class** → Poor tenants, Landless labourers couldn't benefit.
- **Gender** → Female infanticide. Dowry
- **Rural-Urban** → Migration checked urban untouched.
- **Caste** → Class based stratification rose from caste-based stratification leading to rise in conflicts, even Naxalism.

More Points:

- Alienation → checked of lower castes.
- Work → changed
- Mobility → increased.
- Tribal → Unchecked.

Uneven Impact of Land Reforms

- LR depended upon the size of holdings.
 - It elevated richer tenants.
 - But broadened the base of proprietary classes, which now had landlords and rich farmers.

How Land Reforms Helped Richer Tenants

- **Zamindars were to be given compensation** by the tenants before they could secure the ownership rights. This was the most basic and the biggest limitation of the policy.
- **Only rich tenants could pay**. Poorer forced to borrow or denied ownership.
- At the same time, they **lost tenurial security**, became “non-owning proletariat” with increased insecurity, obligations and subordination.

Emerging Trends In Post-independent India

By PC Joshi:

- Decline of feudalistic and customary tenancy.

- It was replaced by more insecure and exploitative lease arrangement.
- Increased importance of commercial tenancy.
- Rise of owner-farmers.

Emergence of Commercial Peasants

2 Important Socio-economic Consequences:

- **Increased the production and productivity** of agriculture.
- Accentuated **class conflicts** in villages.

Globalisation And Indian Farmers

Dr. K Somasekhara

- Post WTO Period** – Indian farmers will find it difficult to face global agricultural competitiveness. World Trade will become oligopolistic.
- Increased cost of production will lead to decreased returns.**
- Development not Gender Neutral** because women have lower access to credit and have lower wages.
- Decrease in welfare** oriented activities.

Why High Rate of Farmer Suicides In Recent Times

a) P Sainath

- Ecological Crisis + Economic Crisis + Social Crisis
- (HYV Seeds, (Indebtedness) (Suicide) Chemicals)

b) **Vandana Shiva + Utsa Patnaik**

Negative growth of agriculture in recent past

+

Outcome of liberalization

+

Neo-Colonialism

c) **Deshpande & Nagesh** – Debt Trap

d) **State Sponsored** – Because of poor regulations leading to:

- Spurious pesticides
- Incessant floods
- Manipulation by traders
- Long chain of middlemen eating into profits of farmers, etc.

e) **Arvind Kumar**

- Punjab Farmer Suicide – Because of corporate farming
- Recent cases of *Arhtiya Suicides* in Punjab, owing to ill financial health of Punjabi farmers.

B 2

Caste System

Syllabus

Caste System

- Perspectives on the study of caste systems:
 - GS Ghurye, M N Srinivas, Louis Dumont, Andre Beteille.
- Features of caste system.
- Untouchability - forms and perspectives.

Caste in Contemporary Rural India

By G K Karanth

Village Studies are Out of Fashion?

He said **village studies** where social institutions like family caste kinship system were studied are **now out of fashion**.

Reason:

These institutions are **undergoing considerable changes** as a consequence of

- **Urbanization**
- **Industrialization**
- **Democratization**
- **Spread of education**
- **New Administrative policies**, etc.

further accelerates this dissociation.

Important Consequence of the Change

Consequence:

A decline of sociological interest in the institutions themselves.

Need:

To examine the impact of various programmes of change and development on the institution of caste in rural India.

One Significant Change

There is a growing **dissociation of Caste with hereditary occupation**.

This change is due to several factors and no single factor can be held solely responsible for this change.

Two major institutions which lost their importance:

1. **Caste panchayat** which in the past functioned as quasi-judicial institution
2. **Jajmani** system

Urban employment has become an indicator of **social status**.

Why Untouchability still persists

Role of Dominant Caste

Members of '**Untouchables**' (members of **Madiga** or **Holey** castes in rural Karnataka) **found difficult to move away from their traditional occupation**.

Though **law is against this work** but still **dominant caste** brings **economic and other pressures** on the dependent castes to **ensure the continuity** of master-servant relation.

Role of Government

- For the **implementation of welfare schemes**, government officials ask the people of dominant castes to identify the beneficiaries of lower castes.
- It enhances the role of dominant castes.

Lack of Resources

Low castes do not have enough **resources** and **opportunities** to get into new jobs hence **difficult for them to get dissociated** from traditional jobs.

Why Sanskritisation didn't work

Low castes had **tried to Sanskritize** their customs and lifestyles to improve their ranks in the hierarchy.

This they did by:

- **Naming** children
- Names of **Gods**
- **Puja** rooms

Since **Sanskritization is emulation** of customs and rituals of higher castes.

Lower castes were forbidden from such emulation of higher castes and the **leaders of dominant castes had the power to prevent it**.

De-Sanskritization

- Claiming higher status through **Sanskritization is not the only process active** in rural India.
- There is also **acute competition among castes to claim 'backward' status** as it leads to **benefits of protective discrimination**.
- Same castes often claim to be '**high**' in a **traditional context** and '**backward**' in a '**modern**' context.
- **Post-Independence policies** of protective discrimination, land reforms and other welfare measures have **not significantly changed the relative status of the very low castes**.

- Social mobility more for individuals than for groups.
- Secular factors (power & wealth) are becoming **increasingly important** in the evaluation of caste status.
- Also, under the **influence of electronic media**, there is a widespread **increase in secular and modern values**.

Why Low Castes find it difficult to increase their rural status

Upper castes retain their rural base even after migration.

Low Castes find it difficult due to:

1. Socio, economic factors.
2. Relatively emancipated status in cities, making them **reluctant to go to villages**.

Any such attempt by low castes result into **inter-caste violence** as in Bihar and Andhra.

But Upper Caste is getting Displaced

While Low castes have not been able to substantially improve their social status, **those at the top have not been able to retain** their position.

Reasons:

- Erosion of their (upper castes) **ritual importance**
- Simultaneous increase in **status of lower castes due to Sanskritization**

Changing notions of Purity & Pollution

- Higher castes were prohibited from accepting cooked food and drinking water from the lower; lower prohibited from entering the inner portions of the houses of upper caste people.
- But some attitudinal changes are there.
- Several members of higher castes show their interest to eat food served by lower castes.
- More pronounced in younger people.
- During field study in Rajapura, several members of lower castes (Holey and Madiga) fetching liquor to their dominant Okkaliga patrons, a significant change.

Dual Culture

- These **patterns of behaviour** may be described as a manifestations of 'dual culture', that is, an adherence to traditional values in one context and modern, egalitarian ones in another (Srinivas 1977).
- Governing principle behind such a dual culture is a deliberate 'situation specific' behavioural decision on the part of individuals.

Diffusion of Cultures

- Nowadays, it is not only the higher castes who observe pollution for a certain number of days at birth, death, menstruation etc. but also lower castes.
- Lower castes invite a high caste priest to perform a purificatory rite on the birth of a calf in the house.

- Agriculture labourers from the lower castes are at best allowed entry into the outer areas but not to the inner, more private and 'pure' areas.

Caste Endogamy

- It is related to the notion of **purity and pollution**.
- The norm of **caste endogamy has withstood change** (Kolenda 1978).
- In large parts of **northern India, village exogamy continues** to be the rule for many castes.
- Now **Rural society is becoming more tolerant of inter-caste marriages**

Changing Hypergamy

- **Hypergamy**, the custom of women marrying men from a higher caste or a higher grade within the same caste, is **disappearing** among such castes as Bengali Brahmins, the Nayars of Kerala and the Rajputs in Rajasthan.
- Its decline may be attributed to a widening structural gulf between different different castes and social and economic changes within the concerned castes.
- Nowadays sub-caste barriers are being crossed, particularly by urbanised and educated elite in each caste.

Modern Weddings

- **Guests** come from a **variety of castes**, and they **all sit together for the meal**, caste distinctions are usually ignored.
- Rules of purity and impurity are relaxed.
- The institution of **dowry has spread to all castes**, **earlier** it was characteristic of **South India** during pre-British days (Srinivas 1989).
- Urban employed youth attract higher sums of dowry than others.

Dominant Caste

- It is possible for a caste to be numerically insignificant but economically or politically powerful, and therefore a 'dominant' caste.
 - Bengalis in Orissa, Marwaris in Southern Indian towns and cities.
- It is **not always necessary for a caste to have all the attributes of dominance** as defined in the concept but **one or two are enough** to ensure a modicum of dominance.
- **When all the attributes are present** in a single caste then we have its '**decisive dominance**'.
- **Dominant castes are factional-ridden** and therefore it is **wrong to regard them as unitary** entities.
- It **may not be appropriate any more to refer to caste** in rural India as a '**system**'. Castes **exist as individual groups**.
- **Castes are in competition** with other for the access to material resources, education and share in political power.
- Since Independence, there has been **increase in violence against SC/STs by higher castes**.

Net Result: Reduced vulnerability of the dalits as compared with the situation before Independence due to Universal adult franchise, greater political awareness, employment, mobility.

The Political Economy of Caste

By M.N. Panini

Importance of The Political Economy of Caste

- Perspective of **Political economy** is **distinct** from the political sociology as former is in order to **grasp the changing role and significance of caste** in independent India.
- **Economic liberalization** may in the long run dissolve caste-based distinctions, it is pointed out that in the **short run it may exacerbate inter-caste conflicts and sharpen caste identities**.
- **Caste** continues to be a **salient category in the social infrastructure** of the **economy**.

Occupations without Caste Considerations

- **Sociologists** have now **effectively challenged** the stereotype about the **caste system being a closed and rigid** system not allowing individuals to give up their hereditary occupation and take up new occupations.
- **Ghurye**, has **highlighted the inherent flexibilities** in the system.
- He **highlighted** that tasks such as **cultivation, administration and military** services were **open to all** castes.

Continuity and Change of Caste in Economy

- After **Independence** due to various **schemes** in **favour of SC/STs**, **occupational mobility** across caste boundaries gained momentum.
- **Andre Beteille (1965)**, in an early study of a village in Tamil Nadu, **showed that caste, class and power have now become differentiated axes of stratification** and that **the caste status of an individual no longer determines his position in the class or power hierarchy**.
- Thus, **caste status no longer inhibits** individuals from taking to new occupations.
- **Despite such evidence** of occupational diversification, **caste is an important unit of the rural economy**.

Caste Clustering in Occupations

- Though the composition of land ownership has become heterogenous in terms of caste, upper and middle castes are preponderant in this category.
- Similarly, data on agricultural labour households demonstrates the preponderance of castes specializing in low and menial occupations.
- Thus, though rural occupations have now been freed of caste restrictions, there is a marked tendency for certain castes to cluster in particular occupations.
- In urban-industrial milieu, significance of caste is considerably diluted, because achievement rather than ascription is expected to be the dominant criterion.
- **J.P.Singh** : Found that **Brahmins** continue to dominate at the **highest offices** such as President, PM, Governors.

- **Navlakha (1989)** : Highlighted the **concentration of upper and middle castes in the modern professions** as well.
- Most of **industrial entrepreneurs** are from **trading** and **business castes** and communities.
- **Caste clustering** is also noted in **higher education** in engineering, business management.
- **Lambert (1963) - Study of Poona factories, Sheth (1968)** : Also noted **caste clustering** in **workforce** of 'organised' as well as 'unorganised' sectors.
- **Joshi (1981)** notes that **workers from particular castes dominated in** particular textile mills.

Reason:

- Under the **impact of colonialism** certain castes because of their **skills** and **resources** found themselves in vantage positions to exploit economic opportunities that were opened up while others were at disadvantage (this thesis has been supported by **Bailey, Saberwal, Gail Omvedt**).

Role of PSUs in Caste Clustering

- **Holmstrom (1976)** points out that **politicians, influential labour leaders** and managers are approached by job-seekers in the public sector units (PSUs).
- Thus, **even Public sector corporations indirectly reinforce** the social and economic significance of caste and kinship.

Role of Law in Caste Clustering

- Caste Clustering is partly due to **economic controls and regulations** that socialist planning entailed. Such as:
 - Company Law 1956
 - Industries Act 1951
 - Monopolies and Restrictive Trade Practices Act 1969
 - Foreign Exchange Regulation Act 1973
- Some of these laws have been **amended** or **discarded** but their impact on caste clustering is noticeable.
- This can be understood as **factory owners need trustworthy managers** to find their **ways around these tough laws** and, thus, **preferred to reserve critical control positions in the firm with members** of the family and to recruit managers using ties of caste and kinship.

Impact of rise of Middle Class on Caste

Rise in Middle Class?

- One major **social consequence** of a **socialist strategy** of development is the formation of a **sizeable modern middle class**.
- There are **indications** that the pace of the **formation of the middle class has gathered momentum** after Independence.
- Middle class is growing both in **absolute and relative terms**.
- The path of **upward mobility for many peasant** groups was opened by **agricultural prosperity** in the wake of **land reforms and GR, reservation policy**.

- Hence, **middle class now a heterogenous social category**; mainly the **creation of the government**.

Features of a Heterogenous Middle Class

Social heterogeneity makes it **difficult** to speak of a **unique middle-class culture**:

- **Secularization** - Secular criteria for judging success.
- **Inter caste commensality**
- Inter-caste and inter-religious **marriages**.

I.P. Desai: In Gujarat **caste divisions are becoming secular** and **caste patriotism** is on decline. There is an increasing **stress on education**.

Srinivas: Noted **new status of parents of NRI children**.

Strong tendency among members of **middle class to seek the help** of gurus who they believe have **supernatural powers**.

Lifestyle of middle class has become become a **model for emulation** for industrial workers, rural peasants, lower castes.

Impact of Reservation

- In Tamil Nadu, some of the **more advanced backward castes** have been able to **corner most of the jobs and seats** reserved for the backward classes.
- In Karnataka, **Havanur Commission** on backward classes **recommended separate quotas** for 'backward tribes', 'backward castes' and 'backward communities'.

Caste Continues - Mandal Protests

- Protests during **Mandal Commission** **demonstrates** that **even educated members of the upper castes cannot shed their caste prejudices**.
- Thereby, proving the position of Mandal supporters that **caste continues to be a basic feature** of the Indian social reality even among the educated sections of urban society.

Mandal Protests and Liberalisation

- It is not surprising that the proponents of '**Mandalisation**' initially **opposed liberalisation** of the economy as Liberalisation would mean **more private sector and less reservation**.
- Or, in the **long run liberalization** has the potential of '**annihilating caste**' and **abolishing poverty**, goals which are shared by many socialist thinkers.
- Thus, **Liberalization not the backward class movement (Omvedt)**, represents the **march towards a 'bourgeoisie revolution'** which presents the **only possibility of 'annihilating caste'** as Ambedkar envisaged.

Perspectives on the study of Caste Systems

Views of GS Ghurye

Book: Caste & Race in India.

Historical, comparative & Integrative aspects of caste

Approach – Ethnographic, Indological & statistical

Subscribed to “Race Theory of caste” partially (by Risley).

Caste may have racial origins but regional variations.

Origin of Caste

- Aryans racially distinct from native Tribes.
- Attempt to maintain distinctness & superiority.
- Practiced **endogamy**, rituals.
- **Perpetuated** by writing texts.

Differentiation

- **Compared** races in different parts of country.
- Found **intermixing**.
- Racial purity only in north.

Features of Caste

- Segmental division of society
- Civil & Religious disabilities
- Privileges
- Commensality Restrictions
- Marriage restrictions
- Hierarchy

(SHOPCM)

Perspectives On Untouchability

- Brahminical superiority given by **texts** written by Aryans.
- Brahmins subjected Non-Aryans and they became Untouchables.

Future of Caste

- Caste associations will give rise to **Political consciousness**.
- **Competition & conflict** between castes will **undermine national integrity**.
- Caste associations should be there for furtherance of **education & reforms**.

Criticisms

1. Andre Beteille - Refutes racial genesis
2. Rajni Kothari - Caste associations doing more good than bad.
3. Gail Omvedt - GSG did not study protests in caste.
4. Armed chair theorists
5. Brahminical P.O.V.

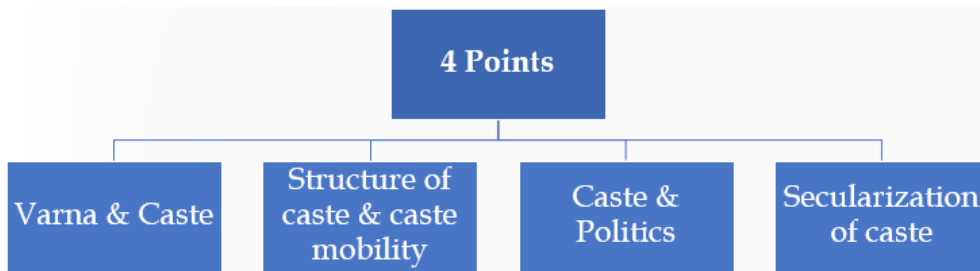
Views of M.N. Srinivas

M.N. Srinivas

View - Field view, Structural Functionalist

Books

1. Caste among India & other Essays
2. Society & Relation among the Coorgs of Mysore.



Varna & Caste

India to be studied from caste perspective, not Varna.

Earlier view: Caste outcome of Race or varna

Srinivas' view: Rigveda itself not sure if:

- Varna = colour or Varna = occupation

But **Purusukta** talks of 4 varnas.

Also, there has been a lot of **inter-mixing of Color & occupation.**

Therefore, **Varnas give a distorted image** of Indian society.

Also, **Varna used as a readymade model** of caste Indian Soc. which is Hierarchical (Western is Stratified)

Different castes at different Places understood uniformly because of varnas. Gave **Regional Interlinkage.**

Therefore, **Varna some form of functional inter-linkages.**

Also, it is important to note that the **inequality is not necessarily permanent.** Because of Sanskritisation:

- Raj Gonds became Kshatriyas.
- Chauhan became Rajputs
- Yadavs became Vanshi Kshatriyas, etc

Also, because of **Bhakti Movement**, various **Brahmins** came up.

Therefore, **Caste under different influences gives mobility.**

Thus, **India to be studied from caste perspective & not varna.**

Structure of Caste & Caste Mobility

Caste has 2 Compartments:

1. Ritual Structure

- Pollution & Purity
- Diety worship
- Language spoken
- Food habit
- Mannerism

2. Secular Structure

- Access to Power
- Wealth
- Education

Earlier, there was primacy of **ritual criteria**.

Now, **secular** dominates.

He quotes **Mckimm Marriot's Kishangarhi Village Study**, where **status comes from both** (Universalization & Parochialisation).

Also, there are examples showing Wealth & Power lead to Sanskritisation. Such as:

MSA Rao: Yadavs of UP

AM Shah: Kunbi, Gujarat

SC Dube: Rajgonds of M.P.

Thus, **Ritual mobility not Possible without Secular** mobility.

Also, it is important to keep in mind that **with Caste mobility an entire Group moves**, with **Class mobility an Individual moves**.

Oscar Lewis : Class mobility leading to ineq within caste.

Adrian Mayer (Multiple Dominations) : Study of Ramkheri Village

- **Jats** : Economic Dominance
- **Rajputs**: Political
- **Brahmins**: Ritual

MN Srinivas: Caste mobility a historical phenomenon, accelerated by modernity.

Caste Dynamic Should be studied empirically.

Contradicts Louis Dumont on Pollution & Purity

Pollution & Purity has 2 Types:

- Individual
- Corporate

Sanskritisation way out of Polluting activities.

MN Srinivas **contradicts Indologists** : Caste not Varna.

Contradicts Louis Dumont: Caste not holy cow that can't be discussed and altered.

MN Srinivas on Caste & Politics

By 1970s in South India

Lower & Middle castes consolidated because of:

1. Land Reforms
2. Decentralised Political System

What is a Dominant Caste?

1. Numbers
2. High ritual status
3. Eco Standing
4. Capacity to articulate caste consciousness
5. Modern Education
6. Land
7. Quasi – organized Political Power
8. Marathas, Lingayats, Jats, Rajputs, Reddys, Yadav.
9. Therefore, Caste not only dividing but also unifying.

Some Broader Perspectives

Micro-Structure

- **Caste as Caste:** Because of mobility in caste & not in Varna.

Macro-Structure

- **Caste as Varna:** Unifies to gain numbers. Because of numbers based politics.

Reservation

- **To untouchables & tribes not to OBCs:** This is politics of caste. Politics of Reservation Over Powering Sociology of Reservation.

Secularization of Caste

Book: Caste & its 20th century Avatar

- Caste driven by Fission & Fusion
- Karnataka: Lingayats + Vokkalingas combined overthrew Brahmin rule
- U.P.: Dalit + OBC

Caste is still divided too.

- 1993 Maharashtra Coalition broke.

Therefore, **only interest-based integration.**

No integration of hearts.

Final Comments

- He **Rejects Modernists** who claim that caste is going to die.
- He **Rejects Marxists** who claim that class is replacing caste.

Stratification of India much more complex than west.

Criticism of MN Srinivas

1. **Ghanshyam Shah** – Dominant caste is nothing but class mobilization.
2. **Yogesh Atal** – Dominant Castes has different meanings at different levels.
 - Village Level → family dominates
 - State Level → Caste
 - Nation → Different Dominant Castes
3. **T.K. Oommen** – Caste a power reservoir operated by caste leaders, where Dalits though great in numbers are powerless individually.
4. **Y. Singh** – A very microscopic view to form Generalization.
5. **Anand Chakraborty** – Power factions not considered by MN Srinivas.

Views of Louis Dumont

Louis Dumont

His understanding of caste lays **emphasis on attributes of caste.**

That is why, he is put in the category of those following the **attributional approach** to the caste system.

For him, **Caste is** a set of **relationships of:**

- Economic
- Political
- Kinship systems
- Sustained by certain 'values'

- Which are mostly religious in nature.

Dumont says that **caste is not a form of stratification** but a **special form of inequality**.

Whose **essence has to be deciphered by** the sociologists.

Ideal type theory from Structural perspective using **Indology**.

Book:

Homo Hierarchicus: The Caste System and Its Implications (1966, 1970).

Caste is explained by:

- **Hierarchy**
- **Pollution & purity**

Dumont starts with Bougle's definition of Caste

Dumont says that Bougle's definition divides the whole Indian society into a larger number of hereditary groups distinguished from one another and connected together by three characteristics:

- a) **Separation** on the basis of **rules** of the caste in matters of **marriage** and **contact**, whether direct or indirect (**food**).
- b) **Interdependent** of work or division of labour, each group having, in theory or **by tradition**, a profession from which their members can depart only within certain limits.
- c) **Gradation of Status** or hierarchy, which ranks the groups as relatively superior or inferior to one another.

Some more views of Louis Dumont

Bailey's Politico-economic theory is wrong

Caste can't be compared with west's class.

Caste is unique to India.

- West "**Homo aequalis**", mobility possible, class society.
- India - **Homo Hierarchicus**. Mobility not Possible. Caste society.
- **Caste** focused on **maintenance of inequalities**.
- India fundamentally different from West.
- He uses the framework of "**Being Encompassed**" & "**Encompassing**" as purity "encompassed" impurity.

Hindu Ideology is of Mutual separation of Pure & Impure

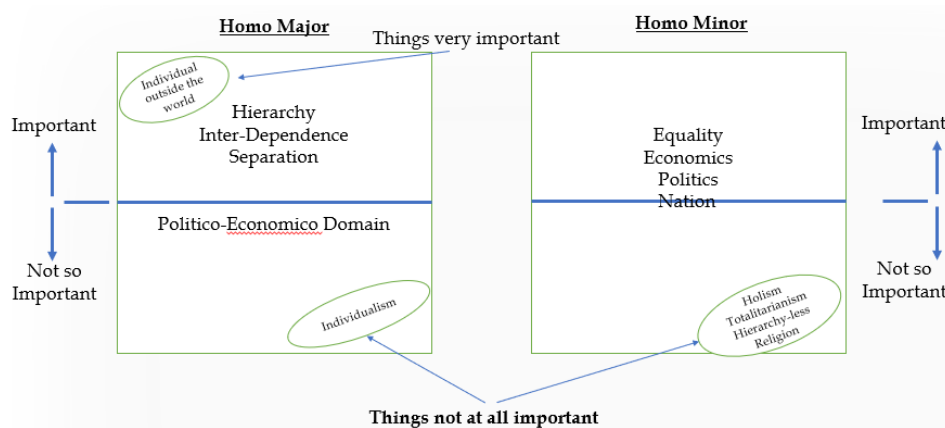
- **Upper caste closes its boundary** to lower.
- It **refuses** them **commensality, inter-marriage, physical** contact.
- However, not only **mutual separation** but also **mutual inter-dependence**.
- **Lower caste absorbs the pollution of the upper** to enable **them maintain purity**.

Relation of Power & Status

- In **west** they are **together**.

- In India – Not always.
 - Example: **Brahmin** could be economically poor but high status.
- In India, **Status** is superior to **Power**.
- In India, **Status** independent of **Power**.

Prof. SK Chaudhary – Paradigm to Understand Louis Dumont



Berreman (2001):

Critically seeing four facets of Dumont's argument

Fundamental disparity between 'traditional' or 'modern' societies

- The assumption that there is a **clear and consistent, universal and fundamental disparity between what the author terms 'traditional' or 'simpler' societies** (e.g., Indian), and 'modern' ones (e.g., French, British).
- Dumont finds '**traditional**' societies to be characterized by conception of the collective nature of man, by the primacy of social rather than individual goals, and thus by 'hierarchy' (by which he means ritual hierarchy, based on the purity/pollution opposition).
- 'Modern' societies are characterized contrastively by individualism and hence by egalitarianism (the antithesis of hierarchy).

Power-Status Opposition

- The notion that **power and economic and political factors are distinct** from and epiphenomenal to caste.
- And that **ritual hierarchy is the central fact of caste, independent of power**.
- Berreman asserts that the **power status opposition is a false dichotomy** in the context of caste.
- The two are **inseparable**.

Caste occurs only in India

- The notion that **caste occurs only in India and is not subject to cross-cultural comparison**.

- The theoretically **weakest part** of the book is where Dumont discusses and dismisses the notion of cross-cultural comparisons of caste organization.

Source of Dumont's Knowledge

- The **limited biased**, albeit scholarly, **sources** of evidence upon which the arguments are based.
- Dumont relies heavily on **some classical Sanskrit** texts while **ignoring others**.

Some more points of Criticism

Dumont can be criticized Empirically, Logically, Ideologically

- 1) Derived from **classical texts** – **Ignores empiric reality**.
- 2) **Gerald Berreman** – **Power & status, 2 sides of the same coin**.
 - **Gonds**, a tribal group because of land became RajGonds.
- 3) **Berreman** – **Brahminical** Point of View which is **artificial, stiff, idealized & stereotypical**.
- 4) **Dipankar Gupta** – Caste Obeyed because of power.
- 5) **Joan Mencher** - Conducted fieldwork in TN, established caste as exploitative.
- 6) **False dichotomy** of Traditional & Modern societies.
- 7) **Individual's** given **no importance**.
- 8) **No acknowledgement of social movements** because of exploitation of caste.

However, Dumont's concept of **P&P explained structuration of culture**.

Views of Andre Beteille

Views On Caste

Book - "Caste, Class & Power"

Caste is:

- **Reflexive**
- **Diffusive** (Not as a structural organization)
- **Variable** explanation to caste

Committed to **Weberian idea** that caste to be studied **historically & empirically** than as good or bad.

Village Study

Sripuram Village, Tanjore, Tamil Nadu

There are variable dimensions of Stratification In Villages:

- a) Caste - Status by Birth
- b) Class - Status by Economic
- c) Power - Status by Political Networking

This is Andre Beteille's use of **Weber's Trinitarian Model** to study stratification in villages of India.

Dynamism - Inter & Intra-Caste Hierarchy

- He found in Sripuram village that there are **castes within castes**.
- That the caste system has acquired **Super segmentary** nature.
 - For instance, Brahmins are divided in Ayangars, Non-Ayangars.
- Various **sub-castes** formed at **various times**.
- Therefore, **caste is dynamic**.
- It **refuses to die**.
- It **can never be replaced** by class.

Caste & Class

- He noticed that Sub-castes have **Endogamy**.
- Because, **within caste** there is **economic variation**.
- Therefore, **Poverty** another reason of social exclusion.
- **Louis Dumont** said **Purity & Pollution** as twin criteria used to segregate humans in India, **Andre Beteille** says that it is **Poverty & Pollution**.
- Therefore, **can't be concluded that stratification is only caste driven**.

Caste Old & New

Book: "Caste Old & New"

Dismissal of theory of Y. Singh's Modernity.

Indian social structure has 3 distinct features:

- a) **Caste** - Hierarchical system
- b) **Jajmani** - Interdependence & Vertical ties
- c) **Hindu Value System** - Hierarchical grading of values

Now:

Emergence of **egalitarian, rational, modern** value system.

Change is visible but **caste is Elastic**.

Earlier: There is a **strong relation between caste, class, power**.

Cumulative Privileges

Caste 1 = Class 1 = Power 1

Now: Dispersed Privileges

Caste 1 = Class 5 = Power 10.

Various Permutations & Combinations possible.

Still, majorly:

Brahmins are Professors

Kshatriya are in Police, Army

Vaishyas run Businesses and Enterprises

Shudras are confined as class IV employees.

Therefore, **Caste has developed cracks but still not collapsed.**

On Caste & Politics

He is critical of caste-based reservation:

- 1) Kills meritocracy
- 2) Rise of Pathological D.O.L.
- 3) Makes caste consciousness stronger
- 4) Emphasizing historic wrongs then contemporary needs.
- 5) Creating vertical division
- 6) Killing spirit of constitution by prolonging it.

In America: There are various social forces like class, gender, colour influencing voting behavior.

In India: Produces, reproduces & perpetuates caste, which influences voting behavior.

Caste not the only factor in politics.

Friendship, leadership matter.

Why there is a rise Of Primordial Identities

Such as Caste, Family, Religion

- As a reaction to **oppression**
- As a method of **Self-assertion**
- For maintenance of **Status-quo**

Dynamics of Caste Than Statics

Caste is **not just an institution** but it is **an empirical reality**.

Strengthened by:

- Culture
- Economy
- Religion
- Ideology

As A Critic to Louis Dumont

Louis Dumont:

- Caste is **unique** to India, gives status by birth.

Andre Beteille:

- Caste **not unique** to India. **Queen, Nobility, Pope** on the basis of their affiliation of birth.
- Religious status **not prerogative of birth**, it can be achieved. **Guru Nanak, Buddha, Sai Baba**, etc. achieved it.
- **Louis Dumont** is **Manusmriti**, telling what society **ought to be**, then what it is. He **ignored challenges to Brahminism**.

Louis Dumont:

- **Only caste** produces hierarchy

Andre Beteille:

- **Caste, Class and Power** are the three prongs of hierarchy.

Louis Dumont:

- India **Homo Hierarchicus** which is Bad.
- Whereas West is **Homo Equillus** which is Good.

Andre Beteille:

- There is religious revivalism in west, Secularization in India.
- Therefore, Nature of social change, a matter of degree than a matter of kind between India & West.

Criticism

- **Gail Omvedt**: Over emphasized change in caste.
- **Anand Chakravarty**: **Hegemonistic domination** not studied.
- **Y. Singh**: Every study lacks **PIO** (Precision, Integration and Objectivity).

Perspectives On Untouchability

What is Untouchability

- Although constitutionally banned, untouchability is still practised in both rural and urban India, by upper castes and lower castes.
- **Sukhadeo Thorat** - The **caste system** in India involves "**rank and gradation**," which make "**the rights and privileges of higher castes**, become the **disabilities of the lower castes**, particularly the untouchables."
- **Gopal Guru** - Book *Untouchability in Rural India*, writes "there are scholars who obliquely suggest that caste is a rumour and **untouchability has become irrelevant in India**."
- Guru argues that those who deny the existence of caste and **those who believe that a practice like untouchability exists only in a "mild form"** are either "**guilty**" or "**embarrassed**" of the very existence of caste and untouchability.

Throat and Joshi:

- There exists a **group of people who were considered "physically and ritually polluting"** due to their occupations.
- This **fifth group existed outside this fourfold classification**, that of the non-classified (avarnas) who did **work** that was, and is still considered, **physically and ritually polluting**, such as **cremation** and the

handling of dead bodies, **removal and skinning** of dead animals, **removal and cleaning of human bodily fluids** and excreta (manual scavenging) and **basket weaving**.

- These “**outcastes**” enjoyed **no rights** and were considered **impure**.
- It is primarily against this community that **untouchability was and continues to be practised**.

B R Ambedkar:

Book - *Who Were the Shudras*

He writes that the **division of society based on occupation was a later addition** to Hindu scriptures to **secure religious sanction for “control and hegemony.”**

Marc Galanter (1969) – Paper “*Untouchability and the Law*,” discussing the “**constitutional meaning of untouchability**,” writes:

- The Constitution does not define “untouchability,” nor is it clear what constitutes its “practice in any form” or “a disability arising out of ‘untouchability.’”
- The English term “untouchability” first appeared in print in 1909 and.
- It gained wide currency but it did not gain clarity.

Shah et al (2006):

- Untouchability as a “distinct Indian **social institution** that **legitimises and enforces practices of discrimination** against people **born into particular castes** and **legitimises practices that are humiliating, exclusionary and exploitative.**”

Untouchability in Colonial India

Galanter:

The legal system of British India supported certain aspects of the caste order

Many still believe that the British are behind the existence of the caste system in India. It is argued that the British did reinforce the caste system in India.

Caste groups did enjoy active **support of the courts in upholding their claims** for precedence and exclusiveness.

Courts granted injunctions to **restrain members of particular castes from entering temples** – even ones that were publicly supported and dedicated to the entire Hindu community.

It was a criminal offence for a member of an excluded caste knowingly to pollute a temple by his presence.

Indian National Movement and the Question of Untouchability

Vijay Prashad :

- In the **1930s**, members of various untouchable communities formed political associations in escaping caste oppression by converting, fleeing bonded labour.
- The union of untouchables in opposition to the Congress plagued elite Indian nationalists.
- The question arose how could Congress represent themselves as a nation when a major segment of the population would not support them?
- The elite Indian nationalists argued that the “union of untouchables” were mobilised by “outside agitators.”

Some Global Perspectives On Untouchability

1. **Dividualistic**: Marriot & Inden: Creator gives particles. Uts have bad particles
2. **Marxian** : It is the **False Consciousness** of the practioners of the system that perpetuates the exploitation.
3. Ambedkar: Roots could be **Racial**. It is important to **Reform** the system, even if it means **annihilation of the caste system or even religion**.
4. **Gandhian**: Genesis irrelevant. It is important to persuade upper caste to start **common dining**. Started **Harijan Sevak Sangh** for upliftment of the lower castes, especially Dalits.

Efforts to Remove Untouchability

Collective Action Based

Ghanshyam Shah

2 types of movements to get rid of Untouchability:

- a) **Reformative**: Sanskritisation, Bhakti Movement, Neo-Vedantic Movement (Success), Arya Samaj, Adi-Dharma, Adi-Andhra, SNDP movement, etc.
- b) **Alternate**: Conversion (Jain, Buddh, Islam), Secular (Law Based, Electorate based).

Mahatma Gandhi's Efforts

- Harijans Sevak Singh
- Ashram
- Change of Heart (Appeal to upper caste)
- Commensality

Dr. Ambedkar's Efforts

- **Mahar Movement** - Countered scrounging
- **Poona Pact** - Separate electorate led to Reservation
- **SC Federation / Bahishkrit Hitkarni Sabha**
- **RPI** - Republican Party of India
- **Annihilation** of caste
- Appeal of **Law**

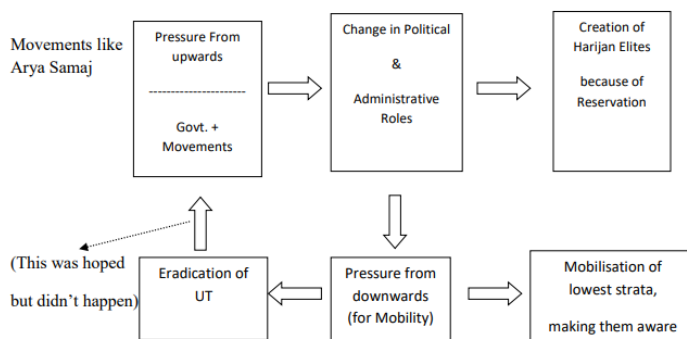
Efforts after Dr. Ambedkar

- a) Start of **Dalit Parties**: **BAMCEF** (Backward & Minority communities Employee Federation)
- b) Proliferation of **Dalit Political Parties** - Lok Janshakti Party (LJP) | BSP | RPI
- c) **Dalit worker's Associations**
- d) Increased **awareness** and **consciousness** of **Empowermental Issues**:
 - **Constitution**: Article 17

- **Laws:** Manual Scavenging Act, PCRA (Protection of Civil Rights act), SCST Prevention of Atrocities Act.

Paradigm by Satish Sabberwal

During Inter-caste Study Of Punjab



Untouchability Today

Thorat and Joshi in “The Continuing Practice of Untouchability in India” found that even in 2020:

- “The mindset prevalent amongst the upper castes is that people belonging to the lower **castes are physically and/or ritually unclean, and therefore, they should not be allowed to enter the kitchen** (a sacred and clean place) or use the utensils that the household members use for consuming food. ”

Why Untouchability still Persists

(From Karanth’s Essay)

Role of Dominant Caste

- Members of 'Untouchables' (members of **Madiga or Holey**a castes in rural Karnataka) **found difficult to move away from their traditional occupation.**
- Though **law is against this work** but still **dominant caste** bring **economic and other pressures** on the dependent castes **to ensure the continuity** of master-servant relation.

Role of Government

- For the **implementation of welfare schemes**, government **officials ask the people of dominant castes to identify** the beneficiaries of lower castes.
- It enhances the role of dominant castes.

Lack of Resources

Low castes do not have enough **resources** and **opportunities** to get into new jobs hence **difficult for them to get dissociated** from traditional jobs.

Why Sanskritisation didn't work

Low castes had **tried to Sanskritize** their customs and lifestyles to improve their ranks in the hierarchy.

This they did by:

- **Naming** children
- Names of **Gods**
- **Puja** rooms

Since **Sanskritization is emulation** of customs and rituals of higher castes.

Lower castes were forbidden from such emulation of higher castes and the **leaders of dominant castes had the power to prevent it.**

De-Sanskritization

- Claiming higher status through **Sanskritization is not the only process active** in rural India.
- There is also **acute competition among castes to claim 'backward' status** as it leads to **benefits of protective discrimination.**
- Same castes often claim to be **'high' in a traditional context** and **'backward' in a 'modern' context.**
- **Post-Independence policies** of protective discrimination, land reforms and other welfare measures have **not significantly changed the relative status of the very low castes.**
- **Social mobility more for individuals than for groups.**
- **Secular factors** (power & wealth) are becoming **increasingly important** in the evaluation of caste status.
- Also, under the **influence of electronic media**, there is a widespread **increase in secular and modern values.**

Why Low Castes find it difficult to increase their rural status

Upper castes retain their rural base even after migration.

Low Castes find it difficult due to:

1. **Socio, economic** factors.
2. **Relatively emancipated status in cities**, making them reluctant to go to villages.

Any such attempt by low castes result into inter-caste violence as in Bihar and Andhra.

B 3

Tribal Communities in India

The Concept of Tribes

Indian Tribe Definition

W.H.R. Rivers

- A tribe as 'a social group of simple kind, the members of which speak a common dialect, have a single government, and act together for such common purposes as warfare'.

In Oxford Dictionary of Sociology

- 'Tribe' is defined as **a social group bound together by kin** and duly associated with **a particular territory**; members of the tribe share the **social cohesion** and **associated with the family** together with the sense of **political autonomy** of the nation.

Dictionary says the word 'tribe' is derived from the Latin term 'tribus' which was applied to the three divisions of the early people of Rome

A Generic Definition

- A body of Indians of the same or a similar race, united in a community under one leadership or government, and inhabiting a particular though sometimes ill-defined territory.

Key Features Of Tribes In India

- India is the abode of a sizeable proportion of indigenous people, who still live away untouched by the shadows of modern society.
- To identify and distinguish these communities, the Chanda Committee in the year 1960 had laid down 5 standards to include any community/caste in the tribal group.

Features as recognized by Ministry of Tribal Affairs

1. Primitive traits
2. Distinctive culture
3. Geographical Isolation
4. Shyness from general Population
5. Backwardness

Tribes as Adivasis

- The tribes in India are also called as "adivasis".
- The term is a **modern Sanskrit word** coined in the **1930s** by tribal political activists to give an indigenous identity to tribal people by claiming indigenous origin.
- Please note that the Government does not officially recognise tribes as indigenous people.

Definitional Problems and Geographical Spread

Sociologists, anthropologists, social workers still not on same wavelength about the definition of the tribes

Arthur Wilke

"For years ambiguity has stalked India's official portrait of tribal people ".

Analysis of Thakorlal Bharabhai Naik's traditional definitions of Tribals

Thakorlal Bharabhai Naik's Analysis of Problems with traditional definitions of Tribals

In Indian Context, T.B Naik has given the following features of tribes:

- A tribe should have **least functional interdependence** within the community.
- **Economically backwarded** (i.e. primitive and traditional means of exploiting natural resources, tribal economy should be at an underdeveloped stage and have multifarious economic pursuits).
- A comparative **geographical isolation** of its people.
- Having a **common dialect**.
- **Politically unorganized** and community panchayat should be influential.
- Have their **own customary laws**.

Problems with traditional definitions of Tribals

1. **Living in forest-** Dublas of Surat and host of others do not live in forests. They live in fertile plains
2. **Primitive religion-** There is a continuance from tribal gods, to Hinduised tribes some converted to Christianity, Islam
3. **Geographic isolation-** Hundreds of tribes who are not living an isolated life-- (Bhil Santhal, Irula)
4. **Primitive economic system-** Many peasant groups who are living by equally primitive economic system.
5. **Economic backwardness** - Many of the tribes are self-sufficient and more economically forward than many castes. For e.g. Khasi, Gond, Bhil are more economically specialised than their non tribal neighbours.
6. **Common language or dialects** - Common in Assam and other Central Indian tribes but not for many Western and Southern Indian tribes.
7. **Politically organised-** May not always be politically organised or even have a tribal Panchayat. Some tribals may or may not have single chief or a few elders. Schedule 5,6, TAC, PESA is changing political organisation of tribal areas.
8. **Joint ownership of property** - May or may not be true. For e.g. among Hos it is not exclusive FRA

Definitional problems due to

1. **Dynamics of tribes-** no more traditional stereotype.
2. Tremendous **increase in population and migration**.
3. **Welfare policies** have led to breaking the stereotypes.

D.N. Majumdar:

Except for the tribes of **Eastern India**, everywhere else ethnic strains have crisscrossed in the sub-continent

Definition as a Continuum

He suggests that the definition of tribe should be seen in **a continuum: the tribe at one end and caste.**

On the other end

1. **Srikanth-** 1) tribals, 2) semi tribals, 3) Accultural tribes, 4) Assimilated tribes.
2. **Ghurye-** Hinduised tribes → Partially Hinduised tribes → Hill section people.
3. **DN Mujumdar-** Primitive tribes → Tribe with degree of association → Hinduised tribe
4. **Elwin-** Most primitive → Individualistic → Detribalised → Tribal aristocrats.
5. Even **Beteille** says "there is no satisfactory way to define a tribe. It can only be explained through the continuum"

Keyword to remember definitional issues of Tribes - RIPPLED

R - Religion

I - Isolated

P - Political

P - Property

L - Live (where do they live)

E - Economy

D - Dialects

Tribes, Constitution and Laws

Tribes in Constitution of India

- According to the constitution of India, tribal communities have been given recognition as scheduled tribe in **Schedule 5**.
- **Article 366 (25) defined** scheduled tribes as "such tribes or tribal communities or parts of or groups within such tribes or tribal communities as are deemed under **Article 342** to be Scheduled Tribes for the purposes of this constitution"
- The inclusion of a community as a Scheduled Tribe is **an ongoing process**.
- There is **reservation of seats** for the Scheduled Tribes in the **Lok Sabha**.
- **47 seats** are reserved in Lok Sabha For Scheduled Tribes.
- The **R.P. Act, 1950** gives the **State Wise break up**.
- The number of seats is decided **on the basis of proportion of Scheduled Tribes in the State** concerned to that of the total population.

Constitutional Safeguards

1. **Article 15(4)** → Special provisions are made for **educational advancement** of the Scheduled Tribes. These provisions are like **reservation** of seats and relaxation in marks in admission to educational institutions, scholarships, etc.
2. **Article 46** → State to promote with special care to education and economic interests of SC and ST and **protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation**.
3. **Articles 330 and 332** → **Seats are reserved for SC and ST in Lok Sabha & State Vidhan Sabhas**.
4. **Under Article 339(1)** → The **President** may at any time appoint a **Commission** to report on the administration of the Scheduled Area and the welfare of the Scheduled Castes and Tribes in the State.
5. **The National Commission for Scheduled Tribes (NCST)** was established by amending Article 338 and inserting a new Article 338A in the Constitution through the Constitution (89th Amendment) Act, 2003

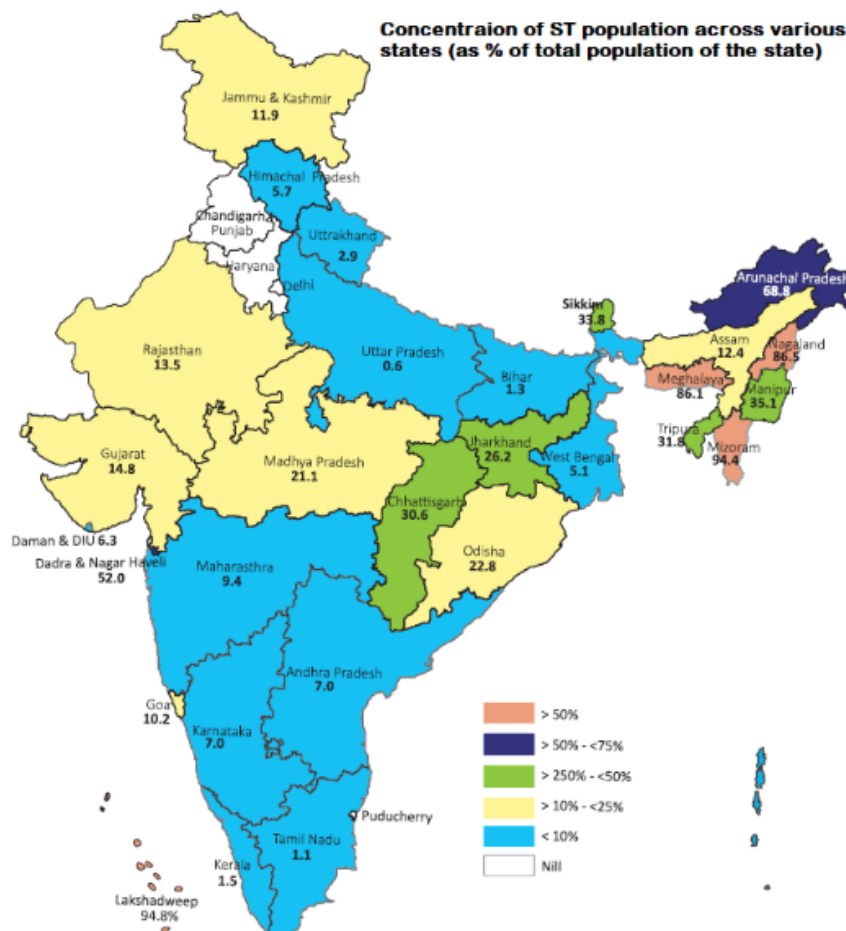
Demography of Tribes

Population of Tribes

- They comprise a **substantial minority** population of India, making up **8.6%** of India's population or 104.2 million people in India, according to the **2011 census**.
- In Madhya Pradesh, Odisha, Maharashtra, Rajasthan, Gujarat, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Andhra Pradesh, and Karnataka, we have the **maximum population** of scheduled tribe.
- The STs in India make the **largest proportion** of the entire population in Lakshadweep and Mizoram, closely followed by the states of Meghalaya and Nagaland.
- Punjab, Delhi, Haryana, Chandigarh, and Pondicherry have **no STs**.

Distribution Of Tribes

- The Scheduled Tribes are notified in 30 States/UTs and the number of individual ethnic groups, etc. notified as Scheduled Tribes is 705.
- **89.97% of them live in rural areas** and 10.03% in urban areas.
- The **decadal population growth** of the tribal's from Census 2001 to 2011 has been **23.66% against the 17.69%** of the entire population.
- The **sex ratio** for the overall population is 940 females per 1000 males and that of Scheduled Tribes **990** females per thousand males.



Geographical Spread

The tribal population can be demarcated in the following three geographical zones:

1. **North-North-Eastern Zone:** It includes the tribal areas of Ladakh (Jammu & Kashmir), Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Sikkim and the North East comprising seven states (Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Manipur and Tripura).
2. **Central or Middle Zone:** It includes West Bengal, Orissa, Bihar, Southern Uttar Pradesh, Southern Rajasthan, Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra.
3. **Southern Zone:** It includes Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Kerala, and the Andaman – Nicobar.

Some major tribal groups

1. More than 4 million **Gonds** live in MP, Maharashtra, AP
2. More than 4 million **Bhils** live in Rajasthan, Gujarat, Maharashtra, MP.
3. More than 3 million **Santhals** in Orissa, Jharkhand, WB.

Variation in socio-economic development

1. Mostly **patrilinear**- but some **matrilinear** (Garo)
2. Embraced **different religions**
 1. Naga, Mizo, Santhals, Munda- Christianity
 2. Bhutia, Lepcha- Buddhism.

3. Bhils, Bhimis- Hinduism
3. Occupations
4. Food gatherers, forestry, shifting cultivation, agriculture, labourers.

Literacy Rate

	1961	1971	1981	1991	2001	2001
Total literate population	24 %	29.4 %	36.2 %	52.2 %	64.84%	73.00 %
Scheduled Tribes (STs) population	8.5 %	11.3 %	16.3 %	29.6 %	47.10%	59.00%
Total female population	12.9 %	18.6 %	29.8 %	39.3 %	53.67%	64.60%
Total Scheduled Tribes (STs) female population	3.2 %	4.8 %	8.0 %	18.2 %	34.76%	49.40 %

Colonial Policies and Tribes

Colonial Policies – 4 Aspects

C – Christian Missionaries

A – Administrative Policies

F – Forest Policies

E – Exclusion

Ideas behind British Policies towards Tribals

1. **The Dominant Policy Of British** → To safeguard their isolation in officially declared excluded or partially excluded areas.
2. **In Practice** → however, the policy of isolation was seriously compromised by the dominant concern of the colonial State for maximising revenue extraction, because regions of tribal concentration were typically the richest in terms of endowments of forest and mineral wealth.
3. The **policy of isolation** translated itself into a general policy of **non-interference with tribal customs and traditions, except** where these became barriers to the extractive objectives of the colonial State.
4. **Entirely alien and fundamentally destructive concepts of State ownership of forests and private property of land**, were laid for the exploitation of tribal wealth which continues until the present day.
5. At the same time, the colonial administrators **encouraged Christian missionaries**, whose main ideology

was of 'assimilation', albeit into Christianity, rather than the caste Hindu mainstream.

6. Although, **missionaries contributed very significantly** by providing **educational and health services** in difficult and remote tribal regions.

Administrative Policies: 3 phases

1st phase (1782-1827)

1. Came with contact of tribal first in Bengal
2. **Revolt** of Paharias of Rajmahal hills against Hindu Zamindars
3. "**Cleveland**", the administrator recognised this problem and **decided to specially administer** the area (Rajmahal hills). **Civil and criminal jurisdiction** provided to **local elders** of the hills. However, this experiment did not succeed due to corruption and mal-administration.

2nd Phase (1855-1919)

1. Pattern on administration experimented with paharias continued till 1855.
2. Till then **Santhal revolution**: leading to creation of **Santhal district**.
3. Then **1858- Queens proclamation**: Giving **right to every community** to right to its own culture.
4. **1861 act**- Tribal areas brought under **special administration**- officers given special civil and penal powers.
5. **1870 act**- Powers given to **GG in council issues laws and regulations** for "**scheduled tracts**" (areas inhabited by tribes).
6. **1919 act**- Brought the concept of "**backward tract**" (where tribals lived with other communities). In case of BTs- only modification of all India laws was sought, whereas for STs exclusive administration and local arrangements were thought necessary.

3rd phase (1919-1947)

1. Britishers feared Tribals joining freedom struggle so they designed the policy of isolation.
2. **GOI act 1935**- tribal areas divided into 2:
 1. Partially excluded- Governor sought advise of village administrators.
 2. Wholly excluded areas- Governor acted in his discretion.

Forest Policies

1. Lord Dalhousie declared "**Teak**" a **state property**.
2. **Restrictions** were also put on collections of **MFP** (Minor forests produce).
3. **1855 - Formal forest policy** declared.
4. **1865 - Restrained some local practices** and customs.

Act of 1878

1. The **entire forest areas** in the country were classified in to:

- Reserve forest
 - Protected forest
 - Village forest
2. Allowed forest dwellers to **enjoy the rights to some extent but restricted from owning**. Applicable only to the forest under control of the government and **no provisions were made to cover private forests**.

5 different successive acts

- Act was followed by **five different successive acts from 1901** Indian forest act to 1927 Indian forest Act, there was gradually taking the **control of over the forest to regulating people's control** over the forest lands and produce.
- It radically changed the forests from common property into state property.
- It was also the beginning of the alienation of village communities from forest.

After Independence

Some **rethinking** on the issue of the forest policy:

1. In **1952** a **new national forest policy** - Forest policy should be based on the **paramount national needs**.
2. **Use of forest shouldn't be permitted** at the cost of national interests.
3. The concept of **national interest** was interpreted in a **very narrow sense**.
4. **The destruction of forest for the developmental projects was justified** in the name of **national interest** and community was discouraged from using the forest.
5. The forest officials of India thought mainly of **increasing the revenue from forests**, treating advasis as the enemies of the forests.
6. **Criticized** - The **mere extension of government authority** over forest.
7. The **traditional rights of tribes** were **no longer recognized** as rights.

1988 Act

- Objectives –
 - Maintenance of environmental stability
 - Conservation of the national heritage
 - Increase in tree cover
 - Meeting needs of the tribes
 - Encouraging efficient use of forest produce
 - Afforestation programmes.
- While this policy has more people – oriented statements, it still has the concept of exclusive state ownership of forest and mention industrial needs as national needs.

The Forest Act of 2006

1. It attempts not only to **correct a historic injustice** committed by the colonial and post-colonial rulers but also **vest in forest communities as primary role in sustaining** forest ecosystems by restoring their rights

as well as their environmental duties.

2. The greatest value of the Forest Act of 2006 is that it effectively **recognizes the rights of forest dwellers** who previously were considered encroaches on state land.

How Government used to see Forest

1. The **forest is the pivot** around which the **tribal life revolves**, but **for the state**, the forest is simply a source of **raw materials** for industry and revenue for itself.
2. In **some states the Forest Department is a major source of revenue** for the government.
3. It is **no wonder** that successive **plans, policies, and legislation** have resulted in **restricting the rights** and usage of forests by millions of tribal people for whom forests are their only refuge and source of sustenance.

Summarising the Colonial Policies and Afterwards

Colonial Policies And Tribes

- Lord Dalhousie : Teak, state property (No MFP)
- 1878 Act : 3 classified - Reserve, Protected, Village
- 5 acts : State's control increased

After Independence → 3 types of forests

1952 -> National interest (Development, Tribals excluded, enemies of forest)

1988 -> Environmental stability (afforestation, environmental nations) (meeting needs of Tribes)

2006 -> Forest dwellers rights (MFP, IPR on traditional knowledge, 4 hectare/family, some duties to protect)

Forest Act

- User right
- Ownerships
- Control right (buy/sell land)

Issues Of Integration And Autonomy

Constituent Assembly Debate

The Constituent Assembly debate on tribal autonomy saw the clash of two schools of thought:

1. **The Assimilationists**

2. The Liberals

The Assimilationists

The assimilationists argued that tribes in the schedule areas should be absorbed into the larger society.

They argued for an inclusive Indian nation that basically reflects a vision of the liberal state, for which the axis of reference is the republican notion of freedom:

- No social distinctions
- No hierarchies

But there will be a sum of individuals whose membership in the nation will be determined by the freedom he/she enjoys.

The assimilationists considered terms like scheduled areas, reserved areas, or excluded areas a colonial baggage and argued for a uniform administration in independent India.

The Liberals

- They thought that tribals should **be given autonomy**, along with the **self-governing rights**.
- The underlying **assumption** behind this view is that tribes should be **integrated** but they should be allowed to **preserve their own autonomy**.
- Integration along with autonomy would also mean the **respect for the pluralities** of tribes.

In the initial years after Independence

- After Independence, the **senior political leadership** in India particularly Prime Minister Nehru, sought to define the contours of a **progressive and sensitive tribal policy** that steered **clear of the excesses of both 'isolationism'** and the implied civilisational **arrogance of 'assimilation'**.
- **Nehru maintained** that **tribal people** possess a **variety of cultures** and are in many ways **certainly not backward**.
- In seeking to bring to these communities the **benefits of health education and communication**, he said that *"one must always remember, however, that we do not mean to interfere with their way of life but want to help them to live it. The tribal people should be helped to grow according to their genius and tradition"*.

Why such a Stance

- This **unusual sensitivity** derived partly from the **influence** that anthropologists like **Verrier Elwin** who stressed that in **designing development programmes** for tribals, their special **cultural strengths must be respected and nurtured**.
- **BN Majumdar**: Policy of '**Limited Assimilation**'
- A lot of practices like **environmental protection, respect of women, elders, marrying late** can be learnt.

Nehru's landmark Tribal Panchsheel

- The search for an **appropriate middle path of integration**, falling between the two extremes of isolation and assimilation, was concretised in Nehru's landmark **Panchsheel**.
- **This is called the Policy of Integration.**

Tribal Panchsheel

1. Avoid imposing anything on them. Try to encourage in every way their own traditional arts and culture.
2. Tribal rights in land and forest should be respected.
3. Try to train and built up a team of their own people to do the work of administration and development. Some technical personnel from outside will, no doubt, be needed, especially in the beginning. But avoid introducing too many outsiders into tribal territory.
4. Do not over-administer these areas or overwhelm them with a multiplicity of schemes, rather work through, and not in rivalry to their own social and cultural institutions.
5. Judge results, not by statistics or the amount of money spent, but by the quality of human character that is evolved.

Memorising Tribal Panchsheel

Remember CLTOR

C: Culture (encourage them to promote)

L: Land Rights (Respect)

T: Team (their own)

O: Over-administer (don't)

R: Results (not by money but by human character evolved)

Impact of Policies On Tribals

Impact On Tribals

1. **Indian forest laws** enacted in the 19th and 20th centuries **treated forest dwellers** and other traditional forest users and especially their farming practices such as shifting cultivation as **a threat** to forest ecology.
2. The **British forest policies** were mainly **aimed at supplying the raw material** for the **British** based industries and commercial **exploitation of forest** was encouraged **at the cost of tribals** in the name of national interest.
3. The **state saw** that the **well-being of forest and forest dwellers** as **two different and mutually exclusive options**. This is based on a premise that the forests can be well protected only if the local forest using communities are excluded, and that the needs of the forest dependent communities can be met only if society is ready to suffer the loss of forest.
4. Despite the **oppositions from tribal people**, the forest areas are **allocated to corporations** to invest in mining and other projects.
5. Now community is experiencing **a new form of encroachment on their customary rights** by developmental interventions such as large dams, mining and conservation.
6. **Social- Impact - Culture, Habit, Occupation**
 - a. Culture affected due to **missionaries**.
 - b. Habits such as **Pan** chewing, **liquor** consumption increased due to proliferation of **money lenders** in the areas.
 - c. **Traditional occupations** were affected.

7. Political - Rights, Migration, Poverty, segregation

- a. **Statehood - Jharkhand, Chattisgarh**
- b. **Educated middle class**
- c. **Many tribal movements have emerged**
 1. **For control of many vital resources**
 2. **For matters of ethnic-cultural identity**
- d. **Poverty** increased
- e. Forest rights **alienation**
- f. Led to **migration** to cities
- g. Policy of **segregation** meant, **no infrastructure** was built in these areas

Case of NEFA

- The Scheduled Areas and Scheduled Tribes Commission, headed by **U.N. Dhebar** (1960) later **endorsed and elaborated** this policy of integration.
- Despite such progressive policy, with the singular exception of the North-East Frontier Agency (NEFA) (Arunachal), the **policy of integration was not implemented with any notable success** in tribal India.
- For the opening up of the hitherto isolated, and strategically sensitive, tribal highlands of NEFA, a **committed and trained group of exceptional officers** were grouped into what was designated as the **Indian Frontier Administrative Service**.
- They **closely interacted on a day-to-day basis with Nehru and Elwin**.
- Elwin advised them, '*Integration can only take place on the basis of equality: moral and political equality*'.
- It is significant that NEFA, now designated **Arunachal Pradesh**, **remains the only state in the Northeast, which is not convulsed with militancy**.
- Incidentally this is the **only state** in India where certain tribes have attained **a hundred per cent level of literacy**.

Examples

1. **Meena and Bhils** are existing side by side with majority
2. **Khond and Oraon** are absorbing themselves with the dominant group
3. **Nagas and Mizos** are attempting to seek political independence based on equality.

Problems of Tribals In India

Problems of Tribes

1. Displacement
2. Rights over forest
3. Naxalism
4. Poor development Indicators
5. Stigma over tribal identity

6. Lack of voice & represent.
7. Tribal Elites cornering benefits
8. Environmental degradation affecting livelihoods & lives

Six Main Problems Faced by the Indian Tribes

- **Loss of Control over Natural Resources**
- **Lack of Education**
- **Displacement and Rehabilitation**
- **Problems of Health and Nutrition**
- **Gender Issues**
- **Erosion of Identity**

Other Important Problems Of Tribals In India

- Land Alienation
- Forests & Tribals and Displacement
- Indebtedness, Poverty and Unemployment
- Health, Nutrition and lack of Health care services, Infrastructure and Medical staff
- Lack of Educational services, Infrastructure, Human Resources
- Identity, Cultural Problems and diffusion
- Concept of Private Property
- In-Migration of other communities
- Language Problem because of unwritten form.
- Problem of separatism

Tribals have been getting ignored because of

- Focus on Partition
- States re-organization
- Wars
- Resource requirements for industries
- Land Reforms
- Less political participation

Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs)

Tribal groups are at different stages of social, economic and educational development.

While some tribal communities have adopted a mainstream way of life, at the other end of the spectrum, there are certain Scheduled Tribes, 75 in number known as Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs).

These are characterised by:

- **Pre-agriculture level of technology**
- **Stagnant or declining population**
- **Extremely low literacy**
- **Subsistence level of economy**

Important Schemes for Tribals

Various Legal Provisions + Government Schemes For Tribals

- Tribal Sub plan
- Ministry
- Trifed
- NSTFDC
- PESA
- Article 14-16
- Article 46/330 – 332
- NCST
- PVTGs

Recommendations of Virginius Xaxa Committee

- Gram Sabha to be empowered (even for Linear acquisitions)
- Acquired but unused lands to be returned
- Tribal co-ops for mining
- No to big dams
- Naxalist killings to be probed by Judicial Enquiry

Government Schemes For Tribals

- Mechanism of Marketing MFP through MSP
- Development of value chain
- Tribes India
- Van bandhu Kalyan Yojana
- Review of FRA under PRAGATI
- District Mineral foundation
- Natural Scheduled Tribe Financial & Dev. Corpn. : Interest subvention

Ministry of Tribal Affairs

MoTA

- Policies
- Planning
- Coordn.
- Various central spon.
- Schemes

Tribal Sub Plan

- Skill Dev.
- Horti + Seri + Apiculture
- Dairy + Fish connectivity improvement
- Education
- Sports
- Culture
- Spl. Central assistance

Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups

Spl. Assistance under TSP to Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups

(which show **Isolation, Shyness, Primitive traits, etc.**)

Education

- Tribal Research Institutes
- Vocational Training (Kasturba Garden Balika Hostels)
- Scholarships
- Hostels

Jan Bandhu Kalyan Yojana

1. Outcome based approach to create enabling env.
2. Use of available resources to augment development.
3. Converging all existing schemes
4. State Govt to formulate long term perspective plan on 14 thematic areas

(Themes -> sustainable employment, health, education, housing, sanitation, security)

Persistent Challenges In Tribal Development

1. Colonial exploitation (historical wrongs)
2. Displacement due to dams, miner, wildlife sanctuaries
3. Physical remoteness (lack of services)
4. Language barriers
5. Weakenings of institutions like tribal research institutes
6. Inefficient usage of funds under TSP
7. Security issues like Naxalism

8. Tribal Elites cornering benefits
9. Environmental degradation affecting lives & livelihoods
10. Lack of voice & representation in contemporary political circles
11. Sex Ratio: 990 but Child sex ration is declining
12. Literacy low and Dropout rate is high

B 4

Social Classes in India

Syllabus

1. Agrarian Class structure
2. Industrial Class structure
3. Middle Classes in India

Agrarian Class Structure

In easier words

Agrarian - Related to agriculture

Class - Similar economic position

Emergence of Agrarian Class Structure

During the British Period

Oppressive policies of Britishers led to the expansion of Agricultural laborers. Also, because of loss of patronage for artisans, a new class of sharecroppers emerged.

Factors of emergence of agrarian class structure were:

- Land Tenure system
- Idea of individual ownership of land
- Payment of **revenue in cash** led to commercialisation of Agriculture
- Moneylender becoming landlords upon non-payment of dues
- Agriculture for profit purpose.

Agrarian Class Structure

- Thus, Agrarian Class Structure Included:
 - Landlords and rich tenants - **Dominant** class
 - Middle and lower tenants - **Intermediate** class
 - Artisans, sharecroppers - **Subordinate** class
- **RK Mukherjee:**
 - Because of **decay of intermediary class**, there was an increase in dominant class and subordinate class.

In post-independence period

If we analyze class structure in rural India in post-independence period, we find **four classes**:

- **Three classes in the agricultural field:**
 - Land owners
 - Tenants
 - Labourers
- Fourth class is of **non-agriculturists**.

A.R. Desai (1959), landowners constituted about 22 per cent, tenants about 27 per cent, agricultural labourers about 31 per cent and **non-agriculturalists about 20 per cent** of rural India after Independence.

Factors that affected Agrarian Class structure included:

- Land Reforms
- Green Revolution
- Democratic political system
- Development of transport & communication

Important Observation:

- The **marketing of agricultural produce** in the mandis (markets) is largely in the hands of **intermediaries** who represent private interests and who **control** both credit as well as disposal of the produce.
- Thus, a large number of **agrarian proletariat**, a large number of uneconomic holders of land, and a small number of artisans and self-employed people in villages **reveal a miserable economic life** lived by these people.

Hamza Alavi's Perspective

- Major Agrarian Classes:
 - **Bourgeoisies** landowners (Farmers high productivity)
 - **Colonial** landowners (Absentee, low productivity)
 - **Sharecroppers** (Payment in kind as were generally, subtenants)
 - Agricultural **labourers** (Wage payment, no land ownership)

Daniel Thorner's Perspective

- Writing in 1973, he wrote, there are **3 categories** in Agrarian Class Structure:
 - **Ownership**
 - **Income**
 - **Use**
- One man can belong to all 3 categories at once.

3 criteria for dividing agrarian population

1. **Ownership** - Nature of rights held in land
2. **Income** - Based on income earned from land

3. **Use** - Extent of field work actually performed.

Based on this criteria - **3 fold classification**:

- **Maliks** - Owner (landlords)
- **Kisans** are working peasants - Use (Tenants)
- **Mazdoors** -- wage labourers or share croppers - Wage/Income (Labourers)

The Malik:

- They may also have **subsidiary income** from business, profession, etc.
- The Maliks are of **two types**:
 - Those who are **absentee landlords**
 - Those who **reside in the village in which they own land**.

Kisans:

- They are the **working peasants**, who may be **small landowners or tenants**.
- The **difference** between the Malik and the small Kisan is the **size of the land** held.
- The **Kisan himself** and one or more **members of his family** actually perform the **field labour**.
- **Sometimes the income** of the Kisan is **so low** that he himself or his family members(s) **work as agricultural labourers**.

Mazdoors:

- They are those **landless villagers** who earn their livelihood primarily from **working on other people's land**.
- They receive **wages in cash** and **sometimes in kind** also.
- When they are not able to find work in villages, they **migrate** to other states either for working as agricultural labourers **or as construction or industrial labourers**.

Summarising Daniel Thorner's analysis on agrarian social structure in terms of three classes:

- (a) **Income obtained from the soil** (i.e., rent, own cultivation, or wages)
- (b) The **nature of rights** (i.e., ownership, tenancy, sharecropping and no rights at all)
- (c) The **extent of fieldwork actually performed** (i.e., doing no work, doing partial work, doing total work, and doing work for others)

Andre Beteille:

There is no single way of classifying Agrarian Class Structure.

He classified based on:

- **Ownership of land**
- **Control over land**
- **Use of land**

D.N. Dhanagre's Perspective

- He says that the agrarian social structure is still marked by **diversities**.
- 'The relations among classes and social composition of groups that occupy specific class position in relation to land-control and land-use in India are so diverse and complex that it is difficult to incorporate them all in a general schema'.
- However, despite the diversities that mark the agrarian relations in different parts of country, AR Desai notes that even Dhanagre attempts to club them together into some general categories.

He suggested a **different model** of agrarian classes. He has proposed **five classes**:

- **Landlords**: Who derive income primarily from land- ownership by collecting rent from tenants, sub-tenants and share croppers.
- **Rich peasants**: Small landowners with sufficient land to support the family and who cultivate land themselves.
- **Rich tenants**: Who have substantial holdings and have to pay a nominal rent to their landlords
- **Middle peasants**: Landowners of medium size holdings and Tenants with substantial holdings and paying higher rent
- **Poor peasants**:
 - Land-owners with holdings insufficient to maintain a family, and therefore forced to rent others' land
 - Tenants with small holdings
 - Sharecroppers
 - Landless labourers.

Forming a Generalised View

A **Generalised view** of agrarian classes has been identified as under:

- **Rich farmers** (Benefitted GR, LR | **AB** : Progressive farmers | **Rudolph & Rudolph** : Bullock capitalism)
- **Middle farmers** (Erstwhile tenants | After LR)
- **Poor peasants** (Landless earlier | LR Beneficiary)
- **Landless labourers** (Migration | Jan Breman : Footloose labour)

Perspectives on Agricultural Labourers

Bardhan and Rudra:

2 types of Agricultural Labourers –

- **Unattached**: Casual labourers without any bondage
- **Attached**: Association with a particular employer
 - **Extremely** Attached: complete bondage without any specific boundaries
 - **Fully** attached: specific sphere of activity
 - **Semi** attached: seasonal association

Bardhan and Rudra:

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Bondage amongst Agricultural Labourers

Bondage:

- Indicates different degrees of attachment of a person with the other within the sphere of work.

ILO Report:

- *Global Estimates of Modern Slavery*
- Most number of slaves in India

Bonded Labour

- Indicates a particular situation in which a person is under a compulsion to be associated with other person.
- This compulsion is enforced by coercion.
- Extremely attached bondage indicates bonded labour.

Contemporary Agrarian Class Structure

- However, these are only broad framework.
- The actual agrarian class relations differ from region to region.
- The agrarian history of different regions in India has been quite different and the trajectories of development during post-independence period (like abolition of zamindari, land tenure, GR etc.) have also been different.
- Agrarian Class Structure is **not static but changes with changing nature of society** at large.
- Due to overall increase in wage level, the cost of labour input increased, low profitability, generating tensions between dominant and subordinate agrarian classes.
- Improving economic conditions in non-Green Revolution areas created a shortage of labourers in Green Revolution areas. Migration decreased.
- Trend towards developing policies for workers in the organised sectors.

Yogendra Singh:

He has referred to several trends in agrarian class structure after independence these are:

- There is a **wide gap between land-reform ideology projected** during the freedom struggle and even thereafter and the **actual measures introduced** for land reforms.

- This gap is the **result of the class character of politicians** and administrative elite.
- The **economic prosperity of the rich peasantry has increased** but the economic condition of the small peasants has deteriorated.
- The **feudalistic type of tenancy has been replaced by the capitalistic type** of lease-labour or wage labour agrarian system.
- The **inequalities between the top and the bottom levels of classes have increased** rather than decreased.
- **Agricultural workers have not received the benefits** of land reforms.

The sociological process dominant in the current class transformations in the villages involves 'embourgeoisement' of some and 'proletarianisation' of many social strata.

P.C. Joshi referring to the trend in agrarian class structure pointed out.:

- The **decline of feudalistic type of tenancy** and its replacement by more exploitative lease arrangements.
- The rise of **commercially-oriented landlords**.

Andre Beteille has referred to change from 'cumulative' to 'dispersed' inequalities due to changing social stratification.

Industrial Class Structure

It is pattern of **relationship that exists between different classes** in an Industrial society.

Marx: Bourgeoisie and Proletariat

Weber (used by Andre Beteille):

- **Propertied Upper Class**
- **White Collared Workers**
- **Petty Bourgeoisie**
- **Manual Labourers**

Evolution of Industrial Society in India

Pre-Independence India

- Started around 1870s.
- Then with the call of Swadeshi (1905) and during **World Wars demand increased**.
- This was also the time of the rise of various trade unions in India namely AITUC, INTUC.

Aim:

- **Marxist** (AR Desai) : Maximising Profits.
- **Functionalist** - Meeting Demand, Giving employment.

Post-Independence India

There is a steady increase in the Government's control of Industry. At the same time there is an increased attempt to increase Social welfare.

Holmstorm (Holmstorm, Dev Nathan)

Working Class in India is of 4 types:

1. Gets **more than a family wage** (that is, more than the value of the labour power)
2. Equal to **family wage** (equal to the labour power)
3. **Less than family wage** (and has to suppress the standard of living to survive)
4. **Pauperised** (not able to meet the immediate demands)

Post LPG Reforms

Few important observations:

- **Informal employment** is increasing
- **Disparity** increasing
- **CSR** activities increasing
- **Social Innovation** increasing.
- Weber's **white collared** increasing
- Holmstorm's 3,4 increasing

Concludingly

Clark Kerr: Convergence theory

- **Similar economies produce similar stratifications.**
- **With time, globalization will remove deprivations.**

Morris D. Morris's perspective on Industrial Class Structure in India

Two viewpoints

There are two viewpoints regarding the behaviour pattern of the industrial labour.

- One view is that labour being short in industry, employers had to scramble for their workforce and make all sorts of concessions which weakened their hold on the workers. The workers frequently returned to their villages to which they were very much attached.
- The other view talks of surplus of labour available in villages for urban employment. Because of easy availability, the employers abused workers unmercifully. Since working conditions in the factories were intolerable, the labour was forced to go back to their villages.

Similarity in these two viewpoints

Thus, **in both views**, it was held that workers retained their rural links which limited the supply of labour for industrial development.

As a consequence, proletarian type of behaviour did not develop.

It also resulted in:

- High rates of absenteeism
- High rate of labour turnover
- Slow growth of trade unions

Bottomore's Perspective

Social classes are characteristic feature of industrial societies.

With the emergence of industrialisation, variously classes emerged, especially in urban areas, as:

- Capitalist
- Educated classes
- Petty traders and shopkeepers
- Working classes

Harold Gould's study of Rickshaw-wallah of Lucknow

- Class structure has **weakened caste structure in India**.
- Cities provide them **anonymity** (upper caste doing menial jobs).

Andre Beteille on Caste and Class

- **Higher caste does not always imply higher class.**
- This **disharmony** is found in Indian cities where **new jobs** are opening.
- However, this **does not mean that caste system is disintegrating**.
- **Earlier cumulative** privileges. Now, **dispersed**.
- **Developed cracks** but not collapsed.
- **Caste** has also become a **basis for organisation of trade union**.
- **Caste** or kinship is used as a **criteria for allotting seats or selecting people** for jobs - i.e. a phenomena of **sponsored mobility rather than contested mobility**.
- In India, with **New Industrial Policy and Globalisation** this class structure is subjected to the most **dynamic change - entrepreneurship**.

5 Broader Features of Industrial Classes in India

1. **Landless as Workers:** Large number of workers in the industries was those who had no significant claim to land.
2. **Rural Systems not a barrier:** The rural social structure (joint family system) was also not a barrier to the flow of population needed for urban economic expansion.
3. **Limited or no Geographical barriers:** Workers employed were not necessarily from the same district in which the industry was located but were recruited from different districts as well as neighbouring states. There were, thus, no geographical barriers inhibiting the flow of labour into the industry.
4. **Limited employment of untouchable castes:** It is **believed that industry is casteblind** because no single caste can provide an adequate supply of labour and because employees are uninterested in caste affiliation, yet **workers did not permit the employers to employ workers of untouchable castes**.
5. **Limited employment of women and children:** Because **employment of women in night shifts was prohibited** and **children below 14 years could not be legally employed**.

Important points for Working Class

Organised and the Unorganised sector

- Holmstrom has said that **all workers do not share all interests**, rather **they share a few interests** only.
- He has also said that it is **necessary to draw a class line** between the **organised and the unorganised sector** industrial workers.
- Joshi says that **organised and unorganised** sector industrial workers are **two classes with different and conflicting interests**.

This conflict in interests can be explained on the **basis of difference in four factors**:

- Wages
- Working conditions
- Security
- Social worlds

Wages

Depend upon **whether the industry is big** (more than 1,000 workers), **small** (250-1,000 workers) or **very small** (less than 50 workers).

The **big industries pay much more** than the small industries because of the:

- Economics of scale
- Unions
- Workers' strong bargaining position.

The interests of workers depend upon the **type of industry** they work in.

The working conditions

They also affect the interests of workers.

- Workers in industries with:
- More **pleasant conditions**
- Having **safety measures** and fewer accidents
- **Less noise** and monotony and fatigue
- **Shorter hours**
- More **space, freedom from close control** or harassment
- A **chance of learning something** more
- **Canteens and creches and washing rooms**

have **different interests** from those which do not provide all these amenities.

Security and career chances

They demarcate two classes of workers.

- A **permanent worker has not only a job but also a career** while the **temporary worker is bothered** more about the security of the job.
- The **permanent worker's career extends into the future** but the **temporary one remains bogged down into the present**.
- The **permanent worker may plan to improve his job by learning a skill** and getting promotion; the **temporary one is terrified of losing his job** if he joins a union.

The social worlds

The 'social world' refers to:

- Differences in economic conditions
- Life chances
- Mutual aid and dependence, etc.

The **factory workers in the organised sector have more solidarity, fewer hostility and less tensions**.

Their interests and ideology keep them separate from the 'outsiders'.

Thus, the **organised sector workers form a privileged upper class**.

Post-Industrial Society

Daniel Bell:

Book "Post-Industrial Society (1973)"

- Bell predicted that we are **fast moving towards a society where services and knowledge related technologies would dominate rather than industrial production** that was conventionally viewed.
- He held that **postindustrial society would replace the industrial society as dominant mode**.

3 components of Post-Industrial Society

There are **three components** to a post-industrial society, according to Bell:

- A **shift from manufacturing to services**
- The **centrality of the new science-based industries**
- The **rise of new technical elites and the advent of a new principle of stratification**.

Term used for post-industrial society is '**information age**', as another characteristic feature of post-industrial societies is the domination of information technologies and industries related to it.

Why Post-Industrial Society will Emerge

Bells prediction of post-industrial society was based on already **emerging patterns in America** in the 1970s as:

Employment figures in 1950's: US became the first country to have a majority of its working population in services.

1. Evidence showed that **contribution to service sector to GNP** was steadily mounting.
2. **Increase in Financial allocation** towards higher education i.e. theoretical knowledge.

How Post-Industrial Society is a Solution

To bell post-industrialization offers a solution to many problems in industrial society such as :

- Individual talks to individual rather than interacting with machines (Interacts with life people and not mindless machines.)
- Vision of a new worker.
- Performs interesting and varied jobs in pleasant surroundings
- Is engaged in production of a service and not in production of good.
- As customer demands vary, offers personalized service.
- Service not fragmented to which there was lack of identification with product – there is a certain unity in service provided by worker.
- Finally new work places is a pleasant office room and personal shop floor.

(Reform in Alienation, creativity)

Some argue that post industrialism is unlike industrialism in its consequences for people.

Industrialism promoted alienation as it made material affluence possible.

Benefits for workers (De-Alienation)

- Post industrialism in contrast allowed **individual to set its own pace**, instead of being paced by machines, by offering work i.e. **varied and interesting**.
- Worker does **complete jobs** instead of fragmented bits of work.

Hence post industrialism offers solution to the alienation of man.

Criticism of Post-Industrial Society

Critics say that it is too rosy a picture. For them:

- **Marxist would not agree that is alienation can be solved within the framework of capitalist system** of production.
- To **them root cause of alienation is private ownership** i.e. what robs worker of his control over tool and production.
- Employment in service class implies that it is at the cost of agriculture.
- Many tasks involved in the provision of services such as catering, cleaning, entertainment, and transportation are of manual or even menial kind are not very different from general run of industrial jobs.
- The argument that white-collar workers in the service sector perform varied jobs in a **pleasant atmosphere and has come under severe attack**.
- **Vast bulks** of service sector employees are **clerks** who have been handed into **large impersonal offices**.
- The **repetitiveness, division of labor, fragmentation of tasks** and **monitoring** that characterize industrial

employment are to be found here as well.

- Finally, Bell's assertion that there is **a growing proportion of professionals within the white collar has been questioned.**
- **The expansion of professionals** in the service sector is **taking place at lowest levels.**
- These people are **assigned impressive titles** such as engineer and technologist. However, they **hardly enjoy freedom** on their job.
- Their actual **job is to perform according to someone else's specifications.**
- They are **mere providers of information.**
- **Production of scientific knowledge itself has become an industry.** With vast number of **people performing fairly simple and regulated jobs** for a coordinator who alone knows how the pieces fit together to make a whole.

Conclusion on Post-Industrial Society

- While there are many critiques to Bells's arguments and his prediction, we are **indeed moving from an industry-oriented economy to a post-industrial one.**
- **The new technologies have definitely altered social structures, they have speeded up the globalization processes.**

Important Shortcomings of India's Industrial Class Structure

- Keith Dan's: **Government Control**, License Raj, Quota Raj **slowed growth of Industries** in India.
- Sudipto Kaviraj : **Slow employment growth** led to **increased poverty.**
- **Limited Employment to women** and children.
- **Workers have little or no land**
- Though workers are from diverse backgrounds, yet very **limited presence of erstwhile untouchable castes** in Industries.

Middle Classes in India

Middle Class

- Despite extensive study, there is **no commonly agreed definition** of the middle class.
- Some scholars define it in terms of its link to the **means of production**, while others define it in terms of **relative salaries** or **spending patterns**.
- The middle class has notably **evolved as a strong, influential, and dominating element** of society, **determining the nation's** economy, polity, culture, education, and social interactions based on money, social status, education, occupation, and consumption.

Defining Middle Class

- **According to Karl Marx**, ownership of means of production is critical to understanding class status, and he also discusses class consciousness.
- According to him, **in the long run, the middle class will merge with the proletariat**, leaving only two classes.
- **Weber** defines the middle class in terms of **structural life opportunities**, including small property owners, artisans, skilled employees, public officials, and so on.
- **According to John Urry**: The middle class **does not control the means of production**, but it is a **powerfully favoured status condition in the workplace relationship** system.
- **Anthony Giddens** defines middle class as having the necessary **educational and technical qualifications**.

The Economist

- If more than 1/3rd income is left after paying for food & shelter.

B.B. Mishra

- Middle Class lies between 75% to 125% of median salary of the population.

Generic Definition

- Either **own MoP at a lower scale** (as compared to Higher class) or **sell skilled labour** (as compared to working class which is unskilled).

Perspectives on Middle Class In India

Middle Class In India

Historically, the **middle class in India evolved as a result of colonialism**:

- Britain educated Indians, compared Indian and Western principles, and implemented reforms to put India on the road to growth.
- For example, KC Sen, Raja Ram Mohan Roy, and IC Vidyasagar.
- **A.R. Desai**: The **middle classes played a vital part in the national movement** and pioneered several social reforms.

B.B. Misra:

- In his work "The **Middle Classes in India**", he concluded that the British rule resulted in the emergence of a class intermediaries serving as a link between the people and the new rulers.

- **Classes** formed in India as a **result of British rule**.
- The **British wanted** to build a **class akin to their own** to aid the former in country governance.
- The British intended to create a **class of imitators** rather than creators of new ideals and techniques.
- The **middle class has an occupational interest**, but it is **united by a common way of life and behavioural patterns**, and it represents **democratic principles** in their social and political lives.
- Middle Classes **continued to increase in strength and prosperity** with the progress of British rule.
- **Pawan Verma**: Discusses **upper caste dominance** in early middle-class creation.
- **Pranab Bardhan**: The **coalition governments** include **members of the middle class**.
- **Satish Deshpande**: The middle class as **hegemonic** in social, political, and economic terms.

Andre Betteile:

- The rise of the middle class in India is a result of the **colonial government's** introduction of modern education and work prospects.
- He views Middle Class in India as a part of a **relatively new social formation based on caste and kinship**.
- In his opinion the **Middle-Class values are difficult to characterise** because they are **still in the process** of formation i.e. **transitional** and have not acquired a stable form.
- As such they are marked by **contradictions & oppositions**.

Evolution of Middle class in India

DL Seth analyses four different phases:

- **Early Colonial period**: Tax collectors (MN Srinivas – Middle Class developed because of Primary, Secondary westernization)
- **Indian Renaissance**: Growth of modern education
- **Post-Independence**: Jobs, education, reservations, green revolution, all these numerically increased Middle Class (farmers also showed up in Middle Class)
- **Post LPG**: Salaried classes increased.

DP Mukherjee (Marxist): Middle class in India is **Synthesis** of:

- Indian system (**Thesis**) → British system (**Anti-Thesis**)

Sanjay Joshi:

- He believes that **definition and power of Middle class** was from its **propagation of modern ways of life and heterogeneity was an attribute** of the Middle Class.

Differentiating between Rural and Urban Middle Class

Y.Singh

It is important to **differentiate between Rural and Urban Middle Class**.

Similarities: Both share **conservative & narrow utilitarian ethos**.

Differences: Rural Middle-Class harbours intense **antagonism & conflict with Urban Middle Class due to historical reasons** like slowdown in agricultural production, post Green Revolution under-development in agriculture.

Old Middle Class vs New

Old Middle Class:

- Small manufactures
- Artisans
- Independent Professionals etc.

New Middle Class:

- Technocrats - Related to technology
- Bureaucrats
- Managers - White collar employees

Contemporary Middle Class

- The contemporary middle class arises against the **backdrop of economic liberalisation rhetoric**.

According to Sinha:

- The creation of the **new economy was linked to the expansion of the urban middle class**, which he refers to as the "**new**" middle class.

Estimates of the size of this class vary greatly.

Nobel laureates **Abhijit Banerjee and Esther Duflo**:

- They estimate the **per capita expenditure thresholds for the Indian middle class**.
- With the **global poverty level set at \$1.90 per day** per capita spending, the **lower-middle class is limited to \$2-4**, and the middle-middle class is limited to \$4-6.
- Depending on the approach used, **their numbers range between 10% and 30% of the Indian population**.

Features Of Contemporary Middle Class

The gradual but steady dissolution of the caste system is one key development.

According to Kuppaswamy:

- A person's standing is defined by his education, job, and wealth, but caste is only taken into account upon marriage.
- As a consequence of urbanisation, globalisation, and modernization, it appears that caste-based professions are disintegrating in India.
- It is resulting in a **multitude of employment possibilities** outside of traditional vocations, both locally and worldwide, notably in the private, IT, and associated sectors.
- **While the higher castes dominate the new middle class**, a significant number of lower caste households have also joined it.

Increasingly Consumerist Lifestyle and Identity:

- The middle class are among the **leading customers of "high-end" things** like as autos, air conditioners, designer apparel, laptop computers, mobile cellphones, gadgets, and many other items.
- *To summarise, consumption has become their standard.*

Technologically Savvy: "Knowledge Class":

- Middle Class are frequently referred to as the "**knowledge class**" because to their specialised, advanced education, technical competence, and much superior knowledge in various fields.

Gurcharan Das:

- *IT entrepreneurs and professionals are the new middle-class heroes.*

Middle Class Culture and Society: More Globalized Than Localized:

- They lead a **professional lifestyle**, are **fast-paced**, anticipate a **modern, western quality of living**, and have a strong global perspective.
- Furthermore, they are **becoming a transnational and global phenomenon**.
- Middle Class educated by **western education and modernism** are exposed to **liberal, secular, and logical moral** notions.
- Nonetheless, they are **deeply ingrained in traditional and religious social** structures.
- This circumstance has definitely **positioned them as "Glocal," allowing them to be both "local" and "global."**
- For example, western food outlets such as McDonalds modify their menu to meet the demands of Indian customers.

The middle class as a social change catalyst:

- Following the **1991 reforms**, various **social movements** in the country saw **significant participation from** the country's **emerging middle classes**, such as the **India Against Corruption** campaign.
- They use law, press, media, and social activism to bring social change or awareness about different issues in the society.

Contemporary Middle Class

- **Rajesh Kochar** calls the middles class as **Denationalised Middle Class** as it strongly believes in better opportunities even if they come from abroad and require moving there leaving the country behind.
- **Suhash Palshikar** believes that the upper class (Bourgeoisie class) is dependent on Middleclass because of Middle Class's spending power.
- **MNCs like McDonald** are **rapidly transforming themselves** so as to **better cater to the requirements of Indian Middle Class** (as can be seen in vastly different Indian Menu of McDonalds as compared with its international menu).
- In contemporary times, Middle Class is **not yet modern while** there is **modernity in consumption patterns**.
- It is still in the **transition** phase wrt **interpersonal relation** as consumerism has increased.
- There is continuity in terms of the belief that **Male is still breadwinner** and there is **superficial emancipation of women** where they have freedom to choose their clothes but **motherhood is still considered to be most important goal**.
- Middle Class, thus, is **believed to have still not acquired stable form** and cannot be labelled as modern.

Causes for the rise of Middle Class in India

- **Social:** Westernisation, Sanskritisation, Modern Education, Administrative jobs, Land Reforms, Green Revolution.
- **Economic:** Commercialisation and Industrialisation
- **Political:** Democracy (Participation in Decision Making leading to more policies for middle class), universal adult franchise, Reservation policy.

Political Repercussions because of education, awareness.

Impact of Rising Middle Class

1. According to a survey by the **National Council for Applied Economic Research (NCAER)**: The Indian middle class has become the segment **driving consumption of "luxury" goods** like cars and air-conditioners.
2. Tremendous **growth in numbers** is having an impact on the rising **consumerism** and **consumption ambitions** of the country.
3. There is a vivid **change in the class structure** (3 classes now)
4. Impact on **Laws and Policies** made, **Economic** policies, **Social** setup, **acceptance of Technology**, etc.
5. There is an increasing **social transformation in politics and poll promises**.

Always remember the 3Is – **Initiator, Indicator, Integrator**

- Indicator of social change
- Agent of modernization
- Stabilizing force (between top & bottom)
- Significant role in Freedom movement.
- Harbinger of social change through press, media, law, medicine, political ideology, social activism

BB Mishra: Member of middle class predominantly higher caste (generally elitist) but due to protective discrimination policy of govt. there is an increasing number of SC/ST in Middle Class.

Globalization & Middle Class

- Globalisation has led to an **increase in the size** of middle class. **Development indicators** also seem to have improved.
- **Suhash Palshikar:** Increased **consumerism due to globalization** is leading to Bourgeoisie becoming more and more dependent on Middle Class.
- **MN Srinivas:** Middle Class an **outcome of erstwhile globalization** when British arrived.
- **Y. Singh:** There is homogenisation of Middle Class. But cultural Identity maintained
- **Rajesh Kochhar:** Rise of **denationalized** Middle Class. Globalisation becoming **Glocalisation** because of large Middle Class.
- **NCAER:** Civil society will increase which will have political impact.

Values Related to Family, Marriage and Women's Status Amongst the Middle Class

Even in the 21st century:

- **Marriage is considered an important traditional social institution** that all are supposed to enter into.
- **Choices available with individuals, specifically women, are very few as marriage and motherhood are taken to be the ultimate goals.**
- A **woman's identity** is seen to be largely dependent on her marital status.
- Marriage is still seen as a **way of life** through which an individual entered adulthood in both upper and upper middle classes of urban India, who outwardly appear to be modern.
- **Particularistic criteria continue** to provide the normative basis for the formation of intimate relations among people across all classes.
- Although **arranged marriages**, whereby parents choose the prospective mates for their children are the **preferred form** of marriage, in the upper and upper middle classes, **certain changes** are observable.
- **Semi- arranged marriages**, in which individuals choose their own life partners but **marry only with the consent** of their parents, are also taking place.
- In **such marriages, inter-caste and inter- religious** marital alliances are being **tolerated**, albeit conditionally.
- **Hindu-Muslim and Hindu-Christian marriages are still taboo.**
- **Wedding ceremonies** are performed in a **traditional way**.
- In case of the **lower middle class**, such values and norms are comparatively **more deep- rooted**.
- **Certain ambiguities** are quite evident in the attitudes of those belonging to the middle class as they **seem to be more open to change** while responding to the same queries in questionnaires **but adopt a more traditional viewpoint** while narrating their life histories without being too conscious during in-depth interviews.
- Furthermore, the **stereotypical roles of man being the 'breadwinner' and woman the 'nurturer'** are perpetuated.
- There is '**superficial emancipation**' as **women are choosing clothes** that are in tune with the latest in the world of fashion. Yet **marriage and motherhood** are considered to be the **most important goals**, all decisions have to be in consonance with these.
- Although **women** in the upper and upper middle classes in the contemporary **appear to be more autonomous** compared to those belonging to the previous generations, they are **still considered to be appendages to men**.
- In the **realm of the size of the family**, the **women seem to have as much say** as the men.
- In the upper middle class, **parents lay emphasis on their daughters excelling in their studies** just as they would wish their sons to. **However**, emphasis is **not** laid on **higher education** as that is taken to be a **hindrance in getting good matrimonial matches**.
- A **harmonious marital relationship** is seen to be **dependent on women occupying a sub-ordinate status to men**.
- **Education is considered important** in order to **enable them to be better wives and mothers**.
- Significantly, **most women are gainfully employed but** they are compelled to join the work force **to meet the economic needs** of the family.

- **Women** are essentially **expected** to remain within the **domains of their households** and cater to the needs of their families. This is **viewed as a natural phenomenon**.
- Women do not have absolute freedom to decide on matters concerning selves. Thus, it is quite apparent that **women** in the middle class, both upper and lower are **still not self-determining individuals**.
- **Social roles** continue to be defined in accordance with **traditional expectations**.
- Also, **while forming friendships, particularistic norms continue** to play some role as such relationships are usually based on **class similarities** i.e. with similar economic background and value systems.

Thus, it is **quite interesting** to note that in contemporary times, the **middle class in India has not acquired a stable form** and **cannot yet be labeled as 'modern'**.

Concludingly

- Marriage, motherhood still an important goal in a family
- Arranged to semi-arranged, Inter caste allowed.
- Man – breadwinner
- Women seen as Nurturer
- Women still considered appendages to men, Higher education still not emphasized)

Issues Concerning The Middle Class

- **Caught between 'traditional' and 'modernity'** - In an economic sense, the emerging middle class **wants to replicate Western ideas and practises while culturally adhering to tradition**.
- There is still a **dominance of same-caste marriages**, for example, or a **surge in religious intolerance and hostility**.
- **Denationalisation** of middle class leads to continued **brain drain**.
- **An increase in 'Alienation'**: As a result of **over-competitiveness and a lack of assistance**, many employees in the corporate sector are experiencing **alienation, depression, and other mental difficulties**.
- Middle Class is **alienated** because of ambitions.
- **Women's Status**: Women's engagement in public spheres has expanded in recent years, although there are still **limits to their liberty and empowerment**.
- For example, there is a **rise in sexual harassment** and **lower income than male peers**.
- **The stereotypical roles of male as "breadwinner" and woman as "nurturer"**. Contradiction in middle-class ideals; they are modern in commercial choices, yet concepts remain ingrained in tradition, for example, women's identity still revolves around mother and wife rather than as an individual entity.
- There are increasing trends of family **Nuclearisation**.
- Increasing emphasis on **Consumerism** in the family keeps the evils like **Dowry** alive.

Impact of Covid on Middle Class

India's middle class has expanded rapidly in the twenty-first century.

Prior to the pandemic, **it was predicted that by 2025, 40% of the country's population** will be in the middle class.

However, the pandemic's onslaught had severely harmed the middle class, and **disparities** in society as a whole had worsened.

- According to the **Pew Research Center**, those earning **\$10-20 per day** are classified as middle class.
- According to PEW, due to covid, **32 million Indians** have fallen from the middle class to the poverty.

Pew Research Center on impact of Covid on Indian and Chinese Middle Class

- The number of people who are poor in India is estimated to have increased by 75 million because of the COVID-19 recession.
- **In China**, the number of people in the middle-income tier **likely decreased by 10 million**, and **poverty was virtually unchanged**.
- **Because economic growth in China remained positive**, even if slower than anticipated, the limited impact on its middle class helped to ease the strain.
- During covid, as a huge number among them were **forced to fall back on their savings**, many who had graduated to the middle class over time eventually **fell out of that category**.
- Similarly, **Inflationary pressure** might force the middle class to start **bringing down their consumption** further.
- But the whole issue here is **poor quality of public infrastructure**.
- Government has been doing well on creating a **start-up ecosystem as well as to push for private sector (gig) employability**.

Covid And Impact On Middle Class

Employees of the government or large commercial corporations

- This segment of the middle class is considered the most privileged since it was least harmed and gained financially from restrictions and lockdowns as travel costs and other expenses were decreased.
- However, this class was subjected to a great deal of work pressure
- The notion of working from home blurred the concept between 'home' and 'office'.
- Using the savings and benefits of decreased spending, this class began investing in financial markets. Between April 2020 and January 2021, around 10.7 million new demat accounts were established.

People associated with service sectors like transport, catering, hospitality, teachers in private schools & colleges, running coaching centres etc.

- **Huge financial stress** as no source of income. **EMI and other expenditure** eroded their savings.
- The Centre for Monitoring Indian Economy (CMIE) in May 2022 estimated that **over 1 crore Indians have been rendered jobless** because of the second wave.
- They were **also not able to get government help** as they were not part of lower class.
- This **vulnerable section** has a much higher presence of **70% amongst the middle class**.

The influence of covid on Gender differed among the middle class as well.

- While **male spouses** were primarily interested in **professional tasks**, **female partners** were involved in both the "outside" and "inside" domains.
- According to **UN Women**, women were battling a 'shadow epidemic' within their own homes.
- **Gendered division of labour**: Women were mostly responsible for the **family's needs** because domestic home assistance was not accessible. The phenomenon can be described as "**double load**" or "**second shift**".
- **Increase in domestic violence**: According to **National Commission for Women (NCW)** data, domestic violence complaints in India more than **quadrupled** after the statewide lockdown was implemented.
- **An increase in divorce lawsuits** and complaints: The **National Commission for Women** indicated that **more complaints were made in the 68 days after lockdown than in the previous ten years**. In 2020, the Commission received 23,722 complaints, the most in a single year in six years.

Other impacts

- Loss of **independence**
- Loss of **privacy** owing to a shortage of space in houses
- Increased **worry, stress, and sadness** as a result of many uncertainties
- **Lower middle-class families shifted their children** from private to **government schools** (considered a **downward mobility in Indian context**).

The Rising Importance of The Middle Class in India

By Ejaz Ghani (Senior Fellow, Pune International Center, Previously Lead Economist at the World Bank)

- Middle class is claimed to be the '**bird of gold**'.
- Empirical investigation suggests that **rising middle class is both a causal factor** behind India's improved economic and social outcomes – growth, education, home ownership, and social security – **as well as a consequence** of the rise in the middle class.

Impact on Government

- The government is **unlikely to be able to provide the quantity and quality of services** that will be demanded, in areas like health, education and water.
- Nearly **55% of the Indian population** is expected to join the ranks of the middle class.
- **India's favorable demographic trends** have set the stage for a massive expansion of the middle class as compared to China and USA.
- **Resurgent economy and Government's policy** can lead to the emergence of a **large bulge of population by 2025 out of absolute poverty** would create a new dynamics.
- **Future growth will depend on the rising middle class, and evolution of middle class depends on growth.**

Impact on Industries

Ejaz Ghani and Homi Kharas:

- The expanding demand for consumer durables is already leading to an acceleration in manufacturing in India.
- Data shows that Private consumption in India is almost 60% of the GDP, and private consumption growth

has accounted for 70% of Indian growth since 2000.

- Whereas in US, where domestic savings are declining and India's domestic savings and investments are on the rise and are financing investments.

Important Contributions of The Middle Class

- Contributions that the middle class makes to economic growth and social progress are:
 - Source of **entrepreneurship**
 - Contributor to **savings**
 - **Democracy** and **consumption** leading to demand for **infrastructure**
 - **Accelerating manufacturing** sector
- *Middle class being increasingly well-educated, enterprising, innovative ahead with a services-led growth, will keep making services more tradable.*

Other important observations

- Middle class can make and help **small businesses** that thrive.
- Technological advances will grow as **job opportunities cluster**
- There will be **sufficient migration between states** and from **rural to urban** areas.
- India as a **major consumption market** based on India's middle class as avid consumers with **sizeable spending capacity** and disposable income.
- This **attracts global businesses and investors**.

These middle-class people have a **cultural influence** over their purchasing tendency.

B 5

Systems of Kinship In India

Syllabus

- a) Lineage and descent in India.
- b) Types of kinship systems.
- c) Family and marriage in India.
- d) Household dimensions of the family.
- e) Patriarchy, entitlements and sexual division of labour.

Lineage And Descent In India

Lineage And Descent Revisited

Lineage

- It is the principle based upon which inheritance is chosen.
- **Example:** Patrilineage, Matrilineage.
- It refers to a particular type of kin group in which a member has a common ancestor whose identity is known.
- Also, a body of people who are arranged together on the basis of common blood linkage. Patriarchal society-daughter not part of father's lineage group.

Descent

- It is the principle whereby a child is socially affiliated with the group of his/her parents.

Classical Anthropologists

Patrilineal - determining descent through the male line.

Matrilineal- determining descent through the female line.

Lineage system can be divided into 2 parts

- **Unilineal** - a system of determining descent in which someone either belongs to father's lineage or mother's lineage, both patrilineal and matrilineal are included under unilineal lineage system.
- **Non unilineal**- a system where exists multiple forms of relationships.

Indologist: Ghurye

- **Role of descent in defining** marriage, family, kinship and India.
- In **Northern India** - some one can't marry within extended kinship group - marriage is driven by rules of kinship and descent.
- **Gotra and Charna are exogamous** groups- They bring dispersed people together.
- The **gotra and charna were kin categories** of Indo-European cultures which **systematized the rank and status** of the people.
- These categories were **derived from rishis** (saints) of the past.

- These rishis were the real or eponymous founder of the gotra and charna.

Gail Omvedt:

- Caste is an **expanded descent** system.

Andre Beteille:

- Kinship in India strong, so that **voting is driven by kinship** rather than on merit.
- Primary source of **political recruitment** is also kinship group.
- Thus, **Democratic political system** in India is engaged in **social and cultural reproduction**.

Krishna Kumar:

- Kinship in India is so intensive that- behind every **corrupt man** - there is an **ambitious family**.
- **Industrial recruitment** greatly takes place on the **basis of kinship** rather than on merit.
- With **modernity** in India, the **kinship and descent have not changed** much. Making them **important to study** under social transformation.
- Role of **descent and kinship** not only decides **private spheres** of life like marriage, family etc. rather very well defines occupation, political activities etc.

Types of Kinship System

Irawati Karve's Perspective

4 different kinship zones:

- North
- South
- Central
- East

North Indian Kinship System:

- Areas of more **Aryan culture influence** and Odisha, Bihar and West Bengal.
- **Patrikins and Matrikins** are different.
- Within patrilineal system **father's brother is distinguished from father's sister**.
- **Fathers brothers are also distinguished in terms of age**, so **differential respect** is attributed to them.

North Indian Kinship System:

- **Rule of marriage is highly exhaustive:** One is not supposed to receive a woman from a group to which a woman is offered within 5 to 7 generations.
- **One can't receive a woman from** his mother's group, mother's mother group, father's mother group, and his own village.
- **Marriage not in intra-family ties** rather in **inter-village** ties.

North Indian Kinship System:

- **Residential system is Virilocal:** Same as patrilocal and involves a series of presentational obligations.

- Please **recall that**, patrilocal residence or patrilocality, also known as virilocal residence or virilocality, are terms referring to the social system in which a married couple resides with or near the husband's parents.

North Indian Kinship System:

Veena Das adds:

- In north Indian kinship – **father son relationship** precedes over **husband wife relationship**
- On analysis of **Punjabi kinship system** she said- the natural **sexual** relationship between husband and wife is **subdued** to socially established father son relationship **glorifying patriarchy**.

South Indian Kinship System:

- Entire South India, some parts of Maharashtra and Odisha.
- No distinction between patrilineal and matrilineal.
- Father's brother is equivalent to mother's sister's husband- both their children, **parallel cousins**, see marriage among them.
- Father's sister group is equivalent to mother's brother group. Implying, mother's brother is at par with father's sister's husband.
- Specific patrilineal kins are equated with specific matrilineal kins.
- Love for younger and respect for elders cutting across generational principles- father ~ elder brother, mother ~ elder sister and younger brother ~ son, younger sister ~ daughter.
- Cross cousins marriage allowable- exogamy not exhaustive like north India.
- Husband wife relationship is not subdued to father son relationship unlike north India.
- Hostility of relationship between the laws driven by suspicion –weak in south India.

Central Indian Kinship System:

- Gujarat, Maharashtra, MP- mixture of elements from NI and SI.
- Rajputs- marriage- on status of girls' family- no caste bar- girl of their choice.
- Marthas-32 divisions- primary, secondary, tertiary divisions- marriage accordingly.
- Kumbi of Gujarat- can't marry within one generations from father's side and within 3 generations in mother's side.
- Rajasthan- On Akshaya Tritiya- massive marriage takes place- all age groups-relaxed norms.

Eastern Indian Kinship System:

- Munda of Odisha, Manipuri of Manipur, Nagas, Kukis and Khasi.
- Munda- 6 different class- associated with symbols like- bamboo, lizards, teak, crocodiles etc each class many lineage group- son gets patrilineal grandfather's name, daughter gets patrilineal grandmother's name, divorce is common among them.
- Khasi- youngest daughter inherits property from mother- status of man ~ status of woman in north India.

- These variations of kinship system speaks about differential residential system, property relations, status of men, women and children, entitlements based on gender-pluralistic society-unity is **not about destruction of plurality rather respecting the plurality.**

Family and Marriage In India

Indian Family: Joint or Nuclear

- In India, study of family was always about debate on Joint family vs Nuclear family.
- **David Mandelbaum:**
- Considers **Joint Family as one of the 3 characteristics** of Indian society (other two being Caste System, Village).
- **Henry Maine, O Mailey:**
- They **studied traditional Indian Joint Family** and termed it as **patriarchal family.**

What is a Joint Family?

Irawati Karve:

- **3-4 generations** people organically related to each other
- **Common Kitchen**
- **Common Residence**
- **Common Rituals**
- **Common Obligations** To Kartas

Joint family is a **product of culture**, so **economic transformations can't change** joint family system.

Indian Family is Joint Family

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Sir Henry Maine:

- He was the legal advisor to colonial govt.
- He compared Indian joint family with Roman and Greek joint family system.
- Based on textual material, he gave 2 concepts- **Common property holdings and Absolute authority of Karta.**
- Such a system **works like corporate unit**, where everyone **contributes differently but takes as per need.**
- It's sustenance is attributed to **moral institutions and rituals for common dead ancestors.**

GS Ghurye:

- Joint family is a **product of Indian culture**, that **glorified classical values**.
- One can see **universal presence of joint family** across **caste, religion and region**.

PN Prabhu:

- Individual's association with joint family is based on **moralism**.
- When **moralism converts to individualism** (tradition to modernity) - **joint family converts to nuclear family**.

Structural Break Down Of Joint Family System

Yogendra Singh- "Modernisation of Indian tradition"

In urban India:

- Inter Caste Marriage
- Love Marriage
- Guilt Free Sexuality in pre-marital and post-marital life.
- Industry-Occupational Mobility leading to rise of Nuclear Families
- Women Empowerment

This all is **causing structural break down** of Joint Family System.

Indian Family: Joint Family Persists

MN Srinivas and SC Dubey:

Caste and joint family relation-

- Higher Caste go For Joint Family
- Lower Caste Nuclear Family
- Joint Family Is Driven By Economics Logic Rather Than Cultural Logic.

Contrast To Y Singh:

- Joint Family Is Not Breaking Down Under Influence Of Urban Living.

Alan Rose:

- A study in Bangalore- 70% of families- either **structural jointness**, **functional jointness** or **both**.

MS Gore:

Study on Agarwals of Delhi:

- **Mother son** relationship **precedes** over husband wife relationship.
- **Family** is seen as a **strong support base** for its members in **selection of occupation, financial assistance** and **selection of mates**.

TN Madan:

- There is **Residential Separation**

- But there is **No Break Down** Of Joint Family
- “**Money Order Economy**”: Family members though live far away, yet support each other through remittances.
- Family jointness has always been **enduring** in India.
- Family transformation in India is **different from western** transformations.

Family In Contemporary India

What is a Family

- In classical terms, Family can be defined as a social group based on marriage having common residence with affectional relations.
- While according to Parsons, in modern society, the family can be defined as an institution based on emotional or marital relations who perform the function of stabilization of personalities.

Changes in Family in India

Yogendra Singh: The family structure experienced modern social changes in the form of **legal rational reforms** started by the Britishers and continued by new legislation in independent India with many more modifications. E.g. Hindu Marriage Act, Population policy etc.

The **major factors responsible for change in family** structure are:

- **Modernization**
- **Industrialization**
- **Education**
- **Democratization**
- **Urbanization**
- **Individualism**
- **legislation etc.**

Change in family structure

- **Traditionally** the families in Indian society were mainly **Joint families** while in **contemporary times** it is more of **nuclear families**.
- **I.P. Desai** studied families in **Mahuwa**, Gujarat and found that there is **an increase in nuclear family and decrease in joint family**.
- And now there is **emergence of a new live-in relationship**, where there exists **a nuclear family without marriage**.
- This change in structure is **mainly caused by migration of family members** to urban and metropolitan areas for better life opportunities.
- **Thus a large type of family types are now existing in India.**
- **I.P. Desai** has given five types of family – nuclear, functionally joint, functionally and substantially (in terms of property) joint, marginally joint, and traditional joint.

- **K.M. Kapadia** has given five types of family: nuclear (husband, wife and unmarried children), nuclear with married sons (what I.P. Desai calls Marginal Joint and Aileen Ross calls small joint family), lineal joint, collateral joint, and nuclear family with a dependent (widowed sister, etc.).
- **Aileen Ross (Book: The Hindu Family in Its Urban Setting)** has given four types of families: large joint, small joint, nuclear, and nuclear with dependents.

Change in Division of Labour

- In **traditional family** structure the work was **gender based**(sexual division of labour) as well as **age based**.
- The **senior most male member** used to define roles and responsibilities.
- While in **modern family** structure, it is **based on individual talent or merit** and is **increasingly becoming more egalitarian**.

Change in interaction within the family

- In traditional families there **used to be a centralized decision making** (mainly done by eldest male member of family) but **now the power within families are getting decentralized** with emergence of nuclear families, change in economic structure etc.
- There are increasing instances of families becoming **filiocentric**.

Increasing individualism within family

- Earlier in **traditional families** the decisions were made keeping in mind the **requirement of whole family** i.e. a **collective orientation** was present.
- But **modern family** system the decisions are getting **individualistic**.
- For example, earlier similar food for all members, buying clothes for whole family together.
- But this consumption behavior has changed to more individualistic with emergence of e-commerce sites and online food delivery apps.

Social subordination and Exclusion of women

- There is a remarkable change in social subordination and exclusion of women in family.
- In **traditional** family the status of women were **subordinate or relatively lower** than men.
- But in **nuclear families** and **more economic independence** of women, they are **increasingly getting equal status as men**.

Single parent Household

- In contemporary society **divorce and separation** is a new normal and a legal rational phenomenon leading to single parent household.
- Earlier divorce was considered as a **social taboo** and was not preferred at all even if there is no coordination in relation among husband and wife.
- **Empty shell marriages** are decreasing in number.

Change in reproductive function of family

Earlier **family and marriage** were considered as a **medium for procreation** and adding new members in the society.

But now this function of family has **lost its center stage** as many couples now prefer **not to have child due to**:

- Hard work schedule
- Fear of losing better career opportunities, especially for women
- Adding responsibility that might impact their independence
- Uncertainty of the relationship, etc.

Transforming intimate relationships

- According to Anthony Giddens, the romantic intimacies are now transforming into more passionate and individualistic intimacies.
- Now there is a higher level of sexual freedom which was earlier restricted by family values, cultural norms, caste, religion etc.

Impact of Green Revolution on families

- Families in green revolution zone definitely **improved on economic terms** but there was also **some dysfunctional consequences to female** counterparts of family.
- In traditional family structure women had equal participation in agricultural works.
- But green revolution involved heavy machinery to be used on fields and women were not considered capable to handle heavy machines (a patriarchal mindset), and moreover because of increased economic importance of Land, son preference increased manifold in regions like Haryana, Punjab etc.

Impact of COVID on families

- As COVID incurred a nationwide lockdown, which gave opportunity for members of families to live together which resulted in increased familial bond.
- But the long-term lockdown and many other social, economical problems also led to problems in families.
- For example there was increased cases of violence against women, increase in more assignment of care work to women, led to domestication of women etc.

Concludingly

According to Edmund Leach, in modern industrial society, the 'isolated nuclear families' are largely isolated from Kin group and wider society.

But even after widespread changes in contemporary family there are many traditional functions which are still continuing in modern families in India like:

- Socialization function of children
- Nuclear families still unite on festivals and celebrate it as a joint family
- Supporting family members in time of need (it was seen in COVID times, when all family members came

together to help each other) etc.

Making family still an important institution in Indian Society

Marriage in Contemporary India

What is Marriage

Marriage is one of the **important social institutions** found in all societies of the world **notwithstanding** having **different forms** of mate selection and different types.

One of the core issues of this institution is that **it sanctioned the:**

- **union of male and female for purpose of establishing a household**
- **procreating and**
- **providing care for the offspring**

Institution of Marriage and India

- Marriage is seen as indispensable in almost all the societies.
- According to **Hindu ideology** life is divided into **four stages**:
 - Brahmacharaya
 - Grihastha
 - Vanaprashtha
 - Samnyasa.
- The **second stage 'Grihastha'** dealt with marriage.
- The second stage grihastha dealt with marriage and included the **goals of Dharma, Artha and Kama**.
- The **Vedas** consider **marriage as a sacrament, a social and religious duty**. Marriage constitutes an **important process in a person's life cycle**.

Changes in pattern of Marriage in Contemporary India

The major changes in pattern of marriage in contemporary India

- With the change in time the **institution of marriage changed** as well.
- The **society transformed** from primitive to feudal and from feudal to industrial.
- This led to **changes in mode of production and so the division and differentiation of labor** which **affected all spheres of social existence** like the social, economical, political, cultural aspects of the society.

Marital Choices

- Earlier the marital **choices were made by family** (in traditional joint family system) also called **arranged marriage** by parents, while in **contemporary industrial society**, it has become **more of an individualistic phenomenon** (love marriages).
- In Indian society the phenomena like '**Co-decision making**' exist.
- Where marrying individuals along with parents make marital choices (**love-cum-arranged marriage**).

Aim of Marriage

- Earlier marriages were considered as a **responsibility** of society and family for procreation, legitimization of sex and cooperation to family.
- But now the goals for marriage is **more of individualistic, companionship** based and to fulfill intimate requirements.

Endogamy and Exogamy trends

- In **traditional** society the **inter-caste or inter-religious marriages were strictly prohibited** by caste norms and values but now inter-caste and inter-religious marriages are legally recognized.
- Still, most of the marriages in India are **in accordance** with caste and religious norms and values but there is a **slow shift towards inter-caste/inter-religious** marriages as well.

Form of Marriage

- **Monogamy** is the **most prevalent form** of marriage in contemporary India.
- **Polygyny** was practiced among Hindus **by a limited section** of society like Kings etc.
- But after passage of **Hindu Marriage Act 1955, Polygyny is strictly prohibited** for those who come under this law and monogamy is enforced.
- But **in Muslim community, a man can have up to 4 wives** at a time. But **such privilege is not extended to Muslim women**.
- **Polyandry is highly limited** in India, only few tribes like Todas of Nilgiris etc practice it.

Legal Rationalization of Marriage

- In traditional society marriage was institutionalized in terms of religious, spiritual, social, economic and political spheres but in modern society, it is more institutionalized in legal terms i.e. registration of marriages in courts.

Stability in Marriage

- In **traditional** society **divorce was considered as a taboo** and it was no option for the couples to consider if they are facing difficulties in managing their relation.
- So, the **traditional marriages were considered more stable** in nature.
- But in **contemporary** Indian society, the **divorce is legal rational** phenomena.
- Now there is high number of divorce cases seen in Indian society as well mainly due to **more economic independence, education, technology advancements** etc. this increasing phenomena of divorce is leading to establishment of 'single parent household system'.

Changing role of women

- In traditional societies the women after marriage was highly domesticated, especially women of higher

caste and class.

- But with increasing participation of women in workforce, they need to perform the 'dual role' i.e. taking care of home as well as doing their jobs.

Age of Marriage

- In traditional society child marriage or pre-puberty marriage was prevalent.
- Many efforts were made by liberal thinkers before independence to increase the age of marriage. For example Sarda Act.
- After independence, the Hindu Marriage Act 1955 fixed the minimum age of marriage to 21 and 18 years for boys and girls respectively (which is again being revised).
- So, the unhealthy practice of early marriage could be eradicated from society. And recently the government has decided to increase minimum age for girls to marry should be increased to 21 years.

Widow remarriage

- Now the rights of widows to remarry is legally recognized which was prohibited in traditional society and widows had to perform sati after death of their husband or live a totally secluded life from society.

Emerging new Institution

- **Heterosexual and Homosexual forms** of marriages or partnership are now being recognized in the society.
- Also, there is **emergence of live-in** relationships which **allows cohabitation of couples** without marriage.

Impact of COVID-19 on Marriage

- People resorted to **simple wedding ceremonies** instead of normal Indian weddings which involve participation of whole kinship group as close social group.
- With long lockdown period the institution of marriage witnessed change as there was **increased proximity**, joint domestic **chores sharing**, sometimes **strengthening of the bond** between husband and wife was witnessed and **sometimes increased instances of domestic violence** as they spent more time together.

Concludingly

- **Changes are inevitable** in any society and thus the institution of marriage has also experienced many changes.
- **Technological, economical, new educational patterns**, and **changes in lifestyle** are major factors responsible for change in marriage patterns in India.
- There are definitely some serious consequences of the changing marriage patterns such as the **increasing age at marriage** makes a considerable difference in **lowering the fertility rates**.
- But it has also provided us to avoid unhealthy practice of early child marriage which caused many health problems to premature pregnant girls as well as high infant and maternal mortality rates.

Household Dimensions Of The Family

AM Shah:

Book "Household **dimension of Indian family**"

He posed a fundamental question:

"Is the joint household disintegrating or not?"

He also believed that the **proportion of joint households is more today** as compared to the past.

It could be because of:

- Rising population and scarcity of space to build a new house.
- Construction of houses is becoming costlier
- Migration for employment
- Bigger households splitting into smaller households but strong emotional ties though not staying together
- Joint household splitting not joint families.

Therefore, it is **important to study Household in India**.

Also, **Sociologists** believe that Because of modernity it is important to distinguish between Household (which is a residential place) and the **family** (which is a social institution).

What is a Household?

U.S. Census Bureau:

A household is defined as **all the people who occupy a single housing unit, regardless of their relationship to one another**.

The two primary types are:

- Family households
- Non-family households

Family households:

- They have a **householder** and one or more additional **people who are related to the householder** by marriage, birth, or adoption.
- Any **children** under age 18 who are the **biological, adopted, or stepchildren** of the householder are classified as "own children."
- Family households **include married couples** with and without children under age 18, **single-parent households** with children, and other groupings of related adults such as **two siblings sharing a housing unit or a married couple** whose adult child has moved back home.
- Family households **can also include additional people** who are not related to the householder, **such as a boarder**.

Nonfamily households:

- They have a **householder who lives alone or who shares the housing unit** only with **nonrelatives**, such

as **roommates** or an **unmarried partner**.

- **Unmarried** partner households can be **either family or nonfamily** households depending on which partner is designated as the householder and whether any additional household members are related to the householder.
- If an unmarried couple has a **biological child** together, then for census purposes such a **household is considered a single-parent family** even though such a child would actually be living with both biological parents.
- However, if a child is related to only one partner of an unmarried couple, then the household can be either a single parent family or a nonfamily household depending on which partner is arbitrarily designated as the householder.

Indian concept of a Household

- The **family** is based on the principles of kinship whose members usually share a **common residence**.
- They **reside in a house**. This residential unit is **called the household**.
- The members of a household have a **set of relational ties amongst them**. These ties are **linked with the statuses held and the corroborating role complexes** members of the family are expected to constitute.
- The **household** (ghar) is a **residential and domestic unit** composed of one or more persons living under the **same roof and eating food cooked in the same kitchen** (hearth/chulah).
- It may so happen that **not all the members of a family live in the same household** all the time.
- **Geographically distanced** homes may be occupied by a few of the members of a given family.
- These members then reside in **two or more households** but they **consider themselves as belonging to the same family**.
- The household is a **commensal** and **coresident** group/unit (with provision for the phenomenon of single person households).
- Thus, **kin and residence rules distinguish between family and household**.

Shah's Household Dimensions Of The Family

Dimension of study should be household based on:

- Commensal
- Co-resident
- Coparcenary
- Co-rituals

Two types of household:

- **Simple**
- **Compound** (2 or more parents).

Pauline Kolenda's Household Dimensions Of The Family

- Kolenda consistently worked towards clarifying the conceptual issues about family and household.

- She has proposed the 12 type classificatory scheme in her comparative study of the Indian joint family based on 26 post-1949 ethnographic studies and household censuses (Kolenda 1968).
- These classes of obtained household compositions are vast and extend our horizon beyond the joint-nuclear or extended-elementary types of families.
- This scheme does not obscure the phenomenon as a simple joint versus nuclear family one does.

The 12 type classes are as follows:

1. Nuclear Family, a couple with or without unmarried children
2. Supplemented nuclear family
3. Subnuclear family
4. Single person household
5. Supplemented subnuclear family
6. Collateral joint family
7. Supplemented collateral joint family
8. Lineal joint family
9. Supplemented lineal joint family
10. Lineal collateral joint family
11. Supplemented lineal collateral joint family
12. Other, a residual class

Why shall we still study The Household Dimension Of The Family

- These classes of households are useful in the understanding the continuum between variations of joint and nuclear family forms over a life cycle.
- Even after modernity has emerged in India, joint households and joint families still exist.
- There can't be a clear-cut conclusion unlike Marxist scholars on the disassociation of Joint Families.
- She writes that number of Nuclear is more than Joint Families.
- Average size of household increasing (this is because the death rate is decreasing and life longevity is increasing).
- Household have lifecycle (fission - fusion - fission).
- There are **instances of Stem family**, that is Parents residing with married children.
- **Rural household size is typically more** than urban size.
- There are **regional differences**. For example, North India has more incidence of Joint Family than South.
- Shah, Kolenda helped **break the myth of disintegration of Joint Family** in India.
- **Feminist view-** whether joint family or nuclear family transformation is **not affecting status of women** - sexuality, DOL, reproduction are still based on **patriarchy**.

Rise of socialism and modernity:

- Since a lot of **functions of the Family are being taken by alternatives** such as play schools, old age homes, marriage bureaus, child-care centers – **family's importance has come down**, making the **household's**

importance up.

- From **household study** we can **find out changes in Indian society**.
- **Increased migration (Global and within the country)**: It is leading to **married women finding job outside, living in households with friends or alone**.

In a household:

- More **importance to friendship** than to kinship
- Immense **individual liberty**
- **Sexual freedom**
- Limited or **no liability** towards other members
- Suitable for **fragile or mobile population**.

Household study is taking place of **family study**, so as **friendship study** taking place of **kinship study**.

Patriarchy, Entitlements And Sexual Division Of Labour

Patriarchy In Contemporary India

What is Patriarchy

- Patriarchy generally refers to the hierarchical power relation in which men are dominant and women are subordinate.
- The subordination of women is explicit in many ways, in both private and public spheres, where women are denied rights and access to many things that are easily available to men.
- Patriarchy, then, can be seen as a social system in which men hold primary power, predominate in the roles of political leadership, moral authority, special privilege and control of the property.
- They also hold power in the domain of the family, as fatherly figures.

Why study Patriarchy

- Patriarchy as a concept/tool helps in the critical understanding of the status of women in any society.
- According to the eminent gender historian Gerda Lerner:
 - Patriarchy manifests and institutionalises the domination of men over women and children within the family, and extends its influence over the public sphere in a society.
- In spite of patriarchy having common features across societies, it acts differently in every society, combining with other dominant structures.
- In India, this nexus between patriarchy and the caste system has been found to be historically exploitative and mutually feeding off each other.

The Major Changes of Pattern Of Patriarchy In Contemporary India

Endogamy

- The institution of marriage plays a significant role in the preservation of caste order and hierarchy.

- The patriarchal practice of marrying within one's caste has long been a functional component in maintaining the purity and hierarchies of the caste system and leading to oppression of women.
- Women in the caste stratified patriarchal society are perceived as gateways to caste order and purity, any step towards flouting the system of endogamy reduces them to a social position and condition that is morally and emotionally humiliating.

Dr. Ambedkar's Perspective:

- **"Castes In India: Their Mechanism, Genesis and Development"**, a research paper in which **Dr. Ambedkar** seeks to establish caste as a product of sustained endogamy.
- He says that the **surplus woman** is **"disposed of"** in one of two ways. When **sati** – burning a woman on her husband's pyre – was not possible, **enforced and degraded widowhood** was pressed into service.
- **"Male superiority among groups" did not allow a surplus man**, or a widower, to be subject to the same treatment. Because **losing a man was losing labour and depleting group numbers**, the problem was resolved by **marrying him to someone from a not-yet marriageable group**, a moral fence scaled by institutionalising girl child marriage.
- **Sati, child marriage, and enforced widowhood** accrued social values and led Brahmanical ideology to both **preserve and eulogise** the very **practices that degraded women**.

This practice is still prevalent but has **changed its form** and has become **online and advertisement oriented**.

It is not unusual to see **online matrimonial profiles asking for same sub-caste person** for marriage.

Honour Killing

- In a patriarchal society, women are believed to be the **carriers of a family's or a group's honour**.
- In such a society, it is believed that the honour flows from a woman's body which, thus, shall be controlled and protected by men.
- **Women lose agency of even their bodies.**
- Honour killing is defined as **a death that is awarded to the women or men by their own family members for marrying against their wishes** or having a **pre-marital relationship, marrying within the same gotra** or **marrying outside their caste**.
- It is mainly found in case of **Pratiloma marriages** which is **not sanctioned by Hindu traditions**.

Pink Collarisation

- This socially accepted patriarchal behavior created a vicious cycle where women or less dominant men are not fully in charge of choosing their career or occupation(s) and are, then, increasingly confined to low status and low income occupations such as nurses, primary teachers.

Dual Burden

- Indian society consists of many religious and cultural groups but some **gender stereotypes** are consistent among the majority of these social groups thereby **perpetuating sexual division of labour** where a woman though if working is required to perform household duties after returning from work.

Son Meta Preference

- Economic Survey 2018 highlighted the phenomenon of son meta-preference which involves parents adopting fertility 'stopping rules' having children until the desired number of sons are born.
- This meta-preference leads naturally to the notional category of 'unwanted' girls which is estimated at over 21 million.
- Thereby the earlier practice of female infanticide though has declined but these unwanted girl child have to bear the brunt of lack of resources being allocated to them.

Dowry Deaths

- Dowry is the **collective urge of a patriarchal society to show off their status, wealth and groom's worth** in society thereby showing how much money or gifts the groom received.
- The practice of dowry exchange has assumed a **prominent place** in contemporary society even though there are **enough legal provisions to curb** it.
- The practice of **virilocality further alienated a woman from her parental support system** and made her **dependent on her husband's family**, with her parents always at the disposal of her husband's family demands.
- Along with the presence of **gender-inequality** makes the **bride's family obliged** to make the dowry demands met at any cost.
- The **enormous pressure on women from society and family** forces them to spend their **lives within the four walls** of the house **without raising their voice and enduring** all forms of violence at the hands of in-laws and husbands just for the **protection of pride, honor and reputation** of their families.
- The sheer **ignorance and lack of sympathy from society** makes it even more difficult for the victims of abuse and torture to come forward and raise their voices or put forward their opinions.

Educational Deprivation

- In India, the **literacy rate of women is much lower** than men because boys receive more schooling than girls.
- **India is one of the 43 countries** in the world where the **male literacy rate is at least 15% higher than female** rates. (The results of 2011 census reveal that there has been an increase in literacy in the country. The literacy rate in the country is 74.04 per cent, 82.14 for males and 65.46 for females.)

Disguised Political Representation

- The concept of '**sarpanch pati**', where men relatives (mostly husbands) of elected women run office in place of them.
- The concept of **Sarpanch Pati** gives a sense of accomplishment that women have been **given representation but they do not have decision making power**.

Concludingly

- Many Feminists argue that Patriarchy exists in all cultures, and thus the **concept itself is too general to be useful**, as it **fails to take account** of how **other factors** such as **caste, class and ethnicity** combine to oppress

different women in different ways.

- With the **advent of feminism**, women's rights on the ground of the equality of the sexes were strongly advocated. The **French and American revolutions** in the late 18th century made people, for the first time, pay attention to the **issue of rights for women**.
- The **different waves of feminism** took up issues related to **political change, unity and sisterhood**, and **class and race** to ensure women political, economic, and social equality.
- A lot has been changed since then, instead of earmarking patriarchy, the **focus of responsible and sensible families is on respecting varied women's involvements, individualities, acquaintance and influence**, and **facilitating women empowerment** so that they can grow to realise their full rights, and consequently reduce social inequalities.

Patriarchy, Entitlements And Sexual Division Of Labour

What is Entitlement:

- It is a form of individual right.
- It is a belief that one is deserving of or entitled to certain privileges.

It is driven by:

- Culture
- Rules of law
- Societal Values

Modernist theory- Various forms of entitlements have now **extended to every section** – gender not the only criteria.

Modernity and Women Empowerment

Talcott Parsons wrote that with **increasing modernity**, the following will work for the **empowerment of women** and the gender gap will reduce:

- **Industrialisation**
- **Urbanisation**
- **Migration**
- **Occupational mobility**

Modernist Theory in Case Of India

Increasingly in India:

- Relationship between Husband And Wife is beginning to Precede Parent Child Relationship
- Conjugal Relationship More Important Than Obligation Towards Kinships
- Irrespective Of Gender, Every Child Inherits Property From Parents
- Selection Of Mates No Longer Family's Responsibility
- Child Birth Is Linked To Economics And Mutual Agreement Between Spouse

- Modernity Has Broken Down Traditional Form Of Marriage, Hierarchical Form Of Relationship.

But the following values are still active

- Preference of **Sexual purity**, therefore, **child marriage**
- **Sexual experimentation outside marriage** and **premarital sex** is **immoral** and evil
- **Male child** makes a woman complete
- **Divorce** is evil
- **Widowhood** is disaster
- **Culture defines** sexuality, reproduction, DOL, Sexuality (Modernist contradicted- nuclear family, child birth by choice, individual control over sexuality increasing)
- **Indira Jai Singh**: All laws of entitlements based on patriarchy than gender equality. She takes the example of **Hindu marriage act** where **divorce can be based on adultery** but have to be proved in court.
- **Victims of rape** have to **recast the same experience again and again** in order to **get justice**.
- Inheritance rights over parents property to women have recently been made law but the culture still prohibits it.

Patriarchy and Entitlements

Tulsi Patel

- Women consider it as sin to prohibit their husbands from sexuality, which leads to unwanted pregnancy.
- Women lose life during child birth, in bad health, accepting patriarchal convention, forgetting their entitlements.
- Wage payment: Women's less than half compared to men, despite doing twice work than men in factories.
- Family is a paradise in a hopeless world, where marriage, child birth, motherhood makes woman's life complete.
- Feminist movements is not rebellion against patriarchy rather asking for equality.

B 6

Religion and Society

Religious Communities

Religious Communities in India

- India is a land of several religions.
- Religious communities in India can be broadly divided into 3 categories on the basis of their **origins**:
 1. **Local** origin - Hinduism, Sikhism, Buddisims, Jainism.
 2. **Foreign** origin - Islam, Christianity, Zoroastrianism.
 3. **Folk** religion - Donyi-Polo (Arunachal P.), Sarna(Santhal), Sanamahi(Manipur), etc.
- **Continuous interaction** between local religious communities and those which came from outside led to the formation of **composite culture**.

Major Religious Communities - Hindus

- Constitute about 80% of the population.
- One of the most ancient religions, tracing back to IVC.
- Does not have a single historical founder.
- Composite culture - amalgamation of different sects, & belief systems, No single sacred text
- Belief in vast body of sacred texts : Vedas, Upanishads, Puranas, Darshanas, Tantras, etc.
- Social basis- 4 Varnas, Concept of Purity & pollution
- Innumerable endogamous 'Jatis'

Major Religious Communities - Buddhism

- Historical Founder: Siddhartha Gautama (Buddha)
- Propagated throughout the world under the rule of Mauryan king Ashoka.
- Less than 1% population in India.
- Opposed Caste system, Brahmanical order.
- 4 Noble Truth ->
 - Suffering (Dukkha), Cause (Samudaya), Cessation(Nirodha), End of suffering by 8 fold path (Atthanga Magga)
- Major Sects in India -> Hinayana, Mahayana, Vajrayana/Tantrayana & Neo-buddhist(Dr. Ambedkar)

Major Religious Communities - Jainism

- Historical Founder: Vardhamana Mahavira (24th Tirthankar)
- 0.4% of total population in India.
- Social Basis- Non-violence (ahimsa) & vegetarianism

- Followers -> Ordinary people & 'Yatis' (monks)
- Prescribed way of life - Triratnas (Right Faith, Right Knowledge, Right Conduct)
- Two main sects - Digambara(males -'Munis') & Shwetambara (monks- both men & women 'white clad')
- Various sub-sects under two main sects.

Major Religious Communities - Sikhism

- Historical Founder: Guru Nanak -16th Cen. AD
- Sacred Text - Guru Granth Sahib
- Started as a movement against Idol worship & untouchability.
- Belief system - One God, Ten Gurus and the holy book
- To practise equality - started community kitchen (Langar)
- Major sects -
 1. Nirankaris (Opposed Idol Worship)
 2. Namdharis (Opposed Caste system, early marriages, Infanticides)
- Securing religious interests - Sri Gurudwara Prabandhak Committee (SGPC) & Akali Dal for Political interest.

Major Religious Communities - Islam

- Historical Founder: Prophet Muhammad (7th Cen. AD)
- Abrahamic Religion like Christianity & Judaism
- About 14% of total population
- Sacred Text - The Quran
- Established in India through Muslims trader & Invaders
- Social Basis - Collective morality and responsibility
- 4 religious duties
 - Prayer(Namaz), Paying 'Zakat' (welfare-tax), Fasting (Ramzan), Pilgrimage (Haj)
- Two main sects - Sunnis & Shias | Sufi - Liberal sect
- Interaction with Hindu system led to emergence of caste system in South Asian Muslims.

Major Religious Communities - Christianity

- Historical Founder: Jesus Christ
- First came in India - around 52 AD (at Kerala)
- Second movement of Protestants Christians came in 16th century with European traders
- 2.3% of total population
- Sacred Text - The Bible
- Belief system - One God - revealed himself to Jesus

- Two major sects -
 1. Catholics (consider Pope - main authority)
 2. Protestants (reformist - Pope not an authority)
- Colonial Christian Missionaries converted mainly from lower caste & tribes, providing education & money.

Major Religious Communities - Zoroastrianism

- Historical Founder: Zoroaster, 1000 BC
- Came from Pre-Islamic Iran (Persia) in 8th Cen. AD
- 0.06% of total population
- Sacred Text - Zend Avesta
- Does not follow any Caste or Class system
- Settled mostly in western India (Gujarat & Maharashtra)
- Parsis have been the leaders in India's modernisation.

Religious Minorities & Their Problems

Religious Minorities in India

- The country of India is multilingual and multireligious.
- Indian society has a pluralistic nature from a religious and other perspective.
- People from many faith communities have coexisted in this nation for a very long time.
- Despite the fact that **Hindus make up the bulk** of the population here, people belonging to different religious communities, including Buddhists, Christians, Sikhs, and Muslims, Jains, and 26 **others coexist** alongside Hindus and **have equal access to the same rights and opportunities**, too.
- Hindus make up the majority because of their size compared to the rest of the population.

Who is a Minority - Constitutional Position

"Minorities" appears at four places in the Constitution – in the headnotes of Articles 29 and 30, and clauses (1) and (2) of Article 30.

The Constitution does not define "minority".

- The **most obvious definition of minorities is in terms of numbers** – a minority is a group that is **numerically smaller** than the majority in a society. **But the preponderance or the lack of numbers alone is not a guide to any authoritative definition.**
- In **apartheid South Africa**, minorities exercised power and domination over the rest of the society.
- A **second component** of the definition of minority is that the **group must be non-dominant** in society and the polity. But **this may not lead to despondency or a feeling of exclusion** always. Parsis are a good example.

- The **Constitution** talks of only religious and linguistic minorities. It **does not** recognize sexual minorities such as LGBTQ+.

Who is a Minority – Arnold Rose’s Perspective

- Before we proceed, it is important to describe who is a Minority.
- In the **International Encyclopaedia of the Social Science**, **Arnold Rose** has defined minority **without any quantitative connotations**.
- He defines it as:
- ‘a group of people differentiated from others in the same society by race, nationality, religion or language, who think of themselves as differentiated group and are thought of by others as a differentiated group with negative connotations.
- Further, they are **relatively lacking in power** and hence are **subjected to certain exclusions, discrimination** and other **differential treatments**.

Who is a Minority – Jagnath Pathy’s Perspective

Jagnath Pathy (1988) has also listed out the defining properties of minority group.

In his opinion, the minorities are:

1. Subordinate in some way to the majority
2. Distinguishable from the majority on the basis of physical or cultural features
3. Collectively being regarded and treated as different and inferior on the basis of these features
4. Excluded from the full participation in the life of the society.

Problems Of Religious Minorities

The challenge of providing protection

- Minorities frequently feel a need for safety and protection. Minority communities request police protection, particularly when there is **intercommunal violence**, caste conflict, widespread **festival observance**, or **large-scale religious events**. It is **challenging for the current administration's government** to offer such protection to all minorities. Furthermore, it is rather pricey. State governments that do not offer this protection are frequently criticised.

The issue of racial tensions and riots

- Since independence, racial tensions and riots have been steadily rising. **Minority interests are jeopardised whenever riots and racial tensions occur**, and broad worries and anxieties develop. Regaining people's trust in the current administration becomes a difficult undertaking.

Lack of participation in politics and the civil service

- Despite the **Constitution's guarantee of equality and equal chances** for all citizens, including religious minorities, the largest minority group—**Muslims in particular**—has **not taken advantage of these provisions**. They have the impression that they are being ignored. The **other religious minority communities**, such as the Christians, Sikhs, Jains, and Buddhists, **do not appear to experience this feeling**, as they appear to be **better off economically and educationally** than the dominant group.

Deprivation of societal goods

- Deprivation of beneficiary job opportunities and quality education has led to the members of some of these communities to struggle for a minimum standard of living. Abject poverty characterizes the members of some of these communities.

Identity Crisis

- The **issue of identity** also becomes prominent in this regard. The minority communities have felt **disoriented** and **displaced** due to their **fear of being engulfed** by the overwhelming majority. They feel threatened by the proposition of losing their own identity to the majority religious community.

Hate Crimes

- We have witnessed an **alarming rise in the hate crimes** against the minority communities in India, including the **desecration of places of worship**. Programs like the Ghar Wapsi Movement, have led to the rise of **forced conversions** in different parts of the country.

Issue of Separatism

- **Some of the demands** made by some religious communities in certain regions are **not acceptable to others**.
- **The distance** between them and others **has grown** as a result.
- Examples: The **issue of Kashmir** is often seen as an issue of **Islamist extremism** and not as an issue of **sub-nationalism**.
- Similar demands for breakaway states made by certain **Christian fanatics in Nagaland and Mizoram** is not often seen in **religious light**.

Lack of Secular tones in Politics

- India has proclaimed itself to be a "**secular**" nation, yet it has **not adhered rigidly to secularism**. Our Constitution's core principles are secular. Almost all **political parties** including the Muslim League **profess themselves to be secular**. However, **in practice, no party is seen sincerely dedicating itself to secularism**. These parties **frequently politicise topics that are purely religious**. Similarly, situations that are merely law and order-related and secular are both given **religious overtones**.
- As a result, these parties' **credibility** in their dedication to secularism is **compromised**. **Minorities have developed mistrust** and a sense of insecurity as a result.

Specific Minority oriented Problems

Problems Of Muslim Minorities

- **Social Issues:** Around 14% of the population but one of the most discriminated minority in India **due to historical reasons, Muslims face prejudices** in areas including **employment, education and housing** leading to their **Ghettoization**.
- **Failure to Stay Strictly to Secularism-** Parties who claim to represent them, **politicize communal issues** and take political advantage out of it.
- This led to **suspicion and a feeling of insecurity** in the minds of minorities.
- **Problem of Separatism:** The demand of Majority community in **Kashmir** for a separate nation, **widened the gap between them and others**.
- For eg: The tendency to relate Islamic religious extremists and their need in Kashmir. The establishment of independent Kashmir is **unacceptable to the majority**. Such a demand is **considered anti-national**.

Problem of Communal Tensions and Riots:

- Whenever **Social tensions and riots** happen for whatever reason, it is **appropriated to Muslim community**, serving the interests of a few people; **fear and anxiety spreads** in larger community.

Problem of Providing Protection:

- The sense of **helplessness** prevails when **state's inability to provide protection**.
- Especially in times of community violence, consumer disputes, mass celebrations and religious activities scale, small groups are constantly seeking police protection.

Problems Of Sikhs Minorities

- **Social Issues:** Despite the Sikh community's relative wealth, the **sex ratio** is dismal.
- The additional issues are the **high rate of drug** and **alcohol abuse** among young people.
- Punjab's drug addiction problem is not only a matter of law and order, the problem is **economic too**.
- Even though the **governments of the time have also been held responsible to help and encourage it**.
- A more extensive discussion is required on the best way to **gainfully employ both the youth** leaving the agricultural sector and the new workers.

Inadequate employment opportunities:

- The **menace of drug addiction is only a symptom** of the **larger malaise** afflicting our economic policy which has **failed to create adequate employment** opportunities.
- Unfortunately, there is **not enough recognition** of the problem, making a solution a distant dream.

Depeasantization:

- With **migration abroad slowing** in recent years and **lack of alternative employment** the process of 'Depeasantization' has led to a **situation where the farming Sikh community is increasingly moving out of agriculture**.
- A **majority of the cultivating castes and groups are still averse to manual labour** and have not been able to find work in the non-farm sector.

Political Problem:

- The question was "How could the Sikhs retain their distinct and separate identity in a nation-state nominally pledged to secularism but in actual practice increasingly following Hindu norms?"
- Their relations also became strained with the majority in the wake of **events related to Khalistan Movement, Operation Bluestar**, the consequent **assassination of PM Indira Gandhi** and ensuing communal violence for which justice still seems elusive.

Problems Of Parsi Minorities

Demographic Challenge:

- The real problem confronting the community is not political but demographic – one of the steadily declining numbers.
- They are the most **affluent minority community in India, but their numbers are dwindling**.
- The 2011 Census found that the Parsi population has declined by 18 per cent to 57,264 in a decade, virtually reducing them to the status of an urban tribe while in the same decade total population of India increased by around 17.64 per cent.

- **Socially**, they are well off with the **literacy rate of 97.9 per cent** and a **sex ratio of 1050** as per 2011 Census figures.
- This is a **highly inward looking group** with a **prohibition** on entry to the community by way of **conversion** and **no permissions for exogamy**.
- **Inbreeding, reduction of fertility rate, late marriages, and out of community marriages of Parsi women** is further dwindling their numbers.

Outsiders and Exploiters:

- The **Parsis in Assam, Bengal and Bihar** are a **minority**, but they **control trade and business** in these states.
- They are treated as '**outsiders**' and '**exploiters**'.
- '**Sons of the Soil**' movement have been **reported in Assam, Bengal, Orissa and Karnataka**, and subsequently **Parsis were looted, killed** in Bolangir (Orissa).
- According to **Roy and Unisa**, **childlessness and migration** are big contributors to their dwindling numbers.

Some Solutions

Religious Minorities Rights' violation

- The pluralist and multi-religious character of the Indian society faces a constant challenge against these problems confronting the minorities.
- These problems **not only correspond to the failure of the government in facilitating equality to all communities** but are **also major human rights violations**.
- They contradict the fundamental statutes of religious freedom and equality, as guaranteed by the constitution.

Protection against Communal Riots

- In **areas identified as sensitive** from the religious point of view, very **efficient, honest and strict police officers** known for their secular outlook should be appointed so that better protection could be given to the minorities.
- **Police officers and district collectors** who render an impartial and an **efficient service** in controlling communal tensions must **be felicitated**.
- **Stringent legal action** must be taken against those **who instigate communal riots** and violence.
- **Separate courts** to be established to investigate into the criminal cases connected with communal riot.
- **Mass media** such as radio and T.V. etc., must assist the establishment **in reviving communal harmony, peace and mutual understanding** in the riot-hit areas.

Appointment In State And Central Services

- The **States** are to be instructed to take extra care regarding the minorities in **making appointments** for the police department.
- The **railways, banks and industries in the public sector** do provide **employment opportunities** to a large number people. These establishments should pay **proper attention to the employment needs of the minorities**.

- **Special training classes** should be held in the minority institution to the candidates belonging to the minority communities, so that they improve their qualities in competing for competitive examination. Such a training may help them to become successful in getting jobs.
- Special encouragement must be given to **open technical institution** such as ITI, polytechnics and engineering colleges in the areas in which the minorities are found.

Other Programmes

- In the various developmental programmes and projects of the Government including the 20 point programme, care should be taken to see that the minority people are also able to obtain their due share in these programmes.
- In addition to the above mentioned , many local issues such as Wakfs properties, cremation ground encroachment disputes, conversion cases, provision to create minority run special educational bodies etc. may create lot of tensions.
- If these are not settled immediately and amicably they may turn out to be big problems tomorrow.
- Local administration must pay proper attention to these.

Protecting Religious Minorities

- The development and well being of these minority religious communities rests on the **amendments to existing laws and the better implementation** of the same.
- Immediate attention is required to protect the rights of these communities and to improve their conditions of welfare.

Supreme Court and Religious Minorities

- The court recently said that no new religious group is to be recognised as a minority, and that the National Commission of Minority must work towards reducing the list of religious minorities and finally do away with it altogether.
- This was a call for assimilation – but our Constitution wants integration, not assimilation.
- Article 25 does not give freedom of religion only in respect of existing religions but also newer forms too.
- It does not bar the birth of new religions. New religions can come into existence, and such groups may be recognized by the government as religious minorities.

UCC Uniform Civil Code

What is Uniform Civil Code

- Uniform Civil Code also known as “Samāna Nāgrika Saṁhitā” is a proposal in India to **formulate and implement personal laws** of citizens which **apply on all citizens equally regardless of their religion, gender and sexual orientation**.
- Currently, **personal laws of various communities are governed by their religious scriptures**.

Functions of Uniform Civil Code

According to **Faizan Mustafa** (former Vice-Chancellor of NALSAR University of Law, Hyderabad):

- **Eliminating gender discrimination** - over the years the rights of women have been limited because of religious laws. Liberal and gender sensitive civil code is need of the hour
- A uniform law **increases inter-caste and inter-religious marriages**.
- **Religious harmony** - because it separates social relationships and personal laws from Religion.
- Uniform civil code **controls the population explosion**.
- **Jawaharlal Nehru and Dr. BR Ambedkar** continued **endorsing** the uniform civil code as an **instrument of modernization, secularisation and national integration**.
- **Supports national integration** - supreme court judge **YV Chandrachud** says -a common civil code will also help in **strengthening the cause of national integration by removing conflicting interests** because **humanism is our creed** and a common law for all Indian is our ideal.
- All religions as **oppressive products of a less developed society**, the introduction of a uniform civil code seen as the only **solution to get rid of the continued exploitation based on religion**.

Criticism of Uniform Civil Code

- **Threat to communal harmony** - it creates fear among various religions especially minorities.
- **Government interference into personal matters** - question the legitimacy and secularism of the state.
- **Law Commission of India** stated that the Uniform Civil Code is “**neither necessary nor desirable** at this stage” in the country. The Commission said secularism cannot contradict the plurality prevalent in the country.
- **Constitutional contradiction** - The conflict of **freedom of religion with equality** before law and right to equality.
- **Generalization of oppression of women** - Blind drive for social reform without addressing
- the **distinct subject position and living reality of the women** have been the bane of the rights of women and change in their status.
- **Threat of Majoritarian dominance** over minorities - misconception about Hindutva model
- of uniform civil code.
- Just **formal equality instead of substantive equality**.

Sabarimala Judgement and Patriarchy Operating via Religion

Sabarimala (literally meaning “the Sabari hill”) is a hill located in the state of Kerala, and is an important Hindu temple dedicated to the worship of **Ayyappan**.

Peculiarity

The main peculiarity about Sabarimala is that the **near totality of its pilgrims are men**.

Till the Supreme Court verdict was passed in September 2018, there existed **a formal prohibition** preventing women between 10 and 50 years old -- that is to say women in fertile age -- from accessing the temple at any point in time.

Reason for the ban

Ban on entry for women of a certain age at Sabarimala temple is based on the "**patriarchal**" belief that the dominant status of a **man** in society makes him **capable of performing** austerity while a woman, who is only a "**chattel of man**", is **incapable of remaining pure for the 41 days of penance** prior to the pilgrimage.

Judgement

After years of struggle, the Supreme Court in 2018 declared unconstitutional the banning the entry of women in the age group of 10-50 years (menstruating women) into the hill shrine in Kerala.

The majority stressed that:

- Women must be treated equally with men under Articles 14 and 15 and
- Affirmed their right to freedom of religion under Article 25.

The petitioners and the amicus also argued that Article 17 of the Constitution prohibited untouchability "in any form", therefore it covered the current case as well.

The practice was termed as "unconstitutional" and as a form of "untouchability" within the meaning of Article 17 by Justice Dr D.Y. Chandrachud.

While acknowledging Ambedkar's contribution to annihilate the caste hierarchy, Justice Chandrachud proceeded with widening Article 17.

He took Article 17's roots of "purity and pollution" along with a literal interpretation of the phrase "in any form" to advance this provision to the exclusion of menstruating women.

The Kerala government decided to wait for a clear-cut and final verdict before extending protection to women who wanted to exercise their right in the face of opposition from traditionalists and temple priests.

It was said during the judgement that the Constitution is not bound by any religious practices. While it was widely contested whether the court had the mandate to interpret religious practices, the judges held that irrespective of a religious practice being essential or not, the constitutional values will and should prevail over essential and certain aspects of religion.

Patriarchy

Patriarchy, as defined by Sylvia Walby, is 'A system of social structure and practices in which men dominate and oppress women'.

Part of the idea of "patriarchy" is that this oppression of women is **multilayered**. It operates not only through **inequalities at the level of the law and the state**, but also through the **home and the workplace**.

It is upheld by powerful cultural norms and supported by tradition, education and religion.

Only "patriarchy" seems to capture the peculiar elusiveness of gendered power – the idea that it does not reside in any one site or institution but seems spread throughout the world.

A very important explanation for the origin of patriarchy was given by Frederick Engels in 1884 in his book, *The Origins of the Family, Private Property and the State* (Engels 1940). Engels believed that women's subordination began with the development of private property, when according to him, the world historical defeat of the female sex took place. He says both the division of classes and the subordination of women developed historically.

Patriarchy and Religion

- **Gender, religion and patriarchy are foundational social constructs** operating at the basis of social organization of society.
- **Marx's theory of religion** needs to be seen in the **context of his general view of a capitalist society and the oppression of the working class**. He argues that the **class that controls economic production also**

controls the production and distribution of ideas in society.

- Feminists see **society as patriarchal based on male domination**. Many feminists regard **religion as a patriarchal institution** that reflects and perpetuates this inequality. **Religious beliefs** function as a patriarchal ideology that **legitimizes female subordination**.
- Feminist sociologists such as **Simone De Beauvoir, Jean Holm and Mary Daly** see religion as an ideological instrument of domination and repression that generally **serves the interests of men in preserving, justifying** and helping to reproduce, generation by generation, male power in patriarchal societies. In this sense, religion as a patriarchal ideology is traditional and conservative and generally opposes social change in terms of the liberation of women.
- **Simone de Beauvoir**- like Marx, de Beauvoir saw **religion as an oppressive ideology** but whereas Marx saw it being used to control the poor, De Beauvoir sees it as a successful strategy by men to control women. She argued that men usually control religious organisations and claim that their authority comes from God. She argues that religions give women the false belief that their suffering will be rewarded in heaven. Religion therefore results in women experiencing 'false consciousness' which keeps them in their place. It deceives women into thinking they are equal to men, while in reality they are disadvantaged as the 'second sex'.
- Under the towering influence of Michel Foucault many writers dismiss the idea of power as a possession which is unequally distributed in society, above all between men and women, in favour of a picture of power as constantly negotiated in the small, ceaseless, real-time interactions between individuals.
- (More perspectives given in the Chapter of Religion, Paper-1).

Conclusion

In conclusion, the apex court held that the Constitution of India prohibits exclusion of any community or section of people from places of worship and that constitutional values would prevail over religious practices.

The judgement demonstrates that exclusion of women does restrict freedom and dignity and is thus, legally invalid.

As every major movement, Sabarimala episode saw protests both in favour and against the ban. While many campaigned for the lifting of the ban in virtue of their "right to pray" or, more generally, to put an end to practices deemed patriarchal, others protested that their religious freedom, as Hindu women, was at risk. This polarization highlighted that on feminist issues there is often division among women themselves.

Ursula Le Guin: "Civilized Man says: I am Self, I am Master, all the rest is other--outside, below, underneath, subservient. I own, I use, I explore, I exploit, I control. What I do is what matters. What I want is what matter is for. I am that I am, and the rest is women & wilderness, to be used as I see fit.

Delhi Riots and Secularism In India

Definition

The term 'secularism' in India differs from the French concept of 'secularity'.

While the French concept demands absence of government institutions in religion as well as absence of religion in government institutions and schools, the Indian concept in contrast provides financial support to religious schools and accepts religious laws over government institutions.

The Indian structure has created incentives for various religious denominations to start and maintain schools, impart religious education, and receive partial but significant financial support from the government.

The word 'secularism' means that the country doesn't follow or propagate a particular religion and grants the right of religious propagation to all its citizens.

In a secular country, religion is subjective and the state doesn't have much to do with one's religion. The state in turn respects the freedom of its citizen to follow any religion.

The word 'secular' was added in the Preamble of the Indian Constitution in the 42nd Amendment (1976) by the then Prime Minister (Indira Gandhi), given the colourful religious and cultural diversity of the country which changed the description of India in the preamble from "sovereign, democratic republic" to 'sovereign, socialist, secular, democratic republic.'

Delhi Riots

Start of the problem: Indian parliament passed a law in December 2019- the Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA).

The law provides a faster way to attain citizenship for migrants from three neighboring countries, specifically if they are Hindus, Sikhs, Buddhists, Jains, Parsis, or Christians.

It conspicuously leaves out Muslims.

Since the law was passed, there has been widespread protests and opposition against the same.

There are two reasons for this opposition:-

- It appears to be discriminating against the Muslims of the country.
- It is closely linked to the much controversial initiative: the National Registry of Citizens (NRC), a citizenship list that could potentially leave millions of people, primarily Muslims, stateless.

As of now, only the state of Assam has implemented the NRC. A citizenship list which was published by the government of Assam in August 2019, didn't have the names of nearly 2 million residents. And without the citizenship fast-track that the Citizenship Amendment Act grants other religions, the Muslims left off that list are at risk of losing their citizenship entirely.

By the same time, because of politically charged up atmosphere during the Delhi elections in February 2020, there were various controversial, communal speeches by various people including the members of the party in power in Union government. It is believed what flared up riots in Delhi.

It is also being assumed that the hate speeches were a deliberate attempt to incite Hindus against Muslims and especially those protesting peacefully.

The Delhi riots left 53 dead, several injured and resulted in a severe loss of livelihood.

The Delhi Minorities Commission (DMC) said Muslim homes, shops and vehicles were selectively targeted during the rioting that erupted in northeast Delhi in February when protests against the new Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA) broke out across the country.

"The trend we see across India is that a lot of the violence perpetrated against Muslims these days is actually perpetrated by subsidiaries of the Hindu nationalist movement," says **Thomas Blom Hansen**, a Stanford professor of anthropology who has studied religious identities and violence in India for three decades.

As **Michael Mann** wrote in 2005: **India "sees recurrent violence, but most of it takes the less serious form of a riot cycle"**.

Low-intensity cyclic riots, are a structural feature of Indian society, are therefore not always extensively covered in official reports and the media

C 1

Visions of Social Change In India

- a) Idea of development planning and mixed economy
- b) Constitution, law and social change
- c) Education and social change

Idea Of Development Planning And Mixed Economy

Modes of Development

When **India got independent**, there were debates on **what Modes of Development to follow**.

There were 3 options:

1. **Capitalism** with minimum state control
2. **Socialism** with state guidance
3. **Sarvodaya** based on distrust of state

But there were problems of

1. Refugee inflows & their settlement
2. Fertile lands gone to Pakistan (cotton), Bangladesh (Jute).
3. Mahatma Gandhi → Inclined to socialism but distrust of state.

Favored capitalism but of small scale, cottage industry.

Development Model Followed Post Independence

1. Mass Welfare Oriented
2. Broad Spectrum Approach to planning
3. Based on Modernity
4. Mix-Model: 5-year Plans (USSR's influence)

Development Model Post 1970s

- **After 1970:** Approach changed to **Integrated with Area specific Focus**.
 - Eg: Green Revolution in certain areas.
- **Planning was also further integrated:**
 - Central Planning → State Plans → District → Block → village level plans

Challenges of Development

1. Devolution of funds
2. Stagnant Agriculture

3. Rural – Urban gap in development indicators
4. Continued Exclusion, especially of Tribals
5. Inequality
6. Demography → education, health, sanitation, skills, etc.

Recent trends in Development Planning

1. Decentralized Planning + Delivery (from imperative to indicative planning)
2. Planning → Indicative + Participative + Groundwork oriented
3. Rising trend of NGO and Civil societies.
4. Community involvement in various policies (eg: education policy, women policy)
5. Sensitivity to Global Problems (eg: environment, terrorism, inclusion)
6. Rural sector, co-op federalism, ICT, MNREGA emphasized
7. Right based approach from earlier Role-based (eg: RTI, RTE)

Constitution, Law & Social Change

Constitution – An Introduction

- The constitution is a **living document** in the sense that it observes **societal evolution** via numerous flexible mechanisms and provisions that respond to the people's needs and desires.
- In other terms, it is "a document that sets down the **core principles** and rules of a nation, state, or social organisation through which the **authorities** and obligations of the **government** are **created** and certain **rights are guaranteed** to the people."

Constitution of India

Constitution:

- is the fundamental law of the land.
- It incorporates norms of equality, social justice, freedom and secularism (Preamble)
- Recognises cultural pluralism, presence of caste-based inequalities, economic & social backwardness of some sections
- Tries to bring social change through FRs and DPSPs
- Abolishing social evils like untouchability, forced labour, dowry, trafficking in woman & children
- Equality through reservations (affirmative action)
- Has certain limitations (eg: cannot enforce DPSPs.)

Views On Indian Constitution

Amartya Sen:

- He believes that the constitution originates and sustains social change, as seen by freedom of speech and expression, provisions to protect the interests of minorities, SCs, and STs, and education for all.
- It recognised socialism's growth concept and equal distribution.

Rajni Kothari:

- India's Constitution provides for multi-party parliamentary democracy. It has contributed to political socialisation through the development of PRIs, the division of power, and other means, and therefore to social change in India.

Gail Omvedt

- She believes that the constitution provided for the **liberation of Dalits**, which led to the commencement of **Dalit consciousness** for the creation of an **inclusive society**.

Marxists:

- **Legislation** is part of a wider **ideological framework** of the state acting at the **request of powerful groups** in society.

Upendra Baxi:

- The **majority** of people in India **do not have access to the justice delivery** system and its **compromises** of laws as a viable tool of social change.

Andre Beteille

The **constitution dictates the direction** in which government should proceed, but it is **people's actions and ideologies** that determine the law's efficacy.

Rajeev Bhargava:

- Constitution is expected to check the tyranny of a majoritarian democratic state & protect the rights of vulnerable groups.

Y. Singh:

The **legal system** has been **an important source of modernization** in India (can also write **3-Is**)

He refers to 3 functions of law :

1. As an **indicator** of change
2. As an **initiator** of change
3. As an **integrator** of change

Law alone cannot do much.

Why Constitution Is Important

To check despotism

- A constitution serves as the foundation for a political society.
- It determines the kind of governance it will use, as well as its functions in the political community and the limits on its authority.
- This serves to keep the government from acting rashly.

- This would keep people in authority from becoming overpowering and tyrannical.

Balanced government

- A constitution aids in **the separation and distribution of power** or authority among government agencies.
- It **guarantees** that all of these **institutions' authority is limited**, and that they also **check and constrain** one another.
- This **prohibits any institution from dominating** the others.
- It prevents unrestrained political power from being wielded.

Social Instrument

- A constitution also serves an important function in providing a **foundation for socioeconomic growth**.
- Many constitutions across the world, notably the Indian Constitution, have played important roles in **guaranteeing equality and justice for marginalised** communities.
- The **Directive Principles of State Policy** in Part IV of the Indian Constitution have inspired the government to enact **laws that preserve the environment, support labour rights, and promote free access to education** for children, among other things.

Improvement in the protection of Marginals

- With the establishment of a **Minorities Commission** and a **SC/ST Commission**, there has been an improvement in the protection of Dalits, Tribal & minorities.
- **Several Rights** based laws have been enacted, including the **Food Security Act**, the **Forest Rights Act**, and the **Rural Employment Guarantee Act**.
- These helped to **broaden and enhance the rights of the impoverished and marginalised** elements of society.

Continuous Expansion of Rights

- On the front of fundamental rights, we saw some **enlargement of rights**, notably by the **Supreme Court**, through an **expansive and imaginative interpretation** of the right to life (which was held to encompass a right to live with dignity) and freedom of expression (which was held to include the right to information, a free press, the right to privacy, etc.)

Human Rights and Democratic values

- Many democratic nation-state constitutions exist to ensure that the **process of selecting people in power is transparent and fair**.
- It also gives citizens the **right to vote and the freedom to criticise** those in authority.
- A democratic society is defined by elections, representative governance, and the freedom to criticise those in authority.

Constitutionalism

Definition:

- It refers to a polity which is governed by a constitution that ordains essentially **limited government** and **rule of law** as opposed to arbitrary, authoritarian or totalitarian rule.
- **Constitutional government should necessarily be democratic government.**

Constitutional scholar **David Fellman** says:

- 'It may be said that the touchstone of **constitutionalism** is the **concept of limited government under a higher law**'.

2core features:

- **1. Entrenchment:**
 - Constitutionalism establishes **norms which imposes limits upon government power** must be in some way be entrenched, either by law or by way of constitutional convention.
- **2. Written-ness:**
 - Scholars believe that **constitutional rules do not exist unless they are in some way enshrined in a written document.**

Constitutionalism In India

- Democratic government with a written Constitution
- Basis of governance – Rule of Law.
- All administrative structures are expected to follow the law in both letter and spirit.
- In India, It is expected that Constitutionalism is a natural corollary to governance.

Criticism:

- India has an excellent administrative structure, but it resulted into excessive bureaucratization.
- In contrasts to China, India's development process has been a lagged one.
- Overall development remained much below the expectations of the people, many backward areas still lack basic facilities.

Constitutional morality – Dr. B.R.Ambedkar

- The doctrine of **constitutional morality** means **adherence to noble principles enshrined in a constitution**, principle interpretation of the constitution in line with the ethos of constitutional democracy.
- First propounded by **George Grote** in the 19th century in his book "**A History of Greece.**"
- In Indian context, **Dr B.R. Ambedkar** propounded the idea of Constitutional Morality as:
 - **An effective coordination between conflicting interests of different people**
 - **Administrative cooperation to solve those issues**
 - **Conflict resolution** to be done **amicably** or in **friendly** way as far as possible.
- It essentially means, **an obligation on the part of State** authorities to conduct themselves **in accordance with the Constitution**, instead of behaving like feudal overlords.

- Constitutional Morality, commands and empowers the **judicial minds to interpret the constitution and its provisions in a moral way**, subject to the constitution and **not to the public morality**, in the recent development we get to see this from our judiciary.
- For eg: The influence of public sentiments on Courts' judgement.

Pratap Bhanu Mehta writes For Ambedkar:

“without fraternity, equality and liberty would be no deeper than coats of paint. “

A constitutional morality, requires both **features**:

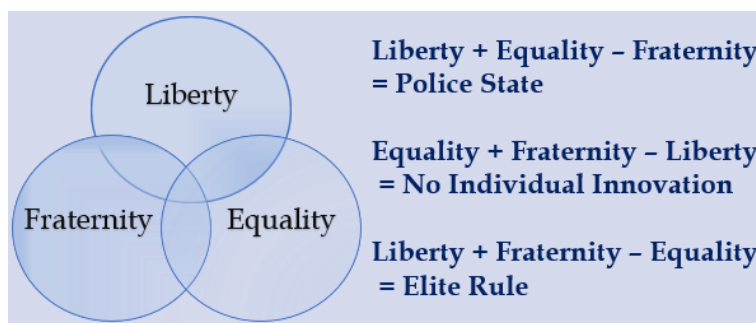
- **Abstraction**
- **Agreement** or cooperation.

It requires the **presumption that everyone is equal**, regardless of the status and power.

However, that equality is possible only when for constitutional purposes our caste, class, religious, regional identities do not matter.

Constitutional morality requires the sense that despite all differences we are part of a common deliberative enterprise.

For Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, A **Social democracy** which embodies constitutional morality, **would cease to exist without an equal element of Liberty, Fraternity and Equality**.



Sources of Constitutional Morality

- Constitutional morality has originated from within the **Constitution itself**.
- A proper **interpretation of Fundamental Rights, DPSP, Preamble and the Fundamental Duties** tends to have the pervasive essence emphasising upon constitutional morality.
- The **debates and discussions** that happened in the **Constitutional Assembly**.
- **Various Case laws and reading down** of draconian laws by higher courts, upholding the spirit of constitutional spirit, morality.

Constitutional morality - Conclusion

Indian Constitution was made possible by a **constitutional morality that was liberal** at its core.

Not liberal in the eviscerated ideological sense, but in the deeper virtues from which it sprang:

- **An ability to combine individuality with mutual regard**
- **Intellectualism with a democratic sensibility**
- **Conviction with a sense of fallibility**
- **Deliberation with decision**

- Ambition with a commitment to institutions
- A hope for a future with due regard for the past and present

Constitutionalism Vs Constitutional Morality

Constitutionalism	Constitutional Morality
"A compound of ideas, attitudes, and patterns of behaviour elaborating the principle that the authority of government derives from and is limited by a body of fundamental law"	It implies the harmonious interaction between the governing and governed, including the peaceful settlement of dissent, without indulging in any major confrontations or resorting to violent revolutions.
Constitutionalism proclaims the desirability of the rule of law.	Respecting the constitution and all forms of authorities deriving their command from it.
In a political society government officials are not free to do anything; they are bound to observe both the limitations on power and the procedures which are set out in the constitutional law of the country.	'Self-restraint' and 'Plurality' formed the fundamental elements of constitutional morality.

Threat to Indian Constitution

Communalisation:

- A rise of **majoritarianism** and communal conflicts had threatened the secular nature of the constitution.
- To target Muslims, other minorities, and the poor, **Indian states has implemented 'anti-beef eating' and 'love jihad' legislation.**
- They are often deemed to highlight **assaults on the right to life and the secular ideals** enshrined in the Constitution.

Regional Development Discrepancies:

- It has been observed that the influence of the government's **economic policies has not resulted in inclusive and equal development**, but **rather large disparities** in different areas.
- In general, the southern and western states have had faster economic growth, while the north eastern and central regions of the country have lagged, clearly **highlighting state's inability to put into practice the ideals of DPSPs.**

Success of Indian Constitution

- The Indian Constitution deserves respect for ensuring that, despite the express mention of separation of powers, the **three organs of government** - legislature, executive, and judiciary - **work well together to serve the people** of the country.
- It can be observed that the **Indian Constitution is a cornerstone that holds the country together** with individuals from **many cultures and beliefs.**
- This keeps everything in a **stated agreement with harmony and fairness** and a possibility of getting the grievances redressed.

Law as an Instrument of Social Change

- **Indian Society is complex and heterogenous.**
- Here, **laws can ensure homogeneity and assimilation** of divergent sections through various laws: Universal suffrage, abolition of titles.

Examples:

- **For Women:** Hindu marriage act, Hindu succession act, dowry prohibition act , Equal wages, Domestic Violence act , PCPNDT Act.
- **For Backward Sections:** Abolition of untouchability, reservation policy, Forest rights act for tribals.
- **For Rural Poverty:** MNREGA
- **Laws are the mirror** that reflects how people relate to one another, their values, what they consider worth preserving in life, and how they define their own security.
- Law has been a very **influential instrument to bring in social change** both in the past as well as in the present.
- **Several judgments** have also been passed by the Indian courts relating to social issues that have made people aware of the laws that are existing so as to prevent themselves from getting affected by social issues.
- Eg:
- SC/ST (prevention of atrocities) act, Right to Privacy under Article 21.

Education and Social Change

Francis J. Brown in Educational Sociology says:

" Education helps in changing basic outlook of a person towards society. Education changes the established patterns of social relationships, attitude/values of a person and also structure of society".

Thus, it can be seen that Education changes Established Patterns, Values and the Structure of society.

Objectives Of Education

- Pursuit of man to know himself and the universe and to relate himself with the social world
- Building bridges between past and future
- Accelerating the process of human progress
- Integral growth of personality traits like intelligence, skill
- Development in terms of man's condition of life, i.e. development of both individual and society
- Generating and strengthening harmony and peace.

Education and its Importance

It Involves both **formal** education and **informal** education (Mass media)

- Creates favourable attitude to acceptance of skills
- Upgradation of skills
- Focuses attention leading to change e.g. ecology books now-a-days will affect future.
- Creates awareness
- Promotes innovation (eg: healthcare through technology)
- Brings change in terms of gender equality, and inclusivity.

Education In Past

- In British era, education aimed at **producing mainly clerks**.
- Education was **not student-centered** rather it was **teacher-centered**.
- **Christian missionaries** engaged in imparting education gave considerable importance to conversion of religion.
- Education in school and colleges was **not productive which could break down the social, regional and linguistic barriers**.
- It **never aimed at making people masters of technology**.
- It also **did not focus on fighting injustice, intolerance and superstition**.

Education in Present

- Oriented towards promoting values of an **urban, competitive consumer society**.
- Education aimed at **freedom of individual, excellence of individual, equality** amongst all people, individual and **self-reliance** and **national cohesion** while also keeping in mind **global cues and demands**.

Education For Future

- Emphasis on rapid skilling and re-skilling.
- Emphasis on holistic and spiritual understanding of life.
- Learning Sustainable living.
- Emphasis must shift from higher secondary and higher education to primary and adult education.
- Content at university level education needs serious consideration.
- Problem of accountability of teachers needs to be addressed.

Education For Future – Issues

- Greater seriousness regarding studies among students - push to vocational / professional courses
- Issue of making all illiterate literate
- Reducing number of drop-outs
- Present examination system needs to be improved

Critical Analysis Of Education

K. Ahmed (1974):

- Formal education can play a vital role in 'ideational' change through transformation of knowledge, attitudes and values of the people.
- Its effectiveness in bringing about structural changes in society is extremely limited.
- This is because of the linkages between the existing practices and procedures in education and vested interests of the status-quoists.

A.R. Desai:

- He has **questioned the validity of education as an instrument of social change**.

- His contention is that after Independence, education has **not been purposively geared** to obtain the desired changes.
- He has **criticised the policies and funding** and financing of education to attain the goals of social mobility and equality.

Examples:

- Education of SC, ST, Women failed in uplifting their status and **bridging the gap** with the mainstream.
- **Unemployment** and **under-employment** of educated youth is a persistent concern.
- Education has **not been able to eliminate casteism**
 - Eg: Caste based discrimination in Silicon Valley, USA

Changes in PESTEL

- **Political** change: values for democracy, equitable rights, duties of citizens
- **Economical** change: more employment, less burden on agriculture , more SMEs
- **Social** Change: literacy, awareness for health and sanitation , decrease in superstitious beliefs
- **Technological** change : defence, communication etc.
- **Environmental** change : e.g. chipkoo movement
- **Ideological** change : anti-superstitious movements in Maharashtra

Criticism of Modern Education

Presently, concern is not only about education but quality education (**ASER reports**)

- Education plays both **Conservative & Radical** role.
- **Karl Manheim** → Education needs to be critical.
- **Steve Lukes** → ‘3rd face of Power’ i.e. **Ideological** power promoted through education.
- **Marx** → Promotes **dominant class ideology**
- **Althusser - Ideological state apparatus** -Education used as apparatus by state to propagate its ideology.
- **U without Q syndrome**: Mentioned in 12th Five Year Plan, the focus of the government and SDGs is on Universalising the Education causing the focus on Quality to backburner (focus only on numbers)
- **Pierre Bourdieu- Cultural Reproduction** - Current education system is benefitting only top classes. Corroborated by **MM Tumin**: Top classes have culture of excellence.
- **RH Tawney - Tadpole Theory** - Only the “top of the bottom” get sponsorship from state. Dalit Elites, Tribal Elites - **Sachidanand Sinha, Bagaiyyan**.

Education Deprivations – In a nutshell

- Caste related discrimination
- Gender (uneducated/undernourished)
- Class - Higher tuition fees renders quality education inaccessible.
- Creation of Elites (“Harijan Elite” -> Sachidanand Sinha “Tribal Elite” -> SD Badgaiyyan)

- Taboo based – HIV parents' children
- Religion – Sachar committee, Rangnath Mishra committee – Muslim denied entry in schools in Ahmedabad

Actions to promote education

- **Govt. Actions** → RTE, SSA, MDM, RMS, RUSA, Articles – 15. DPSP
- Eg. Ambedkar witnessed mobility through education.
- **NEP, 2016** → Skills, Cultural Heritage, Values. Contains vague terms.
- **NEP, 2020** → Focus on Quality teaching and learning, Vocational courses, structural reforms.

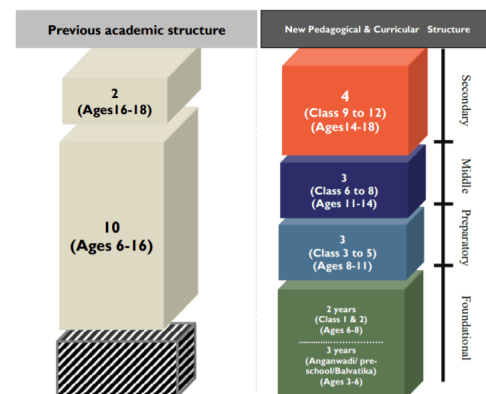
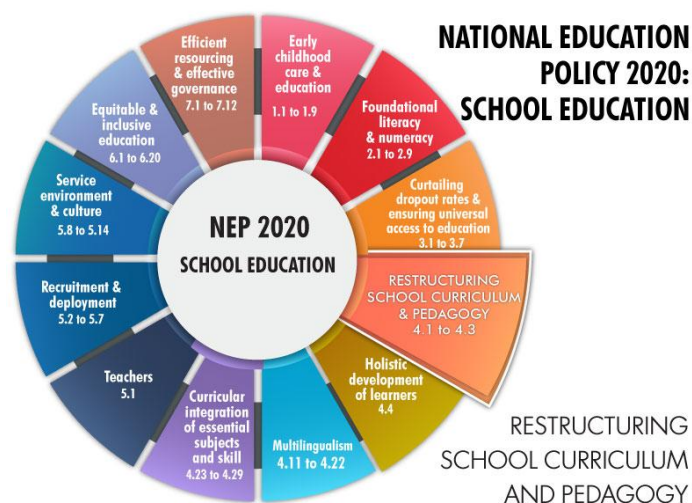
New Education Policy

The New Education Policy covers **all aspects of school education and higher education**, as well as **significant aims** and a **fundamental redesign** of the education system.

The following are the policy's key points:

School Education

- Recognizing that over **85% of a child's cumulative brain development happens before the age of 6**, the existing form of **10+2 structure** will be altered to a new **5+3+3+4 structure**, with a solid foundation of **Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE)** from age 3.
- The education system's priority will be to attain **universal fundamental reading and numeracy in elementary** school by 2025.
- The policy seeks to guarantee a **pupil-teacher ratio (PTR)** of **less than 30:1** at the school level.
- Recognizing that the **early hours after a nutritious breakfast** might be particularly **fruitful** for the study of cognitively more demanding topics, a **basic yet stimulating breakfast** will be served in addition to noon meals.
- There is a **large dropout rate after Grade 5**, and significantly higher after **Grade 8**. The strategy **prioritises re-enrolling these children** in school, with the goal of reaching a **100% Gross Enrollment Ratio from preschool to secondary school** by 2030.
- The **curriculum for each topic will be simplified** to its fundamental elements in order to **encourage critical thinking and inquiry-based, discovery based, and analysis-based learning**.
- There is option for **vocational training** as well as **internships** during the school year.
- Wherever practicable, the **medium of teaching will be mother tongue** (local language/regional language) **until at least Grade 5**, but preferably until Grade 8 and beyond.



- The policy **embraces the three-language formula**; however, the three-language formula will be more **flexible**, and **no language will be imposed** on any state.
- While **continuing board examinations** for grades 10 and 12, the proposal **advises eliminating the necessity for coaching classes**.
- Board examinations will be revised to **focus on basic abilities and competences rather than memorization**.

Higher Education

- Given the demands of the twenty-first century, great higher education must strive to generate good, intelligent, well-rounded, and creative persons.
- The following initiatives are planned for the higher education sector policy.
- **Colleges** will be encouraged, mentored, supported, and motivated to gradually meet the **basic accrediting requirements**.
- Over time, **each college is expected to evolve into either an autonomous degree-granting college or a constituent college of a university**.
- The **fundamental goal of this higher education strategy is to stop higher education fragmentation** by converting higher education institutions into **big interdisciplinary universities, colleges, and HEI clusters/Hubs**, each with 3,000 or more students.
- According to policy, **all higher education institutions should strive to become interdisciplinary** by 2040.
- The **undergraduate degree will last three or four years**, with **numerous exit choices** available with relevant credentials.
- An **Academic Bank of Credit (ABC)** will be formed to **digitally record academic credits** obtained from various **recognised HEIs** so that degrees from a HEI can be granted taking credits gained into consideration. **HEIs will be able to offer a variety of Master's programme designs**.
- A **Master's degree** or a four-year Bachelor's degree with research is required to **pursue a Ph.D.**
- The **MPhil. programme will be phased out**.
- To make **high-quality higher education opportunities available to all persons**
 - By allocating **adequate money** for the education of **socioeconomically disadvantaged groups (SEDGs)**.
 - **Improve gender equality** in HEI admissions
 - **Improve access by building high-quality HEIs** in aspirational districts and **Special Education Zones**
- The policy aims to **boost the Gross Enrollment Ratio** in Higher Education to 50% (currently 26.3%) by 2035.
- The policy reiterates the government's decision to establish the **Higher Education Commission of India (HECI)** as a **single umbrella organisation** for all higher education in India (**excluding medical and legal education**).

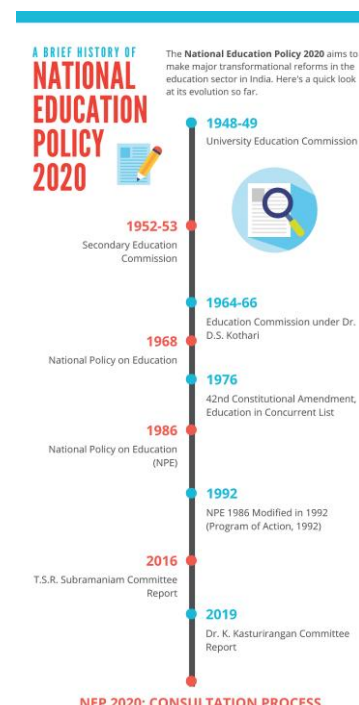


Other Changes

- The policy suggests establishing a **National Educational Technology Forum (NETF)** to facilitate the **open exchange of ideas** on the use of **technology** to improve learning, **evaluation, planning, and administration**.
- A **fee cap** will be implemented for private higher education institutions.
- It also paves the path for **international universities to establish campuses in India**, as well as **encouraging top Indian educational institutions to go worldwide**.
- It also **reiterates the goal of increasing public expenditure** in education to 6% of GDP as soon as possible (from current levels of 4.6%).

What Is The Significance Of The New Education Policy?

- The addition of **vocational classes** in the school curriculum is a **critical and potentially game-changing** policy effort.
- This will aid in **encouraging poor communities** that do not value education to **send their children** to school.
- It has **expanded the scope of universal education** from 6-14 years to 3-18 years, which is a welcome step.
- One of the major points of contention on the **medium of instruction** has been **addressed**, with categorical support for the **three-language formula** and the suggestion of teaching in mother tongue/local language for at least the fifth grade.
- The **higher education** sector is encouraged to be **multi-disciplinary** under this policy, which includes proposals to **do away with silos in terms of disciplines**.
- Interacting with a range of subjects will result in an **all-around and enriched personality**.
- The policy recommends **more international university admissions** and pushes more **top-tier Indian colleges to go worldwide**.
- This is a positive step since it would **encourage healthy competition** in the Indian higher education system and **conserve vital Foreign Exchange reserves** as a large number of students choose to study overseas.
- IITs are already in the process of planning to go global.



What Are the Issues With The New Education Policy?

- While the strategy intends to **end the coaching class culture** and the resulting **monopoly of English medium schools**, implementing it will require adequate **political will**.
- This, according to experts, is a challenging process.
- The same is true for **teacher education institutes**.
- The **low-quality schools are primarily managed for profit**, with little regard for the demands of teacher education.

- One of the most crucial factors that is sometimes overlooked is the **policy of no tests** until the seventh or eighth grade.
- This strategy has been **strongly criticised** for having an **influence on learning** results in the absence of school-level assessments.
- The **Kothari Commission proposed spending 6%** of GDP on education, but successive administrations have **failed to meet the benchmark**.
- There is a **mismatch between the skills taught in schools and the employment** accessible.
- This critical topic has received little attention in policy.
- There has been **minimal debate on new-age technologies** such as **artificial intelligence, cyber security**, and so on, despite the fact that these disciplines dominate world knowledge and employment space.
- The majority of experts believe that, while **policy speaks of supporting reason and critical thinking**, college activities, the **actual actions on the ground differ**, as seen by **recent attacks on campuses and critical thinkers**.

Sociological views

According To Meenakshi Thapan

- a) A one-size-fits-all approach would not work; policies must take into account the many types of conditions that exist on the ground in a country as diverse, multifarious, and complicated as India.
 - Understanding isolated areas, steep terrains, tribal hamlets, nomadic mobility, and other complications common in a broad and diverse geography is critical.
 - This would need extensive research and the development of a broad and comprehensive education curriculum.
- b) The NEP 2020 also states that teaching in **one's native tongue** is "preferred."
 - While many people feel that early childhood education in the mother tongue is important, it would be **problematic in a place like Chhattisgarh**, where **Chhattisgarhi is just one language and there are several spoken dialects**.
 - So, will separate schools have distinct mother tongues? **How will the material alter depending on the state** and dialect or language?
- c) Those **who pursue alternative undergraduate courses** in the humanities, arts, or vocational training should **not be stigmatised or fear unemployment**.
 - Their education must be afforded the same advantages as other more 'elite' or 'mainstream' educational institutions and fields.
- d) In NEP 2020, there is a special **emphasis on 'multi disciplinarity'** in higher education, which gives the opportunity for a really comprehensive style of education even as children progress from secondary to higher education.
 - However, the NEP 2020 does not specify how this will be done.
 - What are the underlying principles of an interdisciplinary approach, and how will they be realised?

Who will decide the content –

- According to **Michael Apple**, a curriculum theorist, **knowledge selection for curriculum is a result of people with authority.**
- This means that people in a given culture at a given moment select what is important to educate future learners, so strengthening their position of power.
- Do we **recognise this feature in the conceptualization of knowledge** and are we aware of the struggles of society's marginalised and oppressed?

Ideological state apparatus (Althusser) –

- The proposal does include creating colleges and schools, as well as providing incentives to professors who want to teach in rural regions.
- However, we must also consider how we will intentionally handle questions of knowledge and power.
- **Is our curriculum going to include stories about the marginalised, gender discrimination, and class and caste struggles?**

Homogenisation Of Education –

- Due to **globalization and other forces** there is rise of **job-oriented education** and **less focus on** the subjects that are **critique the modern** setup.
- E.g. rise of **STEM** and **decline of Social sciences.**
- **Postmodernism opposes the homogenisation** of educational systems.
- They consider modern education to be oppressive to many pupils, particularly minority groups, and believe that **school's "factory production-line mind-set" destroys creativity.**

Replication of cultural capital –

- Use of **technology can increase gap** between various sections of the society.
- **Pierre Bourdieu introduces the notion of cultural capital**, which specifies class systems in addition to economic, social, and symbolic capital.
- The education system aids in the replication of cultural capital, and hence in the **preservation of a comparable framework of power connections and symbolic linkages** between classes.
- This **guarantees that the disparity between classes persists.**

C 2

Rural and Agrarian Transformation in India

Sub-topics:

- Programmes of Rural Development
- Community development programme
- Cooperatives
- Poverty Alleviation Schemes
- Green Revolution and Social Change
- Changing modes of production in Indian Agriculture
- Problems of rural labour, Bondage, Migration.

What is Rural Development

- Rural Development involves, utilization, protection and enhancement of the natural, physical and human resources needed to make long-term improvements in rural living conditions.
- Rural Development is much broader than Agriculture's Development.
- But since agriculture is the main source of employment, therefore, main focus is always on agriculture.

Rural Development: Objectives

Rural Development aims to provide below mentioned aspects:

Economic	Social	Infrastructure
Rural Housing	Increase per capita productivity	Rural Roads & Transport
Land & Soil Improvement	Vocational Skills	Electrification
Village, Cottage & Small-scale Industry	Healthcare	Drinking Water & Sanitation
Animal Husbandry	Education	Minor Irrigation
Fisheries & Aquaculture	Women & Child Development	Communication
Minor Forest Produce	Family Planning	Internet Connectivity

Various Phases of Rural Development

First Phase

Community Development Programme (CDP) - 1952

- Based on Gandhian concept :
 - **Sevagram** → **Self-sufficiency** (*Empowering Khadi & Village Industries*)

Sevagram, meaning "A town for/of service" is the name of a town in the state of Maharashtra, India.

It is located about 8 km from Wardha.

It was the place of Gandhiji's ashram and his residence from 1936 to his death in 1948.

Community Development Program 1952

CDP drew inspiration from a few pre-independence rural development programs with Pt. Nehru being its main enthusiast.

For e.g.

1. Shriniketan Project, Bengal – Rabindranath Tagore (1920)
2. Baroda village reconstruction project - B.T. Krishnamachari (1932)
3. Grow More Food Campaign – Agriculture Dept. (1942)

Village was seen as a **single unit with common interests**.

Broadly, CDP is

- Development of rural life with **community participation driven by free labour** provided by one person from every family, so as to instill a sense of **collective ownership & responsibility**.
- At Block Level, a BDO, a Political Leader and Media to work in tandem for **development at the cluster level**.

Creation of New Village Level Institution

As Carl Taylor puts it, creation of the post of Gram-Sevak as multi-purpose village-level worker, to achieve:

- Development at village level
- Caste Disappearance from public life

Phases of CDP

3 phases of CDP

- **National Extension phase** – Areas selected with little govt expenditure.
- **Intensive Community Development phase** – Blocks selected with high govt expenditure.
- **Post Development Phase** – Previous phases assumed success, govt expenditure lessened, now more supervisory role.

Major Areas of Work

By 1957 – focus on 4 Major areas of work

- **Constructional** Programs (schools, roads etc.)
- **Minor Irrigation** (wells, tube wells, pumps etc.)
- **Agriculture** (waste land dev., soil, manure etc.)
- **Institutional** Programs (youth, women, dispensaries, smokeless chulhas etc.)

Drawback of CDP

CDP failed to deliver expected results due to,

Reasons of Failure:

1. Projects on Paper → Implementation issues
2. Upper caste, Upper class domination

3. Caste inequality rose
4. Leakage of money → Corruption

Criticism of CPD

Critique says,

1. Created Community **dependence on govt.**
2. Interests of landed class are **contradictory** with service and other classes
3. **Bureaucracy lacked social service** ethos.
4. Development with **top-down approach** → **Failed** to acknowledge local conditions.
5. Large land owners more benefitted.
6. Greater emphasis on Economic aspect, Little on Social and Technical aspect.
7. Dominant castes hijacked top positions in bureaucracy and politics → diverted subsidy benefits.

Second Phase of Rural Development

- Land Reforms (early 60s) – Already covered
- Green Revolution (mid 60s) – In next slides

Green Revolution and Social Change

What happened in Green Revolution

- **Breakthrough in agricultural production in 1960s**
- Application of **HYV** seeds
- Introduction of **Chemical fertilizers**.
- **Assured Irrigation** through major irrigation projects
- **Agri-machinery** used.

Scholars on Indian MoP

William Wiser :

- Indian feudalism different from European (Jajmani) (inter-dependencies were there)
- Indian Agriculture → feudalistic but changing into capitalistic.

Multidimensional effect of GR:

- Increased agricultural productivity
- Self sufficiency in food grain production
- Subsistence Farming → Commercial Farming

Andre Beteille :

- It created a **new faith in the dynamism** of Indian farmer to absorb technology.

Rudolph & Rudolph :

- Called GR Farmers to **be Bullock Capitalists**.
- That is, GR farmers were “**Progressive Farmers**”.

Sociological Implications Of GR

1. Increased **inequalities** (increased class based division of society)
2. **Displacement** of **tenant** cultivators
3. Introduction of machinery led to **displacement** of **service caste** groups
4. Rural-Urban **migration**
5. **Rich getting richer** and poor getting poorer
6. This **economic influence** got **extended** to **political sphere** also
7. Search for **exclusive political identity** – **Khalistan** in Punjab
8. **Intensified Patriarchy**; increase in **dowry** demands, increased **female infanticide**, great **gender imbalance**, cross regional **demand for brides** (Kerala, Orrisa, Assam to Haryana)
9. **Worsening** of **regional inequalities** (Bihar, Eastern UP, Telangana, Vidharbha → relatively undeveloped); resulted into **inter caste conflict** (Bihar), farmers suicide (Vidarbha & Telangana) and agrarian unrest.

Some Views

1. **PC Joshi** : GR has contributed for the **rise of capitalist agriculture** and offered an economic foundation for the rise of big bourgeoisie in the country side.
2. **Kathleen Gough**: **Domination in economic base** lead to **domination in the superstructure** of social life.
3. **JPS Oberoi**: **Affluence** gave rise to the search for an **exclusive political identity** – **Khalistan**
4. **Deepankar Gupta**: GR contributed for the **intensification of caste consciousness**;
 - Western UP – Jaats, Punjab – Sikhs, Haryana – Jaats
5. **Lakshmi Menon**: **Worst victims** are **women** – **intensified patriarchy**
6. **AR Desai**: Indian Agriculture was:
 - Before British → Semi Feudal
 - During British → Peasantry
 - After Independence → Commercial, Tenant farming

Changing Power Structure In Rural Areas

Earlier: In the hands of Zamindars, Jagirdars.

After Independence:

M N Srinivas →

Prevalence of Dominant caste based on:

- Numerical strength
- Economic Influence

- Political Power

Yogendra Singh → 4 Phases

- **Leadership based: Pragmatism + Reconciliatory** b/w castes.
- **Factions developed** b/w castes
- **Regaining by Dominant caste**
- **PRIs & its Impact**

Yogendra Singh's 4 Phases of Changing Power Structure In Rural Areas

1. Leadership based:

- **Pragmatism + Reconciliatory** b/w castes.

2. Henry Orenstein did a Goan village study:

- In his book 'Conflict & Cohesion in an Indian Village'.
- **Factions developed** b/w castes
- **Brothers contesting against each other**

Important Studies to quote:

- **Edward B. Harper:** Totagadde, Mysore state
- **Allan R. Beal:** Namhalli, village near Bangalore
- **T. S. Trent:** Study of Manhalli, a village near a sugar factory town in Mysore State.

3. Regaining by Dominant caste

- Jaats in Western UP
- Patels in Gujarat (Andre Beteille)

4. PRIs & its Impact:

- Empowering women, SC | ST

Changing Power Structure In Rural Areas

Jeffrey & Jeffrey:

Book "Development Failure & Identity Politics in Uttar Pradesh"

- **Class based identity** → Rich Farmers | Poor Tenants
- **Caste based identity** → Caste Consciousness
- **Interest based identity** → Increasing Democratisation (OBC reservation)

Green Revolution And Changing Modes Of Production In Indian Agriculture

Imagine the changing mode of production in Indian agriculture to be like this:

- The initial MoP of agriculture in Indian sub-continent can be imagined to have started as Asiatic MoP (Primitive communism)

- Then British arrived, changing it to Semi-feudalistic type.
- Commercialisation of agriculture starts.
- Presently, after LR & GR, Mode of Production is moving towards capitalist form.

Third Phase of Rural Development

Third Phase is characterized by **development of those areas which were left out of green revolution.**

- **Post Green Revolution**
- **Area Centric Prog (1970s)**
 - Draught Area Development Prog.
 - Hill Area Development Prog.
 - Command Area Development Prog.

Various Phases of Rural Development

Third Phase → Strategy

- Employment, Poverty Alleviation Prog. (1980s)
 - 20-point programme
 - Comprehensive Child Development Prog.
 - National Rural Employment Scheme
 - Crop insurance, etc.

Criticism of Area Centric Prog.- III Phase

Critique

- Slogan – **Growth with redistribution**. But **growth was missing**. (Slow economic growth)
- **Class conflict took caste form**. Politics re-focused on caste. Many parties came up. (Caste in politics)
- **Rural Labour Enquiry Commission** – Half of the population is in perpetual debt. (High debt)
- **Social Work Research Centre** – Agri workers employed for 3 months only. (Seasonal employment)
- **Subsidy** approach increased dependence on state. (Dependence)

Drawbacks of Phased Rural Development

Broadly

- Govt. Dependence
- Caste interest clash
- Class conflicts
- Bureaucratic hurdles
- Seasonality of employment
- Urban – Rural Plans not synergized
- Top – Down approach

Fourth Phase of Rural Development

Fourth Phase

Fourth Phase-1990s

- **Indian Economy was in transition** phase: Opening up of economy was highly anticipated
- Discussed in **Post-Independence Post LPG Phase**.

Post-Independence Post LPG Phase

Contemporary Indian agrarian history can be divided in 2 phases:

- **Post-Independence, Pre-LPG Phase** (most important changes through legislation, LR, Green Revolution (already discussed))
- **Post-Independence, Post-LPG Phase** (Discussed ahead)

It consisted of:

- Feminisation of agri-labor – Men move outside for work. Also, women labor is available at cheap rates.
- Participation in WTO

Dr. K. Somarsekhara discussed –

- Opening of Indian markets for imports.
- Imported fruits common
- Indian farmers not as adequately supported as European, American ones.
- **Contract Farming** – Though assured return, increased insecurity by dependency on companies, loss of own indigenous knowledge. Products like **Cut-flowers** divert from food-grain production.
- Production of **mainly elite and costly products** using fertilizers, pesticides, considered not good.
- **Multi-nationalisation Of Agriculture**- From selling of seeds to marketing produce. Govt agents replaced by profit-driven agents of companies. (Terminating seeds)
- **Circulation of labour** – Agriculture commercialized, growth of seasonal migrant agricultural labor.
- **Jan Breman**:
 - Calls them **Footloose labor**. They live in poor conditions.

Utsa Patnaik's Perspective

- 1990 afterwards → Indian agriculture became **Capitalistic & Commercial**.
- Increase in **conspicuous income**
- Increase in **Farmer Suicides**.

Farmer Suicides

While farmers have been in distress from centuries, farmer suicides is relatively new. Sociologists attribute a range of factors, such as:

- Mainly **marginal farmers trying to increase production using GR methods** by borrowing.

- **Failing** which means **heavy debt and suicide**.
- Increasing demand for **dowry, better health, education, medical care**.
- Lack of mobilization making **agriculturists unable to influence policies**

Farmer Suicides Hotspots

Farmer Suicide Hotspot Detection

- by Amisha Bharti and Sonajharia Minz using NCRB Data from 2021 onwards
- (School of Computer and Systems Sciences, Jawaharlal Nehru University)

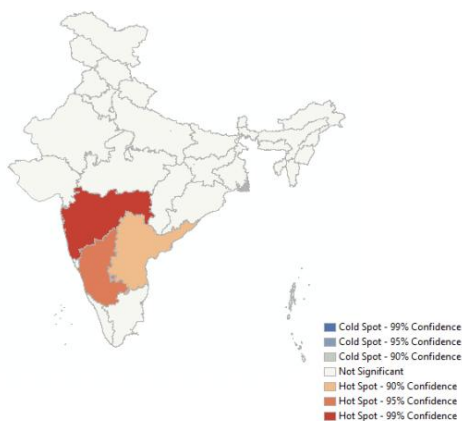
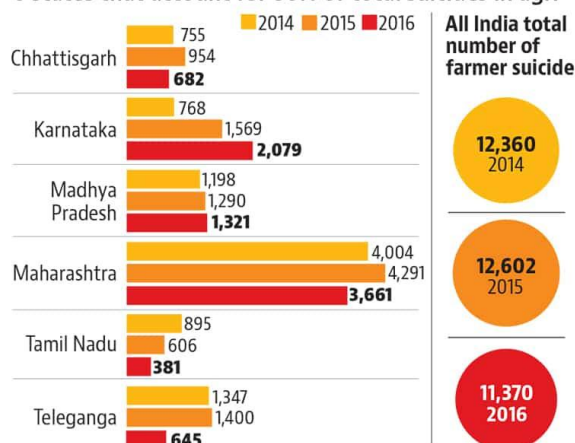


Figure 4. Farmer suicide hotspot

Farm suicide hotspots

6 states that account for 80% of total suicides in agri



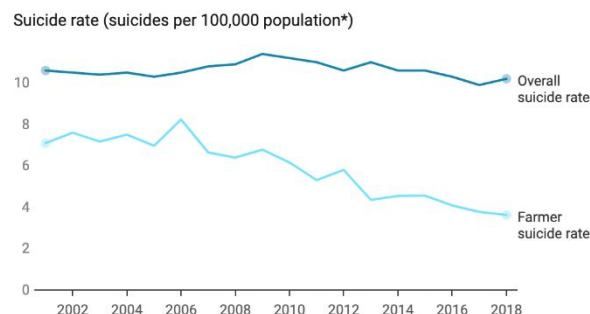
Source: Parliament reply based on provisional data from National Crime Records Bureau 2016 (unpublished)

Farmer Suicide Rate vs Overall Suicide Rate

A Study of NCRB Data by Live Mint highlights this.

- Suicides, especially farmer suicides, are commonly attributed to a single issue such as an agrarian crisis or rising indebtedness.
- Research suggests that explanations are more complicated. In the analysis of farmer suicides between 1997 and 2012, the researchers argue that farmer suicides are a result of three broad factors:
 - Existing vulnerability in a region
 - Agrarian crisis
 - Lack of alternative opportunities.
- There could also be social factors.
- In his book *Unraveling Farmer Suicides in India*, Nilotpal Kumar argues that patriarchy in societies makes farmer suicides an act of patriarchal honour.
- Successfully tackling farmer suicides will require comprehensive, multifaceted policies that address all these issues.

Farmer suicide rates have decreased steadily over the last decade



*Farmer suicide rate calculated as a percentage of total number of workers engaged in agriculture (estimated using census projections). Until 2014, farmer suicides were reported as part of the self-employed category in NCRB data. But since then, NCRB has reported farmer suicide data separately under the heads of cultivator suicides and agricultural labour suicides. In this analysis, we've assumed that the aggregate number of farmer suicides in each year is comparable before and after 2014.

Farmer Suicides – Way Forward

While agriculture is still an important source of earning, agriculture and land is overburden by large dependent population.

1. **Reducing dependency on agriculture** and nature.
2. Using **effective water management** techniques
3. **Effective and timely counselling** should be given to farmers.
4. Generating **additional sources of income** for small and marginal farmers
5. **Relief provisions** for small and marginal farmers against natural hazards and man-made calamity like war, etc.

Cooperatives

Evolution of Cooperatives in India –

- Existed before Independence as well, Cooperative movement started in Germany, 1890s.

Cooperatives – Planned Implementation

First Plan:

- Only recommendary in nature.
- Small and Medium farmers to be encouraged for forming cooperatives.
- CDP had cooperativisation in agenda.

Second Plan:

- More concrete plan.
- A 10 years horizon for bringing half of the agriculture under it.
- Myths created that China achieved tremendous success in agriculture because of cooperatives.
- Myth broken after Mao's death in 1976, their agricultural growth rate less than India's.
- Still, **India under Nehru emulated Chinese** example of cooperatives and envisioned institutional changes in agriculture which didn't ask for much financial outlay.
- Nehru insisted but states wary to implement.

Third Plan:

- It mellowed down the ambition.
- 10 pilot projects per district was envisaged
- Targeted cooperatives in:
 - **Credit** growth (Credit Cooperative Societies)
 - **Marketing** of goods (Amul, IFFCO, etc)
 - **Housing & Distribution** sector
 - **Processing** Sector (Shri Mahila Graha Udyog – Lijjat Papad)

Structure And Significance of Cooperatives

Cooperatives operating in various sectors:

- 80% in agriculture sector
- 60% for credit-based only

Broadly, Divided into 2 groups

- Credit Societies
- Non-credit Societies

Structure And Significance Of Coops

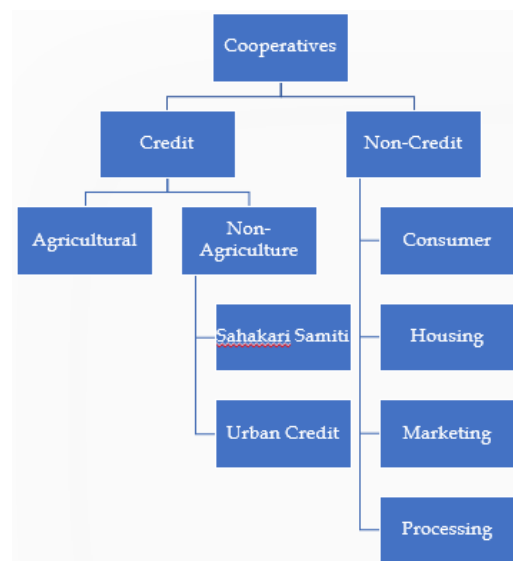
Both **further** divided into two groups

- Agricultural Societies
- Non-agricultural societies

For supervision and financial assistance

- State co-op banks and Centre Govt. banks.

Structure of Cooperatives in India



Significations of Cooperatives

A B C D approach

- A - Accessibility**
- B - Bureaucratic hassles to be decreased**
- C - Class conflicts to be decreased**
- D - Development**

D - Development -> for illiterate, Poverty alleviation, women empowerment

- Accessible by small and cottage industries.
- Reduces bureaucratic and political hassles.
- Softens class conflicts.
- An institution for illiterate, poor and unskilled

What Constitution of India Says...?

Constitutional Mandate-

Constitutional Amendment 97th, 2011:

- Addition of Article 19 (1) (C)
- Article 243 (B) Cooperatives
- Cooperatives word added after Trade Unions

Ministry of Cooperation

- Formed in July 2021
- For strengthening cooperative movements in India
- Objectives
 - Prosperity through cooperation ("Sahkar se Samriddhi")
 - Streamline processes for "Ease of doing business" for co-operatives
 - To deepen the cooperative as a true people-based movement reaching upto the grassroot level.

Why the need for Ministry Of Cooperation?

- Recent examples of multi-crore scam in credit-cooperatives in various states of India, led to the growing debate around monitoring administrative operations of cooperatives.
- Bureaucratic Red-tape: Multi-state cooperatives find compliance issues with state-specific regulation.
- Cooperatives needs a serious technological upgradation.

Criticism of Ministry of Cooperation

- **Subject of State List:** Experts says, creating such a ministry at the central level would increase the power in the hands of the union government.
- **97th Constitutional Amendments** strengthened the role of co-operatives and settled the issue of direct capture of the institutions through a regulatory takeover.

Kerala's Minister of Co-operation and Registration **V. N. Vasavan** stated that, "

- Creation of a new Cooperation ministry is an infringement upon the federal rights of the state governments. This is an **intrusion into the authority of the state governments.**"

Limitations of Cooperatives

Daniel Thorner :

- Co-ops formed as a **result of evading Land Reforms** by rich and influential families.
- **Evading ceiling and tenancy** laws. Land tilled by bogus members, mainly wage labour. Also cornered subsidies.
- State co-op farms had **poor quality land** given to landless and lower castes.
- Extremely **high cost of running** them proved fatal for their success.

Daniel Thorner :

- Dominant caste **diverted public money** for private use.
- **Reinforced** the unjust **Indian social structure** when dominant caste overtook leadership positions.
- A case of public money given to private investment.
- A very small percentage (less than 10%) of credit to small and marginal farmers - Very less small farmers
- A large bureaucracy crept into cooperatives as well - Bureaucracy crept in Populist Policies.
- Populist policies to write-off debts burdened exchequer and eroded the viability of rural credit institutions.

World Bank Study on Cooperatives

World bank Study on Operation flood :

Anand Milk Union Limited (Amul)

- Paid rich dividends. Need to replicate it elsewhere.
- Milk growth from 0.7% per annum to 4% per annum .
- 60% member farmers are small and marginal.
- “Self-Selection” – an imp. observation – by focusing a project on a predominant activity of poor, “self-selection” is likely to result in a majority of the beneficiaries being poor thus reaching target groups.

World bank Study on Operation flood : Amul

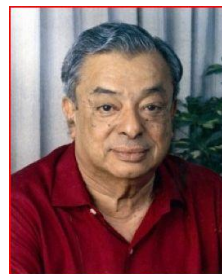
- Milk cooperative's reached to the grassroot poor irrespective of caste, religion or gender. A major politico-economic implication.
- A byproduct of Op. Flood is creation of indigenous dairy equipment manufacturing industry and an impressive body of indigenous experts.
- Now, Indigenisation was considerably cheap.
- Women empowerment – along with SEWA, Ela Bhatt and others 6000 Women Dairy Cooperatives Societies were setup.
- Demand driven education, schooling, infra. etc.
- Impetus to various other brands, eg – Dhara (NDDB effort in vegetable oils).

Diversity - India (Highlight)

For writing in Essays or otherwise while highlighting diversity of India

Dr. Verghese Kurien : Milk-man of India

- A Syrian Christian from Kerala Working in Gujarat.



Poverty Alleviation Schemes

Since Independence, many schemes were formed

Important ones being-

- **20 points programme** -
 - Controlling poverty
 - Inflation
 - Lending
 - crime control
 - Irrigation
 - Rural employment
 - SC/ST, women & children specific programs
- **Integrated Rural Dev. Program (IRDP), 1992:**
- Selected 20 districts from the entire country.
- Self-employment schemes, Targeted approach based on
 - i. Number of poor households.
 - ii. Resources available.
 - iii. Fixed Time-span to achieve results.
 - iv. Limitation -
 - i. Leakages.
 - ii. Finding “guarantor” for credit.
 - iii. Misallocation of loans.
 - iv. Little knowledge of schemes
- **TRYSEM** (Training Rural Youth for Self Employment) -
 - Age 18-35
 - Priority to SC/ST
 - Reason of Failure - But inadequate stipend and low level of skills given.
- **Food for Work Program**
 - Predecessor of MNRGA
 - Generation supplementary wage scheme

Poverty Alleviation Schemes – MNREGA

MNREGA – (with social impacts)

- **Right based** - Work given in time bound guarantee (within 15 days) for 100 days of work (liability on State).
- **Women Empowerment** – 1/3 persons have to be women.
 - Work Site facilities – Crèche, water, shade etc.
 - Work within 5 kms (otherwise 10% extra).

MNREGA – World’s largest Poverty Alleviation Program

- **Decentralised Planning** – 50% of the work to be allotted to Gram Panchayats.
- **Labour Intensive Work** – 60:40 ratio of wage and material. Machinery prohibited.
- **Public Accountability – Social Audits.**
- **Transparency** – All records available to anyone on payment of a fee.

Evaluation of MNREGA

- **Issues discovered**
 - Low quality Asset created
 - Followed arm-chair policies, does not resonate with ground reality.
 - Populist approach: Less emphasis on 3Es...
 - Efficiency
 - Economy
 - Effectiveness
 - No focus on rural-industrialisation.
- No coordination among various programmes.
- Improper delivery of funds- Ghost Beneficiaries
- No effective awareness building measures.
- Increased dependence of masses on State
- Women given work (48% of total)

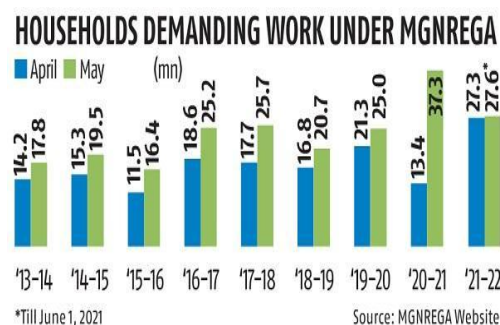
MNREGA

Lessons from Covid-19 Pandemic

MNREGA during Covid Pandemic

Covid-19 fallout: Displacement of migrants

- An immediate Nationwide lockdown to curb the spread of Covid disease left millions of informal workers jobless (mostly wage-labourers)
- Manual labourers in urban and rural areas which worked in informal and casual employment were the worst hit.
- More than 70% of them were seasonal or circulatory migrants, those who come seeking employment at urban centres.
- As economic activities came to sudden halt, migrants left with no option but to return back to their place of origin.
- MNREGA scheme turned out to be the **main livelihood** source for millions of returning migrants and other workers in rural India providing much needed daily wages and subsistence.
- **To highlight:** Once the work started the demand for work went up to 3.05 crore in May 2020, as compared to just 95 lacs in April 2020.



MNREGA: Demand from Workers

Demand from workers:

- **From 100 days per household to 200 days per person:** Terming the existing scheme inadequate, workers collectively demanded an increase in annual guarantee of work to 200 days per person.
- **NREGA Adhikar Diwas:** On, June 29, 2020, thousands of workers observed the day for peaceful protest at their worksites to highlight their demands.

MNREGA: A Saviour in Distress

- **Additional INR 400 Billion:** Govt. allocated additional budget under "Aatmanirbhar" (self-sufficient) campaign, so as to provide wage-employment to returning migrants.
- **Unprecedented demand for work:** In June 2020 alone, while 4.1 crore households were in need of jobs, work was supplied to only 2.8 crore households.
- MNREGA proved to be a **safety net** for millions of poor people, strengthening the role of NREGA in responding to the COVID-19-induced crisis, will be a game-changer in curbing unemployment and distressed migration.

MNREGA need for a revamp

Standing committee recommends a complete revamp of

MGNREGA scheme, these are:

- Increase of guaranteed days of work from 100 to 150 days
- Issuance of job card withing 24-48 hours of receiving application

- Value addition to the scheme such as
 - Skilling of labourers in different aspects,
 - Provision to upgrade the quality of life of the beneficiaries
 - Increase utilization of technology to make timely payments.

MNREGA - After Covid

Lessons learned during pandemic, shows that:

- Govt. needs to increase budgetary allocation for MNREGA.
- Up-skilling rural poor, program for creating self-employment & entrepreneurship.
- A recent study has found that, workers belonging to the “others” categories (over 85% of all MGNREGA workers) ended up facing much longer delays in payments. → Need Improvement
- NREGA can play an important role in reviving rural mass consumption → Needed for economic recovery

Urban MNREGA: Rajasthan's Experiment

“Indira Gandhi Urban Employment Guarantee Scheme”

Idea behind Urban Employment Scheme.

- **Unemployment higher in Urban Areas:** The incidence of unemployment is much higher in urban areas than in rural areas.
- **Unemployment higher among Educated:** The incidence of unemployment among the educated is much higher than the overall unemployment.
- **As Herbert Gans puts,**
 - In cities, unemployed people with low formal education feels ‘**sense of deprivation**’, lives in poverty and often fall a victim to drug and substance abuse.

Demand for such scheme:

- The demand for a job guarantee scheme in cities is increasing because of the growing distress among the urban poor.
 - Persistently high inflation affecting the people and the prevalence of low-wage and poor quality informal work in urban areas.
 - Moreover, as against the rural unemployment being mostly seasonal, unemployed people in the cities face problems throughout the year.

Need for such scheme:

- Populated cities → High competition for jobs → Tendency to commit crime higher. [Delinquency]
- Lack of investment in labour-intensive industry.
- More people migrating to cities seeking higher wages
- Mismatch between needs and availability of relevant skills.

- Unemployment rates for females higher than that for males and highest among urban females → Risk of human trafficking & forced prostitution.

Indira Gandhi Urban Employment Guarantee Scheme

- **IGUEGS - Rajasthan's initiative**
 - **On the lines of MNREGA:**
 - **Rajasthan govt.** on Sept. 9th 2022, rolled out urban employment guarantee schemes.
 - **Objective:** To provide economic support to the poor and needy families living in the cities through work to be provided on demand for 100 days in a year.

IGUEGS - Rajasthan

Features of IGUEGS

- Wages of Skilled : 283/day | Unskilled : Rs. 259/day
- 100 Days of employment to families of urban areas
- 18 - 60 age group is eligible
- Wages to be paid directly in account.
- No income limit restricted - preference will be given to those who lost livelihood in pandemic
- As on 15th sept., more than 1 lakh people are given jobs under the scheme.

Other States - Urban Employment Initiative

- Ayyankali Urban Employment Guarantee Scheme: Kerala
- Urban Wage Employment Initiative under UNNATI: Odisha
- Mukhya Mantri Shramik Yojana: Jharkhand
- Mukhya Mantri Yuva Swabhiman Yojana: Madhya Pradesh.

Problems of Rural Labour, Bondage & Migration

Problems Of Rural Labour

Composition

- Rural labour comprising of agricultural & non-agri labourers and artisans.

Traditional Division of labour system -

- Jajmani: Traditionally upper castes dominated lower serving caste under patron-client relation via Jajmani System
- Willian Wiser - characterized it as regulated Division of labour

Pre-Independence

- **British Administration:** Exploited Jajmani system-
- Britishers introduced private property through land system and made system more exploitative.

- It created class of landowners , sharecroppers, land labourers (increased indebtedness, socio-economic exclusion)

Post-Independence

- **LR, GR:** Created their own problems
 - Eg: Patriarchy, Suicides, etc.

Numerous measures by govt. including LRs, GR. But failure to these schemes further aggravated the problems of Rural Labourers.

- Biggest sufferers were women and children.
- Increased farmer suicide
- Poverty and deprivation
- Corruption in govt. schemes
- Poor wages
- Unequal land access led to conflicts

Sociological Views on Rural Labours

Anand Chakravorty :

- Power faction- hegemonistic domination by rich farmers.

Solution: Needed comprehensive integrated targeted approach by govt.

Bondage

The problem of debt bondage in India is linked to the phenomenon of poverty, which is closely linked to the absence of land and assets.

- Strong commonality between the **community of rural poor and victims of debt** bondage.
- An overwhelming percentage of belong to the category of landless agricultural labourers, a majorly from SCs and STs.

Pranab Bardhan and Ashok Rudra:

Describe 2 types of bonded labourers

- **Unattached**
- **Attached**
 - **Extremely-attached**
 - **Fully-attached**
 - **Semi-attached**

Judicial Stand

Supreme Court in **ASIAD-82 case** said, where there was use of child labour to complete the projects in time:

- **Anyone who's paid less than minimum wages is a bonded labour.**

Also, Highlighted recently by **Kailash Satyarthi's - Bachpan Bachao Andolan.**

Types of Bondages witnessed:

- Debt based
- Kinship based
- Widowhood based
- Marriage based
- Displacement based

Causes of Bondage

Economic:

- Extreme poverty of people - Inability to find work for livelihood
- Inadequate land holdings
- Inaccessibility to formal credit mechanism for the rural and urban poor, due to low awareness and illiteracy
- Impact of natural calamities like droughts and floods
- Meager income from forest produce
- Inflation and constant rising prices

Social:

- Unequal access to opportunities because of social disabilities
- High expenses on social occasions like marriage, death, etc
- Caste based discrimination
- Lack of concrete welfare schemes
- Non-compulsory and unequal education system
- Indifference and corruption among govt. officials

Religious:

- Arguments used to convince the people of low castes that religion enjoins upon them to serve people of high castes.
- Illiteracy
- Ignorance & Immaturity
- Lack of skill and professional training sustain such beliefs.

Sociological View

Bondage originates mainly from economic and social pressures

Tom Brass

- **Deproletarianisation** of agricultural Workers
 - Workers are dispersed
 - Difficult to organize

- Become Bonded.

Surinder S. Jodhka

- Workers keeping getting attached voluntarily
- Constantly into relations of mortgaging (and they keep returning the debt with their labour)

Policy Initiatives

Article 23 -> Forced Labour prohibited

Bonded Labour System (Abolition) Act -- it includes

- Identification of Victim
- Release of Victim
- Action against offenders
- Regular meetings of vigilance committees
- Conferring of judicial powers to executives, magistrates

But there still lies problems in

- Identification
- Economic rehabilitation.

Migration

Definition

- Migration is a livelihood strategy and a means to cope with distress arising from drought, flood and lack of employment opportunities locally.
- It is a change of place of residence for a comparatively long period.
- Migration is Voluntary, whereas, displacement is Forceful, Permanent.
- Migration is a livelihood strategy

4 Main Streams Of Migrating

- Rural – Urban (most important, only this will be discussed)
- Rural – Rural
- Urban – Urban
- Urban – Rural

Different Types of Migration

- **Translocator**: to settle down at different location.
- **Circulatory**: migrate repeatedly and for varying duration.
- **Step Migration**: migration in graded steps from small to large settlements

Why Migrate: Reasons Of Migration

Ashish Bose explained it from demographic perspective.

- **Push factors**
 - Economic
 - Natural
 - Social -> Caste based disabilities, etc.
 - Political -> Riots, conflicts
 - Lack of resources, unemployment, overpopulation, droughts, floods etc.
- **Pull Factors**
 - Better employment opportunities elsewhere
 - Better Education facilities elsewhere
 - Better trade opportunities elsewhere, etc.
 - A means to more freedom.

Why Migrate: Reasons Of Migration

Socio-Economic factors:

- Small landholdings
- Depressed economic conditions
- Poverty
- Failed LR
- Regional disparities
- Failure of poverty alleviation schemes
- Virilocal/Patrilocal pattern of residence -> Girls migrate to husband's home.

Migration - Impact on Social Life

Impact/Consequences:

- **Family**
 - Functionally joint family arrived
 - I.P. Desai:
 - Traditional joint families are replaced by functionally joint family.
- **Caste**
 - Diminished caste identity
 - Weak caste solidarity and caste panchayats.
 - Andre Beteille: Class ties are much more important than caste ties

Migration - Impact on women

Impact/Consequences

- **Women:**
 - Status improved
 - Divorce more
 - Remarriage
 - Increase in marriage age
 - Karuna Ahmed: Still women cluster in low status occupation.

Migration - Impact on Social Structure

Impact/Consequences

- **Mobility**
 - Increased
 - **Ashish Nandy:**
 - Urbanization has supported caste mobility
- **Ethnic Minority**
 - Increased
 - Society becoming multi-ethnic.

Migration - Problems

Problems caused by migration

- Pollution
- Crowding
- Corruption
- Unemployment
- Crime

Problems caused by migration

- Juvenile delinquency
- Slums
- Drug addiction
- Alcoholism
- Begging due to population explosion in urban areas.

Migration - Composition of Group

Migrants are not a homogeneous group

Huge **variations** in

- Age
- Gender
- Educational level
- Occupational status
- Skills
- Earnings
- Linguistic and cultural background.

Outcomes:

- As a result, different levels of vulnerability and inclusion exist.
 - For example: North-Easterners often find it tough in Delhi, whereas Punjabis better fit in.
- Migrants with poor skills and education are hugely vulnerable and suffer from deprivations and exploitation in the places they migrate to

Migration - Solutions

Solutions

- Restructuring of village life (**PURA**) (**Rurbanisation - MS Ghurye**)
- **Improve agriculture** as a means of livelihood
- **2nd Generation of Land reforms**
- **Taking GR to Eastern India - BGREI**
- **Reformed MNREGA** (Providing employment opportunities)
- **Better infrastructure**, electricity, water, education in villages, Bharat Nirman, OFCN

Migration - Sociological View

Yogendra Singh:

- In India this process of migration to urban areas is characterized by “over urbanization” where there is Migration without Industrialization.
- Migration has increased continuity between rural & urban Areas.

UNESCO Report

Titled "Social Inclusion of Internal Migrants in India".

It highlights that:

1. Internal migrants a neglected segment of population

2. A third of India's population categorised as internal migrant by the census
3. Half of them participate in the workforce
4. Visible everywhere in big and small cities, rural areas
5. Prominently employed in the construction and textile sectors, at brick kilns and salt pans
6. Also in commercial and plantation agriculture
7. Informal sector as vendors, hawkers, rickshaw pullers and daily wage workers, domestic workers
8. They contribute to the rising GDP of India and send remittances to their families back home, to be spent on food, education and healthcare.
9. Remittances by internal migrants amount to about Rs 60,000-70, 000 crore.
10. But financial inclusion has not spread much among migrants yet – less than 50 per cent of the remittances are sent through formal channels.
11. States like Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Odisha and Uttarakhand are the major recipients of internal remittances.
12. Social remittances (Urban Culture) - Returning migrants bring a variety of skills, innovation and knowledge to their areas of origin.

In the long run, migration could play a positive role.

UNESCO Report – Concludes

- Right policy could benefit both the areas of origin and the areas that receive migrants.
- Migration cannot be stopped. It is a historical process that shapes human civilisation, culture and development.
- Article 19 of the Indian Constitution grants citizens the fundamental right to move.
- Urgent need to issue a universally recognised and portable proof of identity. (UIDAI, One Nation One Ration Card a right step)

UNESCO Report – Challenges Highlighted

So, imagine it like this:

- Composition
- Contribution
- Financial resistances
- Social resistances
- Urban culture
- Usage
- Recognition

National Sample Survey

- Internal Migrants are deprived of Political (voting) & Economic rights (Access to schemes).
- About 15 million seasonal and temporary migrants.
- Not able to exercise their political and economic rights because rights and entitlements are place bound.
- Lacking residential and identity proofs, barred from exercising their voting rights.
- Excluded from the PDS and other government programmes.

Imagining From A Migrant Woman's Angle

- Vulnerable to sexual harassment (Domestic helps)
- Most women migrate along with their family members, many also move independently.
- Their statistical database is extremely poor.
- Usually marriage as a reason for these migrations.
- Such women do work before and after migration.
- Migrant women vulnerable to sexual harassment and trafficking.
- Urgent need to ensure safe migration for women workers particularly those joining the domestic workforce.
- Affects regular and continued schooling
- Hampers Socialising
- Development of sub-cultural tendencies, leading to deviance
- These children could be kept in the source regional-seasonal hostels.
- Another option - set up work-site schools.

Problem Of Urbanisation For Migrants

- Urbanisation is inevitable.
- Shelter is an important issue for the migrant and homeless population.
- Migration issues should be factored into city development plans - JNNURM & RAY.
- Night shelters as well as working women's and men's hostels could be incorporated in city development plans.

Problem of Labour Issues

- The Inter-state Migrant Workmen Regulation Act, 1979 deals with contractor-led movement of inter-state migrant labour, is not enforced adequately.
- A segment of migrant workers moves along with contractors.
- Many move independently through the network of family, friends and kin.

Migration should not be seen merely as a law enforcement and governance issue. It must be integrated with development concerns.

Summarising

Problems of Migrants

- **Identity** issue : No proof of identity
- **Political** rights deprived
- **Economic** rights deprived (schemes entitlement)
- **Lack of acceptability** host society (North Easterners)
- **Homelessness**

Problems of Migrants

- Vulnerability of women as domestic help
- Generally have to stay in slums
- Easy pray for criminals, traffickers, prostitution rackets
- Many become bonded labour
- Compromised family life

Important Topics Swaminathan Report

A Broad set of 11 recommendations

1. Total five reports submitted. Through December 2004 – October 2006.
2. 5th report focused on farmer suicides and farmer distress. It then recommends a National Policy for Farmers.
3. **Cause of Farmer's Distress**
 - a. Unfinished land reforms
 - b. Quantity and Quality of water.
 - c. Technology fatigue.
 - d. Access, Adequacy and timeliness of institutional credit.
 - e. Opportunities for assured and remunerative marketing.

Important Recommendation

- Agriculture be inserted in the Concurrent list of the Constitution.

Recommendation on Land Reforms

- Distribute ceiling surplus and waste lands.
- Prevents diversion of prime agriculture land and forest to corporate sector for non agricultural purposes.
- Ensure grazing rights and seasonal access to forests to tribals and pastoralists, and access to common property resources.
- Establish a national land use advisory service, which have the capacity to link land use decisions with ecological meteorological and marketing factors on a location and seasons specific basis.
- Set up a mechanism to regulate the sale of agricultural land, based on quantum of land, nature of proposed use and category of buyer.

5. Recommendations on Irrigation

- Increase water supply through rainwater harvesting.
- Recharge of the aquifer should become mandatory.
- "Million Wells Recharge" program, specifically targeted at private wells should be launched.

6. Recommendations on Credit and Insurance-

- Reduce rate of interest for crop loans to 4 per cent simple, with government support.
- Moratorium on debt recovery, including loans from non-institutional sources, and waiver of interest on loans in distress hotspots and during calamities, till capability is restored.
- Establish an Agriculture Risk Fund to provide relief to farmers in the aftermath of successive natural calamities.
- Issue Kisan Credit Cards to women farmers, with joint pattas as collateral.
- Develop an integrated credit-cum-crop-livestock-human health insurance package.
- Expand crop insurance cover to cover the entire country and all crops, with reduced premiums and create a Rural Insurance Development Fund to take up development work for spreading rural insurance.

7. Recommendations on Food Security

- Implement a universal public distribution system. Total subsidy required for this would be one per cent of the GDP.
- Reorganise the delivery of nutrition support programmes on a life-cycle basis with the participation of Panchayats and local bodies.
- Eliminate micronutrient deficiency induced hidden hunger through an integrated food cum fortification approach.
- Promote the establishment of Community Food and Water Banks operated by Women Self-help Groups (SHG), based on the principle 'Store Grain and Water everywhere'.
- Help small and marginal farmers to improve the productivity, quality and profitability of farm enterprises and organize a Rural Non-Farm Livelihood Initiative.
- Formulate a National Food Guarantee Act continuing the useful features of the Food for Work and Employment Guarantee programmes.
- By increasing demand for food grains as a result of increased consumption by the poor, the economic conditions essential for further agricultural progress can be created.

8. Recommendations on Farmers' Suicides

- The National Rural Health Mission should be extended to suicide hotspot locations on priority basis.
- Set up State level Farmers' Commission with representation of farmers.
- Restructure microfinance policies to serve as Livelihood Finance, i.e. credit coupled with support services in the areas of technology, management and markets.
- Decentralise water use planning and every village should aim at Jal Swaraj with Gram Sabhas serving as Pani Panchayats.
- Ensure availability of quality seed and other inputs at affordable costs and at the right time and place.
- Have a Price Stabilisation Fund in place to protect the farmers from price fluctuations.

- Need swift action on import duties to protect farmers from international price.
- Set up Village Knowledge Centres(VKCs) or Gyan Chaupals in the farmers' distress hotspots.
- Public awareness campaigns to make people identify early signs of suicidal behaviour.

9. Recommendations on Competitiveness

- Promotion of commodity-based farmers' organisations.
- Improvement in implementation of Minimum Support Price (MSP).
- Arrangements for MSP need to be put in place for crops other than paddy and wheat.
- MSP should be at least 50% more than the weighted average cost of production.
- Availability of data about spot and future prices of commodities.
- State Agriculture Produce Marketing Committee Acts [APMC Acts] relating to marketing, storage and processing of agriculture produce need to shift to one that promotes grading, branding, packaging and development of domestic and international markets for local produce.
- Move towards a Single Indian Market.

10. Recommendations on Employment

- India must seek to achieve two things:
- Create productive employment opportunities.
- Improve the 'quality' of employment.
- The "net take home income" of farmers should be comparable to those of civil servants.

11. Recommendations on Bio resources

- Preserving traditional rights of access to biodiversity (access to non-timber forest products including medicinal plants, gums and resins, oil yielding plants and beneficial micro-organisms).
- Conserving, enhancing and improving crops and farm animals as well as fish stocks through breeding.
- Encouraging Community-based breed conservation.
- Allowing export of indigenous breeds and import of suitable breeds to increase productivity of nondescript animals.

Swaminathan Says MSP Better Than Loan Waiver

The protesting farmers, apart from a repeal of the laws, have also demanded a law guaranteeing MSPs calculated using the C2 yardstick. The farmers will hold the next round of negotiations with the center on Friday.

UPSC & Swaminathan Report

Countless Questions related with Agriculture in Mains and Prelims.

Internal Migrants: Covid-19 Crisis and Beyond

Overview of Migrant Crisis

- During the COVID-19 outbreak, Indian migrant workers encountered numerous challenges.
- Millions of migrant workers faced a loss of income, food shortages, and uncertainty about their future when companies and businesses were shut down due to the country's lockdown.
- Many of them, as well as their families, went hungry as a result of this.
- Thousands of people then began walking home because they had no other option owing to the lockout.
- As a result, the central and state governments took different steps to assist them, including arranging transportation for them.

Steps taken by Governments for the Migrants.

- The 'One Nation, One Ration Card' initiative was launched to enable nationwide ration card portability.
- Special Credit Facility for Street Vendors (Allocation: Rs. 5,000 crore)
- Free food grain Supply to migrants for 2 months
- Migrants were not needed to present ration cards or address evidence for LPG connections under the Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana 2.0 (PMUY 2.0). A self-declaration sufficed as proof.
- The Ayushman Bharat Scheme's benefits were made portable across the country, allowing beneficiaries to receive cashless care at any empanelled public or private hospital in India.
- In the aftermath of the COVID-19 epidemic, the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Rojgar Abhiyaan (PM GKRA) was developed to increase employment and livelihood options for migrant workers returning to communities.
- The government has recently approved the Developing of Affordable Rental Housing Complexes (ARHCs) initiative for urban migrants and the underprivileged.

Reasons for Migration

Push Factors

- Rural areas' agricultural base does not provide work for all of the people.
- Village small scale and cottage industries are unable to provide employment as well.
- The rural poverty alone accounts for about 69% migration from the rural to the cities of better opportunities
- Violence based on caste drives people out of villages.

According to National Commission for Schedule Castes - UP, Bihar and Rajasthan lead in registered crimes against Dalits. (These are major sources of Migrants) The study of Rajasthan villages by Rajni Kothari shows that the propensity to migrate is high in upper and lower caste groups

- Natural calamities such as floods, droughts, and cyclones are becoming more intense in villages.
- After marriage, many women migrate in considerable numbers.

Pull Factors

- Cities are major employers of the country.

- *Economic motive predominates all other factors of Migration as seen by Ravenstein. (German-English Geographer gave Laws of Migration)*
- The open mindedness in cities especially with respect to identities.
- The other benefits such as schools, health infrastructure.
- Extra income during the season when there is no work to do on farm.

Issues faced by Migrants during Covid-19 Crisis -

- Because of the crisis's unpredictability, many migrants fled on foot or in overcrowded buses and trucks.
- 198 migrant labourers perished as a result of road accidents. *Data compiled by the SaveLIFE Foundation, a road safety NGO*
- The lack of proper medical infrastructure, such as testing and quarantine facilities, exacerbated the problem significantly.
- Villagers reportedly refused to allow the migrants to enter villages. *Dipankar Gupta once said - much romanticised harmony of village life is now exposed for the sham it perhaps always was.*
- Migrants, particularly those working in the informal economy, fell deeper into poverty as a result of job losses.
- Reduced remittances from migrant workers as a result of COVID19's lockdown measures and business closures pushed children into labour, particularly in rural areas. *Increase in proportion of working children from 28.2% to 79.6% courtesy Pandemic/lockdown - study conducted by Campaign Against Child Labour (CACL)*
- Migrant workers in their hometowns were forced to rely on debt and exploitative interest rates to make ends meet. This will result in intergenerational bonding and wage less labour for decades.

Issues faced by Migrants in general

Basic Issues

- They dominate low-paying, hazardous and informal market jobs - Construction site, brick kiln, manufacturing, transportation, etc.
- There is a continuous fear of being dismissed which creates insecurity.
- Because of their lack of education, they are exploited by their employer. *Illiteracy affects 57.8% of female migrants and 25.8% of male migrants (Census, 2011).*
- Migrant workers' children do not have access to education near their job areas.
- The majority of migrants live in slums and have difficulty accessing basic services such as sanitation, which has a negative impact on their health and well-being.

High Cost of Migration

- Money paid to the contractor
- Travelling cost between source and destination
- Medical expenses and cost of accident
- Repayment of money borrowed (indebtedness)

M.P. Todaro (American economist) defines the cost of migration as the moving cost or money available to move,

travel and afford the costs of living at the destination

Citizenship Issue

- Interstate migrants are unable to vote since their eligibility is decided by their inclusion on the electoral roll of the local constituency.
- Hence States are unconcerned about the needs of migrants, preventing them from receiving social benefits.
- Such a sedentary conception of social and political citizenship effectively restricts the population's mobility.
- This coupled with the informal nature of employment points to the "immobile foundations of labour mobility" in India.
- They experience discrimination and political isolation since the local language and culture differs from that of their home region.
- The continued social and political exclusion of circular labour migrants in India point to the antinomies of freedom.
- Antinomies of freedom - On the one hand, they are freer than ever before to journey to the destinations of their choice. But those very same freedoms disqualify them from exercising their social and political rights.

(Example of Passive Exclusion - Amartya Sen)

- It prevent workers' migratory journeys from translating into meaningful social mobility.

(Intergenerational or Intra generational)

Social Issues

- The migrant women are vulnerable to sexual harassment at work place.
- Issues faced by children include malnutrition, sexual abuse, child labour, etc.
- The lockdown and its consequences have exposed the presence of caste as a factor, not only in determining one's social capital (*Pierre Bourdieu Concept*) but also a determining factor in governmental decisions.
- Data suggests that daily wage labourer in cities & migrant labourers comprise largely of the OBC, SC, and ST communities. (Example of Overlap of Caste and Class)

Institutional Issues

- Migrant labour are trapped by middlemen/contractor hiring, using the methods of advance payment, and one-time payment settlement.
- Employers and contractors (middlemen) exploit workers through non-payment of salaries, physical abuse, and accidents.
- The existing legal system is insensitive to the nature of unorganised sector legal issues.
- Migrants do not have a position in trade union manifestos due to their mobile character.
- Poor implementation of protections under the Inter-State Migrant Workmen Act, 1979 (ISMW Act)
- The Inter-State Migrant Workmen (Regulation of Employment and Conditions of Service) Act (1979) only applies to migrants crossing state borders, excluding a major segment of the population.
- Spending on all key social security programmes by the central government has decreased from 1.6 percent in 2013-14 to barely 1.28 percent in 2019-20.

Data Issue

- Internal migration data in India is mostly derived from two main sources: the census and the National Sample Survey Office's surveys.
- Total number of internal migrants in India is 45.36 cr or 37% of countries population as per 2011 census (Decade old data)
- The inadequacy of both the Census and the NSS surveys to fully capture seasonal and/or short-term circular mobility is one of their major flaws

Benefits of Migration

- They contribute to the rising GDP of India and send remittances to their families back home, to be spent on food, education and healthcare.
- Remittances by internal migrants is around Rs 60,000-70, 000 crore.
- States like Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Odisha and Uttarakhand are the major recipients of internal remittances.
- Social remittances (Urban Culture) - Returning migrants bring a variety of skills, innovation and knowledge to their areas of origin.
- In the long run, migration could play a positive role.

Migration cannot be stopped. It is a historical process that shapes human civilisation, culture and development. Article 19 of the Indian Constitution grants citizens the fundamental right to move.

Right policy could benefit both the areas of origin and the areas that receive migrants.

What could be done for Internal Migrants?

At the Destination

- To avoid work discrimination, the state should remove the necessity of domicile status.
- There should be adequate arrangements for migrant populations including affordable housing, employment, and health care.
- Migrant children should be given special consideration for admission to schools under the Right to Education.
- Local bodies and NGOs should be used to upskill migrants.
- Policies should be framed separately for household and individual migrants as their needs are different.
- Microfinance should be made available for the migrants.
- To protect wages, a legal cell should be established at the central and state levels.
- A database to track migrant labourers dispersed across the country is required.
- Within public services and government programmes, provide targeted components and a special outreach plan for migrants.
- MGNREGS should be expanded to urban areas in order to provide work for the needy.

- Sensitize and instruct policymakers, employers, and financial institutions about the barriers that migrants face in obtaining public services.

At the Source

- Increasing investment in agriculture to make it profitable.
- Setting up small scale industries in villages to provide employment.
- Better schools, hospitals, and recreational infrastructure in village/town areas. GS Ghurye's phenomenon of Rurbanisation
- Land reforms, prevention of land degradation, and 2nd generation green revolution.
- Build Panchayats' competence to maintain a migrant worker database.

M.P. Todaro said - decision to migrate is taken by people on the basis of their assessment of the opportunities available to them in rural and urban areas.

Additional Information

The ISMW Act provides certain protections for inter-state migrant workers.

Labour contractors recruiting migrants are required to:

- i. be licensed,
- ii. register migrant workers with the government authorities, and
- iii. arrange for the worker to be issued a passbook recording their identity.

Guidelines regarding wages and protections (including accommodation, free medical facilities, protective clothing) to be provided by the contractor are also outlined in the law.

Farmers Protest

Basic information of Farmer Protest

- The 2020–2021 Indian farmers' protest a protest against three farm acts.
- This were passed by the Parliament of India in September 2020.
 - The Farmers' Produce Trade and Commerce (Promotion and Facilitation) Act, which allows a barrier-free trade of farmers' produce outside the physical premises of the markets specified under the various state Agricultural Produce Marketing Committee laws (APMC Acts).
 - The Essential Commodities (Amendment) Act which provides that the central government may regulate the supply of certain food items including cereals, pulses, potato, onions, edible oilseeds, and oils, only under extraordinary circumstances. These include: (i) war, (ii) famine, (iii) extraordinary price rise and (iv) natural calamity of grave nature.
 - The Farmers (Empowerment and Protection) Agreement on Price Assurance and Farm Services Act. It creates a framework for contract farming through an agreement between a farmer and a buyer before the production or rearing of any farm produces. It provides for a three-level dispute settlement mechanism: the conciliation board, Sub-Divisional Magistrate, and Appellate Authority.
- Farmers, farmer unions and their representatives demanded that the laws be repealed.
- Eleven rounds of talks took place between the central government and farmers but all were inconclusive.
- Supreme Court "suspended" the "implementation" of three farm laws in a bid to persuade farmers agitating.
- Finally, Government announced on 19th November 2021 that the three farm laws stands repealed.

Need for the Farms Laws

- To weed out Middleman (Licenced commission agents)
- APMC are not able to satisfy the needs of small and marginal farmers who cannot transport their produce to APMC
- To provide more opportunity / choices to the farmers thus creating competition and thus increases their income.
- To save the farmer from the taxes they have to pay to the APMC (State Tax / Mandi Tax)
- The Essential Commodities (Amendment) Act provides the incentive for building cold storage infrastructures.
- To protect farmer from crop failure since the "The Empowerment and Protection Act" says that the corporate in agreement will bear the loss.
- The existing agricultural practise is outdated the investment from corporate will upgrade it.

Concerns of Farmers and Government's Response to it

Concerns of Farmers	Government's Response
APMC will be shut down	Nothing of this sort mentioned in the Act. Further power on APMC is given to state government.
MSP will be abolished	Nothing of this sort mentioned in the Act. Government was willing to give written assurance on MSP.
New Market Place will create monopoly	The change in law is going to help farmers who cannot benefit from APMC. The power on regulation of New Market place is with State Government
If the contract is not fulfilled by the farmer the corporates will confiscate the land.	The Empowerment and Protection Act (section 8) specifies that no transfer of land by sale, lease & mortgage
Only SDM are authorised to deal with grievances Farmers have no right to approach Civil Court	Will make provision for appeal to the court

Farmers Demands

- Convene a special Parliament session to repeal the farm laws.
- Make MSP and state procurement of crops a legal right.
- Assurances that conventional procurement system will remain.
- Implement Swaminathan Panel Report and peg MSP at least 50% more than weighted average cost of production.
- Centre should not interfere in state subjects, decentralization in practice.
- Withdrawal of all cases against and release of farmer leaders. Etc.

Methods Employed by the Protester

- Blocking of borders and roads
- Rail Roko and Dilli Chalo
- Republic Day Kisan Parade
- Calling Bandh

Support of people from other fields

- NGO's and farmer organisation setup langar, tents, solar powered mobile charging points, laundry, library, medical stalls, dental camp, etc.
- UN called on the Indian government to allow the protests.
- Human Rights Watch asked government to drop "baseless criminal charges" against journalists covering the protests.
- Academicians from across India came out in support of the three farm laws
- Politicians, Artist, et., returned the awards
- Greta Thunberg uploaded a document on Twitter which allegedly guided protestors about protests and on how to mobilise people
- On Social Media hashtags like #FarmersProtest, #standwithfarmerschallenge, #SpeakUpForFarmers, etc. were trending
- Counter legislation by states like Punjab, Rajasthan, Chhattisgarh.

Nature of Farm Protest

- Not a pan India Protest.
- Led by farmers of Punjab, Haryana who are better off from farmers in rest of the country.

Beneficiaries of Green revolution whom Rudolph called Bullock Capitalist

- Largely peaceful with few incidence of violence.

One can see Gandhi's approach of Love and Ambedkar's approach of Law

- Long movement spanning more than a year.
- Secular in nature though largely spearheaded by Sikh community.
- Involvement of men women of different age group.

Charles Tilly said Social Movement acts as a vehicle for ordinary people's participation in public politics

- Self-funded along with support from various NGO's.

Can be seen as example of Resource Mobilisation Theory

- Use of Social media platforms.
- Political in nature as farmers were getting involved in election campaigning against Government.

Structural Reason for the Protest

- Low income from Agriculture that necessitates support from Government.
- Less diversification of agricultural produce.
- Small fragmented land holding.
- High dependence of people on agriculture as source of income.
- The cartelization of APMC and vested interest of the Traders.
- The fear of corporatization of Agriculture.
- The lack of confidence in the Justice delivering apparatus.
- The lack of education that makes the situation of farmer precarious.
- Very low investment by government in Agriculture.
- The lack of wider consultation by the government before bringing out the laws.
- Communication failure between Government and Citizens
- Failure of government scheme to bring changes such as e-NAM

Farm laws can be seen as example of Neil Smelser “Precipitating factor” for Social Movement from his “Structural Strain Theory.”

Issues with the Protest

- It did not take into consideration the needs of the wage labourers, migrants.

Whom Jan Breman called footloose labour.

- Protest was largely spearheaded by the landowning farmers, the actual participation of the Dalit agricultural labourers was negligible.

Rudolphs - bullock capitalists after GR, claim to speak for all.

- Success of the protest will not change the positions of landless sharecropper most of whom are Dalits.

NSSO Data shows upper minority agrarian class dominates more than 60% of land in rural areas

Sukhdev Thorat – almost 75 % of Dalit household are either landless or near landless

- The invisible and unpaid labour force i.e. Woman though at the forefront will not benefit much with the farm laws or without it.

Vina Majumdar while viewing agrarian class structure from feminist perspective points at the economic un-freedom of woman

- It will not change the regional disparity in the agricultural sector because of limited beneficiary of MSP.
- Only 6 % farmers are benefiting from MSP thus the protest is securing the interest of limited farmers.
- Lack of involvement from the farmers from other parts of country shows the region specific nature.
- The counter-protests by farmer Unions such as Shetkari Snagathana in Maharashtra in support of the Bills.

- Involvement of religious sect (Nihangs) reduced its secular credential.
- The participation of Bindrawale sympathizer became a concern.
- Violence during Republic Day Kisan Parade became a concern.
- The allegation of foreign funding raised concerns.
- The blocking of roads lead to economic loss not only to the industrial units but also to the people dependent on it.
- The obstacle in commuting caused major problems to patient, physically challenged and elderly as per NHRC.
- The demand to repeal farm law raised question on the Parliamentary system which is a Basic Structure of Constitution

According to Andre Beteille, while Constitution may define direction in which government should move, it is the people, through their action and ideology, determine the efficacy of law.

- The environmental degradation due to nature of MSP will continue even if the farmer's demand are met.

Case Study (source Hindustan Times)

International Experience with farm laws that encourage agri-business

- Research at the London School of Economics on a decade of high-quality farmer-buyer data from Kenya.
- Kenyan government introduced such laws to transform smallholder agriculture for the better.
- Soon after the policy was implemented, small farmers became more likely to sell these crops to agri-businesses,
- But, five years on, many had stopped selling to these businesses.
- Farmers who were reliant on agri-businesses saw their incomes fall by an average 6%.
- The ease of doing business increased in buying and marketing. As agri-businesses moved into these new activities, greater investment outlays and hence greater profitability was needed to finance them.
- Farmers began facing bigger agri-businesses which, on average, saw their profit margins rise by 5%.

While some farmers were able to leave their agri-business relationships, many were facing bigger and fewer buyers in crop markets.

C 3

Industrialization and Urbanisation in India

Sub-topics:

1. Evolution of modern industry in India.
2. Growth of urban settlements in India.
3. Working class: structure, growth, class mobilization.
4. Informal sector, child labour.
5. Slums and deprivation in urban areas.

Evolution Of Modern Industry In India

Early phase 1850s:

- Establishment of Cotton and jute mills, Mines gradually flourished.
- Regulated to suit the needs of British capitalism.

Between 1920s to 1940s:

- Phenomenal increase in demand of factory products in India.
- No serious efforts by Britishers to foster the growth of capital goods industry. [Raw materials were exported and factory finished products were dumped into the Indian markets]

Emergence of Indian Industrial community:

- There were however several business communities who were initially the collaborators and middlemen with the British, like the **Parsis and Marwaris who ventured in to setting up industries.**
- The **Marwaris of Calcutta** moved from being traders to industrialist in the jute business. The transformation of a few Marwari families from 'traders to industrialists' was gradual.

This pattern can be described in the following steps:

- A. Marwaris slowly increased their importance in the **trade of raw jute and jute manufactures;**
- B. **Some of the Marwari traders became members of the formal jute-trade organizations.** Others became brokers to British managing agency houses, or, by buying shares got a place on the board of directors of British managing agency houses;

Rise of Indian Industrial Community

- C. Finally, in the **early 1920s, a few Marwaris entered the jute industries by setting up their own jute mills.**

The **Birlas** started their **first jute mill in 1919**, whereas **Goenkas** and **Bangurs** started theirs after World War II

Rise of Indian Industrial Community - Parsis

The **Parsis** on the other hand did not face stiff opposition from the British like the Marwaris.

They were the collaborators of the British and sympathized with them.

1. **They partly financed the military defense of the Bombay fort.**
2. **They were loyal to the British during the Mutiny (1857), financing the British military apparatus.**

3. A part of the Parsi community was fast to recognise that it was very useful to **learn English, to adopt British customs and to intensify their relation with the British** in order to improve the socio-economic status of the community in West India.
- The Parsis were among the first to build up the Indian cotton textile industry in Bombay.
 - Parsis owned nine of ten mills built in Bombay between 1854 and 1863. This included two mills of the **Petit family**.
 - In the period between 1878 and 1915, the Parsis owned 30 per cent of the mills in the city.
 - **Apart from these communities, the bankers of Ahmedabad started setting up mills without any British intervention or association.**
 - After this initial foray many trading families started to invest in industrial enterprise.
 - This challenged the monopoly of British capitalist, the government started adopting discriminatory policies towards them.
 - **The tariff, taxation and transport policies were made favourable to the British capitalist.**
 - Thus, there was stiff competition in the marketing of goods as well.
 - The Indian capitalists organized themselves in to **Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI)**.

Evolution Of Modern Industry In India

Indian Industrial community in favour of free India:

- The capitalists were aware that they would be better off in a **free India** and were **active supporters** of nationalist struggles.
- The leadership of the national movement were also aware of the need for industrialization of the country.

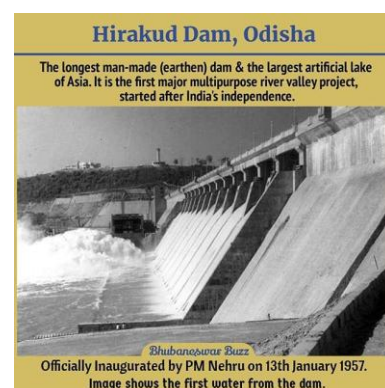
At the time of independence :

- Several jute and cotton textile mills, sugar factories and two major iron and steel plants existed.

Evolution Of Modern Industry - After Independence

After Independence :

- Mixed economy, conscious and deliberative efforts for **industrialisation through successive 5YP**.
- Industrial output grew till the mid-sixties then faced recession, leading to a sharp fall in capacity utilization and public investment.
- Industrial policies in post-independent India were not solely influenced by aspects of colonialism. But they were also informed by **dominant paradigms of development** discourse and by contemporary politics.
- This history made Indian leaders wary of international free trade.
- Pt. Nehru who was inspired by **Fabian socialism and by the Russian example** decided to adopt a **socialist pattern of economic development**.
- Much of early economic activity in newly independent India was state induced, and state controlled.
- Pt. Nehru wanted to adopt **Harold Laski's idea of mixed economy**, which he did.



- The **state controlled major industries** and public-utility related services.
- Pt. Nehru truly believed that like Russia, India needed to develop its heavy industries which are capital intensive.
- Thus, in the **initial phase of economic development** saw setting up of heavy industries and the construction of dams.

Criticism of Indian Economic Development

Criticism:

- Some critics of Indian economic development believe that the economic model of the Nehruvian and post-Nehruvian era, resulted into inefficient public sector entities.
- Crony-capitalist private sector entities on the other hand, used the so-called license raj to carve out lucrative niches for themselves.

Planned Economic Development Model 5YP

- After independence, **India opted to have a centrally planned economy to ensure an effective and equitable allocation of national resources** for the purpose of balanced economic development.
- The idea of planning was taken from **Russian centralized planning system**.
- Indian Economy is based on the concept of planning. This is carried through **Five Year Plans, developed, executed and monitored by the Planning Commission**.

India followed polices of:

- Import **substitution**
- Industrialisation and **state intervention in labour and financial markets**
- A **large public sector**
- **Overt regulation** of business (Sectoral Restrictions)
- **Central planning**

Plan-wise GDP growth rates

Plan	Actual growth*
1951-56 First Five-Year Plan	3.6
1956-61 Second Five-Year Plan	4.2
1961-66 Third Five-Year Plan	2.8
1969-74 Fourth Five-Year Plan	3.3
1974-79 Fifth Five-Year Plan	4.7
1980-85 Sixth Five-Year Plan	5.7
1985-90 Seventh Five-Year Plan	5.8
1992-97 Eighth Five-Year Plan	6.5
1997-02 Ninth Five-Year Plan	5.5
2002-07 10th Five-Year Plan	7.8
2007-12 11th Five-Year Plan	7.9
2012-2017 12th Five-Year Plan	Scenario 1-8 (Strong growth)
	Scenario 2-6 (Partial reform)
	Scenario 3-5 (Policy logjam)

From 1966 to 69, there was no five-year Plan but annual plans. Similarly, from 1979 to 80 and from 1990 to 1992, there were no five-year Plans.
 1951-56 means April 1, 1951, to March 31, 1956, and likewise
 *In percentage
 Source: Planning Commission of India

Slower Growth than other Emerging Economies

Hindu Rate of Growth:

- Economist Raj Krishna coined the term.
- Till 1980 this was the general tone of economy, the growth rate was steady but not substantial and it was generally referred to as the 'Hindu growth rate', because all other surrounding Asian economies, especially the 'East Asian Tigers' were growing at rapid pace. [South Korea, Singapore, etc.

Push for Major Economic Reforms

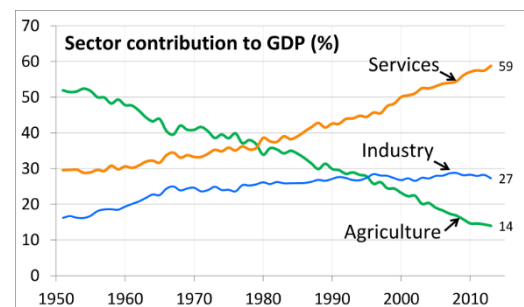
In 1980 the first steps towards liberalization were taken up by **Indira Gandhi** and followed by **Rajiv Gandhi**, that involved:

- Easing restrictions on capacity expansion for incumbent businesses
- Removed price control
- Reduced corporate taxes

End of License Raj – New LPG reforms

Post Liberalisation :

- LPG era – decline of License Raj
- Encouraged adoption New technology
- More foreign investment
- Service industry started booming → IT and Telecom Industry



Thus, after liberalisation:

- Emergence of a market economy with a fast-growing private sector.
- Planning became indicative rather than prescriptive in nature.

Macroeconomic crisis and Govt's Policy

The economic liberalisation of 1991, initiated by then Indian prime minister **P. V. Narasimha Rao** and his finance minister **Dr. Manmohan Singh** in response to a macroeconomic crisis (**Balance of Payment**) did away with

- **License Raj (investment, industrial and import licensing)**
- **Ended public sector monopoly in many sectors**, thereby allowing automatic approval of foreign direct investment in many sectors.

Successive Liberalization policy

- Since then, the overall direction of liberalisation has remained the same, irrespective of the ruling party at the centre, **although no party has yet tried to take on powerful lobbies like the trade unions and farmers.**
- Even contentious issues like **labour reforms** and cutting down **agricultural subsidies** have **failed to yield results.**

Working Class (Structure, Growth, and class mobilization)

Working Class Explained

Definition:

- Marxian terminology : "those who sell their labour" in class based societies → proletariat
- WC is a complex , contradictory and constantly changing entity, i.e. the composition , the size , and the character of a WC changes over a period of time.

Mark Holmstrom:

- 'People commonly refer to industrial workers and sometimes other kind of wage earners and self employed workers as WC'.
- It suggests a common interest and shared consciousness of these interests.

Two Counter Views –

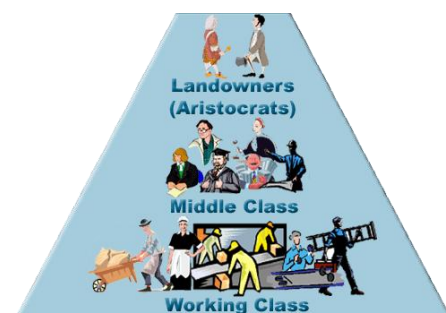
2 Counter View on working class:

- Working Class (WC) is expanding as students, teachers, blue collar, white collar, salaried all comprise WC
- WC is disappearing with the automation of industry and apparent displacement of blue collar jobs.

WC During Pre Independence Time

Characteristics :

- Geographically localized – Major Industrial centers
- Highly exploited- Low wages | Tough Working condition
- Mostly unskilled without any formal education
- At the bottom of the pyramid



Working Class – Indian Scenario

- India has a multi-structural economy where a number of pre-capitalist relations of production co-exist with capitalist relations of production. (Jajmani → Labour-wage)
- Here, differentiated working class structure exists i.e. the numerous types of relations of production, consumption and accumulation of surplus combine to produce a variety of forms of the working class.
- So the composition of the working class is affected by the caste, tribe, ethnic origin and the gender based division of labour between male and female and associated patriarchy.

Nature And Structure Of WC Today

Types of Working class : On the basis of Wages

First:

- Those workers who are permanent employees of the large factory setting and get family wage.
- By 'family wage' it is meant that the wage of the worker should be sufficient to maintain not only the individual but also the worker's family.
- They are mostly employed in the public sector enterprises and modern sectors of petrochemicals, pharmaceuticals, Banking and engineering.

Second:

- There is a large and preponderant section of the working class that does not get a family wage, but survive on 'minimum living wage'.



- This includes workers in the older industries like Cotton and Jute Textiles, Sugar, Paper and Tea plantation worker
- Fair wage is more than minimum wages. Fair wage is determined after considering several factors such as the wages paid for similar work in other trades and industries.

Third:

- Minimum Wages is referred as wage for the bare necessities of a worker, It presumed to provide for the maintenance of efficiency of the worker, Employer is bound to pay minimum wage to the worker.
- Minimum wages for variety of trade and occupation is fixed by various labour laws of the country.
- It comprises low-skilled worker, daily wage labourers and temporary workers.
- Not only is there a wage differential among the working class, there is also variation **in the terms of working conditions**.
- **Better paid labours have also much greater job security**. However the workers on the lower end of the wage scale not only lack job security but also suffer considerable extra economic coercion and personal bondage which leads to lack of civil liberties.
- Similarly, working conditions for the low paid workers are uniformly worse than that of high paid workers.
- The situation worsens further with regard to women workers.
 - For example, **women are not allowed to work in the steel plants for safety reasons, but are not prohibited to be employed on the same site as contract labour.**

Growth of Working Class

- **Formative Period**(1850 - 1880) : modern industry got established, rural poor migrated to urban areas for work.
- **Philanthropic phase** (1890s - 1915s) : heavy industries, expansion of WC, deterioration of agriculture, **Shashipada Banerjee** in Bengal started welfare activities in 1870s , a monthly magazine '**Bharat Shramjivi**' started in 1874. **L.M.Lokhande** was active in Bombay and published '**Deenbandhu**'.
- **Consolidation phase** (1915s - 1947): formation of Trade Unions, and ILU in 1919 , AITUC in 1920. At the time of independence,
 - 4 main trade unions : AITUC , INTUC , HMS , UTUC.

Working class Movement - Trade Unionism

Definition :

- By working class movement we mean the organized efforts of wage-earners directed towards the advancement of their economic interests.
- An allied long-term objective of the movement is to secure social and political leverage for the working class people.

The urban labour movement is closely related to the trade union movement

Growth of Working class Movement

Colonial Period:

- Unlike west, Workers were mostly rural poor who were forced out of their homes by the severity of famines.
- Thus in the early years the workers did not grow into an industrial proletariat.

Post WWII:

- India emerged as a major industrial power in the world. This had the effect of creating a sizeable industrial proletariat in the major cities of the country.
- In the beginning the movement was confined mostly to textile industry, as this was the first major industry set-up in the organized sector

After Independence:

- Now, the working class movement has spread to several industries.
- This reflects the industrial growth process with all its diversities.
- With the growth of trade unions, organized labour movements have moved to plantations, mines, transport as well as to service sector.

Weakness of Working class movement

Significant constraints which erode the strength of the organized movement

- **Fragmentation of Interest** – Cultural | Caste | Political
- Beside fragmentation, there is the problem of **easily available substitute labour, because of unemployment.**
- **Politicisation of Trade Unions**
- **Multiplicity of Trade Unions & Negligence for Marginalised Sections**, particularly peasants
 - Eg: Trade Unions associated with Political Parties does not share common interest with others.
- There are also examples of trade union leaders **appealing to caste and kinship sentiments** for mobilising opinions among workers (**Ramaswamy 1976, Ghosh 1988**).
- While **V.V. Giri (1958)** and **H. Crouch (1966)** argue that trade unions have **not made themselves free from the parochial loyalties.**
- **N.R. Sheth (1968)** has found that bulk of the workers refrain from union activity mainly because of their primordial ties with the employees.

ON THE WANE

The fall in the number of strikes and lockouts has been steep since 2012. In 2012, 447 such incidents were reported compared with 143 in 2014.

Year	Strikes and lockouts	Workers involved	Person-days lost (in thousands)
2007	389	724,574	27,167
2008	421	1,579,298	17,433
2009	345	1,867,204	17,622
2010	371	1,074,473	23,131
2011	370	734,763	14,458
2012	447	1,307,505	12,876
2013	198	1,057,887	3,665
2014	143	1,008,275	3,636
2015*	40	NA	446

(* January-April)

Source: Labour ministry

Working Class Mobilization

In pre-LPG era:

- Major role of welfare state
- Trade unions were dominant and considered powerful
- NGOs were few and were at nascent stage

In post-LPG era:

- Recognition of problems in unorganised sector
- Adoption of Social security measures by various labour laws
- Microfinance initiatives through credit societies
- Rise of NGOs and Civil Societies

Social Background Of Indian Working Class - Studies

- Indian working class came from diverse social backgrounds in which primordial identities such as caste, ethnicity, religion and language played very important roles. In recent years, the significance of these elements has been reduced but they do persist nonetheless.
- In this regard, the Ahmedabad study (1973), points out that where jobs are secured through introduction by other workers, the latter was a blood relation in 35 per cent of the cases, belonged to the same caste in another 44 percent and belonged to the same native place in another 12 per cent.

Social Background of Indian Working Class

Role of kinship and Caste

- Friends helped in 7 per cent of the cases. Several other studies have pointed out the **role of kinship ties in getting employment (Gore 1970)**.
- Kinship ties not only play a significant role in securing employment, but also in the placement in the wage scale.

Higher Income jobs - Dominated by Upper Castes

- Five studies of Pune, Kota, Bombay, Ahmedabad and Bangalore covering large number of industries found that **61 per cent of workers were upper caste Hindus (Sharma 1970)**.
- The dominant position of the workers from upper caste was also brought out in a study of Kerala.
- This study points out that in higher income jobs upper castes dominates whereas Dalits/Adivasis have preponderance in low wage jobs.

Low Paid Jobs - Dalit and Adivasis

- The **middle castes are concentrated in middle to bottom ranges**.
- Even in public sector, the representation of backward castes, schedule castes and tribes is not up to their proportion in the population.
- It seems that caste based division of labour is followed in the class III and IV jobs in government and public sector enterprises.
- So the **jobs of sweepers are reserved** for dalits and adivasis.
- In coal mines, hard physical labour of loading and pushing the coaltubs is done by mostly dalits and advasis.
- In steel plants the production work in the intense heat of coke oven and blast furnace is mainly done by advasis and dalits.
- This is because, as **Deshpande (1979) points out, of 'pre-labour market characteristic'** such as education and land holding.

- So those who possess more land and education ended up in a higher wage sector.
- **Caste serves the function of ensuring the supply of cheap labour for different jobs** with the fact of not paying more than what is necessary.
- In other words, the depressed conditions of adivasis and dalits helps in ensuring a supply of labour, who can be made to work at the mere subsistence level (**Nathan 1987**).
- Hence, caste on one hand plays a role in keeping the lower sections of the society in the lower strata of the working class, on the other hand, **the upper caste get a privilege in the labour market**.
- Further, caste is not only a determinant of marriage and to an extent residence, but more so a continuing pool of social relation for the supply of various kinds of labour for the capitalist mode of production.

Informal Sector

J. Keith Hart (Anthropologist) while working in Accra, Ghana coined the term 'Informal sector'

The 2002 International Labour Code Resolution, describe as 'all activities that are, in law or practice, not covered or insufficiently covered by formal arrangements'.

- That it refers to working people who are largely excluded from the exchanges that take place in the recognised legal contract system.
- They are often not captured by national accounts and official statistics and as a consequence invisible in policy formulation.

Informal Sector - Characteristic

Characteristic of Informal sector workers:

1. Low skill
2. Low wages
3. Migratory
4. No social security
5. Low entry barriers

Informal sector in a way,

1. Guardian to Poor
2. Provides employment
3. Provides uniform lifestyle

Naila Kabeer→ Informal sector not peculiar to developing countries. E.g.: Vendors are seen in New York, London are part of informal sector.

Indian Informal Sector

1. Agriculture (Maximum)
2. Self Employed (vendors, small shops)
3. Contract Laborers
4. Household Laborers (mostly women)

5. Child labor (UNICEF -> 5 Crore in India)

[If No DOL -> Informal.

If beyond government's regulation. -> Unorganised]

Globalization & Informal Sector

Sarath Dawala Report

In India -> 1991 -> 91% is Informal Sector

- 2005 -> 94%
- 2014 -> 96%

Reasons why globalization is increasing Informal Sector are

1. Increase in contract labour.
2. Downsizing in Organised Industries (Railways, PSUs) **Bhowmik & SEWA** -> These People found jobs in Informal Sector.
3. Lifestyle & Inflation made women work and most of them are concentrated in Informal Sector
4. Increase in MSMEs.

Positives of globalisation:

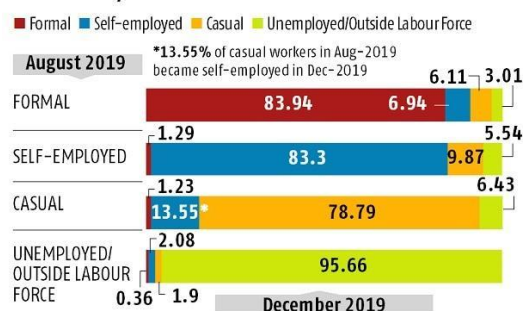
Ela Bhatt (SEWA):

- Sees positive of Globalisation -> women getting jobs, becoming decision makers, will attack Patriarchy, women given education now.
- Therefore, **Feminization of Labour** happening.

Also to highlight:

- Street vendor's rights are now debated and being legislated.
- **Insurance (Pension + APY) facilities**
- **Health facilities for unorganized (Swasth Bima Yojana)**

3: INFORMALITY ROSE SLIGHTLY BEFORE THE PANDEMIC; TRANSITION TO SELF-EMPLOYED BEGAN



Child Labour

Definition

- The term "**child labour**" is often defined as work that deprives children of their childhood, their potential and their dignity, and that is harmful to physical and mental development.
- In India, a person below 14 years, working for most part of the day.
- UN -> Below 18 years

General Definition - One who ought to be in education system but working

Causes

- Poverty
- Under-employment of parents
- Inadequate vocational education

- Education -> Infrastructure + Material missing
- Illiterate & ignorant parents
- Large families
- Unhappy homes – Dysfunctional families
- Families lacking social security
- **Preference for child labour** -> Nimble fingers -> carpet, Bidi factories prefer child labour because of intricate work
- Orphan Protection Failure
- Failure of education system to provide education - **Loss of trust on education system.**
- **Corruption** : Grants, scholarships not reaching to beneficiaries, instead ghost beneficiaries benefits from corruption and culprits are not brought to books.

Constitutional Provisions

Child Labour prohibited under Constitution of India.

- Article 24
- Article 39 (e) and (f)

CL & Globalisation

Negative impact of Globalisation:

1. Competitiveness, Profit orientation of industry
2. Increased avenues to employ child labour
3. Urbanization -> Migration.
4. Sustenance become difficult leading to employment of Child Labour

Negative impact of Globalisation:

1. Increased demand of Domestic child labour in households owing to Increased incomes of the middle class because of Globalisation.
2. Sweatshops closing in B'desh Nepal, forcing children to work + Prostitution.
3. New forms of exploitation -> child Pornography + Trafficking

Positive impact of Globalisation:

1. Increased awareness -> leads to prompt reporting
2. Global conventions -> Increased role of govt.
3. Global Movements against Products made by children
4. Global NGOs are coming to rescue child labour
5. Increased limelight because of Noble Prize winner (**Kailash Satyarthi**)

Legal Provisions

Prohibition and Regulation:

- Child Labour Prohibition and Regulation Act 1986 -> 2014 bill = 18 years Amdt.
- In 2016
 - Juvenile Justice Act, 2000
 - The Factories Act, 1948
 - Ban on Child Labour from 2006

Institutional Provisions

- National Authority for elimination of child Labour
- Special cell in ministry of labour.
- Special committees at state level.
- Ministry of women and child development for overall supervision.

Programmes & Policies

- Help from NGOs (Bachpan Bachao Andolan – Kailash Satyarthi)
- National policy for child labour
- International programme on the Elimination of Child Labour
- Special Schools (Evening schools)
- **Right to Education**
- Rehabilitation of Children Working in Hazardous Occupations programme

Initiatives by NGOs and civil society

- **Bachpan Bachao Andolan**
- IPEC - International programme on the Elimination of Child Labour
- UNICEF
- CREDA - Centre for Rural Education and Development Association.

Integrative Approach

Way forward – Integrative Approach

- Employment to Parents
- Banning CL is not enough, Parents also to be held responsible and prosecuted under law.
- Civil society - To not employ child domestic labour & report it wherever they come across any child labour
- Media can highlight: TV Serials like Udaan.

Growth of Urban Settlements in India

Urban Settlement - Definition

What is **Urban**: The term is used in two sense:

- Demographically, the **focus is on the size and density of population** and nature of work of the majority of the adult males.
- Sociologically, the focus is on **heterogeneity, impersonality, interdependence and the quality of life**.

Defining The City

- The city is not merely the point at which great numbers are concentrated into limited space, but it is also a **complex heterogeneity** in almost every characteristic in which human beings can differ from one another.
- In this respect the city represents perhaps the most **striking contrast to the social entities that we call primitive, folk, and peasant societies**.
- Consequently, the methods adapted to the understanding of the **population of the metropolis are strikingly different from those suited to simpler and more homogeneous societies**.
- This accounts for the fact that **in attempting to understand the city we have had to resort to extensive statistical inquiries** to determine the human elements which it is composed of.
- They differ, as do in all societies, in sex and age, but they show **peculiar distribution of age and sex groups and great variations in these respects** as we pass from area to area.
- They differ widely from one another in occupation, in view of the **more extensive division of Labour**, which the growth of the market has made possible.
- They **differ in wealth and in income**, ranging from the extreme of affluent to the depths of the direst poverty and insecurity.
- The city, moreover, by virtue of its focal position in the **complex of capitalistic civilization**, has attracted within its confines the racial and ethnic stocks of all the world.
- It has more or less amalgamated them and blended their traits into a new aggregate of hybrids, here mingling with one another and there segregating themselves from one another, here collaborating and there at war, **but in any case building a complex of cultures unprecedented in human history**.
- This **heterogeneity** of the human materials in the city is at once **a source of ferment** and stimulation and of the frictions and conflicts that characterize modern society" (Louis Wirth 1940).

Urban Settlement - Sociological View

Tonnies: differentiated between

- **Gemeinschaft (rural)** → Close personal ties of kinship
- **Gesellschaft (urban)** → Impersonal and secondary ties, formal and contractual interpersonal relationship.

Other sociologists like **Max Weber** and **George Simmel** have stressed on **dense living conditions, rapidity of change** and **impersonal interaction** in urban settings

Early Evidence of Urban Settlements In India

- Evidence of Urban Settlement in India
 - **Prehistoric** – Mohenjo-Daro, Harappa
 - **Historic** – Pataliputra, Vaishali , Kannauj etc.
 - **Medieval:**
 - **Political and military towns** – which were agricultural surplus
 - **Trading and manufacturing towns** – termed as ‘nagar’
 - **Education and Temple towns** – Nalanda, Dwarka, Takshila, Puri, Varanasi (Kashi) etc.

Growth of Urban Settlements In India

Characteristics:

1. Political, Demographic & Spatial characteristics- New Delhi, Shimla (Hill Station)
2. Economic – Mumbai, Calcutta
3. Religious and socio-cultural centers: Agra, Varanasi, Lucknow, Amritsar, etc.

Urban Settlement – Pre & Post Independence

- **Colonial Settlement** – Seaports-cum-trading centres were developed → Surat, Bombay, Madras.
- **Post-independence Urban settlement** –
 - Mixed character
 - Centres of trade and commerce
 - Core areas of old inhabitants (M.N. Srinivas)
 - Fringe of large cities→ New immigrants’ settlement
 - E.g. Mumbai, New Delhi etc.

Post-Independence Urban Settlement

Post-independence Urban settlement :

- Administrative towns – Chandigarh, Srinagar , Bhopal
- Industrial – Mumbai , Bhilai
- Commercial – Kolkata
- Mining towns – Raniganj , Jharia
- Garrison Cantonment towns – Ambala , Jalandhar
- Educational Towns – Roorkee , Aligarh
- Tourist Towns – Nainital , Mussoorie

Crisis of Urbanisation

Urban Crisis

Almost all contemporary social problems have been associated with the process of urbanisation.

Thus, a diverse set of problems such as those relating to –

- Crime
- Mental illness
- Broken family life
- Poor housing
- Poverty

Thus, a diverse set of problems such as those relating to –

- Unemployment
- Class conflict
- Racial and ethnic conflict
- Drug addiction
- Pollution
- The city and the metropolis are the settings in which **many social problems have developed or intensified**, and to understand these problems in their urban context is important.
- **India** is being increasingly judged by the stature and condition of its great cities, where lie the core of its commercial and industrial power and the strength of its transportation, distribution and communication system.

The cities of India have played an **important role** in: -

- **Breaking away from tradition-bound social practices**
- It is from these cities that most of the modernization processes in the country radiates
- **Political and social reform movements** have largely **originated in the cities** and then spread out to rest of the country.

Concludingly

Impact of Urbanisation on Environmental Quality

- **Physical Environment**
 - Air Quality
 - Water Quality
 - Solid Waste Generation
 - Noise Levels
- **Social Environment:**
 - Urbanisation and Slums
 - Crime in Cities
- **Environmental Infrastructure**

- Housing and Housing Amenities and Infrastructure
- Energy
- Transport

Urban Poverty

- Urban Poverty makes poverty more **visible**.
- Particularly in the industrial towns and cities where large numbers of poor labour were to be found, in and out of ill-paid and insecure employment.
- **Poverty and overcrowding** are the two most visible features of the **industrial slum**.
- **Segregation and exclusion** were governed by caste in India just as they were governed by race elsewhere, but poverty has a large part to play in these operations.

Social disability and economic disadvantage went hand in hand in the past as they still do to a great extent.

Income and expenditure were important, but others factors such as:

- Security of livelihood
- Disconnection from family and community
- Overcrowding
- Sanitation and health were also important.
- Sociological accounts of poverty tend to lack precision but they aim at a rounded picture.
- Individuals and families may suffer from a **chronic sense of loss and deprivation** even where there is an **increase in their average earning** and expenditure. It is often accompanied by **social and cultural dislocation**.
- Poverty studies would remain incomplete unless they took some account of this sense of loss and deprivation.
- The **new settlements** that emerge often have a **makeshift character**, and there is laxity in the rules for the regulation of conduct.
- Often, women and children become victims of new forms of social abuse.

Slums and Deprivation in Urban Areas

Slums and Deprivation in Urban Areas

Louis Wirth:

- Slums is a way of life which is predominantly unhygienic.

Oscar Louis:

- Culture of poverty leads to people not striving to change their lives and continue living in poor conditions.

Definition

- The new definition of slum states that- even a small cluster of 20-25 households living in a contiguous area and exhibiting slum like characteristics such as:
 - *“little or no access to basic civic amenities like water, sanitation and sewerage” should be categorised as slums.*

- Earlier the cluster size for identification of slums was 60 households.

GOI defines slums as any area which is:

- Dilapidated
- Overcrowded
- Faulty arrangement of buildings
- Lack of ventilation, Light, Sanitation facilities,
- Or combination of these factors which are detrimental to safety, health and Morales.

Sociologically

- Slums are a sub-standard, haphazard, housing system
- Slum is a relative term.
- Slums are a way of life, with:
 - Low Sanitation
 - High Crime Rate
 - Apathy
 - Social Isolation
 - Anonymity

Trilok Singh:

- Slums put pressure on urban infrastructure.
- Slums also have an inherent sense of relative and absolute deprivation with respect to the prosperous neighbours.

Slums

- A concomitant of urbanization in India has been in the continuous growth of slum population, as most internal migration has been concentrated in the **slums**.
- Although **India is a large heterogeneous country** whose diversity often makes generalization difficult.

Slums Conditions

Slum conditions can still be characterized in general terms:

- The streets, lanes and open drains in typical slum areas are filthy.
- The Indian slum, are far more complex than the mere aggregate of these appalling physical condition; it is a way of life.
- Rates of diseases, chronic illness and infant mortality remain high and there is still a little knowledge of health and sanitation, nutrition or childcare.
- Illiteracy is exceedingly high

Slum conditions can still be characterized in general terms:

- **Cultural and recreation activities are almost entirely lacking** except those provided by such commercial enterprises as the **cinema and gambling**.
- Most slum dwellers are **apathetic** and suffer a **great sense of futility**.

Slum conditions can still be characterized in general terms:

- They have **little community pride** or even consensus, and they often **blame the local authorities** for their plight.
- They have become antagonistic towards authorities, seldom co-operating with municipal personnel in efforts to improve their immediate areas or the city as a whole.

Causes Of Slum Formation

- Original Slums as a result of land squatting by migrants
- Slums was created because the erstwhile Middle Class moved away to better location.
- Slum are formed because of Occupational necessity (slums are created around sources of employment, which is usually of low remunerations)
- **TB Ramachandran:** Indian cities are unplanned
- **MSA Rao:** Mohalla Culture
- **Demographic dynamism:** Expansionist modernity and declining agriculture.

Functions Of Slums

- Cheap Labour Supply
- Small industries
- Housing for low income migrants
- School to newcomers of urban life
- Place for anonymity

Deprivation

- **Economic:** Poor housing , Regular power cuts , weak transport , unsafe water and sanitation system.
- **Environment:** Pollution
- **Social:** exclusion, poverty, poor state of education, health, increase incidence of alcoholism and riots.

Way Out

There are **four main objectives** of urban community development programme applicable to the slums are-

- I. Development of **community feeling**.
- II. **Self-help** improvement of a person or a group by its own contributions and efforts and largely for its own benefits.
- III. **Indigenous leadership**
- IV. **Cooperation between govt. and the people** who are using the services.

The approach to the problems of the city slums **through urban community development** involves the following elements:-

1. Creation of a sense of **social cohesion** on a neighbourhood basis and strengthening of group interrelationship.
2. Encouragement and **stimulation of self-help**, through the initiative of the individuals in the community.
3. **Stimulation by outside** agencies where initiative for self-help is lacking.
4. **Reliance upon persuasion rather than upon compulsion** to produce change through the efforts and participation of people.
5. Identification and development of local leadership.
6. Development of civic consciousness and acceptance of civic responsibilities.
7. Use of **professional and technical assistance** to support the efforts of the people involved.
8. **Coordination of city services** to meet neighborhood needs and problems.
9. Provisions of **training in a democratic process** that may results in decentralization of some govt. functions.

Broader Approaches To Eradicate Slum

1. **Marxist:** Slum is a conscious creation of political and economic dominant class. Need to give entire population similar homes.
2. **Welfarist:** Tear down slums -> Remake them (Rajiv Awas Yojana)

Geeta Diwan Verma refutes this approach because the remade houses are sub-let by the people and also paves way for corruption.

Louis Wirth says - Need is of changing Culture

3. **Community Development Approach:** Identify leader, change way of life & occupation.
 - **Kalpana Sharma** found in Dharawi, Mumbai that CDA is successful in long term.
4. **Humanitarian Approach:** Give people assurance of tenure, they'll develop good practices.
5. **Modernisation Approach:** Slums are temporary. With modernity slum dwellers will become landowners.

Supreme Court says: Approach shall be **slum dweller oriented and not slum oriented**.

Govt. measures:

- Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana
- Smart Cities
- Decentralisation of Urban
- Rural reconstruction (PURA)
- JNNRUM

Constitution And Slums

- Our Constitution has laid down the **right to property**, which is **basic and fundamental**, but not the **right to work or right to adequate housing, education and employment**.

- The **Constitution also proclaims certain freedom and rights to citizens** viz. **right to move** throughout the country, right to life and security and freedom to search for earning and prerequisites needed for that search within legal limits
- But at the same time Constitution **does not ensure the right to have resources** for securing livelihood, source of earning, of adequate facilities for stay and other things essential, also in mobile jobs, for citizens to ensure better purchasing power to live adequately.

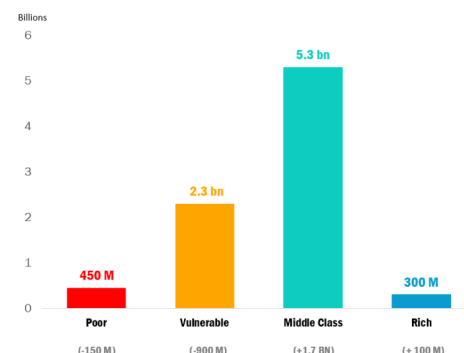
A little Extra

Bourgeois Revolution

Bourgeois Revolution and Social Change

According to Barrington Moore:

- Definition: This revolution is the “broad institutional results to which Bourgeois contribute”
- Or the essential institutional contribution is of development together of Capitalism and parliamentary democracy.
- Barrington Moore says that if there were No Bourgeois there will be No Democracy.
- He emphasizes the important role played by middle-class (neo-Bourgeois) in accomplishing democratization and ensuring democratic stability.



Since the LPG reforms, India is witnessing its **Bourgeois revolution**, as its **new middle class** is leading the social change.

- In general terms, these middle classes is comprised chiefly of families whose incomes are derived from employment in the educated professions, managerial and other high salaried position in the modern industry and commerce, ownership of urban capital and of family farms that are engaged in commercial agriculture.
- These classes are neither closed nor entirely self-perpetuating.

Bourgeois Revolution and Embourgeoisement

- Accompanying bourgeois revolution in India, and congruent with it, is substantial and accelerating **embourgeoisement** – the **migration of new entrants into the ranks of the middle classes**.
- **Without replacing the caste** as India’s customary social system, **class has increasingly impinged its secular value**, and trying to shadow sacred value and caste dynamics.

Bourgeois Revolution and Social Change

- As per Robert W. Stern, Bourgeois revolution is the dominant pattern of change in Indian Society only in the sense that it describe the general direction of its political and economic development, and concomitant change.
- He further explains that the culmination of Bourgeois revolution will be a momentous event in world history, no less than transformation of China into modern industrial state.

Urban Agglomerations and Cities- Data and Definition

Census of India 2011

Provisional Population

Totals Urban Agglomerations and Cities

Data Highlights

- This data release covers the total population, population (0 to 6 years) and number of literates for each UA/City with a population of 1 Lakh and above as per the provisional population totals of Census 2011.

Definitions

- **Towns**

For the Census of India 2011, the definition of urban area is as follows;

1. All places with a municipality, corporation, cantonment board or notified town area committee, etc.
2. All other places which satisfied the following criteria:
 - i. A minimum population of 5,000;
 - ii. At least 75 per cent of the male main working population engaged in non-agricultural pursuits; and
 - iii. A density of population of at least 400 persons per sq. km.

The first category of urban units is known as Statutory Towns. These towns are notified under law by the concerned State/UT Government and have local bodies like municipal corporations, municipalities, municipal committees, etc., irrespective of their demographic characteristics as reckoned on 31st December 2009. Examples: Vadodara (M Corp.), Shimla (M Corp.) etc.

The second category of Towns (as in item 2 above) is known as Census Town. These were identified on the basis of Census 2001 data.

Urban Agglomeration (UA):

- An urban agglomeration is a continuous urban spread constituting a town and its adjoining outgrowths (OGs), or two or more physically contiguous towns together with or without outgrowths of such towns. An Urban Agglomeration must consist of at least a statutory town and its total population (i.e. all the constituents put together) should not be less than 20,000 as per the 2001 Census. In varying local conditions, there were similar other combinations which have been treated as urban agglomerations satisfying the basic condition of contiguity. Examples: Greater Mumbai UA, Delhi UA, etc.

Out Growths (OG):

- An Out Growth (OG) is a viable unit such as a village or a hamlet or an enumeration block made up of such village or hamlet and clearly identifiable in terms of its boundaries and location. Some of the examples are railway colony, university campus, port area, military camps, etc., which have come up near a statutory town outside its statutory limits but within the revenue limits of a village or villages contiguous to the town.
- While determining the outgrowth of a town, it has been ensured that it possesses the urban features in terms of infrastructure and amenities such as pucca roads, electricity, taps, drainage system for disposal of waste water etc. educational institutions, post offices, medical facilities, banks etc. and physically

contiguous with the core town of the UA. Examples: Central Railway Colony (OG), Triveni Nagar (N.E.C.S.W.) (OG), etc. Each such town together with its outgrowth(s) is treated as an integrated urban area and is designated as an 'urban agglomeration'.

In the 2011 Census, 475 places with 981 OGs have been identified as Urban Agglomerations as against 384 UAs with 962 OGs in 2001 Census.

Number of UAs/Towns and Out Growths (OGs):

	Type of Towns/UAs/OGs	Number of towns	
		2011 Census	2001 Census
1	Statutory Towns	4,041	3,799
2	Census Towns	3,894	1,362
3	Urban Agglomerations	475	384
4	Out Growths	981	962

- At the Census 2011 there are 7,935 towns in the country. The number of towns has increased by 2,774 since last Census. Many of these towns are part of UAs and the rest are independent towns. The total number of Urban Agglomerations/Towns, which constitutes the urban frame, is 6166 in the country.

Population of UAs/Towns:

- The total urban population in the country as per Census 2011 is more than 377 million constituting 31.16% of the total population.
- Class I UAs/Towns: The UAs/Towns are grouped on the basis their population in Census. The UAs/Towns which have at least 1,00,000 persons as population are categorised as Class I UA/Town. At the Census 2011, there are 468 such UAs/Towns. The corresponding number in Census 2001 was 394.
- 264.9 million persons, constituting 70% of the total urban population, live in these Class I UAs/Towns. The proportion has increased considerable over the last Census. In the remaining classes of towns the growth has been nominal.
- Million Plus UAs/Towns: Out of 468 UAs/Towns belonging to Class I category, 53 UAs/Towns each has a population of one million or above each. Known as Million Plus UAs/Cities, these are the major urban centres in the country. 160.7 million persons (or 42.6% of the urban population) live in these Million Plus UAs/Cities. 18 new UAs/Towns have been added to this list since the last Census.
- Mega Cities: Among the Million Plus UAs/Cities, there are three very large UAs with more than 10 million persons in the country, known as Mega Cities. These are Greater Mumbai UA (18.4 million), Delhi UA (16.3 million) and Kolkata UA (14.1 million). The largest UA in the country is Greater Mumbai UA followed by Delhi UA. Kolkata UA which held the second rank in Census 2001 has been replaced by Delhi UA. The growth in population in the Mega Cities has slowed down considerably during the last decade.

Greater Mumbai UA, which had witnessed 30.47% growth in population during 1991-2001 has recorded 12.05% during 2001-2011. Similarly Delhi UA (from 52.24% to 26.69% in 2001-2011) and Kolkata UA (from 19.60% to 6.87% in 2001-2011) have also slowed down considerably.

Child Population (0-6 years):

- Population of children in the age group is 158.8 million in Census 2011. In the urban areas there are 41.2 million children in this age group. In comparison to Census 2001, the number of children (0-6) in urban areas has increased (by 10.32%), while in the rural areas it has decreased by 7.04%.

2. Of the 41.2 million children (0-6) in the urban areas in the country, the population in Class I UAs/Cities is 27.9 million, which is about 67.8% of the total Urban child population. In Million Plus UAs/Cities the Child Population (0-6) is 16.6 million constituting about 40 % of the total urban child (0-6) population of the country.
3. Among the 53 Million Plus UAs/Cities 16.6 million are children (0-6), of which 52.7% are boys and 47.3% are girls, showing a preponderance of male children in these large cities.
4. Malappuram UA has the highest proportion of Children (0-6) (13.57%) in the Million Plus category, followed by Ghaziabad (13.09%). Kolkata UA has the lowest proportion at 7.54%.

Sex Ratio

1. Sex ratio, the number of females per thousand males, in urban areas in India is 926 in Census 2011. It has registered an increase of 26 points over the Sex Ratio in 2001 Census.
2. Sex ratio in Class I UAs/Cities (population of 100,000 and above) is 921, which is 5 points lower than the total urban sex ratio in the country.
3. Among the Million Plus UAs/Cities the Sex Ratio stands at 912. The UAs, where population of females exceeds the total male population in this group are Kannur UA (Kerala) at the top with 1168. Surat UA (Gujarat) is at the bottom of the list with Sex Ratio at 754 where males outnumber females.
4. In the two of the three mega cities there is predominance of male population as they have returned low Sex Ratio (e.g., Greater Mumbai UA - 861, Delhi UA - 867). Kolkata UA has returned a better Sex ratio at 928.

Child Sex Ratio (0-6 years):

1. The Child Sex Ratio in the country has declined from 927 to 914 in Census 2011. This decline is more pronounced in rural areas than in urban areas of the country, where the decline is by 4 points from 906 to 902 in Census 2011.
2. The Child Sex Ratio in UAs/Cities with 100,000 persons and above is 899 which is a shade lower than the national average for urban areas.
3. The combined Child Sex Ratio in Million Plus UAs/Cities is 898. Thiruvananthapuram UA (Kerala) has returned the highest Child Sex Ratio (971) in this group. The lowest slot is occupied by Agra UA (780).
4. Child Sex Ratio in the three Mega Cities are 946 (Kolkata UA), 900 (Greater Mumbai UA) and the lowest in 868 (Delhi UA).

Literacy Rate

1. The literacy rates among both males and females have shown improvement in Census 2011 compared to the last Census. The literacy rate in the country as a whole is 74.04%. In the rural and the urban areas the literacy rates are 68.9% and 84.9% respectively.
2. The female literacy rate in rural and urban areas shows wide variation. In the urban areas of the country the female literacy rate is 79.92% in the rural areas it is only 58.75%.
3. In the 468 UAs/Towns the progress in literacy has been quite encouraging. In 89 UAs/Cities the total Literacy Rate has crossed the 90% mark. The corresponding number of UAs/Cities in Census 2001 was only 23 in Census 2011. In another 288 UAs/Cities, the Literacy rate ranges between 80% to 90%,

improving from 197 in Census 2001.

4. The total Literacy Rate in Greater Mumbai UA is 90.78%, the highest among the mega cities. The Literacy Rate in Delhi and Kolkata are 86.43% and 88.33% respectively. The female literacy rate is also the highest in Greater Mumbai UA (87.19) the top three megacities.

Child Labour

Definition

This is how ILO defines child labour: -

- 'Child labour includes **children permanently leading an adult's life.**
- **Working long hours with low wages under conditions which are detrimental** to the physical and mental health, **sometimes separated from family.'**

The problem

According to the ILO:

- The **COVID-19** health pandemic and the resulting economic and labour market shock are having a huge impact on people's lives and livelihoods.
- Unfortunately, **children are often the first to suffer.**
- The **crisis can push millions of vulnerable children into child labour.** Already, there are an estimated 152 million children in child labour, 72 million of which are in hazardous work. These children are now at even greater risk of facing circumstances that are even more difficult and working longer hours.
- The ILO and UNICEF fear **a sudden increase under the combined action of school's closures and the collapse of the world economy** that plunged millions of families, deprived of a livelihood, into poverty.
- According to the pre-pandemic figures published by the ILO, 152 million children between the ages of 5 and 17 - one in ten children worldwide - work, 73 million of whom do hazardous work, making them vulnerable to serious health and safety risks. Almost half of the children concerned come from the African continent and are between 5 and 11 years old.
- **Three-quarters of them work in the informal economy and the agriculture** sector. These children are **at risk of working longer hours or taking even more hazardous jobs** to support their families.
- In addition, **gender inequalities** may increase, with girls particularly vulnerable to exploitation in agriculture and **domestic work.**
- Broadly, we can say that we see COVID-19 impacting child labour in three ways:
 - Increasing the involvement of children in work.
 - Increasing the risk of relapse for those removed from child labour.
 - Increasing working poverty among youth (15-17 years) in decent work.

Stakeholders' role and child labor:

- The stakeholders most directly affected are the **children and their families**.
- Children are working at the **expense of their education and normal mental development**. Education is important not only for the **intellectual development** but also for the **empowerment** and acquisition of **new skills** for adult life.
- The health of children is endangered by work in **hazardous conditions, abuse, exhaustion, malnutrition, or exposure to toxic materials**.
- The psychological harm leads to behavioural problems later on in life.

Need to bring together a variety of stakeholders to achieve **Target 8.7 of the SDGs** (Sustainable Development Goals), to eradicate child labour by 2025 and forced labour by 2030.

Impact of Covid-19

- **Loss of jobs across the world**
 - The worst affected are the more **marginalised** communities without adequate social security nets, like **migrant labourers**.
 - According to the World Bank, in India, 12 million people have a chance of slipping below the poverty line due to pandemic-related job losses.
- **Increase in the number of people under poverty line**
 - **Poverty is correlated to child labour**. Previous research has indicated that one percentage point increase in poverty leads to about 0.7 percent percentage point increase in child labour.
 - Hence, there is an **increase in child labour and decrease in the number of children attending school** during prolonged periods of crisis. It is the financial condition which forces parents to push their children into work, as seen in India.
- **Impact on schemes that kept children in school**
 - One of the ways in which the Indian government provided incentives for children to go to school was by implementing the **midday meal scheme** in government schools since 1995.
 - A survey conducted by Save the Children in June 2020 in 15 states in India, revealed that out of the sample of 7,235 families, **two-fifths of the families did not receive midday meals-related compensation for their children**.
 - The **failure of some of the states to adequately distribute meals has driven many children to be work as rag pickers** during the lockdown to earn money to eat food.
- **Post-pandemic problems**
 - When schools eventually resume, many **people may not have enough money to send their children back to school**. As a result of this, and the loss of jobs of their parents, **children may have to continue working** for the family's survival.
 - The NGO Child Rights and You (CRY) has pointed out that many **children may even prefer to work and earn money to support their families through this crisis rather than go to school**.
- **The Consequences of migration**
 - With the **return of migrant labourers to their rural communities**, household poverty as a result of **lack of income and remittances will also contribute** to a rise in child labour.
 - The **exodus of the migrants has also led to a huge shortage of labour** in the cities.

- The fundamental drivers of the economy including agricultural, automobile and construction sectors, and warehouses, which rely predominantly on migrants labourers, are the worst affected.
- Additionally, the **FMCG sector and e-commerce businesses are also struggling to produce and deliver goods** due to the shortage of labour.
- **Changes made in some of the labour laws**
 - States like Haryana, Gujarat, and Rajasthan, to name a few, have **diluted their labour laws** since the beginning of the pandemic.
 - These include increased **work hours**, **reducing social protection** clauses that relate to the **safety** of employees, and **doing away with certain inspection** apparatuses.
 - Since **child labour is cheap and “cost-effective”** – many employers may exploit these changes to hire children as they have **lower bargaining power** and are mostly unable to press for their rights.

Solutions

Obviously, no single organization cannot solve a challenge of this complexity and scale alone.

Resolving it **requires long-term collaboration between different actors.**

- **Efforts to keep children at school**
 - The **public educational system should be expanded** to accommodate labourer children who still do not have access to school.
 - **More schools** should be built, **more teachers should be trained**, and more educational materials should be available.
 - A special attention should be given to **children living in exceptional geographical conditions and mobility** should be provided at the cost of the community.
 - Children who **dropped** out of school should receive adequate guidance and support, and a smooth re-entry should be facilitated.
 - The **development of schools in the rural areas** would decrease the load of children in urban schools. This will allow parents to accommodate children's needs without having to migrate in big cities.
- **There is a need to address poverty and access to education**
 - Governments also need to provide access to free and quality education for children and access to decent healthcare for everyone.
 - Supporting vulnerable families through social protections and income support is also essential.
- **International Policies**
 - To date, there is **no international agreement to define child labour**. Every country has different laws and regulations
 - regarding the minimum age for starting working based on the type of labour. **The lack of international consensus** on child labour makes the limits of child labour very unclear.
 - Therefore, it is **mandatory to create international policies that adopt a holistic approach** to free quality education for all children, including labour children from poor families.
 - Governments need to ensure that **child labour laws are in line with international labour conventions** and that such laws are enforced through regular inspections.
- **Education should be continued beyond the primary school level** and should be done in a formal setting. Studies show that **nonformal education is a necessary but not a sufficient prerequisite** for permanently withdrawing children from work.

- **Examples:** Many states like **Kerala and West Bengal** opted to **distribute raw materials and dry rations through the Anganwadi workers.**
- **Civil society organisations** like CARE, Save the Children, Oxfam India have come together to request the government to relook at the new legislation made by the government regarding these changes.

CONCLUSION

- Remarkable strides have been made in the last 20 years to decrease the number of children involved in child labour worldwide—and the UN Sustainable Development Goal 8.7, which aspires to eradicate all forms of child labour by 2025, has created a new momentum for this pressing challenge.
- Still, we are no way near to eradicating this menace from the face of the earth.
- **Statistics show that child labour in India is likely to increase post-pandemic.**
- In a conference with the labour ministry, the **director of ILO stressed that India has to provide basic social security that guarantees children's protection.**
- **Labour Minister** agreed that **there is a possibility of more children engaging in child labour due to the loss of jobs** during the pandemic.
- **Poverty, which is the root cause** of child labour, despite being a priority for a succession of Indian governments, is yet to be eradicated.
- **States and districts that employ high child labour must especially be monitored** in the post-pandemic era.
- **The implementation of various social security schemes** will have to be stepped up and **corruption in their rollout dealt with firmly** to ensure income/rations for households so that children will not be forced to work.
- Above all, it is **essential to remember that child labour leads to illiteracy and reinforces poverty and should be treated as a basic human rights issue.**
- It is the proper enforcement of child labour policies and the focus on education can **break the cycle of poverty** that drives the children into labour.

C 4

Politics and Society

Sub-topics:

- Nation, democracy and citizenship.
- Political parties, pressure groups, social and political elite.
 - Contemporary Political System, India's electoral System
 - Beyond India's 3rd party system
 - Caste and Social Composition
 - Charismatic Leadership
- Regionalism and decentralization of power.
 - Regionalism
 - Communalism
 - Religious Fundamentalism
- Secularization

Nation, Democracy and Citizenship

Indian Context

Nation – Definition

- A nation is an imagined political community which has organized itself either independent or desiring to be independent. [E.g.- India before Independence]
- It comprises a group of people who feel their uniqueness and oneness which they are keen to maintain. [British Nationality]
- There is no universal and exact definition of a nation.
- Peoples with common ethnic roots, language, religion, historical memory and therefore the explicit desire to act as a political community actually form a nation.

Idea of India as a Nation – Colonial View

India traces its origins to **an ancient civilization**, it remains **a political entity** that has been **united and fragmented over and over** under diverse rules, until the advent of colonial rule.

The beginnings of India as a nation, that we see today, started during British rule.

British rule helped the growth of nationalism in two ways:

1. India became **one political and economic entity** for the first time. It gradually came under one system of law and one type of administration.
2. It led to the emergence of **a united nationalist movement**.

Benjamin Disraeli

- Argued, **India was not a nation**: it lacked a **common language**, a common **religion**, a shared **tradition**, a historical experience, a cohesive majority, and a **defined territory**, all of which he regarded as the essential ingredients of a nation.

Winston Churchill

- India, 'is merely a geographical expression. It is *no more a single country than the Equator*.'

Understanding the Idea of India – Counter View

Rejecting, the idea of nation-state, and argue it is simply several nations within a state is also inaccurate.

- From the **Rigveda**, the from the notion of *Bharatvarsha* we learn of the land of *Aryavrata* stretching from the Himalayas and Vindhyas all the way to the eastern and western oceans.
- Among the earliest political consolidations, was under the **Mauryan king Ashoka** from the 6th century BC to the 3rd century BC, when most of India was under his rule.
- The great **Bhakti movement** which started in the 6th and 7th centuries AD had its roots in the south in the Tamil and Kannada languages, exhibited enormous cultural and religious unity across India.

J. L. Nehru:

- India is a **country held together**, 'by **strong but invisible threads**...a myth and an idea, a dream and a vision, and yet very real and present and pervasive.'

Ravinder Kumar (director of the Nehru Memorial Museum and library)

- Defined **India** as a **Civilisation-State**, rather than a nation-state, because of its **capacity to amalgamate into one coherent whole** a large number of cultural influences.

Understanding the Idea of India

- The **immense plurality** of India on caste, religious, ethnic, linguistic and cultural grounds **defies the traditional wisdom of a nation-state**.
- There **certainly exists a feeling of belonging** to an entity with which these communities are organically linked to, beyond just belonging to the post-colonial state.
- The sense of Indian identity emanates not from the 19th century when India began to imagine itself as a nation-state in response to the challenge by the colonialism, but from the civilisational continuity and heritage of past several millennia.

Emergence of Modern India as a Nation

- The **nationalist movement** created a **national feeling**.
- One part of nationalism was the **urge for freedom**.
- The other was that the people of **different areas**, people subscribing to **different religions**, ethnicity and speaking **different languages**, belonged to the **same nation**.
- Thus, India with its vast diversity happens to be united under a **common identity**, inculcating a sense of brotherhood and belongingness to a great nation.
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Ambedkar's View on India as a Nation

For Ambedkar, the idea of India as a Nation, involves a deep emotional tie:

- *"A longing not to belong to any other group"*
- What would be the conditions for such a sentiment?
 - A shared race, culture and language may provide the basis for a patriotism that was particularly Indian.
- For nation to exist there needed to be more than a common race, language or culture.
- *There needed to be a "spiritual essence," a tie of kinship.*
- *Above all, it required "the will to live as a nation"*

In a Nutshell

In general – India qualifies to be called a nation because it has a **clearly defined Indian territory** ruled and administered by a sovereign. India has its own:

- Flag
- National Anthem
- Constitution
- Codified legal norms and rights for its citizens.

But it has its **own exceptions to being called a nation** because post-independence there is increasingly **a lack of clear consensus on the historical sense of belonging, cultural identity or ethnic roots**.

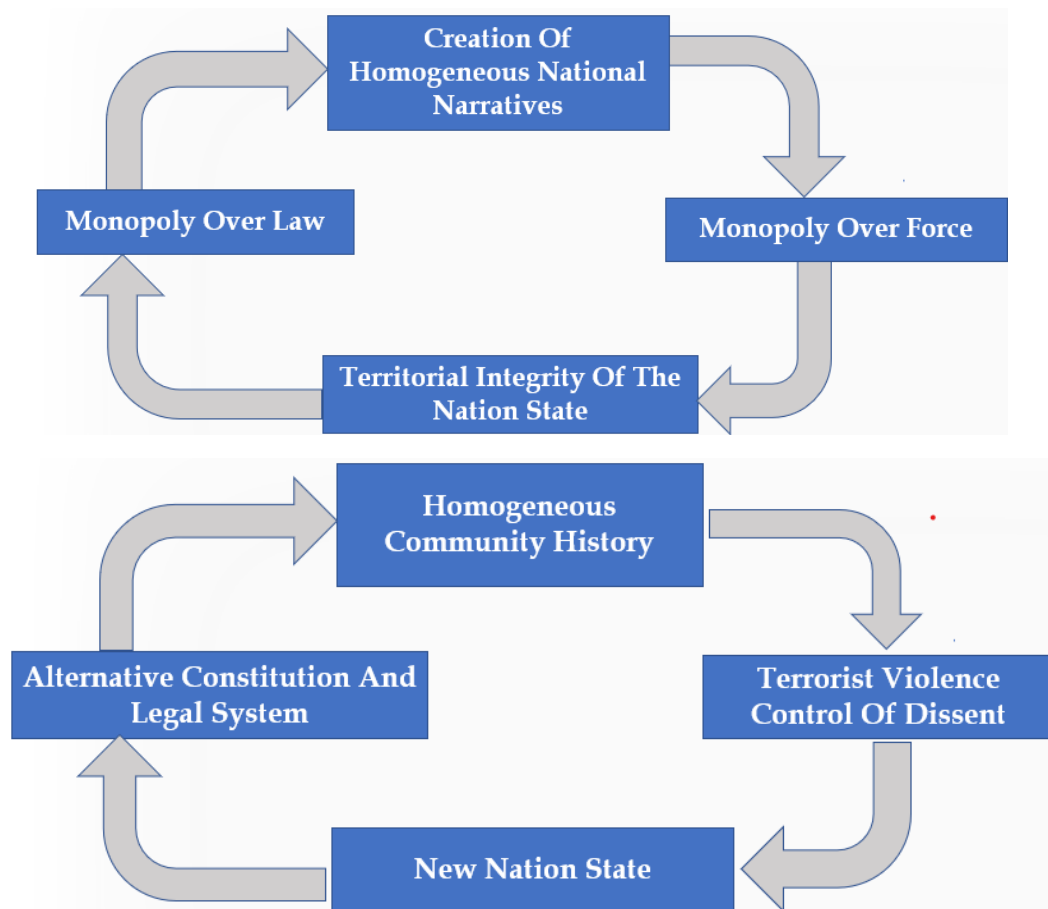
- There is today not a single nation in the world whose people belong to the same cultural and ethnic roots.
- Every nation has people of mixed racial and ethnic background.

According to **Ramsay Muir**:

- A nation may be defined as a body of people who feel themselves to be naturally linked together by certain affinities, which are so strong for them to live together, they are **dissatisfied when disunited** and cannot tolerate subjection to people who do not share the same ties.

Veena Das On Nations

Veena Das - How Nations Form



Democracy in India

Democracy in India - Ambedkar's View

In Dr.Ambedkar's word, "Democracy is not a form of government, but a form of social organisation."

He believed that, **Democracy is essential in imparting social justice.**

He laid down certain conditions in this regard:

1. There should **not be glaring inequalities** in society that is, privilege for one class
2. The **existence of an opposition**
3. **Equality in law** and administration
4. Observance of **constitutional morality**
5. **No tyranny of the majority**
6. **Moral order** of society
7. **Public conscience**

Important to remember:

- **Political democracy cannot succeed without social and economic democracy.**
- The best mode of achieving socio-economic democracy is to **achieve political democracy at the first instance.**

Democracy in India - Some Contexts

Democracy has been defined in many ways.

- **Bryce** believes that “**Democracy** really means nothing more or less than the rule of the whole **people**, expressing their **Sovereign will by their votes**”.
- **MacIver** observes, “**Democracy** is not a way of governing, whether by majority or otherwise, but primarily a way of **determining, who shall govern, and broadly to what ends**”.

Democracy as practiced in India

In a broader sense, a number of features can be attributed to democracy.

- A written constitution
- The rule of law
- Basic human rights
- Independent media
- Independent Judiciary
- Separation of powers between the executive, the judiciary and the legislature
- Therefore, when we say that India is a democracy, we mean not only that its **political institutions and processes** are democratic.
- Also that the **Indian society and every Indian citizen is democratic**, reflecting basic democratic values of equality, liberty, fraternity, secularism and justice in the social environment and individual behaviour.

Challenges to Indian Democracy

- **Illiteracy** – It was a matter of grave concern for the successful functioning of democracy in India on the eve of independence and it still continues to be a major challenge. And perhaps, more importantly, it is an essential condition for human dignity
- **Poverty** - It is generally said that for a hungry person right to vote does not have any meaning. For him/her the first requirement is food. Therefore, poverty is considered as the greatest bane of democracy.
- **Gender Discrimination** - Discrimination against girls and women exists in every walk of life. You must have had such experiences of prevailing gender inequality in our society and polity
- **Casteism, Communalism, Religious Fundamentalism** -The Indian democracy faces serious challenges also from casteism, communalism and religious fundamentalism. They weaken the functioning and stability of democratic system.
- **Regionalism**- India has also been struggling with regionalism which is primarily an outcome of regional disparities and imbalances in development.

- **Corruption** - Corruption continues to exist in covert and overt ways at all three levels - political, bureaucratic and corporate sector. One can see the nexus between the politicians, the bureaucrats and the industrialists which has resulted into corruption and corrupt practices
- **Criminalization of Politics** - According to ADR, a vast number of MPs have serious criminal records, and more than 80% of MLAs have criminal cases against them.
- **Political Violence** - In India we have been witnessing various forms of violence. Communal violence, caste violence and political violence in general have attained serious proportion.

Citizenship in Indian Context

Citizenship - Definition

T H Marshall

- Citizenship is 'full and equal membership in a political community'.
- There are certain rights, duties, and responsibilities that citizens have, but they can either be denied or partially extended to aliens and other noncitizens residing in a country.

Kymlicka and Norman

Three basic dimensions:

- Legal Status of Citizenship - granting Civil, Political and Social Rights
- Citizens as political agents - Active participation in political activities (E.g. - Elections)
- Citizenship to be membership in a political community which creates a unique identity.

Ambedkar

- The right to social life is important for all individuals as denial of the same infringes upon the sense of belongingness.
- To protect the fundamental rights of the citizens from tyranny, discrimination and social ostracism of a large section of the society, Ambedkar consolidated the Directive Principles under part IV of the Indian Constitution
- Thus, the fundamental rights and the directive principles protect the rights of the citizens of India.

Citizenship - Indian Constitution

- The Indian Constitution provides for a **dual polity with a single citizenship**.
- India's population can be divided into **natural citizens and aliens**.
- Unlike aliens, natural **citizens enjoy full political and civil rights**.
- **Only natural citizens can contest for offices** such as those of the President, the Vice President and Judges of the Supreme Court.

Relationship Between Democracy And Citizenship

Rights and Responsibility-

- Citizens not only have rights but they also have certain responsibilities so that the harmonious balance between the two is not disturbed. Others must recognize and respect an individual's rights while we too have the same responsibility.

Active and Passive Participation

- Participation by citizens in a democracy adds legitimacy to government policies. Political participation and political equality are two main ideals of a democracy.

Issues of Identity-

- Active commitment to membership of a common political community.
- A shared citizenship identity is fundamental to the achievement of a genuinely democratic society.
- In fact, one of the problems for contemporary democracy is of recognizing the differences without falling into a situation in which the citizens see themselves as the bearers of exclusively particular identities.

Criticism

- **Modern societies** are increasingly being recognised as **multicultural** due to internal diversity and globalization.
- The **liberal understanding** of the idea of citizenship focusing on the individual is **being challenged** now.
- Critiques opine that specific contexts like **cultural, religious, ethnic, linguistic etc.** should be the determining factors of citizenship.
- Liberals worry that **granting concessions to national or ethnic groups hurts democracy**: democracy, for them, requires a common citizenship based on treating people identically as individuals.

Citizenship Act of 2019

- The Citizenship Act of 1955 prescribes five ways of acquiring citizenship, viz, birth, descent, registration, naturalisation and incorporation of territory.
- The Act has been amended numerous times with the latest coming in 2019, leading to a lot of debate and discussion.

Who Is An Illegal Migrant?

An illegal migrant is a foreigner who:

- Enters the country without valid travel documents, like a passport and visa, or
- Enters with valid documents, but stays beyond the permitted time period.

Detaining Illegal Migrants

- **Illegal migrants may be imprisoned or deported** under the Foreigners Act, 1946 and the Passport (Entry into India) Act, 1920.

- The 1946 and the 1920 Acts **empower the central government to regulate** the entry, exit and residence of foreigners within India.
- In **2015 and 2016**, the central government issued two notifications exempting certain groups of **illegal migrants** from provisions of the 1946 and the 1920 Acts.
- These **groups are Hindus, Sikhs, Buddhists, Jains, Parsis and Christians from Afghanistan, Bangladesh and Pakistan**, who arrived in India on or before December 31, 2014.

Illegal Migrants and CAA-2019

In 2019, the **Constitution Amendment Act** provides for the following changes to India's citizenship act:

- The Act amends the Citizenship Act, 1955 to make **Hindu, Sikh, Buddhist, Jain, Parsi, and Christian illegal migrants from Afghanistan, Bangladesh, and Pakistan, eligible for citizenship of India.**
- The **cutoff date** for the citizenship is December 31st, 2014.
- Under the Citizenship Act, 1955, one of the requirements for citizenship by naturalisation is that the Applicant **must have resided in India during the last 12 months**, as well as **for 11 of the previous 14 Years.**
- The **amendment relaxes the second requirement from 11 years to not less than 5 years** as a specific condition for applicants **belonging to these six religions**, and the **aforementioned three Countries.**

On Acquiring Citizenship

- Such persons shall be deemed to be citizens of India from the date of their entry into India
- All legal proceedings against them in respect of their illegal migration or citizenship will be closed.
- The amendment act amends the Third Schedule to the Citizenship Act to make applicant belonging to the said communities from the aforesaid countries eligible for citizenship by naturalisation if they can establish their residency in India for not less than five years.

Sociological Analysis of CAA

- In the **wake of implementation** of the provisions of CAA, a series of **protests broke out**, which require some degree of Sociological understanding.

It is essential to theorise the **CAA movement for a sociological understanding** of the movement and to justify it as a social movement.

- This movement involved the collective mobilization of people towards collective action.
- This movement aimed at countering state's authoritarianism and communal propaganda.

Sociological View

- This movement can arguably be explained in the light of '**Structural-Strain theory**'.
- This theory argues that social movements as outcomes of six-factors:
 - Structural conduciveness,
 - Structural strain,
 - Growth and spread of a solution,

- Precipitating factors,
- Lack of social control, and mobilization
- These factor contributes to social change.

Pratap Bhanu Mehta wrote:

- There is a **“battle against state authoritarianism, its attempts to exercise pervasive control.**
- **But there is also the battle against communalism, the attempt to divide society and unleash passions that relegate minorities to second class citizens”.**
- This struggle could also be viewed as a counter struggle to the majoritarian Hindutva ideology of the ruling regime.

Shiv Visvanathan

- put it as **“classic Foucault:**
 - It *dreams liberation and invents nightmares.*
 - It **promises citizenship** and **transforms it into an enclosure and Panopticon.**
 - It **transforms the transparency of democracy into a surveillance state”.**

Alfonso A. Montuori

- The **drive to homogenise societies and cultures** in the image of the dominant elite and the **suppression of pluralism** are the integral aspects of the **authoritarian projects**, which is specially **observed in multi-ethnic societies and nation** states.

Kamalakar

- Studies on **targeted violence against religious and linguistic minorities in India** and election-related violence and mobilisation have shown **significant use of voter lists to identify and deliberately launch attacks** against sections of the citizenry by majoritarian political actors.

Katatare Prajapati Collective

- Argues that **focus has tended to be more on the perceived misuse** and disenfranchisement of Indian Muslim citizens **rather than the persecution of minority Muslims in India’s neighbouring countries.**

Fernandes & Das

- A **legitimate fear of the CAA** (experienced especially by tribal groups in the North East) is that **refugees would end up getting far more access to land, education, and jobs** than the native population.

Conclusion

- In the absence of any real strategy regarding where refugees will be resettled, there is an additional fear that resettlement will be done strategically along ethnic lines to shore up possibilities of electoral victory for some political parties, and maintain the minority status of selected religious groups across electoral constituencies.

Political Parties

- Political party forms an important component of a political system.
A political party is an institution which consists of leaders, followers, policies and programmes
- Its followers may have formal membership of the party or may support it without being formal members. There are different parties.
- Parties can be differentiated on the basis of leaders, policies and programmes, ideologies and internal functioning.
- The principal feature of a political party which distinguishes it from other organizations is that its main purpose is to capture power.
- Political party is only **one of so many social agents** associated with or responsible for political participation.
- There are **other agents** such as voluntary organisations, institutional groups and socio-cultural communities.
- Political parties are **the important links between individuals, state and society**.
- Political parties provide the **crucial connection between social process and policy-makers, and influence debates and policies** on issues affecting the interests of various social groups in a political system.

Types Of Political Parties In India

- There is a **criterion given by the Election Commission** of India to categorize the political parties as national, state/regional and registered/ unrecognized parties.

1. National Party

According to the Election Commission, for being considered as a national party a political party should at least have **one of the following qualifications**:

- i. It has to win a minimum of **two percent of the seats in the Lok Sabha from atleast three different States**;
- ii. In general elections, the party must manage to win **six percent of the votes and win at least four Lok Sabha seats**;
- iii. It should be **recognised as a state-level party in four or more states**.

Examples: In 2020, there were seven national Parties in India: Indian National Congress (INC), Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP), Communist Party of India (CPI), Communist Party of India Marxist (CPI(M)), Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) and All India Trinamool Congress.

2. State Party/Regional Party

- **Election Commission does not use the concept of regional party. Instead, it uses the notion of state party.**
- However, in academic discourse and general parlance, state and regional parties are used interchangeably. But there are differences in ways the Election Commission and academic discourse define state and regional parties.
- The election commission identifies a regional party on the basis of its electoral performance in a number of states.

Academic discourse defines a regional or state party in terms of its policies, activities, support-bases and leadership in specific regions or states.

According to EC, **to be considered as state party**, a party should have one of the qualifications to be acknowledged as a state party:

- i. It must have engaged in **political activity for at least five years**;
 - ii. It must have **won either four percent of the seats in a general election or three percent in a state election**;
 - iii. In addition, it must have had the support of six percent of the votes cast;
 - iv. The status of a state party can still be bestowed upon an entity even if it fails to win any seats in the Lok Sabha or the Assembly if it manages to win at least eight per cent of the total votes cast in the entire state.
- In 2020, there are 36 recognized state parties in India that represent their respective states.
 - Some of the recognised state parties include Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK), Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam, Biju Janata Dal (BJD), Janata Dal (United) JD(U), Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD), Samajwadi Party (SP).

3. Registered/Unrecognized Party

- Registered party is a party that is neither recognised as a state nor a national party, but it is registered **with the election commission**. It is also called **unrecognised** party. At present, there are more than 2000 registered parties in India.

Political Parties: Functions And Role

Political parties are essential for the proper functioning of representative democracy. They perform vital functions in every political system.

The functions performed by the political parties, especially in the context of India, are as under:

- They **nominate candidates** during elections (to act as people's representatives in the legislature);
- They **campaign** to obtain support for their candidates in the elections;
- They place **objectives and programmes** before the voters through their **manifestos**;
- Those securing the majority in elections **form the government** and enact and implement the policies;
- Those not in power form **opposition and keep a constant check** on the government;
- They form **opposition** when they are in minority in the legislature and constantly put pressure on the government for **proper governance**;
- They **educate people** and help in formulating and **shaping public opinion**;
- They **articulate peoples' demands** and convey them to the government; and
- They **provide a linkage between people and governmental institutions**.
- In India political parties have been performing the above-mentioned functions quite effectively since independence. They have **made representative governments in India both possible and successful** for over past seven decades.
- They provide effective links between the citizens and the governments on the one hand, and the electorates and their representatives on the other. **They try to cater to people's demands on public matters, and mobilize political participation.**

- Elections without parties would have almost been impossible. In fact, **democracy needs strong and sustainable political parties with the capacity to represent citizens and provide policy choices that demonstrate their ability to govern for the public good.**
- The experience of functioning of political parties in India during the last several decades indicates that by and large they have been instrumental in **shaping public opinion, creating political awareness, and imparting political education to the people.**
- They have contributed towards making the **institutions and processes of government truly democratic and people centric.** We can, therefore, say that **democracy in India has been strengthened by a competitive and multi-party system.**
- As **India has a multiparty system where coalition governments have been a norm,** the regional and registered parties have been playing a crucial role, especially after the late 1980s, in formation of coalition of government both in the centre and the states.
- **Regional Parties are becoming important determining factors in electoral politics.**
- Regional parties **represent the aspirations** of people at **state or local levels.**

Rajni Kothari's Perspective on Politics in India and The Congress System

Start of Rajni Kothari's Perspective

Rajni Kothari,

- In the year 1970, published a book with the title 'Politics in India'. The book was inspired by the System Theory developed by David Easton and the concept of power as developed by Robert Dahl.
- It described the political processes in India and their impact on Indian society.
- Its opening lines are manifesto-like, putting politics at the center stage of human activity and treating politics as a force of nature

Rajni Kothari's Perspective is Functional in nature

- He examined issue from the **functional point of view.**
- In a **plural society like India, with cleavages and divisions both on horizontal and vertical lines, the western models to assess political development are often inadequate** and that makes him search for a new model to understand the complex nature of Indian polity, by analyzing the key concepts like '**kind of political parties and interest groups**', '**social and national integration**' and '**infrastructure of the society**'.

Factors for Political Development

- He successfully showed the **response of traditional society to modernization.** In Indian society, there had always been a secular element and it survived to this day due to its '**cultural unity**'.
- Starting with the search of factors in nation-building and the meaning of political development, especially in India, he identifies "**administrative-governmental process**" with the "**political process**" as factors of development in India.
- It is one of his views, that the **greatest failure of India throughout its long history** was its inability to function politically, to construct a viable political authority and that **it failed to build a strong centre.**

- He observed that, “**factionalism and caste cleavages, patterns of alignment and realignment** amongst the various strata, and a continuous striving for social mobility have always been prominent features of the caste system.”
- He also says that “**the unavailability of a nation-wide and united opposition party or parties forced the leadership of the Congress Party to admit to its organization an active and virulent factionalism without any significant reference to ideological or pragmatic issues.**”

The Congress ‘System’

Rajni Kothari writes:

- The Indian system can be described as a system of one party dominance (which, it may be noted, is very different from what is generally known as a one party system).
- It is a **competitive party system but one in which the competing parts play rather dissimilar roles.**
- **It consists of a party of consensus and parties of pressure.**
- The **latter function on the margin** and, indeed, the concept of a **margin of pressure** is of great importance in this system.
- **Inside the margin are various factions** within the party of consensus.
- **Outside the margin are several opposition groups and parties, dissident groups from the ruling party, and other interest groups and important individuals.**
- In India, the **Congress**, which is (used to be then) the party of consensus, **functions through an elaborate network** of factions which provides the chief competitive mechanism of the Indian system.
- In 1947, the **Congress**, which functioned as a broad-based **nationalist movement before independence, transformed itself into the dominant political party of the nation.**
- **Although a number of opposition parties** came into existence, it was recognized that the **Congress was the chief party**, representing a **historical consensus** and enjoying a continuing basis of support and trust.
- Under the circumstances, *political competition was internalized and carried on within the Congress.*
- There developed an **elaborate system of factions** at every level of political and governmental activity, and a system of coordination between the various levels through **vertical "faction chains"**.
- Structurally, such a party system displays two features:
 - There is **plurality within the dominant party which makes it more representative, provides flexibility**, and sustains internal competition.
 - At the same time, it is **prepared to absorb groups and movements from outside the party** and thus prevent other parties from gaining in strength.
- It is a **system** that **concentrates strength within** the dominant party and then **builds internal checks to limit** the use of this strength.
- In this way the party representing a historical consensus also continued to represent the **present consensus.**
- This **ensured the legitimacy** of the system and of the institutional framework under which it operates.
- The **role of the opposition in this system** is to constantly **pressurize, criticize, censure and influence** it by influencing opinion and interests inside the margin.

- And, above all, **exert a latent threat that if the ruling group strays away too far from the balance of effective public opinion, and if the factional system within it is not mobilized to restore the balance, it will be displaced from power by the opposition groups.**
- By posing a **constant threat**, it ensures the mobility and life of the internal power structure of the Congress.
- On the other hand, its own strength is continuously conditioned by the strength of the Congress, gaining where the latter loses, and sometimes gaining substantially when the latter has lost grip over the situation or its internal thermostat has failed.
- **Electorate-wise**, the **Opposition** can **only hope** to function effectively at the **local and regional levels**.
- **Legislature-wise**, however, it also functions at the **national level** and performs a very useful role in the **maintenance of the system**.

He mentioned 5 important points about Congress

1. The Congress, when it came to power, **assigned a positive and overwhelming role to government and politics in the development of society.**
2. It made **the power of the central authority the chief condition of national survival**. This power was not only **consolidated but greatly augmented**.
3. It made **legitimacy the principal issue of politics** and gave to the government and the ruling party an importance of great symbolic value. "*Only the Congress could be trusted.*" This is why only the Congress was the party of consensus.
4. The Congress in power made for a **concentration of resources, a monopoly of patronage and a control of economic power** which crystallized the structure of its power and made competition with it a difficult proposition.
5. By adopting a **competitive model of development**, it made **mobilization and public cooperation a function of political participation rather than of bureaucratic control and police surveillance**.

The Congress 'System' - Conciliation Machinery

- Hence, there developed over the years a conciliation machinery within the Congress, at various levels and for different tasks, which is almost constantly in operation, mediating in factional disputes, influencing political decisions in the States and districts, and not infrequently backing up one group against another and utilizing the electoral and patronage systems in confirming the former in a position of power.

The Congress 'System' - Respect for Minorities

- He writes that the Congress has also shown **great sensitivity on the question of respect for minorities**, including political minorities, accommodating them whenever possible, and in general, pursuing a broad-based consensus on national politics.

The Congress 'System' - No Particular Sanctity

- He also believed that the **delicate balance on which the legitimacy and power of the Congress system rests may be rudely disturbed, and a more authoritarian system might emerge.**
- **Political systems do change in their nature over time**, and there is **no particular sanctity in one particular system**.

Ramachandra Guha criticises The Congress 'System'

Historian **Ramachandra Guha** writes in one of his articles about Rajni Kothari as follows.

It can also be seen as a **criticism** of Kothari's model:

- The **bulk of the book** by Kothari ('Politics in India') was **devoted to the then dominant Congress party**.
- Kothari argued that before and after Independence, the **Congress was successful in presenting itself as the "authoritative spokesman of the nation as well as its affirmed agent of criticism and change"**.
- Towards the end of his book, **Kothari offered one judgement and one prediction**.

A Judgement and a Prediction

The Judgement:

Because the Congress managed to be in power continuously and there was no united or effective threat to its authority, the country's political process gained incomparable advantages of continuity and unity.

The Prediction:

The Congress still needs to be an organized political party in the country, with a nationwide following and considerable depth in the localities.

This has two consequences central to the system's functioning:

- It can continue to enjoy plurality at the centre and thus a dominant voice in coalition-making.
- It can continue to control widespread local presence and patronage even where it is no longer in power at the state level.

Contemporary Political System

BJP's victory in 2014 - A Paradigm shift?

- The **BJP's victory in 2014** ushered in a debate among political scientists and political analysts over whether the country's **electoral politics was experiencing a paradigm shift**.
- Indian politics was synonymous with **coalition politics** between 1989 and 2014, **following decades of Congress Party dominance** at the national level.
- But for that quarter century, no single party was strong enough to earn a parliamentary majority on its own, relying instead on dozens of pre and post-election allies to form a governing coalition.
- The **debate was therefore about whether India had left the era of multipolarity, fragmentation, and coalitions behind** in favor of a new, dominant-party system in which the BJP assumed the role of central pole that the Congress had once played.

Birth of a New Party System?

Scholars were less hesitant in asserting that India was witnessing the birth of a new party system.

In the **Journal of Democracy**, E. Sridharan wrote:

"The results were dramatic, possibly even epochal.

The electoral patterns of the last quarter-century have undergone a sea change, and the world's largest democracy now has what appears to be a new party system headed by a newly dominant party."

What happened in 2014

- The BJP's victory in 2014 relied on **near-total sweeps of a relatively small number of states** in the Indian union; in fact, 75 percent of the BJP's parliamentary tally in 2014 came from just **eight states** in the north, west, and central regions of the country.
- Although the BJP clinched a **majority in the Lok Sabha**, it was **nowhere close to a majority in Rajya Sabha**.
- The BJP's reach was **limited at the level of India's states**. Prior to the 2014 election, the **BJP ruled just five (of twenty-nine) states**.
- India ushered in a new, **fourth party system** – one that is premised on a **unique set of political principles** and that shows a clear **break** with what came before.
- In the 2019 general election, the BJP clinched a **second consecutive majority** in the Lok Sabha, a feat last accomplished by the Congress Party in 1980 and 1984.
- By June 2019, the party **controlled twelve states** while its **allies controlled another six**.
- It also made **significant gains in Rajya Sabha**.

What was Third Party System

- In the third party system, **no national party served as the central gravitational force** organizing politics.
- Electoral politics was marked by **increasing party fragmentation, intensifying political competition, and a federalization of national politics**.
- Furthermore, national voter turnout appeared to be relatively stagnant, painting a stark contrast with rising turnout in state elections – a signal that states had become the primary venues of political contestation as opposed to national-level politics.

Third Party System

- Finally, the third party system was characterized by a **changing composition of political elites in which lower castes – Dalits (Scheduled Castes, or SCs) as well as Other Backward Classes (OBCs) – gained political representation**, largely at the expense of upper and intermediate castes.

Contemporary Political System

- Today, many of these principles stand altered, and 2014 represents a key structural break.
- Some less quantifiable traits suggest Indian electoral politics is operating according to a new set of rules. These factors include the **BJP's ideological hegemony, its organization and fundraising prowess, and its charismatic leadership**.

India's Electoral Systems

- There is broad consensus that **India's electoral history** – from the inaugural post-independence general election in 1952 until the sixteenth Lok Sabha elections in 2014 – can be roughly divided into **three electoral orders**.
- **Yogendra Yadav** has argued that a new electoral system commences whenever an observer can “detect a **destabilization of [an old system] and its replacement by a new pattern of electoral outcomes as well as its determinants**.”

First Party System

1952 TO 1967: CONGRESS DOMINANCE

- Between 1952 and 1967, the Congress Party dominated Indian politics, both at the center and across her states.
- As the party primarily responsible for winning India her independence and home to many of the most respected nationalist leaders, the Congress benefited from widespread popular appeal as the umbrella organization under which India would establish its post-independence identity.
- The inadequacies of the other players on the political scene fueled that dominance.
- Opposition forces were badly fragmented, which limited their ability to mount a serious campaign to unseat the Congress.

Second Party System

1967 TO 1989: GROWING OPPOSITION AT THE STATE LEVEL

- With the exception of the election of 1977 – when the Congress suffered due to autocratic excesses during Emergency Rule between 1975 and 1977 – the party remained the default choice for governance at the center.
- But new expressions of caste and regional identities chipped away at the party's monopoly of subnational politics.
- The year 1967 proved to be a critical inflection point, ushering in the dawn of India's second party system.
- Although the Congress's grip on power in New Delhi remained firm, its hold on India's state capitals began to fade.

Third Party System

1989 TO 2014: DAWN OF COALITION POLITICS

- Congress dominance that remained after 1967, came to an end in 1989, which denoted the start of coalition governance in New Delhi and the third party system.
- Three powerful forces – often termed “Mandal, masjid, and market” – disrupted Indian politics, prompting a realignment in politics:
- **Mandal Commission**, a government task force that recommended that **OBCs be given access to quotas** governing higher education seats and civil service posts.
- It was on the backs of the agitation around Mandal that India witnessed what **Yadav** dubbed a “**second democratic upsurge**,” or the **catapulting of traditionally disadvantaged groups into the corridors of political power**.
- During this period, **many caste-based parties** representing Dalit and OBC interests firmly entrenched their position among the representative class.

Beyond India's Third Party System

- In order to **evaluate** whether India has truly entered a new era of politics with the BJP's recent general election victories in 2014 and 2019, it is **necessary to clarify the precise attributes of the third party system** against which any future change can be measured.

Principles Of The Third Party System

There are six defining attributes of the third party system:

- **First**, the **absence of a central pole** in national politics between 1989 and 2009 is the central feature of the third party system.
- **Second**, the third party system was an **era of political fragmentation**. The number of parties contesting elections surged after 1989 as the Congress order broke down.
- **Third**, electoral **contests** became markedly more **competitive**. **Victory margins came down** and the share of candidates winning an outright majority of votes in their constituencies dropped.
- **Fourth**, the entire **political system became highly federalized**. National-level outcomes were directly influenced by the state-level verdicts that preceded them, but the intensity of the effect depended on the proximity of the two polls. **Honeymoon and anti-incumbency effects** at the state level directly impacted national polls.
- **Fifth**, **voter turnout surged at the state level** while **national political mobilization cooled**. As states became the primary venues for political contestation, voter turnout patterns shifted in kind. In the third party system, **the gap** between voter turnout at the state and national levels saw **unprecedented divergence**.
- **Finally**, there was **a clear change in the social composition of the representative class**. For instance, in northern Hindi belt states, the **combined share of OBC and SC legislators superseded that of upper caste** and intermediate castes for the very first time.

From Multipolarity To Unipolarity

In terms of aggregate electoral outcomes, the **2014 and 2019 elections stand apart**.

- First, the **BJP won India's first single-party majority** in the Lok Sabha since 1984, the year the Congress Party under Rajiv Gandhi won an overwhelming mandate in the wake of Indira Gandhi's assassination.
- **Second**, 2014 was the first time in post-independence history that **a single party** other than the Congress had claimed a **majority** of seats in parliament.
- **Third**, in **2019** although the BJP won a majority of seats, it **exceeded its previous best performance** by a significant margin.

Headed into the 2019 race, many election analysts doubted the BJP's ability to replicate its 2014 feat for at least four reasons:

- The BJP's victory was fueled by virtually **turning the tables in a select set of states**. For the BJP to match its 2014 benchmark, analysts thought the party would have to once more sweep this relatively limited swath of territory – especially given its **limited presence in the south and east of India**.
- Second, **BJP relentlessly campaigned in 2013 and 2014** on a pledge to usher in 'acche din' (good times) for the Indian economy by generating rapid economic growth, creating millions of jobs, and revitalizing India's moribund investment cycle.

- Yet **large parts of the economic narrative simply did not materialize** during Modi's first term in office.
- In the 2014 election, **many opposition parties chose to fight the BJP on their own, as opposed to forming constructive alliances**. As a result, in several pivotal states, divisions within the opposition served to fragment the anti-BJP vote, leading to the former's electoral marginalization.
- In 2019, the **opposition adopted – at least rhetorically – a strategy of cooperation**. In several key states, such as Uttar Pradesh (India's biggest electoral prize with 80 parliamentary seats), longtime rivals joined forces not due to any common ideological commitment or adherence to a unified leadership, but rather as **an existential impulse to prevent their marginalization**.
- An additional sign of the BJP's pan-Indian dominance is the fact that, in 2019, **it contested more seats than the Congress Party for the first time** in history.
- In 2019, the **BJP** fielded candidates in **436** parliamentary constituencies, compared to **421** for the **Congress**.
- **In 2014, BJP, for the first time, surpassed the Congress in the numbers of MLAs**. By June 2019, the BJP had 32 percent of MLAs compared to 21 percent for the Congress and 47 percent for all other parties.
- Another metric of the BJP's hegemonic status is the **party's significantly improved standing in the Rajya Sabha**.
- From a paltry 5 percent of Rajya Sabha seats in 1984, its representation grew to 22 percent in 2008 before falling back to 17 percent in 2014.
- Since then, its share has shot up and in **2017, for the first time, the BJP's tally surpassed that of the Congress**.
- By July 2019, the BJP's share stood at 32 percent as compared to the Congress Party's 20 percent share.

Reduction In Political Fragmentation

- As the **dominant-party era gave way to the onslaught of coalitions**, there was a **surge in the number of political parties** contesting elections.
- In India's inaugural general election in 1952, fifty-five parties fielded at least one candidate. That figure grew exponentially in the mid-to-late 1980s as 117 entered the fray in 1989.

There were **two factors behind** this growth:

- **First, regional and caste-based** parties multiplied in proportion to the degree of popular **disenchantment** with the **Congress Party**.
- **Second**, as **coalition** governance became the **default** position in New Delhi, **political entrepreneurs** had every incentive to strike out on their own and form new political parties. With just a small clutch of seats, a single party could be the pivotal party required to form a parliamentary majority – making the party leader the ultimate kingmaker.
- By **2009, candidates from 370 political parties contested** parliamentary elections.
- Political fragmentation in India today appears to be as strong as ever. The number of **parties represented in Parliament has remained in the upper thirties** for two decades: thirty-six parties were represented in the 2019 Lok Sabha.
- In order to derive a **more accurate measure of political fragmentation**, political scientists prefer to calculate the effective number of parties, which essentially weighs **parties by the number of votes (or seats) they actually earned**.

Weaker, Not Stronger, Political Competition

- One way of **measuring the degree of competition is to look at the average margin of victory** – that is the difference in the vote share of the winner and the immediate runner-up – across parliamentary constituencies in a general election.
- In **1962 and 1967**, the average margin of victory was **between 13 and 15 percent**.
- Between **1977 and 1989**, the average vote share of the winning candidate **never once fell below 50 percent**.
- After falling to a **historical low of 44 percent in 2009**, the average winner's vote began to creep back up – first to **47.1 percent in 2014** and **once more cracking the 50 percent threshold in 2019** for the first time since 1989.
- **After 1977, margins steadily came down** over a period of several decades. **By 2009**, the average margin of victory sunk to its lowest level in the post-independence era: 9.7 percent.
- The average margin **in 2014 grew to 15.2 percent** – the highest level since 1989, the first year of the coalition era.
- **In 2019, margins touched 17.3 percent**.

Weakening Federalization Of National Elections

In the third party system, general election verdicts often resembled a collection of state-level verdicts. This interaction had several components, as laid out by **Yogendra Yadav and Suhas Palshikar**:

- **National-level political competition in each state was a reflection of the dynamics associated with that state's politics.**
- **National elections were regularly influenced by state level political calendars.**
- **The degree of political participation in Lok Sabha elections largely mirrored participation in state-level politics.**
- Finally, the **performance of state governments was an important determinant of voter behavior in national elections.**

As Yadav and Palshikar pointed out, **this does not mean that national political choices were “duplicative” of choices made in the state political arena**; however, it does mean they were “derivative.”

With respect to the electoral calendar, **a certain pattern** had taken root in the third party system, as documented by **Nirmala Ravishankar**:

- **If a national election is held in the first year of a state government's tenure, the ruling party in the state has a greater probability of performing well** when that state votes.
- This **honeymoon effect lingers** through the state government's second year in office, **after which incumbency becomes a liability.**
- **In year three** of a state government's tenure and beyond, the **shine wears off.**
- **The party then begins to underperform in national elections** and this **anti-incumbent “penalty”** grows as the distance from the state election grows.
- **Recent data** points suggest that state and national verdicts have become partially decoupled.
- This leads to the second **important break with the past.**
- In both the **2014 and 2019** elections, BJP managed to **presidentialize a parliamentary election** by making the election principally a vote on his **leadership.**

Here, there was **not a single opposition leader who had the stature or popularity** to favorably compete head-to-head with Modi.

- A central component of what **people were voting for is Modi's leadership** – the **belief** that he is a **decisive leader**, is incorruptible, and operates with the **national interest at heart**.
- On the campaign trail, Modi **was explicit in rallying supporters** with the plea that a **vote for the BJP is a vote for Modi**, irrespective of whose name actually appears as the local candidate on the ballot.
- Another **aspect of weakening federal character** of elections is the **change in the balance of power between national and regional parties**. Between 1996 and 2014, voters in India have been evenly divided between the two big national parties – the Congress and BJP – and other regional parties.
- As a general rule of thumb, 50 percent of the vote has traditionally gone to the two national parties while the remaining 50 percent has accrued to hundreds of regional players. In 2009, the share of the regional party vote peaked at 52.6 percent. In 2014, that share dipped to 48.6 percent.
- While the **Congress earned roughly 20 percent** of the vote in each of the past two elections, the grip of regional parties has declined sharply – and this has redounded to BJP's benefit. In 2019, the regional party vote share plummeted to 43.2 percent.

Regional parties are a highly heterogeneous category.

- Broadly, they can be divided into two groups:
 - On the one hand, parties that are only electorally relevant in a specific region but may have larger national ambitions.
 - E.g. caste-based parties like the Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP), Samajwadi Party (SP), and the Janata Dal (United) (JD[U]) – largely concentrated in the Hindi belt.
- On the other hand are “regionalist parties” that may have a geographically circumscribed catchment area but whose political mobilization rests on appeals to their state's regional pride, culture, language, and customs.

Heightened Voter Mobilization In National Elections

- A **fifth characteristic** of the **third party system** was the **relatively subdued level of voter turnout** in national elections, especially compared to the level of voter interest activation in state elections. Voter turnout in India's first party system averaged 60.1 percent, with high turnouts in the first two general elections.
- Turnout over this period (1967–1984) averaged around 59.6 percent. In the third party system (1989–2009), turnout averaged around 59.1 percent.
- From this perspective, **2014 exhibits a clear break in voter turnout, when India recorded its highest turnout, at 66.4 percent.**

This degree of voter mobilization was undoubtedly a reflection of two factors:

- **Widespread frustration with the incumbent Congress-led United Progressive Alliance (UPA) regime** and
- **The excitement around the candidacy of Narendra Modi.**

In 2019, according to data provided by the Election Commission of India (ECI), **67.2 percent of eligible voters cast their ballots**. An average turnout of 66.8 percent in the past two elections demonstrates **a clear break with the third party system** and what came before.

- **Narrowing gap between national turnout and state turnout.**
- **Before the start of the third system, national turnout regularly exceeded state turnout.**
- In the **coalition era, state turnout skyrocketed** while national turnout remained steady. By **the mid-2000s, state turnout was exceeding national turnout by an average of 10 percentage points.** This gap shrunk, to less than 4 percent between 2013 and 2017.

A final aspect of voter turnout is the **gender breakdown.**

Since electoral statistics began accounting for gender in 1967, there has been a clear gender gap in turnout whereby **women's participation has lagged far behind men's.**

- **From 1967 to 2004 : Women's turnout 8-12 percent points lower than men's.**
- As the third party system waned, the gap between 2004 and 2009 decreased by 50 percent.
- The decline grew more intense in **2014**, when the **gap shrank to 1.8 percent.**
- In **2019**, for the first time in Indian electoral history, **male and female turnout rates were virtually at parity** (the gap was a negligible 0.1 percent).
- This change is likely a combination of **demand-side and supply-side shifts:**
 - Growing female education and empowerment.
 - A more dense information environment.
 - ECI's stepped-up efforts to reduce the gender turnout gap
- However, conditional on being registered, women are now turning out to vote at rates equal to men.
- This is having important **impacts on the nature of political campaigning** in India as parties are increasingly tailoring their outreach and messaging to cater to female voters.

Caste And Social Composition

As **Yadav** points out, in the **first electoral system**, the most salient social category for politics was jati (one of thousands of discrete caste groups that reside within the umbrella categories of upper caste, OBC, SC, and so on).

- In the **first party system**, **Jati** was highly embedded within a particular local context.
- **Second party system-** Jati-level identities retained their importance, but changes in the political environment meant that political parties worked to build **state-wide alliances of individual jatis** in order to construct a minimum winning coalition.
- **Third party system-** jatis lost their salience as the debate shifted to the **umbrella-like varna groupings in the wake of the Mandal Commission** report and its aftermath. During this period, categories of "OBC" and "Dalit" took on newfound importance.
- The **fourth party system-** these larger umbrella groupings consisting of multiple jatis appear to have lost their import. Instead, politics has returned to the construction of **jati-level alliances, as in the second party system**— but with a twist. One of the BJP's great successes in many north Indian states, including Uttar Pradesh, has been to undermine the larger caste categories in **an effort to create a wedge between dominant jatis and subordinate groupings.**
- But the fourth party system **also heralds a shift on a second dimension of social identity.** The rise of Mandal politics in the late 1980s and early 1990s, along with pro- Dalit parties like the BSP, had a clear effect on the sociology of power.
- What is also striking is the **dwindling numbers of Muslims elected to the Lok Sabha from these states.**

In 2019, the BJP did not give a single ticket to a Muslim candidate in the Hindi belt (for comparison's sake, the Congress nominated eleven Muslims from the same set of states).

The Foundations of The BJP's Power

Bjp - As System-defining Party

- One of the **defining characteristics of the second party** system in which the Congress featured as the dominant power was that national election verdicts functioned as referenda on Congress rule.
- As **Yadav** explains, "a typical verdict in this period took the form of a nation-wide or sometimes state-wide wave for or against the Congress. The local specificities of the constituency simply did not matter."
- **Major parties contesting the 2019 elections**, with relatively few exceptions, positioned themselves as **either supportive of Modi and the BJP or vehemently opposed to them**.
- While the **opposition did not succeed in either creating a nationwide coalition** to tackle the BJP, it **did forge** a series of **state-specific alliances** that were explicitly constructed on an anti-BJP platform.
- In the end, the opposition's machinations utterly failed to contain the BJP's rise, but the political formations on display were largely in reaction to the **BJP's own standing- The very definition of a system-defining party**.
- State elections held **between 2014 and 2019-** For the BJP, the party more often than not refused to project a chief ministerial candidate, instead preferring to **campaign on the backs of Modi's personal popularity** as prime minister.

Ideological Hegemony

The Foundations Of The BJP's Power

- Suhas Palshikar characterized BJP under Modi as a classic example of a hegemonic political party.
- He defined hegemony as having two components:
 - Ideology
 - Electoral Performance
- According to Palshikar, BJP's twin emphases on Hindu nationalism and what he calls a "new developmentalism" have allowed the party to saturate the political space in India.
- This has been made possible, in part, by the fact that the **Congress Party's legacy of secular nationalism appears to have fallen out of favor and that the BJP has adopted many of the Congress Party's welfarist policies**.
- The party has **developed a new, nationalist narrative**. To reduce this narrative to one of **Hindu nationalism would be inaccurate**; the party's pro-Hindu views are but **one element of its overall nationalist discourse**.

Broadly, this narrative has three elements:

- In the 2014 and 2019 general election campaigns, the party **selectively deployed Hindutva** (Hindu nationalism) in parts of the country where the party felt it would help **consolidate their electoral base**.
- Over the past two decades, the BJP has made sincere efforts at broadening its demographic base beyond a small sliver of Hindu upper castes and trading communities to include Dalits (Scheduled Castes), OBCs, and Adivasis (Scheduled Tribes) by using memes such as **Ram Mandir, cow protection, and illegal**

immigration to transcend caste divisions among Hindus.

- In recent years it has made use of a more amorphous nationalism centered on territorial sovereignty, loyalty to the nation, and resentment towards traditional liberal elites.
- **Devesh Kapur** noted, *"Its nationalism is unapologetic about India's Hindu roots, and it is prepared to be more assertive in defense of what it regards as its national interests – even if it means redefining the idea of the 'nation.'"*
- Modi, towards the conclusion of the 2019 campaign, boasted of his independence from the elite "Khan Market gang" that had dominated the corridors of power for decades.
- **The final strain of nationalism has to do with a muscularity abroad and a reclaiming of India's rightful place in the world.**

For the first time in recent memory, voters on the campaign trail routinely told reporters that this **election was more than a battle between partisan contenders, it was a battle "desh ke liye"**

Aside from nationalism, the BJP has also managed to dominate the discourse on the economy and economic development.

- Three ideas have been central to the BJP's posture:
 - First, the Modi government is **unabashedly pro-business** and the prime minister has contrasted this with the Congress' record – particularly in the final years of its second stint in office between 2009 and 2014 – of policy **paralysis and burdensome regulation**. Although Modi has not emerged as the pro-market reformer, he has been much more consistent about hewing a pro-business line, especially with regards to indigenous Indian business.
 - Second, Modi has **brandished his bona fides as the ultimate anticorruption reformer**. The hallmark of this fight was his government's decision in November 2016 to invalidate 86 percent of India's currency in an effort to squeeze black money circulating in India.
 - Third, he has also refashioned his own image as the **architect of India's modern welfare state**. If Modi's first pivot was to transition from Hindu strongman to **vikas purush** (development hero) in the latter years of his tenure as Gujarat chief minister, his second pivot has been to shift from a leader who talked incessantly about the middle class, jobs, investment, and growth to one whose main message centers on welfare.
- **Modi's pro-welfare emphasis** has placed the **Congress on the back foot** for a simple reason: many of the schemes he has invested in were **essentially schemes the Congress set up**. What **Modi** did was **rebrand** them, **scale them up**, and give them **priority status** in the Prime Minister's Office (PMO). At root, many of these welfare schemes emerged from Congress Party blueprints.

Organizational And Financial Prowess

The Foundations Of The BJP's Power

- A political machine gave the BJP the ability to project Modi as **a leader with unimpeachable credentials**, to deliver its nuanced messages of nationalism to different target audiences, and to parry the opposition's jibes.
- Under the tutelage of BJP President Amit Shah, the party has built **a well-oiled party machine** that is organized down to the level of the *panna pramukh*—literally a party worker who is in charge of an individual panna (page) of the voter roll linked to a neighborhood polling station.
- Furthermore, the BJP owns a first-mover advantage insofar as **integrating technology with campaigning** is concerned. **E.g.: Facebook to SMS to WhatsApp** to build cohesion among its workers, between voters, and between workers and voters.

- **BJP's financial advantage-** BJP's advantage over Congress when it comes to corporate funding stood at twenty to one in 2018.
- In 2018, the government also formally unveiled a new mechanism of political giving, known as **electoral bonds**. Based on information acquired through a Right to Information Act request, 95 percent of the bonds purchased in 2017–2018 accrued to the BJP's accounts.

Charismatic Leadership

The Foundations Of The BJP's Power

- It could be argued that both the 2014 and 2019 elections were Modi's victories rather than the BJP's.
- In the 2014 race, the BJP encountered a perfect storm of anti incumbency against the ruling Congress, economic malaise, a pervasive sense of policy paralysis, and lackluster leadership on the part of the Congress.
- At that time, **Modi** also enjoyed (apart from being a charismatic opposition leader) a well-regarded **reputation as a nonsense, pro-business economic reformer** – was able to take the country by storm.
- Modi's favorability has to be seen in the context of a **general dearth of popular, charismatic leaders among opposition forces**.

Conclusion

- Since 2014, India has embarked on a new chapter in its political evolution.
- Gone are the days of Congress dominance, but **India's grand old party has clearly been replaced by a new, formative political force in the BJP**.
- With the **2019** general election, it is now clear that India is in the midst of a **new, dominant-party system**.
- The dawn of this **fourth party system raises important questions** that deserve greater exploration by political scientists in the years to come.
- First, **how do economic indicators** shape voting behavior? For decades, it was believed that good economics did not make for good politics in India.
- A second issue that deserves greater scrutiny is the role of caste.

There are broadly **two conceptions of Indian electoral politics**:

- First- is that **elections are mainly about arithmetic**, or the ability of political parties to amass support from a sufficient number of castes or communities to get a minimum winning coalition.
- The second conception is that **elections are about chemistry**, rather than arithmetic. In other words, leadership, messaging, coalition dynamics, and so on trump purely identity-based calculations in which a party's popularity can be measured merely with reference to the vote banks that have traditionally supported it.
- A third area relates to **role of political campaigns**. Both the 2014 and 2019 elections suggest that campaigns have a material impact on voter behavior. For instance, it is indisputable that **the tensions between India and Pakistan helped bolster the BJP's case for re-election** even while it is very much disputed how significant this factor was in terms of votes and seats.

Regionalism

- Regionalism means **to situate the approach and sentiments towards the particular region.**
- It is argued that **regionalism can be a form of resistance against the imposition of a particular cultural ideology that is linked to the integration of a nation.**
- Regionalism is **connections with the cultural patterns that exist as a part of the dominant culture.** found to have
- Sometimes, it does become a **threat to the nation state** by regional groups who struggle for their particular sectional interests and at others it acts like **a force that brings people together, their grievances for the broader nation to address, thus, reinforcing unity in diversity.**
- Regionalism is **an ideology and political movement that seeks to advance the causes of regions.**
- As a process it plays role **within the nation as well as outside** the nation i.e. at international level. Both types of regionalism have different meaning and have positive as well as negative impact on society, polity, diplomacy, economy, security, culture, development, negotiations, etc.
- India emerged as an independent nation state and later regionalism became part of the different states in India. It is linked to the politics of **ethnocentrism.**
- For instance, natives of a particular region foreground their **ontological and epistemological priorities** over a particular region. Natives presume that they possess the authenticity over the issues and construction of subject related to that region.
- They imagine a sort of **body politics that includes themselves and excludes the 'other' as outsiders.** It is a process of **"othering"** for outsiders.
- At the same time, it is the **return to 'self' for the natives.** We can analyze the **tangible and intangible forms of regionalism** through the behavioural and social aspects of the diverse sections of people from the different parts of India.

By the 1960s, the provinces seemed to have settled down within the redrawn boundaries.

- The larger province of **Bombay was divided into Marathi-speaking Maharashtra and Gujarati speaking Gujarat.**
- **Punjab was trifurcated** into a Punjabi speaking Punjab, Hindi-speaking Haryana, and Pahari speaking Himachal Pradesh.
- **The Kannad-speaking areas of Bombay were transferred** to the state of Mysore/ Karnataka.
- **Telugu-speaking areas of the Madras province** were transferred to Andhra Pradesh.
- The linguistic reorganisation looked complete and the **first phase** of reorganisation of the states within the Indian union was over.
- **Then came the demands for autonomy in the north-eastern region.**
- The aspirations of the tribal groups were soon recognised by the Indian state.
- The states of **Manipur, Tripura, and Meghalaya** were formed in the late 1970s.
- The **North Eastern Frontier Agency (NEFA)** was granted statehood under the name of **Arunachal Pradesh** in 1987.
- The restive **Nagas and the Mizos**, however, were granted statehood only after violent encounters with the Indian state.

- The Naga insurgency continues until the present day, even after the formation of the state of Nagaland in 1956. The Mizo insurgency subsided after the 1973 agreement which declared the Mizo district of Assam as a Union Territory. Mizoram was later granted full state status after the 1986 agreement with the rebel leader **Laldenga**.
- However; this did not completely exhaust the aspirations for autonomous administration or statehood by many groups. The cultural differences within the overarching linguistic unity, in many cases, led to demands for statehood within the primarily language-based federating units of the Indian union.

Today, even the states often get entangled in violent clashes as was seen in **deadly clashes of forces of Assam and Mizoram in 2021**.

Factors Related With Emergence Of Regionalism

The existence of **relative deprivation** is one of the most important aspects in constructing the argument for regionalism.

- For instance, if the people from any particular region feel that they are more deprived than others in terms of distribution of resources, infrastructures and so on, then it may create regional affiliation.
- For example, **Gorkha Nationalist Liberation Forum (GNLF)** started its movement in the Darjeeling. In the view of GNLF, Darjeeling was the most underdeveloped region in comparison to the southern part of West Bengal.
- **Growing regional inequalities** in terms of income and consumption in the **post-reforms period** have accentuated the perception of neglect and discrimination.
- **Coastal regions/developed regions have invariably benefited more** from the flow of private investment as compared to the regions at peripheral locations, those with disturbed law and order situations, and those with poor economic and social infrastructure.

The second significant factor for the emergence of **regionalism is the issue of language and culture**. Every individual's identity is based on the categories of language and culture which, once politicized, play an important role in the formation of region.

- **Edward Sapir**
 - Language plays a vital role in the creation and determination of a region. Thus, the idea of region has to be explored in the context of language debates.

Unequal access to political power.

- **The local elites complain of "reverse" discrimination** as often the elites from the other politically dominant regions manage to corner financial grants/deals/lucrative portfolios.

Factors Related With Emergence Of Regionalism

Besides the above factors, there are also many other factors responsible for the growth of regionalism like:

- i. Regionalism made its appearance as a reaction against the efforts of the national government to impose a particular ideology, language, or cultural pattern on all people or groups. Thus the States of south have resisted imposition of Hindi as official language because they feared this would lead to dominance of the North. Similarly, in Assam anti-foreigner movement was launched by the Assamese to preserve their own culture;

- ii. Continuous neglect of an area or region by the ruling parties and concentration of administrative and political power has given rise to demand for decentralization of authority and bifurcate of unilingual states. On occasions “sons of soil theory” has been put forth to promote the interests of neglected groups or areas of the state;
- iii. The desire of the various units of the Indian federal system to maintain their sub-cultural regions and greater degree of self-government has promoted regionalism and given rise to demand for greater autonomy;
- iv. The desire of regional elites to capture power has also led to rise of regionalism. It is well known that political parties like DMK, AIADMK, Akali Dal, Telugu Desam, Asom Gana Parishad etc. have encouraged regionalism to capture power;
- v. The interactions between the forces of modernization and mass participation have also largely contributed to the growth of regionalism in India. As the country is still away from realising the goal of a nation state, the various groups have failed to identify their group interests with national interests; hence the feeling of regionalism has persisted;
- vi. The **growing awareness** among the people of backward areas that they are being discriminated against has also promoted feeling of regionalism. The local political leaders have often fully utilised this factor and tried to feed the people the idea that the central government was deliberately trying to maintain regional imbalances by neglecting social and economic development of certain areas.

A Short Note on Why Son Of The Soil?

1. There remains a competition for job between migrant and local educated middle class youth.
2. This theory works mostly in cities, because here outsiders also, get opportunity for education, etc.
3. In such theories, major involvement of people is due to rising aspiration.
4. Economy’s failure to create enough employment opportunity.

Important Outcome of Various Regionalist Movements

- **Regional identity, culture, and geographical differences now appear to be better recognised** as a valid basis for administrative division and political representation.
- **Separate statehood movements are no longer being stigmatised as parochial, chauvinist and even antinational** as was done in the past.
- The shift is visible in the way the **new states are now being proposed on the grounds of good governance** had development rather than on the language principle that had, ostensibly, guided state formation during the first phase of the reorganisation of states.
- The **dialect communities** of late have been asking for their own “**territorial homeland**” while **underlining the cultural and literary distinctiveness and richness** of the dialectic, i.e., Bundelkhand, Ruhelkhand, and Mithilanchal.

What Could Be The Criteria, Then, For Recognising A Region?

Where homogeneities are to be established on ten counts:

1. language dialect
2. Social composition (communities/jatis);

3. Ethnic regions;
 4. Demo-geographic features;
 5. Area (geographic contiguity);
 6. Cultural pattern;
 7. Economy and economic life;
 8. Historical antecedents;
 9. Political background;
 10. Psychological make -up and felt consciousness of group identity
- A Kumar writing in Exploring the Demand for New States says that the underlying principle in various accommodations of identity in India has remained internal self-determination.
 - Internal self-determination has remained the predominant form in which regionalism, and even sub-regionalism, has sought to express itself.

The regional and sub-regional **accommodation of identity in India has served to weaken the bases of political secessionism and separatism while not defeating the principle of (internal) self-determination (of nations).**

To Conclude

- Regionalism is a **dynamic, pragmatic concept.**
- It **seldom sustains itself on one single factor:** a coalition of factors and circumstances, including politicisation of the region and sense of economic retardation is the basis of regional revival and assertions.
- But the specific factors fostering regionalism are apt to vary from place to place, and even in the context of the same place, the precise mix of them and their individual potency do not remain unaltered over a period of time.
- The peculiar historical processes have a bearing on regionalism.

Ashok Behuria

- Says that the **Indian federation has temperamentally behaved as a “union” and not a “federation”.** However, the leadership in the country has to take care to adopt federal principles to judge such cases of autonomy and gradually develop powers (especially financial powers) to the units if it is to contain various ethnocultural assertions.
- Among all these explanations there is a common thread of argument that says that **the shrinking capacity of the state, underdevelopment, and the politicisation of plural peripheral identities, together with the search for power by neo-elites at the margins, have snapped the interethnic and intercultural bonds that have so far drawn them together.**
- This has **created new identities** and led to an overwhelming craze for autonomy or self-legislation.
- It is interesting to note that the concessions of statehood in the recent cases seem to be conditioned by sheer electoral calculations and not by considerations of economic viability.
- And these concessions in no way altered the basic constitutionally guaranteed relationship between the federation and the units, which is lopsided in favour of the federation.
- **Creation of “dependent” states will in no way improve the conditions, and the passion for a greater degree of autonomy will haunt the Indian states until a genuinely developed refederalized system of governance grows out of the present system of Unitarian federal democracy in India.**

Important Example

Formation of Jharkhand

- The demand for the separate state of Jharkhand, shows the dynamics of the politics of regionalism in India. It was demanded by the Jharkhand Mukti Morcha. The struggle for the separate state of Jharkhand took almost fifteen years. All the political parties have played an active role in it.
- **The rationale for creating this state is also based on the uniqueness of its tribal cultural heritage.**
- However, the distribution of resources and the politics of development remain significant in the socio-economic structures in Jharkhand due to the **continuing construction as relatively deprived and backward.**
- Hence, we can understand **that whenever any state formulation happens with the people's struggle, it has certain aspirations and demands, which may or may not be incorporated in or accommodated by, the formation of the state.**
- It is true that **regionalism and sub-regionalism are unavoidable in a vast and plural country like India.** It is not always correct to consider every attempt to **support or defend regional or sub-regional interests as divisive, fissiparous and unpatriotic.**
- The problem begins when these interests are politicized and regional movements are promoted for **ulterior political motives.** Such unhealthy regional or sub-regional patriotism could be cancerous and disruptive. The continuing regional imbalances have **given rise to militant movements in certain parts of our country.**
- Separatist demands in Jammu and Kashmir or by ULFA (United Liberation Front of Assam) in Assam or by different groups in the North-Eastern region are matters of grave concern for Indian polity

Decentralisation in Indian Context

Decentralisation – definition

Decentralisation

- Interchangeably used with terms like deconcentration, devolution and delegation, though they have different connotations.
- It means “*transfer of authority away from the national capital whether by decentralisation, that is delegation, to field officers or by devolution to local authorities or other local bodies*”

L.D. White

- The transfer of administrative authority from a lower to a higher level of government is called ‘centralisation’; the converse is decentralisation.

Decentralisation – Types

Political decentralisation

Transfers policy and legislative powers from central government to autonomous, lower-level assemblies and local councils that have been democratically elected by their constituencies.

Administrative decentralisation

Places planning and implementation responsibility in the hands of locally situated civil servants and these local civil servants are under the jurisdiction of elected local governments.

Fiscal decentralisation

Accords substantial revenue and expenditure authority to intermediate and local governments

Democratic Decentralisation | Administrative Decentralisation

The expression 'democratic decentralisation' is to be distinguished from 'administrative decentralisation'. Democratic decentralisation is **wider than** administrative decentralisation.

- **Democratic decentralisation** envisages **association of more and more people** with government at all levels, national, regional and local.
- **Administrative decentralisation** originated in the need for efficiency in terms of **initiative, performance and speed of administrative personnel**, particularly at the lower levels.

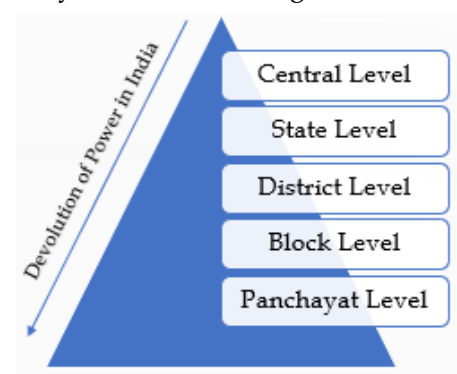
Decentralisation - In Indian Context

Cheema and Rondinelli :

Decentralisation- transfer of planning, decision-making or administrative authority from the central government to its field organizations,

- Local administrative units,
- Semi-autonomous organizations,
- Local governments or
- Non-governmental organizations

Simply, under decentralization authority is not concentrated at the centre, it is distributed to smaller administrative units.



Importance of Decentralisation

1. Decentralisation is very useful for **heterogeneous regions**. It is a means of overcoming the severe limitations of centrally controlled schemes and programmes.
2. It **enables better execution** of programmes, minimize leakages, and misuse of funds
3. **Prevents leakages** at local level and allows social audit by the people who must reap the benefits of govt. schemes.
4. It **ensures closer interaction** between civil servants and the local population. E.g. **E-panchayat** is one of the Mission Mode projects being implemented by the Centre.
5. **Improved participation of people** in policy making and promotes inclusiveness in traditionally stratified village society.

Heller:

Argues that strengthening and empowering local government has been justified not only on the grounds of making government more efficient but also on the grounds of **increasing accountability and participation**.

Cheema and Rondinelli

"decentralisation helps in **institutionalising the participation of citizens** in development planning...It also ensures political stability by increasing the participation of local people in decision-making".

Rajni Kothari

Put it as, decentralisation as an alternative system of governance based on a '**people centred**' approach to sorting out local-level problems.

Democratic decentralisation entails a system of governance in which **citizens possess the right to hold local public officials** to account through the use of **elections, grievance meetings** and other democratic means

Decentralisation - Idea of local governance

Since Independence, numerous committees have recommended decentralisation of administrative authority and devolution of legislative power.

Important committees are :

- **Balvant rai Mehta Committee** : National Extension Plan
- **Ashok Mehta Committee** : Panchayati Raj Institution
- **L.M. Singhvi (1986)** : Report on Revitalization of PRI

Studies of decentralisation have shown that devolution of authority can enhance systems of local governance in a number of ways.

1. **Establishment and empowerment of local resource** user groups can improve the ways in which local people manage and use natural resources, thereby improving the resource base on which poor people are often disproportionately dependent.
2. **'Synergistic' outcomes** - collaboration between citizens and civil servants cooperate to provide goods that would be unobtainable were they acting alone.

E.g. Joint forest management (IFAD, 2001)

Fisheries co-management (Pomeroy and Berkes, 1997)

3. **Enhance participation in decision-making** Particularly among groups that have traditionally been marginalised by local political processes.

Decentralisation - Women in Power

Security through Leadership

- Decentralization provides a **platform for acquiring authority** in a patriarchal society.
- Several survey have found changing perception of women representative that they are **more conscious of, and pleased about, the perceived enhancement of their status** in the family and the local community.
- Relationships within the family are getting transformed as their **husbands have now begun to seek and take their advice**.
- Many women also perceive a **change in the attitude of people** belonging to their own as well as other castes.
- Women now find that they and their opinions receive greater respect both within and outside the household.
- Their influence on decisions regarding the **age of marriage for their children or dowry** has now increased.
- Perhaps the greatest potential for transformation is the experience of women in panchayats, as they **come to recognise the importance of education** and literacy.

Decentralisation - Challenges

Challenges of Decentralisation

- **Insufficient Funding** – Lack of fiscal resources at the local govt. level
- **Constrained spending** – Inflexibility in spending due to various limitations
- **Lack of skilled/trained manpower** - Local governments do not have the staff to perform even basic tasks.
- **Untimely and delayed elections** - States non-serious approach towards local election.
- **Lack policy-making ability** – works merely as an implementing agency.
- **High level of Corruption** – Nexus between local politicians & criminals, role of money and muscle power at play.
- **In context of elected women representatives** – Husbands wielding illegal power on behalf of their wives [Sarpanch Pati]

Decentralisation - Criticism

Even the most successful forms of democratic decentralisation have been **unable to overcome economic and political disparities**.

Ghatak and Ghatak, 2002

- As the Kerala experience has shown, too much devolution can lead to **major duplications of effort and gaps** among different government agencies.

Moore and Putzel, 1999 - Problem of local elite capture

- Argues that, one of the dangers of devolving authority is that it simply empowers local elites and, worse, perpetuates existing poverty and inequality

Saxena and Farrington

- Increased rent seeking behaviour, poor accountability and bad governance can undermine the interests of poor and marginal groups in society.

Religious Fundamentalism

- Infallibility of texts + Selective usage of texts.
- A movement or belief calling for return to fundamentals or basic texts. Consider certain original values to be pure.
- This is in direct contrast to modernism.
- Can be traced back to Protestantism in 1920s in USA and recently in Islam

Reasons

1. According to **Giddens**- reasons is high modernity and globalization.
2. Whenever there is a period of drastic social change, which disturbs the order--> leading to loss of identity or rootlessness---> people clutch onto any support available.
3. Fundamentalism promises earlier better age (Taliban did so). The psychological appeal is difficult to resist for people
4. Perception of threat
5. Economic deprivation
6. Vested interests
7. Lack of modern education

Means

- To bring back the earlier better age- fundamentalists build rigid belief system and practice--> developing intense commitment among believers.
- This belief system is so rigid that non believers are denied their rights.
- So very often fundamentalism takes aggressive militant stand, where killing is justified.

Challenge lies in the balance

Secularism: 4 basic Tenets

1. Tolerance
2. Flexibility
3. Rationality
4. Coexistence

D.Smith -> India has strong secular credentials & makes all efforts to establish it.

Desacralisation

- Opposite of Sacred.
- Means supernatural beliefs are no longer seen as controlling the world. Action is no longer controlled by religious belief.

Consequences Of Fundamentalism

Negatives

- Orthodoxy
- Intolerance
- Hinders progressive social change
- Riots, wars
- Perpetuation of social evils (women at greater receiving end)

Positives

- Helps in checking abrupt social change.
- Brings solidarity.
- Political, social mobility

Clifford Geertz → Ideology based belief system & phenomenon.

Exists at Latent Level but becomes problematic when Manifested

Communalism in Neighbouring Countries

About Communalism:

- Communalism is a term used to denote attempts to construct religious or ethnic identity, incite strife between people identified as different communities, and to stimulate communal violence between those groups.
- Communalism is a significant social issue in India, Bangladesh, Pakistan, Myanmar and Sri Lanka.

Recent Instances of communal tensions in neighbourhood

- There has been rise in resurgence of religiosity and communal tensions in India and its neighbouring countries.
- The recent attacks on the Hindu population in Bangladesh during the Durga Puja festivities.
- It can be seen as a warning that the South Asian area is drifting towards what can be dubbed "competitive communalism," given the emergence of religion-driven politics from Pakistan and Afghanistan to Bangladesh in the west.
- The Islamic-inspired Taliban return to power in Afghanistan provided golden waiting opportunity to all sections in the region to thrust their beliefs and maintain power.

An indication that secularization has not triumphed in the modern world.

- In Pakistan, the infamous blasphemy legislation has been openly utilized to persecute innocent minorities such as Christians and Hindus.
- Aside from that, coercive conversions of Hindu women to Islam and marriages to Muslim grooms have been on the rise in recent years.
- Persecution of Rohingyas in Myanmar

General issues faced by Minorities in these countries:

- Economic, social and political biasness against minorities by state machinery.
- Discrimination resulting in alienation of minorities.
- Poverty, unemployment, etc.
- Feeling of insecurity about their life, assets and well-being.

Subordination, Deprivation, Inferiority, Distinctiveness - 4 dimensions of Problems related with Religious Minorities as given by Jagannath Pathy

- Forced conversion.

Reasons for rise of communalism:

- Divide and rule policy that British followed left the communities fragmented.
- Rule by theocratic governments.
- Majoritarian Hegemony and Minority Insecurities.
- Polarization and radicalization by extremist groups.

Steve Bruce - Lack of centralised control (such as Pope) provides freedom for individuals on the fringes to claim to have found a 'more authentic' and fundamentalist interpretation of those religions.

- Revivals in religious identity worldwide.

Jose Casanova - believes that in contemporary Societies of world religious beliefs and practices are not dying out but have increasingly re-entered public sphere

- Fear of indigenous cultural invasions.

Anthony Giddens - The forces of social change that is "High Modernity and Globalization" are responsible for the emergence of fundamentalism.

- The vested interests by economic and political class to distort and divert popular struggle, to prevent the masses from understanding the real issues.
- Mass poverty and unemployment create a sense of frustration among the people.
- The unemployed youth vulnerable communities can be easily trapped by religious fundamentalists and fanatics.
- Inefficiencies and failures of the governments to control the communal riot.

Impact of Indian policies on Neighbour States:

- The policies on CAA and NRC harmed India's relationships with its South Asian neighbours, particularly with Bangladesh and Nepal.
- Exclusion of Ghurkhas from NRC list in Assam would be enough to create a few ripples in India-Nepal relations.
- Sheikh Hasina blamed the rise of attacks against Muslims in India, as responsible for the attacks on Hindus in Bangladesh.

Ramification of Communalism:

- The real sufferers are the poor, who lose their house, their near and dear ones, their lives, their livelihood, etc.
- Minorities are viewed with suspicion by all, including state authorities like police, para-military forces, army, intelligence agencies, etc.
- Sudden increase in violence against any particular community causes mass exodus and stampede which in turn kills many number of people.
- Ghettoization and refugee problem are other dimensions of communalism induced violence, whether it's inter country or intra country.

- It is threat to values of secularism and religious tolerance in the subcontinent.
- Communalism becomes a threat for the unity and integrity.
- Communal activities occurring frequently do harm the human resource and economy of the country which is hurdle in development of country as whole
- It violates the human rights from all direction.
- According to the UN Refugee Agency (UNHCR), more than 723,000 Rohingya have fled to Bangladesh since 25 August 2017.
- It also estimated that at least 18,000 Rohingya Muslim women and girls were raped

Communalism in India

- In India, there are numerous and growing examples.
- Lynchings of Muslims in various regions of the nation by Hindu vigilante mobs. E.g. - 'cow vigilantism'.
- Communal speeches given by leaders of religious communities.
- Legislation aiming to penalize inter-faith marriages a.k.a. "love jihad."
- Hinduisation of Islamic names of cities, towns, and villages.
- The government's actions concerning the Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA) and the National Register of Citizens (NRC) were interpreted as an attempt to disenfranchise a major portion of the Muslim population.
- This elicited a range of reactions from Hindus and Muslims.
- Recent 2020 Delhi Riots

Merton - pointed out dysfunctional features of religion in a multi religious society. In such a society religion, instead of bringing about solidarity, could become the cause of disorganization and disunity.

Causes for growth of communalism in India:

- Divide and rule policy that British followed left the communities fragmented.
- The wounds of partition are not let to be healed by communal groups.
- The invasions by foreign rulers is seen as insult by one group while others derive their heritage from it.
- Selective interpretation of historic figures such as Aurangzeb, Tipu Sultan.
- The Communal political parties fanning the fire of separatism.
- Reaction to minority appeasement policy adopted by the political parties.

Clifford Geertz (American Anthropologist) - Ideology based belief system & phenomenon exists at Latent Level but becomes problematic when manifested.

- The elections which make the political parties and organizations to make a communal appeal to the voters and to keep alive the communal feelings.
- The subversion of secularism by the political parties. (Secularism = Sick-ularism).

- Separation and isolation found among minorities.
- The economic and educational backwardness found amongst minority groups.
- Large scale conversion activities taking place in India are also contributing to communalism.
- The Hindu militancy too has added to the problem of communalism.
- The media, literature and textbooks that have communal slant and that give support to communal forces.

The 'haves' using 'Religion' belonging to the social superstructure, as a tool to maintain their superior economic position- Marxist perspective

- Communal friction used by the powerful to make the real issues of poverty and deprivation seem insignificant.

'Religion is the opiate of masses'

Government's / State's Measure to prevent Communalism

- Article 25(1) states that all persons are equally entitled to freedom of conscience and the right to freely profess, practise and propagate religion, Subject to public order, morality and health and to the other provisions of this Part.
- Article 19 gives all citizens the right to freedom of speech and expression but subject to "reasonable restrictions"
- Article 28 prohibits any religious instruction in any educational institution wholly maintained out of state funds.
- Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967
- Places of Worship (Special Provisions) Act, 1991 which provide punishment of imprisonment for damaging religious places.
- The Religious Institutions (Prevention of Misuse) Act, 1988 has been enacted with a view to maintaining sanctity of religious places and to prevent their misuse for political, criminal, subversive or communal purposes.
- Model Code of Conduct (MCC) of ECI prohibits hate speech.
- Central Scheme for assistance to victims of terrorist and communal violence.
- Prevention of Communal and Targeted Violence (Access to Justice and Reparations) Bill, 2011' bill was tabled in the Parliament. It provided for the establishment of seven-member National authority for communal harmony, justice and reparations

Suggestions to control and eradicate communalism:

- There should be increase in international media coverage on minority issues in all affected countries.
- Greater interest should be displayed by international watchdogs on minority issues in these countries.

- Problem of unemployment among the youths, illiteracy and poverty should be dealt with honesty and without any discrimination.
- Reducing educational and economic backwardness of minorities.
- The religious leaders and preachers should promote rational and practical things to promote peace and harmony.
- Media, movies and other cultural platforms can be influential in promoting pluralism.

Berge and Luckmann - Pluralism weakens influence of religion.

- The Media must exercise great restraint in spreading unverified reports of communal riots. The state must have strict vigilance over the media.
- The Government in power must use its authority and power in suppressing the communal riots.
- Governments should not hesitate to impose ban on communal organizations directly or indirectly indulging in communal riots.
- Since rioters are making use of modern sophisticated equipment's and weapons to spread communal riots everywhere, it is necessary for the state to resort to new strategies and plans to hook those rioters and instill confidence in the minds of riot-hit individuals and innocent people.
- In the riot-torn areas efficient and secular minded police officials must be posted.
- In the riot-torn places peace committee consisting of the respected leaders of the different religious communities are to be formed immediately after the outbreak of communal violence.
- Special Courts should be established to deal with the cases of communal riots.
- Speedy disposal of the cases is an essential step in this direction.
- The riot affected people must be given protection immediately and sufficient care should be taken to make arrangements for their rehabilitation if needed.
- Immediate legal action should be instituted against those who instigate communal riots.

D. Smith once said India has strong secular credentials & makes all efforts to establish it.

C 5

Social Movements in Modern India

Syllabus

- Peasants and farmers movements.
- Women's movement.
- Backward classes & Dalit movement.
- Environmental movements.
- Ethnicity and Identity movements.

Definition

- A social movement essential involves **sustained collective mobilization** through **either formal or informal organisation** that is generally oriented towards bringing about **social change either partial or total** in the existing system of relationship, values and norms.

E.g.

- *Harijan Movement against untouchability*
- *Chipko Movement against deforestation*

Social movements: Features

1. Integrate masses
2. Highlight the issues
3. Works as Safety valve | Mediator

Peasants and Farmers Movements

Social scientists have broadly underlined the **subordinated, marginalized and underdog position** of the **peasantry** in human society.

Sociological literature -

- Peasants have widely been described as culturally '**unsystematic, concrete tradition of many, unreflective, unsophisticated and the non-literate**' constituting the mosaic of the "little tradition" 'incomplete' and a 'part society with part cultures'
- They are found to occupy an '**underdog position** and are **subjected to the domination** by outsiders'.

Eric Wolf

- Considers that peasants are population that are extensively involved in cultivation and make **customary decisions regarding the process of cultivation**.

Peasant movements

1. When **people** living in village communities practicing **small time subsistence agriculture** cutting across caste; **rebel** against taxation policy, nature and form of land control, introduction of new technology, eviction of land etc.
2. Such kinds of **organized protests** are identified as peasant movements

3. Therefore, social mobilization centering on the:

- Question of **distribution of land**
- Land related **taxes**
- Problems of **rural labour** comes under the jurisdiction of farmer and peasants movements

Singha Roy

Conceptualized Peasant movement as:

- An organised and collective effort of the peasantry (subsistence and small producers, tenants, sharecroppers and agricultural labourers)
- To bring about change in:
 - The pattern of ownership
 - Control and use of land
 - Share of agricultural produce
 - Wage structure
 - Other aspects of socio- economic life

Teodre Shanin on Peasants and Peasant Movements:

- Paradoxical social identity
- Usually subordinate, marginalized
- Culturally unsystematic, unreflective, little tradition
- Subsistence Economy
- Politically driven by outsiders
- Caste obstructs Farmer Movements

AR Desai

- **Before** Independence → Peasant movement
- **After** Independence → Agrarian Movement

K.K. Sarkar

- In Tebhaga, Andhra + Land Grab, UP, **Caste gave death** to movements.

Barrington Moore

- Supports the view that **caste obstructs Peasant movements**.
- People fight for **own castes only**

Peasant Movement in India can be broadly categorized into **3 schools of thoughts**:

- a. **Peasant movement absent** - Barrington Moore and Hayke (Pre-Independence View)
- b. **Similar to Europe** - Supported by Gail Omvedt, Hardiman, Ashok Rudra and others Marxist Scholars
- c. **Nationalist perspective** - D. N. Dhanagare, Ashok Gadgil

A. Peasant movement absent

Barrington Moore and Hayke – Pre-Independence View

1. Peasant movement in India is absent and social change in India is different on that of feudal Europe and Socialist China.
 2. Believes that Peasant Movement would never be possible in India because Indian peasantry is not driven by objective class consciousness.
 3. The subjective consciousness driven by religion, caste and language divide the Indian peasantry.
 4. Many peasants consider that terms and condition imposed by landlords acceptable.
 5. Therefore, Indian agriculture prior to or after independence is neither feudal nor capitalist.
- Communal consciousness is elastic in nature
 - E.g. Champaran Satyagraha
 - Objective class consciousness is there driven by the idea of relative deprivation.
 - Landlords conditions not always acceptable. Alternatives are sought.

B. Peasant movement similar to Europe

Gail Omvedt, Hardiman, Ashok Rudra and others

1. **Peasant Movement** in India is more or less **similar to Proletarian movement** as in case of feudal Europe.
2. **Different Peasant Movement** in India prior to Indian independence emphasized on **common economic agenda** like abolition of intermediaries, improvement in infrastructural conditions for agricultural pursuits, rebellion against excessive taxation.
3. **Formation of village cooperative**, abolition of forced labour, fixation of rent on the basis of produce and other related economic issues.
4. They also argue that **excessive exploitation leading to marginalization** of millions of peasants, in India **offer conducive platforms for the mobilization** of peasantry in Indian society.

Therefore, **Peasant mobilization** in India carrying **different names**, organized by **different leaders**, appearing in **different geographical regions** unified the deprived sections of society.

Hence, it is a form of organized class movement.

In a Nutshell

- Similar to feudal Europe
- Common Economic agenda against -> Intermediate, Bad agricultural Infrastructure, Excessive Taxation
- Movement organized

C. Nationalist Perspective

Nationalist perspectives of *Dhanagere, Ashok Gadgil*).

1. **Indian peasantry is not an economic class. Peasants are microscopic unit of macroscopic Indian society.**

2. **Peasant Movement** should be considered as a **foundation to national movement** than being a struggle for procuring right over land or produce.
3. They consider that **nationalist movement in India started with agrarian question** and ultimately contributed for making independent India.
4. This school of thought indicated that **anti-colonial work started from villages and expanded to macrostructure** of Indian social and political life.

In a Nutshell

- Peasantry not an economic class
- Micro Unit of Macro Indian society
- Foundation to Indian National Movement (Not fight for land or Produce)
- Anti-colonial work started in villages.

Transition from Peasant to Farmer movements

1. Most of the Peasant Movement from **19th century to 1920** --> **reflexive, issue based, temporal and community-oriented** movements which demanded **concession than asking for structural change**.
2. These movements cannot be considered as class consciousness in Marxian sense of the term, as these are not driven by crystallized ideology asking for complete breakdown of economic structure.
3. However, **after 1920** integrative, articulate, issue-based farmers movements demanded complete social change and alternation in control are Mode of production.
4. **A shift from subclass movement to class movement'.**
5. P.C. Joshi indicates that a **shift from Peasant Movement to farmer movements speaks about change of feudalist India to capitalists India**.

From Peasant to Farmer Movements

Before 1920

- Issue based
- Temporary
- Community based (less spread)

After 1920

- Integrating
- Change structure
- Alter control, Mode of Production

Post-Independence movements

Gadgil → Rising farmer Movement in India can be attributed to **capitalist adventure like green revolution and growth of co-operative in Indian agriculture**.

1. Green revolution has **consolidated rich and middle classes**. These classes have **developed frontal organization** to protest and safeguard their interests.

- One such of is the rise of 'Bharathiya Kisan Union' as pressure group extracting varieties of benefits in favour of privileged section of Indian Peasantry.

Kannan:

- Finds out most **co-operative movements** have offered **privilege to the rich and middle peasants** who have larger share of cooperative holding and ultimately got benefitted i.e., justified by their frontal political organization.

Farmers Movement

- Green Revolution
- Growth of co-operatives in agriculture.

In contemporary, India farmers are **committing suicide** in different parts of country as the targeted benefits for the farmers are pocketed by the rich peasantry.

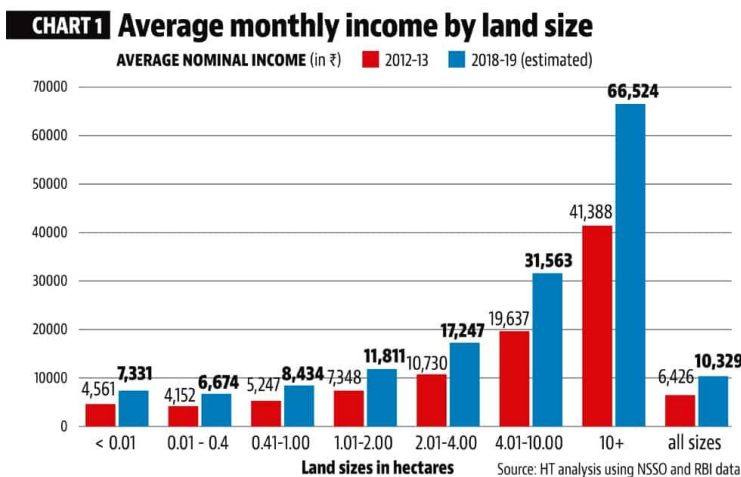
Anand Chakravarti

- Calls this **hegemonic domination**. It is persistent in India. It is reacted by the landless masses in terms of popular mobilization like **Peoples Union For Civil Rights, Peoples Union For Democratic Rights** and **Maoist movement** in different parts of country.

Hegemonic Domination

Hegemonic Domination

- Suicides by Marginalized farmer: **benefits pocketed by rich Farmer**



SUICIDES IN FARM SECTOR

SUICIDES BY	2016	2017	2018	2019	% CHANGE OVER 2016
Farmers	6,270	5,955	5,763	5,957	-5%
Labourers	5,109	4,700	4,586	4,324	-15%
Total suicides	11,379	10,655	10,349	10,281	-10%

SUICIDES IN STATES IN 2019

	FARMERS	LABOURERS	TOTAL
Maharashtra	2,680	1,247	3,927
Karnataka	1,331	661	1,992
Andhra Pradesh	628	401	1,029
Madhya Pradesh	142	399	541
Telangana	491	8	499
Punjab	239	63	302

* Detailed state-wise data for 2017 and 2018 has not been made available by NCRB

[Chart : Income difference between Rich Farmer: Large land holding and Poor Farmer: small land holding]

Women's Movement

Gender Equality: 4 dimensions (by oxford university)

1. Redressing Disadvantage
2. Countering stigma & violence
3. Transforming Institution (social)
4. Facilitating Political Participation

Neera Desai: WM is sustained, collective action for achieving quality.

Women's Movement: Pre-Independence

Pre-Independence:

- Majorly led by males
- Lacked participation of women
- But were meant for women and their emancipation → Raja Ram Mohan Roy, Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar, Behramji Malabari.
- Exceptions – Pandita Ramabai; Sarojini Naidu

1920's →

- Women's India Association
- Emergence of Gandhi & Non-violence
- All India women's conference
- Increased participation of women in outside activities related to freedom struggle

Women's Movement - After Independence

After Independence

- Constitution ensured protective discrimination
- But far below expectation.
- Led to movements in 1960s
- Various conference in UN related to women's empowerment
- Started people's movement along with activities of the state

Gail Omvedt:

2 Ideologies

1. Women's equality movement -> Equality in Political, Economic and Social (P, E, S)
2. Women's Liberation movement - wants change of structure -> Challenges P, E, S

1960's → Intellectual liberation movement

3 heads (Economic)

1. **Developmental** movements → Eco. + Education status (SEWA, Lijjat Papad, coir movement worker)
2. **Ecological** women movement Eco-Feminism → Women Problems related with ecological degradation (Chipko, VesaVirar)
3. Issue based (mainly launched by NGOs, civil society)

Women's Movement - Issue Based

Launched mainly by NGOs and Civil Society

- Anti - Dowry
- Anti - Liquor (Andhra Pradesh)
- Inheritance rights (Coparcenary Rights - Mitakshara)
- Anti - rape, Safety movement
- Anti-feticide
- India still fighting for Equality.
- Other points -> SHG, SEWA, MFIs, MNREGA

Impact of these movements

- Increased participation in employment
- PCPNDT Act
- Domestic Violence Act
- Increased awareness of ecology
- Increased political participation in PRIs | ULBs

Women's Movement - After LPG

Post - 1990s

4 Participatory movement

- Better Socio - economic indicators of women
- Increased women leadership (reservation in parliament, corporates)
- Increased participation in higher education.
- MFIs, MNREGA.

Societal Challenges

Challenges against Women's emancipation

Honour killing

- Honour & shame are vested in the bodies of women, through which communities of men interact.
- Case studies:
 - Jordon -> Alex Miller

- Sind -> Jajma Noor
- Caste, Gender, Patriarchy -> Nikunj Gupta

Reasons for Honour killing

1. Cultural Lag - **Ogborn, Nimkoff** - Nouveau Riches because of GR, LR but no change in tradition, patriarchal mindset.
2. Attempt to oppose Modernity
3. **Gunnar Myrdal** -> Normative vs Instrumental
4. **Parsons** : Institutionalized vs internalized
5. **Andre Beteille's** improvisation -> Caste + Class + Party + Gender

Backward Classes & Dalit Movement

Who is a Dalit - Efforts to Define

The community was variously referred to as "**asprashya**" (untouchable, last born), "**antwaseen**" (residing last).

The 19th century revolutionary reformer Jyotiba Phule used "**atishudras**", and "**Dalit and pat-Dalit**" to refer to backwards.

Various important usages:

- An army officer of the East India Company, **J J Molesworth** who mentioned the word Dalit in a Marathi-English dictionary 1831.
- By radical reformer **Jyotiba Phule**
- Dalit is found in Buddhist Vinaya **Pittaka's** second volume '**Culluvagga**'.

Pre-Independence

Role of Gandhi ji and Congress

- Mahatma Gandhi and Congress ensured the Dalit movement changed course.
- Gandhi brought out 'Harijan' newspaper, Congress became the vehicle to spread the term.

Role of Ambedkar ji and Others

- The 1920s reflected a stress on indigenous roots ati-Hindu, ati-Dravida, ati-Andhra, ati-Karnataka.
- A rebellious Manguram Walia in Punjab called the untouchables' ad-dharma'.

What are Backward Classes

- Backward Classes generally refer to **all socially and economically deprived sections** of the society.
- **British used the term depressed classes.**
- Later **Supreme Court clarified that the term classes can be equated with caste.**
- Hence **depressed classes refers to SC and ST** while **other depressed sections** refers to **OBCs**.

Why no or little Backward Class Movements in North India

Backward Class movement are mostly found in West and South while in North India there has been Backward Class mobilisation but not movement.

This could be because:

1. The **traditional caste Hierarchies in North was not so rigid** as it got **weakened after Bhakti movement and Islam**.
2. **Brahmins did not rule the secular hierarchy** as well (this could be seen as an impact of Islamic rule).
3. They were rarely the dominant landlords while Jats and Ashraf Muslims were economically dominant. Also, Vaishyas were largely the owners of commercial capital.
4. Hence dispersed inequality was present in north.

In case of South India ritual hierarchy was very rigid

1. **Stratification was cumulative** as Brahmins dominated the secular as well as ritual hierarchy
2. Most graduated from Brahmins in Madras presidency (consisting only 3% of the population and 66% graduates)
3. Even freedom struggle leaders- mostly all came from Brahmins (Iyengars)
4. Backward Caste movement concentrated in two areas
 1. Bombay Presidency
 2. Madras Presidency

MSA Rao on Backward Class Movements

MSA Rao:

There are 3 types of Backward Caste Movements:

1. **Brahmins vs Non-Brahmins** (South India) (Shudra – Dalit together) (Justice Party, DMK)
2. **Brahmins & upper Non-Brahmins vs lower Non- Brahmins** (excluding Dalits) : **OBC movements**
3. **Dalit vs All**

Dalit vs All Movements

Dalit vs All

- a) **Pure Dalit Movement**: Radical by Dalits themselves (SNDP)
- b) **Sanskritisation** specific (to get higher status) (Nadir Movement, TN, Ramgarhia in Punjab)
- c) **Socio-Religious Reform** (leadership used to be from outside) → Arya Samaj, Gandhi, Sikhism, Bhakti, Buddhism
- d) **Conversion** movements (Islamic, Christian, Buddhist)

Rise of Consciousness

Q. Is there a rise of consciousness of being exploited?

Yes :

1. Status difference b/w converts & non-converts
2. Western education bringing ideas of equality
3. New occupations (leading to sharing of spaces with upper castes, them protesting)
4. Modern Institutions professing equality
5. Urbanization
6. INM, Socio-Religious Movement brought consciousness.

Methods used in Backward Classes & Dalit Movements

1. Protests
2. Agitation
3. Violence
4. Parallel Legitimacy (SNDP)
5. Changing cultural Practices (sanskritisation)
6. Acquiring Political Power (Justice Party, DMK)
7. Getting Govt. jobs

Contemporary Backward Classes & Dalit Movements

1. **Disappearance of Sanskritisation** in ritual sense because of **reservation** though there is a continuity of pursuit of Sanskrit ideas in lifestyle ways.
2. **After Mandal Commission** Sanskritisation Even ceased in OBCs.
3. Relevance of **socio-religious movements decreased**
4. But **law failed to bring social change** -> New BCMs, Acquiring Political Power as aim
5. **Rise of Dalit Panther, RPI, BSP** (Social Engineering) (vertical + horizontal fusing of castes)

Satya Shodhak Samaj

1. Jyotiba Phule belonging to a gardener caste launched Satya Sodak Samaj as an anti-caste, **anti Brahmin movement**.
2. **Brahmins** were mainly **outsiders** and **non-brahmins** were original inhabitants who could be united. (Aryan invasion theory?)
3. He advocated for **Shudra, Adi Shura unity**.
4. He said that **upliftment** of Shudras and Adi Shudras is **prime importance than freedom** from British rule.
5. This strategy was that **two enemies cannot be fought at same time**.
6. So, he was **ready to align with British to fight against Brahmins**.

7. But he also **criticised British for they caused indebtedness of the farmers.**
8. **Gail Omvedt** says that Phule's solution for the upliftment of the marginalized is **strikingly modern** for example as he recommended **bio tech, watershed development dams, inter breeding of animals** for HYV of milk and wool which are far ahead of his time.
9. He also emphasized on **Vidya (secular education) and not on Shaastra (religious education).**
10. **However, Omvedt and Herald Gould** consider that **Sathya Sodak Samaj** was not a reform movement rather it is a **transgressive movement (transformation through aggression)** and this is the **foundation to Dalit movement initiated by Ambedkar.**
11. **David Hardiman**--> argues that Sathya Shodhak Samaj and subsequently the initiatives undertaken by Ambedkar has been **instrumental for the rise of sub altern movement in West India.**

Self-Respect Movement

“Swayam Maryada” –

Demanding more concessions to non-brahmins

1. **Unlike socio religious reform movement --> self respect movement was initiated as a sub altern movement.**
2. **Brahminic domination was absolutely exclusive** in Tamil Nadu as they got the best from both spiritual and material world.
3. Some enterprising educated middle caste non-Brahmins published the non-Brahmin manifesto in 1916 followed by a formation of South Indian Association in 1917.
4. **After Montague-Chelmsford reform South Indian Association was converted into "Justice party" to counter the political influence of congress.**

Self-Respect Movement: Purpose

1. Political Education of low castes Tamil
2. Do away with superstitious & beliefs
3. Women rights
4. Homes for orphans & widows + their education
5. Found support from Reddy, Kammar (AP) + vokkaligas, lingayats (Karnataka)
6. Also, Muslim, Christians supported because they are also disprivileged.

Self-Respect Movement: Approach

1. No farmer attached to Brahmin should think that his life is a grace of brahmins rather it is the **Brahmins who are dependent on non-Brahmins** for their sustenance.
2. Also focused on **family planning and mass education**
3. Captured power in Madras province in 1920- **Beginning of backward caste mobilisation as a political force.**
4. However, being a party of urban educated professional middle class was **elitist in nature and failed to build a mass base.**

Self-Respect Movement & Justice Party

Andre Beteille -> SRM, Justice Party advocated Privileges

- Power through secular means
- Anti-Hindu, Anti-Brahmin approach
- First Justice Party then came EV Ramaswamy Naicker
- Asked for reservation
- Congress opposed
- Became anti-Brahmin, anti-congress, anti-Gandhi
- In 1944 Justice party + SRM turned into Dravidar Kazham.

E.V. Ramaswamy Naicker (Periyar)

Coming of E.V. Ramaswamy Naicker

1. He demanded **special reservation for non brahmins in assembly** which was rejected by Congress, so he came out with his own manifesto opposing Brahmins, Congress and Gandhi.
2. He found self respect movement in 1925 and advocated for denouncement of brahmins' supremacy.
3. **Hindu culture should be abandoned as it legitimizes the social hierarchy.**
4. In 1944 self respect movement and Justice Party were **merged** into Dravidar Kazhagam under Periyar.
5. He **adopted a militant mass agitation strategy** and advocated **an equalitarian ideology condemning caste system.**

Perspective on Self-Respect Movement

- Gail Omvedt considers that self-respect movement exhibits **protest against the Socio-cultural economic domination of Brahmins through Hinduism.**
- Therefore, it is an **anti - Hindu and anti-Brahmin sub-altern movement.**
- T.K. Oommen considers that self-respect movement is an attempt of the non-Brahmin in search of **progressive modernity.**
- M.N.Srinivas considers that when **Brahmins monopolized over Sanskritisation the non Brahmins wanted to capture secular power.**
- T.N. Madan argues that self respect movement is **symbols of protest by numerous lower classes** that are coming together asserting that Indian society can no longer stay hierarchical.
- It must **cherish the values of democratic and equality** but ultimately their consolidation gave way to **linkage between caste and politics in India.**
- M.S.A. Rao advocates that self respect movement is a **new start in the field of study of social movement** because **all caste movements prior to self respect movement were reformative and revisionary** but self respect movement emerged as a **reactionary movement with revolutionary ideology.** (Pure Dalit Movement)

Self-Respect Movement: Limitation

- Contributed for **intensification of regionalism**
- Consolidation of **caste politics nexus**
- **Strengthening of cultural consciousness**
- It **finally ended as a reservation movement** that was later subjected to **horizontal and vertical extension** of reservation policy talking about **how politics of reservation is predominating over Sociology** of reservation.

Sri Narayana Dharma Paripalan Kerala

SNDP Movement, Kerala

SNDP Movement: (Sri Narayana Dharma Paripalan)

Parallel source of legitimacy

1. In later part of 19th century with the **spread of modern secular ideas**, Izhavas under Narayanaguru reacted **against the domination of Brahmins**.
2. Narayana Guru adopted a **new ideology** based on **new interpretation** of Hinduism.

MSA Rao:

- It was **not reformative but a protest movement**
- **Change in structure not change of structure of caste**
- They adopted the strategy of **caste withdrawal and self organization**.
- Narayana Guru established **parallel sources of legitimacy** by **creating new institutions** like temples, priest, monastery etc.
- It also demonstrated that it was **possible to remain within the fold of Hinduism and yet escape** from the stigma of **untouchability**.

The **new awareness** created among Izhavas by SNDP movement **motivated them to take to modern education**, in the **long run enabled them access to modern occupation** which carried high **secular rewards**.

Utsula Sharma in the book "*The Dynamics of Caste*" also considers, **SNDP is not a reformative movement rather it is a protest movement**.

Backward class movement in North India

Andre Beteille

1. **Yadavs** with the help of myths -> Traced their genealogy to Krishna
2. **Mandal** commission mobilized Backward classes
3. **David Hardgrave** - **Class mobilization** driven by caste interests

Other Important Things To Know About BCM

Gandhi -> **Change heart** of upper caste (Love)

Ambedkar -> **change the social structure** (Law)

Beteille in his book *Backward Class and New Social Order* advocates that:

- Unorganized Yadavs taking the supports of myths, forging their genealogies going for **instituted mobilization** and **ultimately capturing the state power**.
- He believes that **Mandal commission** has further led to the **consolidation of mobilization of backward classes** in north India.

David Hardgrave -Marxist

Considers that backward mobilization in north India can be best understood as **a form of class mobilization driven by caste interest**.

The backward classes specifically the **Yadavs speak more about their economy, education and social deprivations than** speaking about **caste injustice like Dalit** but ultimately the benefits reaching them is contributing for their secular consolidation both within and outside the power structure.

BCM - Pre-Independence Mobilisation

Pre-independence

1. During freedom struggle Gandhi started **Harijan movement in 1930s**.
2. He favoured a peaceful and gradual abolition of **untouchability through introspection and change of heart on the part of upper caste**.
3. To its contrast Ambedkar viewed **untouchability as a political and economical problem**, believed that **caste based inequality couldn't be rectified without changing the social structure** itself.
4. Further he adhered to the view that **it was in the power of the state and its legislative instrument to start social change**.

Post-independence

1. Trust placed in new Indian government.
2. But by the end of 1960s disillusionment among the Dalits were obvious due to the failure of governmental reforms like land reforms and also party politics dominated.
3. Hence, Dalits realised that reformist agenda of those in power would in no way alter the plights of Dalits.

Ambedkar in 1954 formed the SC Federation-

- Federation was converted it into **Republican Party** in 1956 to counter the congress. Also Ambedkar assumed the leadership of **Mahar's movements** to uplift the Mahars.

Dalit Panthers movement

- In 1970s Dalit Panther movement was launched by Dalits of Maharashtra led by educated Mahars following the Black Panther movement in USA.
- Dalit Panther Movement tried to build an alternative socio cultural identity for the oppressed.
- Most of their activities were limited to publication of their ideas only.
- Hence it did not alter the social conditions of Dalits drastically.

BCM - Post-Independence Perspective

- By 1980s and 90s socio cultural deprivation has declined due to the **constitutional guarantee of abolition of untouchability under Article-17**.
- Dalits moved on to fight against political exclusion
 1. 1980s and 1990s Dalits adopted the strategy of **horizontal mobilization of depressed classes**
 2. Today due to their **numerical strength and political empowerment** they have become equal to brahmins
 3. Their **status and political empowerment** has also contributed for the softening of their militant struggle.
 4. However, **economic empowerment of dalits is yet to come though political empowerment started** as is seen in case of Bahujan Samaj Party (Kanshi Ram – Mayawati)

BCM - Some Perspectives

Lancy Lobo considers that:

- Dalits are so powerless that they cannot defend themselves
- They are so powerful that every political formation in India is skeptical about Dalit mobilization.

Herald Gould says that the rise of new India which respects democratic justice can best be explained in terms of dalit mobilization.

He makes a comparison between Dalit mobilization to working class movement considering that the former is driven by ideology and self-respect while the latter driven by time bound interest.

Gail Omvedt considers that Dalit movement in India is instrumental in promoting true social revolution.

India there are present two kinds of poor:

- Those who are incidentally suffering from poverty
- Those who are historically pushed into state of poverty.

Dalit mobilization is addressing to the needs of culture-historical poor who are made poor for no faults of their own.

Hence, their self assertion speak about the protection of human right.

Dalit Empowerment: Challenges

Still:

- Nevertheless, political improvement of Dalit never does mean the mass dalit empowerment rather it is only elite Dalit empowerment.
- Dalit mobilization today is only in the formative stage.
- Once it matures it will have a major impact on the democratic politics of India.
- Economic empowerment is still to come

Environmental Movements

Environmental Movements in India

Important Movements to remember:

- Started with Bhopal gas tragedy
 - Palakkad District, Kerala (Drought Prone)
 - Anti – exploitation of natural resources
 - Anti – dam movement
 - Anti – Polythene
 - Anti – Global warming
 - Role of Judicial Activism, M C Mehta
1. Environmental and public health have been struggling in India. The environmental movement in India **began in 1980s**. The biggest event that developed the movement was the **Bhopal gas leakage** on December 3, 1984. It released 40 tons of **methyI isocynate**, killing 3,000 people and ultimately caused 15,000-20,000 deaths.
 2. India has witnessed a national campaign against **Coca Cola [and Pepsi Cola] plants** due to their practices of drawing **ground water and contaminating** fields with sludge. The movement is characterized by local struggles against intensive aquaculture farms. (**Sunita Narain** and the Centre for Science and Environment (CSE))
 3. The most influential part of the environmental movement in India is the **anti-dam** movement. Dam creation has been thought of as **a way for India to catch up with the West** by connecting to the [power grid] with giant dams, coal or oil-powered plants, or nuclear plants.
 4. **Jhola Aandolan** a mass movement is conducting as fighting against **polythene carry bags** uses and promoting cloth/jute/paper carry bags to protect environment & nature.
 5. Activists in the Indian environmental movement consider **global warming, sea levels rising, and glaciers retreating decreasing the amount of water flowing into streams** to be the biggest challenges for them to face in the early twenty first century.

Examples:

- **Chipko, Narmada Bachao Andolan**
- Koel-Karo Andolan - Koel-Karo movement in Jharkhand is a movement of Munda, Oraon, and other adivasis against the construction of two big dams of a hydroelectric project planned on the South Koel and Karo rivers.
- Mitti Bachao Andolan: The Mitti Bachao Andolan was started in the year 1977. The movement was against waterlogging and salinity caused by the Tawa Dam in Madhya Pradesh. The Campaign mobilized local farmers to demand compensation for the lands affected. (Where: Tawa Dam, MP. Why: Salinity because of water Logging)

The Reasons For Emergence Of Environmental Movements In India?

Think on the lines of PESTEL

Political Reasons

Primary Issues:

- Displacement
 - Promoting industrialization at the cost of people's discontent.
1. After independence in 1947 --> it was **assumed** that the **new government** which was **more aware** of the Indian problems and was equally concerned for the people would definitely **seek to eradicate** all problems.
 2. Observations of industrializations raised hopes. But the government policies focused **only for industrialization without looking at the environment and equal sharing of natural resources**.
 3. **Displacement of people**
 1. Lot of such **displacement of people due to large projects** such as dams like Bhakra – Nangal and many others.
 2. These policies pushed the **local people on the edges**. **More often than not**, the agents of resource intensification are given **preferential treatment by the states through the grant of generous long leases over mineral or fish stocks**, e.g., or the provision of **raw materials at an enormously subsidised prices**, with the **injustice** so compounded **local communities** at the receiving end of this process have **no recourse except direct actions**, resisting both the state and out side exploiters through a variety of protest **techniques**.
 3. These **new struggles** are waged **over gifts of nature** such as forests, and waters, gifts that are coveted by all but **increasingly monopolized** by a few.

Economic Reasons

Control Over Natural Resources

1. Control over natural resources is an important reason for emergence of environmental movement in India.
2. Some good examples of these kinds of movements are like Chipko and N.B.A.
3. In the **first case**, the reason for conflict was **control over forest**; whereas, in the **second** the reason was **control over water**.

Chipko Movement

1. The movement started in the **Garhwal Himalaya** in April 1973. Between 1973 and 1980, over a dozen instances were recorded where, through **an innovative technique of protest**, illiterate peasants, men, women and children- **threatened to hug forest trees** rather than allow them to be logged for export.
2. **Notably** the **peasants were not interested in saving the trees per se**, **but** in using **their produce for agricultural and household requirements**. (Sustenance, survival)
3. In **later years**, however the movement **turned its attention to** broader **ecological concerns**, such as the **collective protection and management** of forest, and the **diffusion of renewable energy technologies**.

Success of Chipko inspired many other movements:

- Most of these conflicts have pitted rich against poor:
 - Logging companies against hill villagers
 - Dam builders against forest tribal communities
 - Multinational corporations deploying trawlers against traditional fisher folk in small boats.
- One important factor is that those **poor people** are **solely dependent upon** those **natural resources** for their survival hood.
- **So, the changes in control of resources** directly **hampers** their **subsistence** economy due to which their survival hood came in danger.
- Therefore, the **protest** of the people rise against those outsiders, which had **ultimately taken the shape of environmental movement** in many instances.

Socio-economic Reasons

1. Most of these **areas are tribal dominated**. (Niyamgiri [Mining hurts our God])
2. These people have **strong beliefs** regarding their forests, land and water.
3. At the same time they are also **totally dependent** upon these resources for their survival hood.
4. The idea that **their lack of voice and state's apathy** will **ultimately** have to lead them to **a final recourse, which is the direct movement** against those people who were harnessing those resources.

Environmental Concerns because of Technology

Examples where Environmental Degradation/Destruction by a project leads to collateral damage for the surrounding communities:

1. Power Plants' (example Kundankulam's) **warm water affects fishes** in the areas where waste water is discharged.
2. **Pollution and fly-ash** due to thermal power plants impacts the nearby farms and soil.
3. **Eutrophication** in nearby water bodies because of farm run-offs.
4. **Silent Spring** (landmark Book by Rachel Carson): **Pesticides** have detrimental effects on the environment. That, these are more properly termed "**biocides**" because their effects are rarely limited to solely targeting pests.

Environmental Awareness And Media

1. The spread of environmental awareness and media has also played pivotal role in **emergence of environmental movement**.
2. **People were previously unaware** of the importance of the environment. But as the environmental awareness increased due various reasons people started protecting their environment.
3. Some **local movements** have emerged to protect the purity of different rivers (such as Ganga, Yamuna, Narmada).
4. The **greening of many Indian cities** also comes under this category.
5. The **Bhagidari movement of Delhi** is a good example of this kind of environmental movement.

6. **Media** has also played an important role in **sustaining these movements**.
7. **Role of international organisations and reports** in **highlighting and simplifying** the impact of these movements making it mass based

Ethnicity Movements

Ethnicity And Identity Movements

Definition:

How an individual identifies itself with the group or society, based on

- **Language, region, religion, caste, history**
- **Tradition** when followed from generation to generation **becomes ethnic identity**.
- **T.K. Oommen** opines that the ethnic group is a group of people who share a **common history, tradition, language and lifestyle, but are uprooted** from and/or **unattached to a homeland**.
- Ethnicity is a processes which **creates a sense of ethnic consciousness** among the members of an ethnic group and **mobilizes** the members of same caste, language and religion **to articulate their economic and political interest**.
- **International Encyclopedia of Social Sciences** defines ethnic group as:
- ‘**a distinct category of the population in a larger society whose culture is usually different from its own**’.
- The **members** of such a group **are, or feel themselves, or are thought to be, bound together by common ties** of race or nationality or culture’.
- **They form their group when they are denied their rights**, liberties and equality by the majority group.
- The members are physically and socially isolated from the larger community.
- **Max Weber** writes: “ethnic groups are those human groups that entertain a **subjective belief in their common descent** because of **similarities of physical type or of customs or both**, or because of **memories of colonization or migration**; this belief must be **important for the propagation of group formation**; conversely, it **does not matter whether or not an objective blood relationship exists**.”
- Ghosh (2003) defines Ethnicity as “**the process of formation and reformation of consciousness of identity** (real or supposed) in terms of **one or more socialcultural-political symbols** of domination/subjugation of a group(s) or community by another that emerge out of the processes of assimilation, acculturation, interaction, competition and conflict”.

Ethnic movements: Mobilisation based on ethnic identities.

- Ethnicities then become a **source of nationalism**. (Khalistan movement, Dravid movement)
- While **ethnicity** is a somewhat **individualistic** source of identity, **Nationalism** is a **collective** source of “we” feeling.
- In India, we witness both real and imagined ethnicity.
 - Real : Comes naturally
 - Imagined : People made to Believe
 - Yadav’s genealogy to lord Krishna, glorious past

Ethnicity Movements – Reasons

1. **Threat perception** – Naga ethnic movement
2. **Insecurity** - Assam movement (Illegal migrants from Bangladesh)
3. **Discrimination** – Dravid Movement
4. **Marginalization** – Gorkhaland Ethnic movement
5. **Contradictory** ideologies – Khalistan movement

Ethnicity Movements – Types

Paul Brass: 3 types of ethnic movements

1. **Intra-ethnicity** : Shia-Sunni, Protestant-Catholic (not very prominent in India)
2. **Inter-ethnicity** : Nationalistic movements (J&K : Political competition between Muslims & Kashmiri pandits)
3. **State vs Ethnic group** : Most common in India. Multiple ethnic groups still not merged as one nation. (E.g. Nagas)

Types of Ethnic Movement in India

In India: Ethnic movements (Paul Brass)

1. **Autonomy** movements (Ladakh, Gorkhaland)
2. **Separate** state (Punjabi subba, Telengana)
3. **Secessionist** (Threat to national integration) (often violent) (Khalistan, Dravidian, Naga)

Some important Ethnic Movements in India

Let's discuss some important Ethnic Movements in India as given in IGNOU

Ethnic Movement in Punjab:

- The Khalistan movement was carried out by a section of Sikhs **to create a separate Sikh country**.
- The movement got **intensified in the Punjab in 1970s** and continued till the early 1990s.
- A group of Sikh leaders **started demanding more autonomy** for the state before the Central government. They demanded a separate country, Khalistan.
- In June 1984, due to violence the Indian Government ordered **a military operation**, Operation Blue Star to clear Harmandir Sahib, Amritsar and thirty other Gurdwaras (Sikh Place of Worship) of people in conflict with law and were resorting to violence in Gurudwaras.
- **Indira Gandhi**, the then Indian Prime Minister was **assassinated** by her two Sikh bodyguards which resulted in thousands of **Sikhs being massacred in 1984 in anti-Sikh riots**.
- **Subsequently Punjab insurgency** saw several secessionist militant groups becoming active in Punjab, supported by a section of the Sikh movement. Indian state controlled the insurgency in the early 1990s.

Ethnic Movement in North-East:

- There are several ethnic movements in the North-east region.
- In this region **large number of tribal people have not been assimilated** with the mainstream culture **due to physical inaccessibility, socio-linguistic and religious distinctiveness**.
- **Majority** of them are converted to **Christianity**.
- The first tribal group, the **Nagas** began a **movement for an independent state**. After a long struggle they succeeded in creating a separate state as **Nagaland in 1963**.
- Similarly, second ethnic problem with tribals of North East is that of **Mizos**. Mizos also continued their struggle to get autonomy by establishing a separate state following which Mizoram's status of Union territory was changed to statehood.

Ethnic Movement in Gorkhaland:

- The recent ethnic movement in India is the Gorkhaland movement in Darjeeling which demands a separate state of Gorkhaland.
- **Subash Ghising** formed the **Gorkha National Liberation Front** in 1980. Ghising's main demand was for **a new state of Gorkhaland for India's Nepali-speaking citizens**. He resorted to violence and scare tactics. He also planned to **create a "Greater Nepal"**. This movement was supported by Nepal with the demands that Indian-origin people get Nepali citizenship in the Terai.
- Bimal Gurung, a leader of the Gorkha Jana Mukti Morcha has been trying to ignite Gorkha anger and emotions to achieve the goal of a separate state.
- He propagates the that Gorkahaland is our birth right. We will not budge one step from this demand.

Dravidian Movement:

- The **Self respect movement** or Dravidian Movement began in 1925 under the maverick leadership of **E.V Ramasamy**. The objective of this movement is **to achieve a society where backward castes have equal human rights, and encouraging backward castes to have self-respect**.
- The two major concepts of Self-Respect Movement were **Anti-Brahmanism and Self-Respect Marriages**.
- The **Justice Party** was formed in the Madras Presidency of British India in **1916**. It mainly focused on **removing Brahmins from the higher positions**. Gradually, the non-Brahmin replaced the Brahmins in every sphere and destroyed the monopoly over education and the administrative services which the Brahmins had previously held.
- In 1947, when India attained independence, Periyar called for members of the **Dravida Kazhagam to boycott the celebrations**. According to him, the **Indian National Congress was dominated by Brahmins**. He **predicted** that an **independent India** would bring South Indians, especially **Tamils**, **under the dominance of Brahmins and North Indians**. The leadership of the movement argued that **imposition of the North Indian Hindi language, Brahminical Hindu religion and Aryan culture** were detrimental to the development of the Dravidian identity.

Ethnicity in Assam:

- The conflict between **indigenous Bodo tribals and ethnic Bengali Muslim settlers** began in Assam in 1952, with subsequent violent clashes occurring in 1979- 1985, 1991-1994, and 2008.

- In 2012 the riots and violence between Bodos and Bangladeshi Muslims erupted in the districts of Kokhraj, Chirang, and Dhubri.
- In this violence 77 people were killed and over 400,000 displaced from the violence, including both Bodos and Bangladeshi Muslims.
- The Bodos resented the Bangladeshi immigration due to the consequent loss of land and cultural identity. After the riots there have been widespread protests across the northeast demanding “early detection and deportation” of illegal Bangladeshi immigrants.
- The Bodos have established relationship with other indigenous tribal communities in Assam to collectively address the issue. Similarly the All Bodoland Muslim Student’s Union (ABMSU) has threatened to declare jihad and take up arms against the state.
- **National Register of Citizens (NRC)** is a register prepared after the conduct of the Census of 1951 in respect of each village, showing the houses or holdings in a serial order and indicating against each house or holding the number and names of persons staying therein.
- The NRC was published only once in 1951 and since then, it has not been updated for the nation until recently. It has been **updated in Assam only for now** and the government plans to update it nationally as well.

Identity Movements

Identity Movements - Definition

Identity is a flexible concept derived either from ascription or achievement.

Identity Movements - Types

Wilbert Moore

- In traditional societies identities are drawn from **primordial institutions** (caste, religion, race) but **modern societies** identities are drawn from one’s **class or occupation**.

<u>Societies</u>		<u>Identity</u>
Tradition	→	Primordial (caste, religion, race)
Modern	→	Class (Occupation)

Identity Movements - Schools of thought

2 Schools of Thought

1. **Modernisation theory** : with the rise of modern societies **common identities will be developed** in terms of citizenship, nationalism, and patriotism.
2. **Primordialists** : primordial identities **never die** out at any point of time they are **simply hidden** in modern society.

Identity Movements - Indian Experience

Dipankar Gupta

He says that identity focused movements can be **understood by time frames** during independence.

Initially **Religious** Then **Linguistic** Then **Tribal**.

- **Religious:** Movement to creation of Pakistan on the basis of religious identity
- **Linguistic:** Movement to create of separate state of Tamil Nadu on the basis of linguistic identity
- **Tribal:** Movement to create Nagaland the basis of Tribal identity.

During 1940s and 1950 these three movements used language, religion and ethnicity as a foundation to the identity-based movements.

Over a period of time it was believed that these Identity Focussed Movements **will die out by the acceleration of democracy**.

It was expected that Democracy will weed out identity movements.

But still we have:

- Movements in NE, Khalistan, Gorkhaland.

But Identity Focussed Movements in **North East India** manifesting as **Naga, Mizo Kasi movements** gave rise to creation of:

- **New status**
- **Special central assistance**
- **Finally, gratification of political dreams of local population.**

Ethnicity And Identity Movements

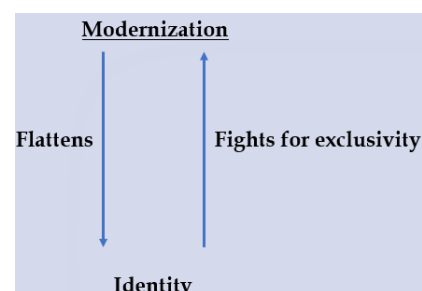
- During 1980s Identity Focussed Movements got a new dimension in a form of Khalistan movement which is not a manifestation of economic deprivatisation.
- After 1980s the other forms of Identity Focussed Movements articulated in India includes linguists movement in Assam started by AGP (Assam Gana Parishad, NRC issue) what consequently got transformed into a political party and Gorkhaland movement by Subhash Ghising.

Perspectives on Identity Movements

1. Identity Focussed Movements may be **driven by Protection, glorification and revitalisation** of cultural identity. [Ahmadiyya Movement]
2. Identity Focussed Movements may be driven by **gratification of community interest** or it may **intend to replace old order by new order** bringing new dominant class against old dominant class.

Ashis Nandy's Perspective on Identity Movements

- Advocates that modernisation tries to flatten culture and communities of the group. But every culture wants to retain to exclusivity and uniqueness.
- Therefore, cultural revivalism is taking place. Religion, language, tribalism, and traditional culture are re emerging as prime source of identity for men today.
- Hence, the more India goes for modernization, the more Identity Focussed Movements are getting momentum.



- Remember, Ethnocentrism (given by WG Sumner) : It is the evaluation of other cultures according to preconceptions originating in the standards and customs of one's own culture.

T.N. Madan's Perspective on Identity Movements

- Considers that **in India traditional identity cannot be forgotten due to the influence of modernity** because **dress, food, inter relationship, behavioral patterns** are driven by culture.
- Therefore, **more India goes modern more elements of tradition will enter into the life of man from backdoors** resulting in **glorification of traditional identity by modern man of India** who is a part of Indian politics, bureaucracy or academics and that is testimony to the fact that **Indian modernity is more Indian than modern.**

Other Perspective on Identity Movements

Samuel P. Huntington (Clash of Civilisations)

- War of ideologies is over.
- All future wars -> based on identity.

TN Madan + Ashis Nandy

- Both **criticise secularization** & elimination of Identity movements.

Identity Movements - Conclusion

Identity movements attempt for

1. Protection
2. Glorification
3. Revitalization

of one's identity.

Anti-Conversion Laws

History of Anti-Conversion Laws

- Anti-conversion legislation originated in colonial India, when it was implemented by princely states during the British period in the 1930s and 1940s.
- These first anti-conversion laws were enacted to preserve and protect the princely states' cultural identities from British missionaries.
- Colonial administrators encouraged Christian missionaries, whose main ideology was of 'assimilation' (especially tribal), albeit into Christianity.
- Several princely states enacted anti-conversion legislation, such as the Raigarh State Conversion Act of 1936 and the Udaipur State Anti-Conversion Act of 1946, and several other states, including Bikaner, Patna, and Jodhpur, followed suit.

Anti-Conversion Laws Post-Independence

- Following India's independence, Parliament introduced a number of anti-conversion bills, none of which were passed.
- The Indian Conversion (Regulation and Registration) Bill was introduced in the parliament in 1954, with the goal of requiring missionaries to be licenced and conversions to be registered with government officials.
- The Backward Communities (Religious Protection) Bill was introduced in 1960 to prevent Hindu community members from converting to 'non-Indian religions.'
- The Freedom of Religion Bill was introduced in parliament in 1979 with the intention of "officially prohibiting inter-religious conversion."
- The Union Law Ministry stated in 2015 that a national law against forced and fraudulent conversions could not be enacted because law-and-order is a State subject under the Constitution.
- State governments, on the other hand, have the authority to enact such legislation.

States on Anti-Conversion Laws

- Anti-conversion legislation is currently the responsibility of state governments.
- The law is intended to prevent religious conversions, and it is currently in effect in eight states.
- Arunachal Pradesh, Gujarat, Odisha, Himachal Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, and Uttarakhand are the states where the law is enacted.
- With a few exceptions, the structure and content of the laws are nearly identical.
- The common goal of the laws is to prevent people from being converted to another religion through force or enticement.
- If the targeted member belongs to a scheduled caste or tribe, the penalties for violating the laws range from fines to imprisonment.

Reasons for conversion:

- Inter faith marriages where women usually converts into the religion of her husband.
- For attaining secular mobility (MN Srinivas).
- E.g. - mass conversions to Buddhism under the leadership of Ambedkar.

Common Characteristics of the various State Laws

- Certain characteristics of state laws are common.
- While all states have laws prohibiting conversions by force, fraud, or allurement, and the inducement of money, only Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, and Uttar Pradesh have laws prohibiting conversion through marriage.
- Except in Arunachal Pradesh, advance notice by the priest or "religious convertor" as well as the converted person is required in all states.
- The Arunachal Pradesh law is regarded as the most lenient in terms of the requirement for notice of conversion.
- Uttar Pradesh has the strictest provisions, requiring a person who wishes to undergo a conversion to give the district authorities a 60- day notice. The notice must be given one month in advance by the priest.
- Odisha and Madhya Pradesh, which have the oldest laws, also have the shortest prison sentences for forced conversion – one year.
- Forcible conversion is punishable by up to five years in prison in Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand.
- In all states, the punishment is harsher in the case of a minor.

Points in favour of Anti Conversion laws

- Article 25 of the Indian Constitution grants citizens of all religious faiths the freedom to profess, practise, and propagate their faith in a way that does not disrupt public order and has no negative impact on public health and morality.
- Article 25 of the Indian Constitution is a fundamental guarantee of human rights that cannot be subverted or misinterpreted in any way.
- The anti-conversion laws in India must be viewed in this light.
- Anti-conversion legislation is based on the premise that forced or induced conversions occur and must be avoided.
- Such laws can aid in preventing religious organisations from coercing or inducing people to convert to any religion, including Hinduism, Islam, and Christianity.
- These kinds of laws are essential in a pluralistic society.
- To make conversion for the sole purpose of marriage illegal (Allahabad High Court said conversion for sole purpose of marriage is not acceptable)
- To reduce a minor girl's vulnerability and to thwart deceptive intentions.
- The law will put a stop to those outfits that have malevolent intentions to entrench and disrupt society's social harmony under the guise of marriage.

- Such laws are not anti-interfaith marriage because they do not prohibit conversion, but rather keep a check on deceptive conversions performed under coercion.
- The Special Marriage Act allows two people to legally marry through a civil contract and there are no religious rites that must be performed under the Act.

Other Reasons for increasing adoption of Anti conversion law

- Fear of being demographically marginalised (due to reducing numerical strength) among communities due to increasing conversions to other religions.
- There is an allegation that these laws are aimed at intimidating minority religious communities due to vested political or other interest.

Points in opposition of Anti Conversion laws

- The laws can be used as a tool to violate the fundamental rights granted by Articles 21 and 25.
- Article 21 of the constitution guarantees the right to marry the person of one's choice.
- There is an inherent bias against Hindu-Muslim marriages, especially when the groom is a Muslim and the bride a Hindu.
- There have been numerous instances of violence on this account
- Article 25 provides freedom of conscience, including the practise and conversion of one's chosen religion, as well as the freedom to follow no religion at all.
- These laws go against the Supreme Court's decision.
- Because it employs words like "undue influence," "allurement," and "coercion," the laws are vague and subject to interpretation.
- There isn't enough evidence to back up the claim of forced conversions.
- Citing a specific group of people as a potential threat will lead to increased marginalisation and vilification of that group.

Arnold Rose - minority are thought of by others as differentiated group with negative connotations.

- Anti-interfaith marriage as a concept will be institutionalised and given legal legitimacy under such laws, thus distorting the social fabric.
- Since most family laws require parties to the marriage to belong to the same religion, conversion of either party to the marriage becomes inevitable.

Westermarck - marriage is rooted in the family rather than the family in the marriage

- Given the unequal power dynamics that exist in most marital relationships (including choice marriages), coupled with the patriarchal emphasis on marriage for women, women invariably convert for marriage.

Tanya Evans - Woman is considered as the property of the husband

- Under these circumstances, performing a marriage through the family law governing either party is seen as a shorter and easier route for the couples as compared to a civil marriage under the SMA.
- Criminalisation of these marriages emboldens right-wing vigilante groups as well as the police and judicial apparatus (*as per French Political Scientist Christophe Jaffrelot 2020*).

- Under the garb of protecting women from forced conversion, women choosing inter-religious marriages become vulnerable to attacks and intimidation by vigilante groups coupled with the might of the state, quite often at behest of the woman's disgruntled family.
- This is because of the predominant model of gendered honour where women's honour is presumed to be associated with her sexuality and body.
- Her honour thus naturally gets connected with her family's honour.
- Violating it can also lead to honour killings.
- These laws facilitates increased policing and surveillance by the state, infringing on the constitutionally guaranteed fundamental right to freedom of religion and privacy, which are intrinsic to life and liberty.

Roger Scurton - Democracy alone cannot lead to personal and political freedom and the institutions of civil society also needs to be strengthened.

- The laws treats women as a homogeneous group of vulnerable and ignorant beings who are easily "allured" and coerced by men from other religious communities.

Indira Jai Singh- All laws of entitlements are based on patriarchy than gender equality.

- Such laws can also create communal tensions and social discord and restrict the freedom of marginal groups.
- Also such laws indirectly polices intermingling of castes and faiths which was cited as a way towards secularisation by GS Ghurye.

Mass Conversion

- One of the biggest mass conversion in the Modern History of India took place in the 1956 when Dr. B.R. Ambedkar with his lakhs of follower converted to Buddhism.
- Mass conversion is taking place in small number.

Ghanshyam Shah called such movement as "Alternate Movement" (The other type of movement is "Reformative Movement")

- The ordinance (The Uttar Pradesh Prohibition of Unlawful Conversion of Religion Ordinance, 2020), passed by the State Cabinet, also lays down strict action against mass conversions, which would invite a jail term of not less than three years and up to 10 years and a fine of ₹50,000.

Previous Orders of the Judiciary related to it.

Lata Singh Case, 1994

- The court ruled that India is undergoing a "crucial transformation period," and that the Constitution will only remain strong if we recognise our culture's multiplicity and plurality.
- Rather than resorting to violence or intimidation, relatives who are dissatisfied with a loved one's inter-religious marriage may choose to "break off social connections."

Hadiya Judgement 2017

- The central aspect of identity includes matters of dress and food, ideas and ideologies, love and partnership.

- Neither the states nor the law can impose a partner selection or limit the free choice of every individual in these matters.

K.S. Puttaswamy or 'privacy' Judgement 2017

- Autonomy of the individual was the ability to make decision in vital matters of concerns to one person's own life.

Sone Gerry Case, 2018

- The Supreme Court warned the judges against acting as "super guardians," succumbing to the mother's sentiments or the father's egotism.

Salamat Ali Ansari and Priyanka Kharwar case of Allahabad High Court 2020

- The right to choose a partner or live with a person of one's choice was a fundamental right of every citizen to life and liberty (Article 21).
- It also declared that previous court rulings upholding the idea of religious conversion for marriage as unacceptable and not good in law.

C 6

Population Dynamics

Syllabus

- a) Population size, growth, composition and distribution.
- b) Components of population growth: birth, death, migration.
- c) Population policy and family planning.
- d) Emerging issues: ageing, sex ratios, child and infant mortality, reproductive health.

Population Size, Growth, Composition And Distribution

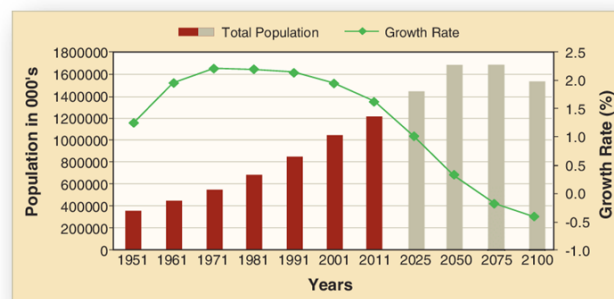
Population Size of India

India the second most populous country after China.

And will surpass China's population by 2023 [UN Report 2022]

As per Census 2011:

- India's population - 1.21 billion.
- ~17% global population in 2.4% world area.
- Growth rate are not always high
- 1901-51 ~ 1.33% per year
- 1911-21 = -0.03% (influenza epidemic)



Population Growth in India

Substantially rose after British rule ended

During 1961-81 = 2.2% growth rate

Since then decreasing...

(For religious demographics, still 2001 census is used)

- Hindus - 80.5%.
- Muslims - 13.4% etc.
- Sex ratio is slightly improved.
- Roughly, every year total population of Malaysia and Australia is added to India's population.
- The problem of population growth is really a serious one as slow growth in employment opportunities and other resources cannot keep up with the rapid increase in population.

Population Size: Composition

Composition

- **Gender Wise** - The sex composition of India population shows that there are fewer females than males. [Son-Meta Preference -Economic Survey 2018]
- **Age-Group Wise** - Nearly 40 % of India's population consist of those below 15 your of age and about 5-6% of 60 years and above.

Population Size, Growth, Composition and Distribution

- This shows that nearly **half of India's population is dependent** upon those who are 'Earners'. The dependency of such a large part of the population **adversely effects economy of country and social development**.
- **Saving and investment** become almost **negligible**.

Components of Population Growth: Birth, Death, Migration

Components Of Population Growth

a) Demographic

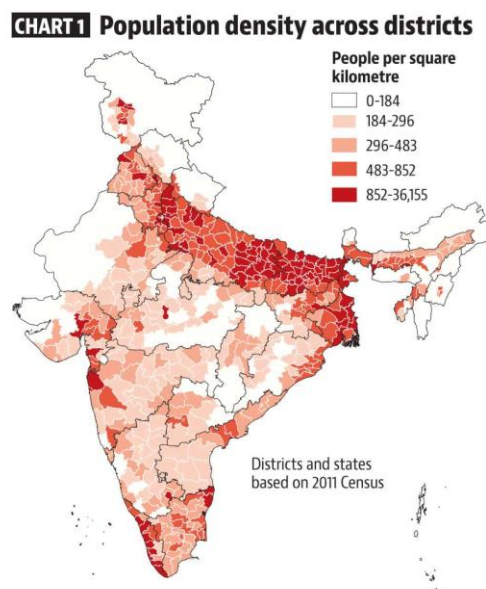
- Natural Growth (Birth rate, Death rate)
- Artificial (In migration, out migration, War etc.)

b) Natural Components

- Soil Fertility - Sheltering near fertile land [**Ganga Plains**]
- Environment - Harsh environment limits survivability
- Geographic Region (Push-Pull Factor) - Desert & Mountains - Low population

c) Socio-Cultural Components

- Conscious Restrictions (late marriage because of education, employment, aspirations)
- Unconscious Restrictions (Incest Taboo, widow Remarriage protest, Taboo on grand parents procreating)



Before 1931 both death rates and birth rates were high whereas **after this the death rates dropped sharply**.

The principal reasons are :

1. Control over famines and epidemic diseases. The later cause was the most important as Healthcare and Nutritional intake improved.
2. Lack of adequate means of transportation and communication.
3. **Amartya Sen** - famines were not necessarily due to fall in food grains production they were also caused by a failure of entitlements or the inability of people to buy or otherwise obtain food. (A,A,A)
4. Improvements in productivity of Indian agriculture.
5. Improved means of communication

6. More vigorous relief and preventive measures by the state.

Nevertheless, starvation deaths are still reported from some backward region of the country.

Global Hunger Index – India consistently a laggard.

The MNREGA, FSA, Mid-Day Meal are the amongst various state initiative to tackle the problem of hunger and starvation in rural areas.

Unlike the death rate, the birth rate has not registered a significant fall.

This is because –

1. The birth rate is social cultural phenomenon that is relatively slow to change.
2. By the large increased level of prosperity exerts a strong downward pull on the birth rate. (once infant mortality rates decline and there is an overall increase in level of education and awareness family size begins to fall.)
3. More working hands, because society is primarily agrarian
4. Less awareness about contraceptives.
5. High IMR led people to go for high birth rate
6. Taboo related to sterilization & abortions
[E.g. Vasectomy & Tubectomy]
7. 7. Even government allocate more fund towards female sterilization. – **Patriarchal mindset.**

Some Terms to Know

Age-specific Fertility Rate

- Age-specific fertility rate is the **annual number of births per woman in a particular age group** expressed **per 1000 women** in that age group.

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Total Fertility Rate

- TFR is the number of children a woman would have if she was subject to prevailing fertility rates at all ages from a single given year and survives throughout all her childbearing years.
- Its calculation assumes that there is no mortality.
- The total fertility rate (TFR) of a population is the average number of children that would be born to a woman over her lifetime if:
 - She was to experience the exact current age- specific fertility rates (ASFRs) through her lifetime
 - She was to live from birth until the end of her reproductive life.
- It is also called the fertility rate, absolute/ potential natality, period total fertility rate (PTFR), or total period fertility rate (TPFR).

World historical
TFR (1950–2015)
UN, average variant,

Years	TFR
1950–1955	4.96
1955–1960	4.89
1960–1965	5.03
1965–1970	4.92
1970–1975	4.46
1975–1980	3.87
1980–1985	3.6
1985–1990	3.44
1990–1995	3.02
1995–2000	2.75
2000–2005	2.63
2005–2010	2.57
2010–2015	2.52

Net Fertility Rate

- NFR is the number of daughters a woman would have in her lifetime if she were subject to **prevailing age-specific fertility and mortality rates** in the given year.
- When the NRR is exactly 1, then **each generation of women is exactly reproducing itself**.
- **NRR is particularly relevant where the number of male babies born is very high** due to gender imbalance and sex selection.

Gross Reproduction Rate

- GRR is the **average number of daughters a woman would have if she survived all of her childbearing years**, subject to the age-specific fertility rate and sex ratio at birth throughout that period.
- This rate is a **measure of replacement fertility if mortality is not in the equation**.

Birth Rate

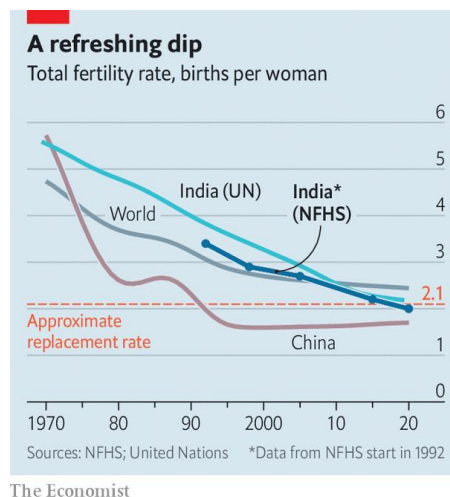
- BR in a period is the **total number of live births per 1,000 population divided by the length of the period in years**.
- Another term used interchangeably with 'birth rate' is **natality**.

Replacement-level fertility

- It is when Total fertility levels of **about 2.1 children** per woman.
- This value **represents the average number of children a woman would need to have to reproduce herself by bearing a daughter** who survives to childbearing age.
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- This value **represents the average number of children a woman would need to have to reproduce herself by bearing a daughter** who survives to childbearing age.
- If replacement level fertility is **sustained** over a sufficiently long period, **each generation will exactly replace itself** in the absence of migration.

Components Of Population Growth -Statistics

- **India's Total Fertility Rate (TFR) has declined** from 2.2 to 2.0 as per the fifth round of the National Family Health Survey (NFHS-5).
- According to the Sample Registration System (SRS) 2019, 13 states and two UTs have attained the replacement TFR of 2.1 and below.
- Replacement level TFR has been reported by Andhra Pradesh (1.5), Delhi (1.5), J&K (1.5), Punjab (1.5), TN (1.5), West Bengal (1.5), Himachal Pradesh (1.6), Kerala (1.6), Maharashtra (1.6), Telangana (1.6), Karnataka (1.7), Odisha (1.8) Uttarakhand (1.9), Gujarat (2.1) and Haryana (2.1).

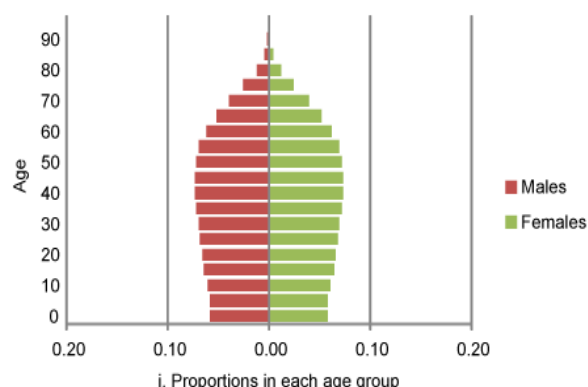


Components Of Population Growth

- There are very wide variations in the fertility rates across the state of India some states like Kerala and Tamil Nadu their fertility rate (TFR) is 1.6 and 1.8 respectively.
- This means that the every woman in Tamil Nadu produces only 1.8 children which is below the 'replacement level'.
- Some states notably Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan And Uttar Pradesh which still have very high TFR of 2.8 or more.

LOWEST FERTILITY RATE IN J&K

STATES	NFHS-5 2019-21	NFHS-4 2015-16	Reduction
Jammu & Kashmir	1.4	2.0	0.6
West Bengal	1.6	1.8	0.2
Delhi	1.6	1.8	0.2
Punjab	1.6	1.6	0.0
Andhra Pradesh	1.7	1.8	0.1
Himachal Pradesh	1.7	1.9	0.2
Karnataka	1.7	1.8	0.1
Maharashtra	1.7	1.9	0.2
Kerala	1.8	1.6	-0.2
Telangana	1.8	1.8	0.0
Chhattisgarh	1.8	2.2	0.4
Odisha	1.8	2.1	0.3
Tamil Nadu	1.8	1.7	-0.1
Assam	1.9	2.2	0.3
Gujarat	1.9	2.0	0.1
Haryana	1.9	2.1	0.2
Uttarakhand	1.9	2.1	0.2
Madhya Pradesh	2.0	2.3	0.3
Rajasthan	2.0	2.4	0.4
Jharkhand	2.3	2.6	0.3
Uttar Pradesh	2.4	2.7	0.3
Bihar	3.0	3.4	0.4
India	2.0	2.2	0.2



Causes Of High Birth Rate

Customs of early marriage

- It has been observed that persons who are married at an early age have more children.
- Laws have been made from time to time to stop the practice of child marriage it is illegal for a girl to marry before she attains the age of 18 years and for a boy the age of 21 year.
- Prohibition of Child Marriage (Amendment), Bill, 2021** seeks to increase the age of girl from 18 to 21 for marriage.

ILLITERACY

- Education of woman is very important. It has been found that the families of illiterate women have more children.
- Lack of Contraceptive knowledge

POVERTY

- For the poor people more children mean additional hands to earn. These children remain illiterate and unskilled labour throughout their life.

Causes Of High Birth Rate

Preference For Male Child:

- Son Meta-Preference [Eco. Survey, 2018]
- This kind of attitude is found not only in the illiterate family but also among the literates. The desire for a male child results in having more children, **exception** only is **Meghalaya** due to Matrilineal Society [NFHS-5]
- Rites & rituals in name of male child property intendance.

Unmanageable growth in population creates many problems

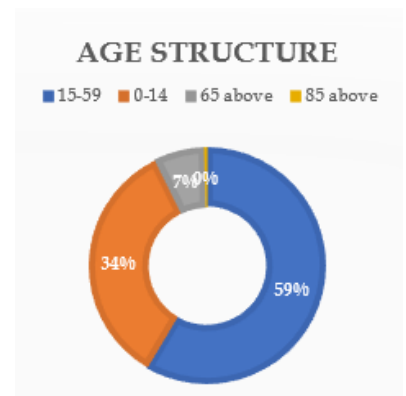
- The country cannot provide nutritious food to its people.
- Space and housing
- Unemployment grows
- Standard of living decline.
- Slum formation leads to sanitation issues, burden on healthcare system
- Increase in crime

The problem is more acute in the rural area where the majority of our people live.

Age Structure Of The Indian Population

Definition

- The age structure of the population refers to **the proportion of persons in different age groups relative to the total population.**
- The **structure changes in response to changes in levels of development and the average life expectancy.**



Overall Global Population Growth Model

In a country, initially

- **Lack of Medical** facilities
- Prevalence of **disease** and other factors make for a relatively short lifespan.
- **High infant and maternal mortality** rates also have an impact on the age structure.

With development

- **Quality of life improves** and with it the **life expectancy** also improves.
- **Relatively smaller proportions** of the population are found in the **younger** age groups and larger proportions in the older age groups this is also referred to as the ageing of the population.
- The **dependency ratio rises**. A rising dependency ratio is a **cause for worry** in countries that are facing an ageing population.
- On the other hand a **falling dependency ratio** can be a source of economic growth and prosperity due to larger portion of workers relative to the non workers.
- This is referred to as the **demographic dividend**. However this **benefit is temporary**.

Malthusian Population Growth Model

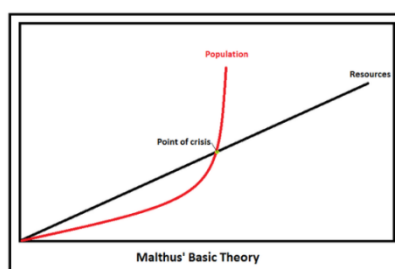
Thomas Malthus was active in 1800s.

- His Essay on the Principle of Population
- **Theory of quantitative development of Human Population.**
 - Malthus regarded ideals of future improvement of humanity with scepticism, considering that throughout history a segment of every human population seemed relegated to poverty.



Malthusian Theory on Population

- Malthus explained the phenomenon by pointing out that **population growth generally preceded expansion of the population's resources**.
- He proposed that the population grows much rapidly than the the resources.
- Malthus's theory of population is based on the following **two postulates**:
 - Food is essential for man's existence.
 - The passion between the sexes is necessary and will remain nearly in its present state.



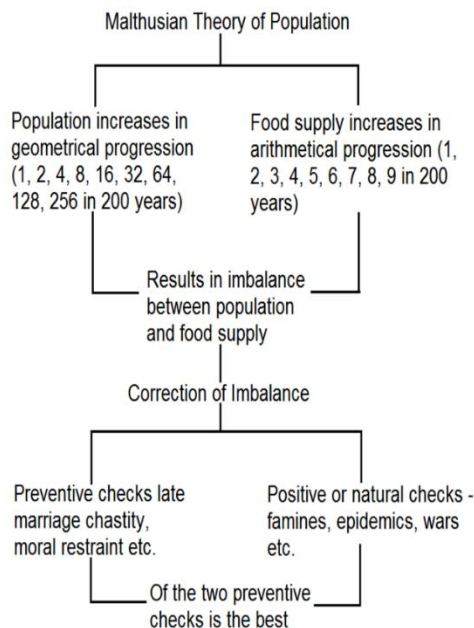
Primary theory: the axioms

- Population increases in **Geometric progression**
- On the other hand, the food supply(subsistence) increases in **Arithmetic progression**.

Secondary theory: the consequences

- In all societies, even those that are most vicious, there is a constant effort to increase of population.

- This constant effort as constantly tends to subject the lower classes of the society to distress and to prevent any great permanent amelioration of their condition.



Criticism of Malthusian theory

- Abundance is rising much faster than population. Hence, Superabundance is the title of **Marian Tupy and Gale Pooley's new book**.
- Economist **Julian Simon**, who realised that human ingenuity is the greatest resource, not land, food, or minerals.
 - Short-term scarcities will constantly occur, induce **more investment and research into alternatives**, and hence increase supply, replacing scarcity by abundance.
 - This is how doomsayers like Malthus are constantly disproved
 - **What we need is not less population but better governance.**
- Desire to have children cannot be mixed with passion and desire for sex.
- Population has rarely grown by geometric progression and similarly production of food rarely multiplied in arithmetic progression.
- Malthus could not think of the use of contraceptives as an effective preventive check.
- Ignoring the role of changing technology and changes in the socioeconomic set up of a society.



Neo-Malthusian:

- Population control is inevitable.
- Disagree with Malthus that factors like war and famine are the key to population control.

Marxian Argument

- Pressure of population on the means of production = the pressure of the means of production on population.
- **Reserve army of labour**

Indian Situation

- Supreme universality of institution of marriage and the **Total fertility rate of certain states is as high as 3.2**. Which is way beyond the replacement level rate of 2.1.

Population control: Bihar vs Uttar Pradesh

Use of condoms has led Uttar Pradesh to overtake Bihar in controlling population growth even as both were at par in terms of total fertility rate just 14 years ago

CHART 1 UP fared better than Bihar in controlling population



Solutions Proposed

- Malthus also saw that societies, through history, had experienced, at one time or another, epidemics, famines, or wars that masked the fundamental problem of populations overstressing their resource limitations.
- **Positive checks** – War, Famine, Epidemics(Covid), Natural Disaster.
- **Preventive Checks** –
 - Low birth rate.
 - Abortion,
 - Birth control,
 - Prostitution,
 - Postponement of marriage, and

Celibacy are some ways

India's Population Growth Model

India has a very young population. In future

- **Age composition** of the Indian population is expected to **change significantly** in the next **2 decades**.
- Most of this change will be at the **2 ends** of the spectrum as **0 -14 age group will reduce** its share by about 11 % while the **60 + age group will increase** its share by about 5 %.
- Right now, it needs to consciously exploit its demographic dividend through appropriate policies.

Does the Changing Age Structure Offer A Demographic Dividend for India?

- It is estimated that even post 2020s the average Indian is still be **close to 29 years of age**.

- It is **very young** compared with average ages of more than 37 in China and 48 in Japan.
- A large and growing labour force which can **deliver unexpected benefits** in terms of **growth and prosperity**.
- Increase in the proportion of workers relative to non workers in the population.
- Changes in the its structure due to the demographic transition **lowers the dependency ratio** thus creating the **potential for generating growth**.

Demographic Dividend – Challenges

- This potential can be converted into actual growth only if the rise in the working age group accompanied by **increasing levels of education and employment**.
- If they **remain unemployed** then they are unable to at all and become **dependents rather than earners**.
- Multiple **reports reveal sharp fall in the rate of employment generation, creation of new jobs** across both rural and urban area.
- The rate of growth of employment in the 15 to 30 age groups which stood at around 2.4 % of a year between 1987 and 1994. It fell to 0.7 for rural men and 0.3 % for urban men during 1994 to 2004.

Two-Child Policy

- India is set to **overtake China** as the world's most populous country
- **Overstressed Infrastructure and Urban Centres:** Excess population is creating overloaded infrastructure.
- **Demographic Curse:** In absence of enough skilling resources, the booming population is bound to be a disaster with more mouths to feed in comparison to the productive hands.

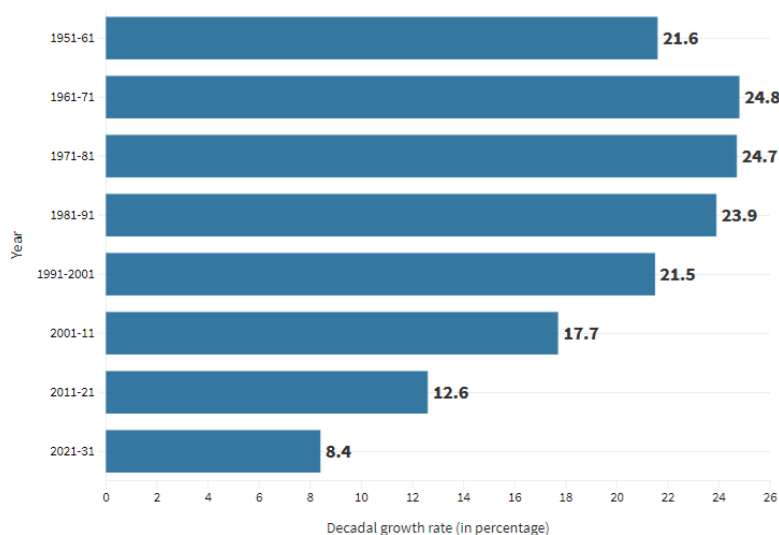
History of Two-Child Policy

- The **debate** for 2 child policy started **even before the start of the 1st Lok Sabha**.
- During the **Emergency** imposed by the Indira Gandhi government in the 1970s, the **two-child policy got an aggressive push**.
- During the 1980s:
 - "**Hum Do Hamare Do**" (We Two Ours Two) was popularised through the mass campaign.
 - The **National Health Policy** was adopted.
- **India** became a **signatory** to the **International Conference on Population and Development Declaration** in 1994.
- The **National Population Policy** came in 2000 with the **long-term objective** of stabilizing the population by 2045.

Criticisms of Two-Child Policy

- **Mahatma Gandhi** was opposed to any policy **which forced people** to have only two children. He advocated **attitudinal change**.
- **Religious Prism**: Some people give this policy **a religious tone pitching it as detrimental to religious rights and beliefs**.
- **No Need of 2 Child Policy**: As per NFHS-5, the **use of contraceptives is on the rise** with the rural-urban gap narrowing. This is a clear sign of the **efficacy of awareness campaigns** over statutory (legal) actions.
- Already the **fertility rate is declining** in India from 3 children per woman in 2000 to slightly above the replacement level of 2.1 per woman.
- **China is also seen to be abandoning** its 2-Child norm owing to multiple shortfalls of the policy.
- **Ageing Population**: Now an aging population can be seen in China due to the forced one-child policy.
- **Against the Right to choose and Dignified life (Article 21)**: Sometimes due to failure of contraceptives, a third child may be born.
- **Accidental Deaths**: Many acts passed by states don't consider child mortality in mind. It **may render parents childless** without any option.
- **Disability and Divorcee**: The complex **social stigmas around adoption, disability, and divorcees** may create complications in the implementation of 2 child policy.
- **Rural illiterate old-age persons**: The capability to administer has nothing to do with the number of children, much like the educational criteria. Hence, it can be a hurdle in the election of a popular and efficient person having more than two children.

The **Centre Government** has also **told the Supreme Court** in the past that it was **against coercing couples** into having a "certain number of children" in a bid to curb population explosion.



Source: Report of the technical group on population projections, Census of India

Migration

The vast majority of the population of India has always lived in the rural areas. Around 65 % of our population still lives in villages.

(About 89% at the beginning of the twenty first century)

Causes of Migration

- Processes of **modern development** ensure that the economic and social **significance of the agrarian-rural way of life decline** and it is true in India as well.
- The relative economic value of what they produce has **fallen drastically**. (Agriculture used to be by far the largest contributor to the country total economic production but today it **only contributes about one-fourth of the GDP.**)
- **Mass media and communication channels** are now bringing **images of urban lifestyles and patterns of consumption** into the rural area.
- **Mass transit and mass communication** are bridging the gap between the rural and urban areas.
- Migration is **no more a taboo** now.
- Accelerated by the **continuous decline of common property resources** like ponds forest and grazing lands (turned into private property or are exhausted).
- **Have to buy many things** in the market that they **used to get free** like fuel fodder or supplementary food items.
- Opportunities for earning **cash income limited** in the villages.
- Also **fragmenting of land**.
- **Shrinking of land holdings**.
- The city may also be preferred for social reasons specially the **relative anonymity** it offers.
 - For the socially oppressed groups like the schedule caste and scheduled tribes.
 - Also, allow the **poorer section of the socially dominant rural** groups to engage in **low status work** that they would not be able to do in the villages.

While urbanisation has been occurring at a rapid pace, **it is the biggest cities, the metropolises that have been growing the fastest.**

Population Policy And Family Planning

Definition

- According to the UNEP - "POPULATION POLICY is an effort to affect the size, structure and distribution OR characteristics of population".
- It includes "efforts to regulate economic and social conditions which are likely to have demographic consequences".

Population Policy - Includes

UN Environment Program defines population policy...

- NO. of People (Population)
- Age - Group distribution
- Regional urban or rural

India has **National Population Policy, 2000** - with its immediate objective to address the unmet needs for contraception, healthcare infrastructure, and health personnel, and providing integrated service delivery for basic reproductive and child healthcare.

Population Policy - Targets

Population Policy (Presently)

- Short term target: Reduce IMR, MMR with focused approach
- Mid Terms : TFR = 2.1
- Long Term : NFR = 1.0

Population Policy - Models

Amartya Sen: Population control 2 models

- Chinese → Strict Political control
- Kerala → Sound Education women Empowerment (Social + Economic)

Population Policy - Objectives

Population Policy Aims At

- Decreasing birth rate
- Limited the number of children in family to two
- Decreasing mortality
- Creating awareness among the masses
- Procuring necessary contraceptives
- Enacting acts like legalizing abortion
- Giving incentives as well as dis-incentives

- Checking concentration of people in congested areas
- Providing necessary public services for effective settlement in new areas.
- Re-location of offices to less populated areas.

Population Policy - Approach

Initially - the policy was **ad hoc** in nature flexible and based on **trial and error** approach.

Gradually - Replaced by a more **scientific** planning.

Various Committees

1. The **sub committee on population** appointed in **1940** under the chairmanship of **Radha Kamal Mukherjee** by the national planning committee (appointed by INC in 1938) laid **emphasis on self control**.
 - It also recommended **raising the marriage age, discouragement of polygamy**.
2. The **Bhore committee of 1943** appointed by the government **criticized self control** approach and **advocated deliberate limitation of families**.

Population Policy - After Independence approach

After independence

- A population policy committee was created in 1952.
- A family planning board was created in 1956 which emphasized sterilization.
- During 1960s a more vigorous family planning programme was advocated for stabilizing the growth of population of a reasonable period.

Population Policy - Initiatives By Govt.

In **1976** the **minister of health and family planning Karan Singh** presented before the parliament the national population policy:

- **Raising** the statutory age of marriage
- Introducing **fiscal incentives to states** which perform well
- Improving female literacy
- **Public education through all available media**
- Direct monetary incentives for adoption of vasectomy and tubectomy operations.

Population Policy - Consequences

- It was planned at a time when the emergency was in operation.
- So many excesses were committed
- In the sterilization campaign under the leadership of Sanjay Gandhi that it came to be regarded with hostility by people.
- These excesses became an important election issue the congress lost the election at the centre. When in 1980's Indira Gandhi returned to power she became extremely cautious and unenthusiastic about reviving her commitment.

Population Policy - Drawbacks

- Since then the policy of almost all governments in the states and at the center has been so lopsided that the growth rate of population which was expected to have fallen below 2 % marks is till around 2.3 %.

Family Planning

India was the first country to evolve a government backed family planning programme in the 1950's.

But India is still trailing behind in population control.

They devised **ambitious program** and carried them out **against popular wishes** and even used such harsh and coercive methods of sterilization that today one is ready to talk of planning to the populace.

In fact for all practical purposes the country is without an effective program of an effective target.

In 1977 family planning was the rechristened family welfare.

Family Planning - China's Approach

China

- Adopted 1 child per couple in the urban centres.
- A ceiling of 2 children per couple in rural.
- Several incentives for the planned child
- Those who violated the norms were penalized.
- China is encouraging late marriage and late child birth.

Attitude Towards Family Planning

The attitude of a woman towards family planning is influenced by her

- Education
- Age
- Family Income
- Background
- Husbands occupation and
- Working status among other factors.
- Attitude of husband's family & Immediate society.

Studies:

Kothari and Gulati - conducted a survey in **Rajasthan**.

- It was found - out of total persons studied 88.1 % were in favour of family planning.

Rao and Inbaraj - conducted a **survey on attitude towards family planning in Vellore city of Tamil Nadu**.

The **reasons** given **for hostility** to family planning

- It was harmful to woman,

- It went against god's will and
- It constituted unnatural behaviour.

However, since **7 out of every 10 persons** were **in favour** of family planning, it points to the fact that **people today have ceased to be very traditional** in their beliefs and values.

Reality Check Of Family Planning

- While it is **true** that the **couple protection percentage** has **gone up**.
- **Who are these couples** who are supposed to have obtained protection?
- It is **not** other than **those who have had 3 or more** children and who have already done their part of the damage to the two children family norm.
- Education & awareness, socio – economic development leading to a fall in TFR. Shall come internally, institutions can only show direction.

Emerging Issues: Ageing: Problems And Solutions

- Advancement in medical science ----> decline in the death rate.
- Diagnosis and Cure easily available.
- Increased human longevity.

Emerging Issues: Ageing: Definition

Clark Tibbitts: The survival of a growing number of people who have completed the traditional adult roles of making a living and childrearing.

Emerging Issues: Ageing – Types

Vanaprastha (Traditional Concept)

- Physical, social ageing
- Rural, urban
- Agrarian society – Industrializes
- Effect of Migration
- Inter & Intra Generational Gap
- Organized vs unorganized sector

BECKER - Aging in the broadest sense as those changes occurring in an individual "as a result of the **passage of time**".

Ageing in Indian context

- Similarly the **optimum minimum age** fixed for treating a person also varies from country to country.
- **In India, 60** has been mostly accepted for the purpose of classifying aged persons

Ageing: Types

- The **ancient scriptures** divide family life into **4 stages**. Out of which the **last** stage is tom as '**vanprastha**' which means withdrawal from active life.
- The religion plays an important role in the life of the aged.

Ageing: Problems

There is a broad distinction between physical and social ageing.

- **Physical ageing** maybe conditions by the **health status** where as
- **Social ageing** maybe coinciding with the **retirement** from the production process & social responsibilities like child rearing.

Rural areas vs Urban areas

- In **rural areas** where still the past oriented societies prevail the **aged** are **meaningful links to tradition and historical continuity**.
- In **industrialized society** & urban area of the **roles get shifted** from authoritarian-patriarchal type to an **equalitarian partnership**.
- In the **rural** setting the old people may **retire gradually** owing to **ill health** or susceptibility of disease instead.
- Hence old age for people without children became a hardship.
- **Rapid urbanisation** change over the **nuclear family** system, change over the flat system and the need for the **woman to take up** jobs have also contributed to the changing roles of aged in and outside the family.
- It is often observed that aged in cities **become asocial** and limit themselves to the 4 walls. Mostly spend their time in looking after grandchildren.
- Changes in the status and the role - There is a transition from the role of the provider to that of the dependent.
- This may result in loss of role or **no to limited participation in decision making** social cultural and economic sphere of family.

Process of migration - A vital role to play in the case of aging. Impact of two kinds

- Forced to migrate leaving behind their older members and relatives
- To join the members of the family who are already migrated (as in parents going to kids' places, out of country too)

Both cases - Impact either in the form of **adjustment or isolation** from the family circle.

- **Family Role Transition and Inter and intra generational gap**
- Created due to the process of **modernisation**.
- **Repercussions** on the aged as well as the **younger** ones.
- **Socio-psychological** and **cultural** changes (may result in) - Inter generational conflict.
- The **urban studies show** - **Though** old age leads to **enhanced status**, it is **constrained by** there **economic situation**.

- Both from the point of view of **economic and emotional support** the role of the **family becomes essential** for the aged.
- The transition from the role of **bread winner to a dependent** causes **emotional problems** among the aged.

Retired from Organised vs Unorganised Sectors

- The persons retired from organised sector have less economic insecurity.
- People from the informal sector lack even the minimum economic security.
- Thus the aged peasants may become the worst sufferers. This may lead to prolonged work participation.

India has been and continues to great extent to be an elder directed society.

Ageing: HE + SOLE

Needs of aged population And Services they offer

HE + SOLE

Ageing: Needs of the aged populations

The needs of the aged can roughly fall into the following category:

- Environmental
- Occupational
- Economic
- Leisure
- Social
- Health

Psychological issue + Migrating with children + Women

Ageing- Benefits

MS Gore

Merits of ageing

1. Social activities (Civil society)
2. Environment activities
3. Carrier of culture, values (Inter-generational)
4. Learning from their experiences

Ageing- Social Aspect

Social Aspects of ageing:

- Decreased influence in decision making
- Plenty of time -> Psychological pressure

- End of routine
- Separation of friends
- Interference in other family matters
- Some ousted from family
- Migration with children

Ageing - Solutions

Therefore, there are **4 types of programs** which are needed in the country for the older persons:

- **Day care** centers
- **Institutions for unattached dependent** and friends less persons (Full time stay)
- **Counselling** for in curable and chronically ill
- **Financial** assistance to those who can live in their families but do not have sufficient meaning to maintain themselves.

Ageing: Social and Emotional Problems

Though the problems of the aged can be looked in different ways, 4 major areas

- **Psychological/Emotional problems and Social problems**
- **Health and medical care**
- **Housing conditions**
- **Financial problems**
- **Psychological/Emotional problems and Social problems**
 - The feeling of dependency on others during sickness causes emotional disturbances besides adverse emotional disturbances while ill.
 - Another type of emotional disturbance is rooted in loneliness and physical isolation mostly among those who have outlived their relations.

Health and medical care is a major problem for aged. A gradual decline in physical strength with growing age.

The **housing conditions** of most of the aged and the infirm are generally far from satisfactory.

- They are obliged to share accommodation with others. This problem is also associated with economic problem.

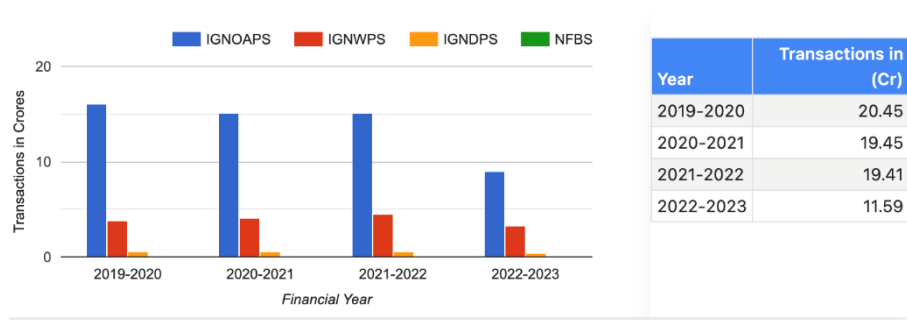
The majority of the elderly people have **financial problem**. Decrease in income and increase in the cost of living.

Ageing: Initiatives

- NSAP - National Social Assistance Program
 - IGNOAPS (Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme)
- AAY (Antodaya Anna Yojana)
- Reverse Mortgage by Banks

- Senior Citizens Act
- CRPC Sec. 125 → Right to maintenance
- APY → Atal Pension Yojana

Newer ones keep getting added with time.



Ageing: Solutions

UNITED NATIONS:

Following principles and recommendations for the aged:

1. Create **Institutions**
2. Encourage **Community to care**
3. Involve elders in **Policy making**
4. Promote **Geriatric Care** in medicine research and hospitals
2. **National machinery should be established** & strengthened to ensure that the humanitarian needs and development potential of the aged are appropriately addressed.
3. The **expansion of research** on the demographic biological social and economic aspect of ageing.
4. **Community-based or institutional care systems** that provide the health and social services for the frail elderly who have limited or no family support should be encouraged.

Organisation and association of the elderly which insured they are **actively involved in policy** and program development should be encourage and promoted.

Training in gerontology and geriatrics should be promoted to ensure that policymakers researchers and practitioners have an adequate knowledge of issue related to aging

The Ministry Of Social Justice And Empowerment - Implementing central schemes of assistance for establishing and maintaining

- The day care centers
- Old age homes
- Mobile Medicare units
- Supporting and strengthening non institutional services for the aged.

Concluding Analysis Of Ageing In India

Traditionally-

- The aged were accorded a **place of honour and importance** in the family and community.
- **The family and community look after** them irrespective of their productive capacity.

CONTEMPORARY TIMES - The **social situation** has undergone a perceptible **change**.

- A substantial **dilution of economic and social values**.
- **Traditional institutions** have **lost hold** and relevance.
- The **joint family system** is faster giving way to nuclear family.

A paradoxical situation

- On one hand, The introduction of modern health technology and medicine has increased the span of life.
- On the other, a higher proportion of aged or retired persons with little income of their own who have to depend on others for their livelihood.

The **changes in kinship and family** organisation in conjunction with **urbanization and industrialization** have been more to the **disadvantages of the aged**.

Paradox : INCREASED Lifespan, DECREASED Incomes

Longitudinal Ageing Study of India (LASI)

Conducted by Minister of Health & Family Welfare

- This was a national survey of scientific investigation of health consequences, economic and social determinants related to the ageing of the population of India.
- This was commissioned in 2016.
- It is India's first and the world's largest survey providing a longitudinal database to design policies and programmes for the older population.
- It deals in various domains such as social, health, and economic well-being.

Agencies involved:

- The national programme for health care of the elderly, ministry of health and family welfare is undertaking this longitudinal ageing study of India.
- Also, agencies like International Institute for Population Sciences, (IIPS), Mumbai in collaboration with Harvard School of Public Health, University of Southern California, USA, United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA) and National Institute on Ageing have been involved.

Population Covered:

- The first national wave of the LASI covered a baseline sample of 72,250 people that are aged 45 or more than that along with their spouses.
- It included elderly persons who were aged 60 and above.
- Also, the oldest persons ranged 75 years of age and above from all States and Union Territories excluding Sikkim.

Methodology Used:

- The data collected on health and biomarkers together with information on family and social network, income, assets and consumption.
- A biomarker is a measurable indicator of the severity or presence of some disease state.
- A biomarker is anything that can be used as an indicator of a particular disease state or some other physiological state of an organism.

Findings of the survey:

- In 2011 census, 8.6% of the Indian population was registered to be 60 plus in age. This made 103 million elderly people in India.
- This number would eventually rise to 319 million in 2050.
- 75% of the people suffer from chronic disease and 40% of other senior citizens have one or the other disability.
- Single morbidity and multimorbidity conditions increase with age.
- Kerala has 52%, Chandigarh has 41%, Lakshadweep has 40%, Goa has 39% and Andaman & Nicobar Islands have 38% multi-morbidity conditions.

Benefits and Significance of LASI:

- LASI is used to strengthen the National Programme for Healthcare of the Elderly.
- It will keep helping in establishing a range of preventive and health care programmes for the senior citizens in India.
- In the situations like COVID 19, **multimorbidity conditions** in elderly are on rising. LASI would help in **analysing the issue further** with the help of the survey data generated through it.

Elderly abuse a growing concern in India

Key findings of LASI 2020:

- At least five per cent of India's elderly population (aged 60 years and above) stated they experienced ill-treatment.
- **Bihar** records highest share of elderly persons ill treated in India.
- Among the elderly who felt ill-treated, 77.3 per cent complained of **verbal/ emotional ill-treatment** that can harm their self-worth or emotional well-being.
- The emotional harm that may emerge from verbal or emotional abuse encompasses **torture, sorrow, fear, perverse emotional discomfort, loss of personal pride or sovereignty**.

Some Important Things to Consider:

- Abuse of the elderly is a **growing international problem** with several manifestations in different countries and cultures.
- It is a **fundamental violation of human** rights and leads to several health and emotional problems.
- The abuse can be classified as:
 - Physical
 - Sexual
 - Psychological

○ Financial

- The ill-treatment is relatively **more frequent among elderly women** and those living in **rural areas**.
- A lot of **women lose support as they lose their partners** to old age. This group of people generally has no income source or economic activity.
- The obstacle of elder abuse cannot be adequately solved if older people's **essential needs for food, shelter, protection and access to healthcare** are not met.

What Could be Done:

- Good **quality health care** be made available and accessible to the elderly in an **age-sensitive manner**.
- **Rehabilitation**, community or home based disability support and **end-of-life care** should also be provided where needed, in a **holistic manner**, to effectively address the issue to failing health among the elderly.
- Those who are unable to generate an **adequate income** should be facilitated to do so.
- The best way to **address neglect** of the elderly is to **counsel families, sensitise community leaders** and address the issue at all levels in different forums, including the **print and audio-visual media**.

Sex Ratio In India

- **The sex ratio - An important indicator** of gender balance in the population.
- **Overall sex ratio** → Improved than the past
- **0 - 6** → Has fallen over the years
- Recent report → Fallen even in SC & ST who have hitherto been unaffected (census 2011)
- **Historically slightly in favour of females.**
- However, India - A **declining sex ratio** for more than a century.
- The sex ratio for the **0 to 6 year** age group known as the **juvenile child sex ratio**, has been falling very sharply.
- The **state level** child sex ratios of a few states offer **even greater call for worry**.

Demographers and sociologists, several reasons for the decline in the sex ratio:

1. Cultural
2. Inheritance
3. Safety
4. Patrilineal
5. Honour & female

Health factor that affects woman differently from men is **childbearing**. May be partly due to the increased risk of death in child birth that only woman face.

However, maternal mortality is supposed to **decline with advancements** as levels of nutrition, general education, awareness, availability of medical and communication facilities improve.

- Severe **neglect of girl babies** in infancy

HEADLINE COMES HERE

State	Sex ratio at birth		
	Rural	Urban	Total
Andhra Pradesh	890	924	912
Assam	905	914	908
Bihar	939	936	938
Chhattisgarh	950	926	939
Delhi	913	925	924
Gujarat	914	889	897
Haryana	901	904	903
Himachal Pradesh	926	929	928
Jammu & Kashmir	967	927	952
Jharkhand	885	843	871
Karnataka	951	935	938
Kerala	967	961	963
Madhya Pradesh	897	903	901
Maharashtra	902	920	916
Odisha	911	911	911
Punjab	898	891	892
Rajasthan	882	916	901
Tamil Nadu	901	939	930
Telangana	921	925	924
Uttar Pradesh	930	907	922
Uttarakhand	962	938	948
West Bengal	984	930	958
Grand Total	924	918	921

- Sex specific abortions
- Female infanticide due to religious or cultural beliefs.

The regional pattern of low child sex ratios seems to support these arguments.

Need more initiatives like 'Beti Bachao Beti Padhao' - Started from Sonapat, Haryana

Anomalies

- **Lowest child sex ratio** are found in the **most prosperous regions** of India.
- **If dowry payment is a problem then prosperous would be the most able** to afford this. However, sex ratios are lowest in the most prosperous regions
- Also possible that as prosperous families decide to have fewer children, now **they may also wish to choose the sex of their child.**
 - This **becomes possible** with the availability of **ultrasound** technology.
 - Government strict laws banning this (imposing heavy fine and imprisonment) prenatal diagnostic techniques act.

Way out

- Involving civil society (social movement) because it's a social phenomenon.
- Stringent laws (PCPNDT)
- More initiative like Beti Bachao Beti Padhao
- Attitudinal change
- Celebrating birth of girl child
- Inheritance/ Property right
- Greater presence in physical + mental space

Reproductive Health - Data

The available facts relating to reproductive health in India point out that:

- Of the **total conception** that take place annually about **78 %** are **unplanned** and about 22 % are definitely **unwanted**.
- Improved Public healthcare infrastructure led to more than 75% institutional deliveries.
- About **22% babies** are **delivered at home** and every 3rd child is **delivered** with the **assistance of a Medic.**
[NSO Data]

Government has started **many programs** to improve reproductive health of women

- Janani suraksha yojana - Now extended to all SC | ST women (no age bar, no number of children bar)
- National rural health mission
- Pradhan Mantri Matru Vandhana Yojana - Cash to Lactating Mother
- LaQshya - Labour Room Quality Improvement Initiative
- ASHA volunteer etc.
- ANM

- Weekly Iron & Folic Acid
- NFSA -> Pregnant + Lactating Mother were given assistance

National Family Health Survey 5 (NFHS 5)

- The National Family Health Survey (NFHS) is a multi-round, large scale survey that is undertaken in a representative sample of Indian households.
- The survey collects data on fertility, infant and child mortality, family planning use, maternal and child health, reproductive health, nutrition, anaemia, and the use and quality of health and family planning services in India.
- The National Family Health Survey 5 is the most recent round of the survey conducted by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare.
- The important findings from the newest NFHS (NFHS-5, 2019-21) second phase have been announced.
- The results of the second phase are a mixed bag, with much of good news and plenty of bad news.
- The findings are significant because they provide a full, comprehensive, multi-dimensional picture of India's demographic and health trends.

Key Findings of the Survey

Positives

Improvements have been seen in a variety of areas, including educational attainment, institutional deliveries, immunizations, infant mortality, and so on.

Population

- The Total Fertility Rate (TFR) has been declining through time, and it is now slightly below the replacement rate of 2.1 (at 2.0).
- This is true across all Indian states, indicating that the overall population has stabilised or going to be stabilised soon.
 - India seems to be entering stage four of Demographic Transition as given by Warren Thompson in his Demographic Transition Theory.
- For the first time in India's history, the total sex ratio — women per thousand men — has reached that of affluent countries.
- There were 1,020 adult women for 1,000 men between 2019 and 21.
- The figures show that India is no longer a country of "missing women,"
 - A term used by Nobel Laureate economist Amartya Sen in 1990.

Family Planning

- The use of contraception, the increase in the age of marriage, and abortions are all contributing to the decline in fertility.

- Increased contraception use has been a major influence in preventing unwanted pregnancies in India, resulting in a fall in the country's Total Fertility Rate (TFR)
- Between NFHS 4 (2015-16) and NHFS 5 (2019-20), the usage of modern contraceptives for family planning increased by 8.7 percentage points, from 47.8% to 56.5 percent.
- The usage of family planning methods has increased in all states except Mizoram.
- The usage of family planning methods has increased the most in Goa (42 percent -point) and Bihar (32 percent -point).

Health and Nutrition

- Nearly all states have seen a slight decrease in infant mortality rates.
- Stunting (low height-for-age), wasting (low weight-for-height), and underweight (low weight-for-age) are the three malnutrition markers that have improved overall.
- The rate of births in institutional settings, such as a hospital, increased by about 8%.
- According to NFHS-5, the number of persons who have access to better sanitation facilities has climbed to 70%, up from 49% in NHFS-4.

Negatives

Population

- The sex ratio at birth (SRB) in India is still more skewed towards males than the natural SRB (929 girls per 1000 boys).
 - An indication of sex selection at birth through female foeticide due to the son-meta preference in India.
 - Skewed sex ratio leads to more violence against women as well as human trafficking
- The biggest states with low SRB include Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Punjab, Rajasthan, Bihar, Delhi, Jharkhand, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Odisha, and Maharashtra.

Health and Nutrition

- The incidence of anaemia in children under the age of five (from 58.6 to 67 percent), women (53.1 to 57 percent), and men (22.7 to 25 percent) has increased in all Indian states (20 percent - 40 percent incidence is considered moderate).
- All states are in the "severe" category, with the exception of Kerala (39.4%).
- Despite the fact that India has achieved food security, 60% of Indians cannot afford a nutritious diet.
- The overall improvement in malnutrition indicators constitutes an anomaly, because multiple States indicated a worsening in one or more of these indicators in Phase 1 of the NFHS-5, yet none of the States showed a worsening in Phase 2.
- It's probable that the covid-19 influenced the Phase 2 survey, resulting in undercounting of instances.
- Furthermore, the proportion of overweight children, women, and men has risen, indicating malnutrition, which has major health effects in the form of noncommunicable diseases (NCDs).

Family Planning

- In states like Andhra Pradesh (98 percent), Telangana (93 percent), Kerala (88 percent), Karnataka (84 percent), Bihar (78 percent), and Maharashtra (77 percent), female sterilisation remains the most popular method of contraception.
- Male participation in family planning is limited, as seen by the low use of condoms and male sterilisation across the States.
- According to the current National Family Health Survey-5 (2019- 2021), less than one in ten males in India use condoms, while nearly four in ten women undergo sterilisation to avoid conception.
- Female sterilisation is also on the rise, including in urban India.
 - "Limitations on women when it comes to sexual freedom" is seen by Sylvia Walby as one of the six patriarchal structures that undermine woman's position in society
- Misinformation about male sterilisation is one explanation for the high prevalence of female sterilisation.
- According to NFHS-4 data, 40% of males believe it is the responsibility of women to avoid becoming pregnant.
 - Thus, burden of family planning largely falls on women.

Other Issues

- The NFHS does not have data on micronutrients.
- The 'One Size Fits All' approach to dietary intake monitoring is unproductive.
- Diets in India are extremely diverse. Many traditional diets reflect both local climate conditions and a diverse range of vital nutrient sources, such as proteins, lipids, and carbohydrates.
- Dietary policing, which imposes an unnatural uniformity and prevents huge sections of Indians who are not historically vegetarian from eating animal protein, is likely to limit micronutrient diversity and lead to poor health outcomes.
- Because the data for the Phase-2 of NFHS-5 was obtained in significant part during the exceedingly unusual conditions of the COVID-19 pandemic, it has been suggested that the poor health outcomes reflect the effect of Covid-19.
- The decline in public health indices, on the other hand, cannot be wholly attributable to the pandemic.
- The NHFS-5 study only measures the percentage improvement in improved sanitation, not actual access to toilet facilities.
- The datasheet does not provide the percentage of families that practise open defecation or the presence of unimproved latrines.
- The survey does not provide a clear picture of the number of homes with access to a safe drinking water supply or a long-term water supply.
- Cesarean births have increased considerably, according to data; 47.5 percent of births in private health facilities are via C-section (14.3 percent in public health facilities).

- These figures are highly unnatural, and they call into question the unethical actions of private health practitioners that place monetary gain above the health of women.
- Spousal violence against pregnant married women has decreased slightly from 6.5 in 2014-15 to 5.8 this year.
- The percentage of young women (18-29) who had experienced sexual violence by the age of 18 has increased from 10.3 in 2014-15 to 11.0 in 2015-16.
 - "Violence" is seen by Sylvia Walby as one of the six patriarchal structures that undermine woman's position in society

Challenges

- Because the population that will give birth in the next 10-15 years was previously born in the past when fertility levels were greater, there is normally a 30-40-year gap between total fertility rates falling below replacement levels and a decline in overall population.
 - - Dr KS James, director and senior professor at the International Institute for Population Sciences.
- ➤ As fertility drops, the proportion of the older population rises, and societies are faced with the issue of maintaining an ageing population while simultaneously diminishing their workforce.
 - Pradeep Kumar Panda, in his study of Orissa found that increasing economic strains of family lead to poor care of adults in family
- While low fertility gives a temporary demographic dividend by reducing the number of dependents per worker, China's experience demonstrates that the increased burden of caring for the elderly may become overwhelming in the long run.
 - Increased "Dependency Ratio"
- Northern states will provide the manpower needed for economic expansion as southern governments struggle with the increased responsibility of sustaining the elderly.
- With its dwindling workforce supplemented by employees from other states, the increased pace of migration may help shore up economic expansion in the south.
- It may have an impact on India's federalism as older states increasingly rely on a workforce from younger states to preserve their economic prosperity.
- Given that we now have an ageing population, our approach to women's health should take a more holistic life cycle perspective rather than one that focuses solely on reproductive health.
 - Yamini Aiyar, President of the Centre for Policy Research. According to Nirmala, in her 2013 study, elderly women now witness increasing instances of ovarian cancer, uterus removal, acute menopausal symptoms
- The fact that more women completed ten years of schooling in 2019- 20 than in previous years coincides with a reduction in female labour force participation, indicating that India's labour market faces severe structural challenges.

- Despite the fact that a large percentage of women polled continue to be victims of marital abuse, the national family health survey (NFHS-5) finds that men justify violence against spouses less than women in the majority of states.
 - Tanya Evans said “Women are considered as a property of the husband”
 - Murray Strauss said “Marriage license is a hitting license”

Way Forward

- An action plan to address India's health needs is required, and it must be inclusive, firm in its commitment, and well-funded.
- There is a pressing need to address women's and children's malnutrition.
- Building resilient and fortified systems capable of delivering nourishment in the most difficult situations, such as a pandemic, is critical.
- To make basic and advanced health services accessible, inexpensive, and acceptable to everyone, all health institutions, academia, and other partners directly or indirectly engaged with health care services must work together to make them accessible, affordable, and acceptable to all.
- To ensure that males take responsibility for family planning, the government must implement a targeted social and behavior-change communication strategy.
- To encourage males to become more involved in family planning, mass media initiatives are required.
- Not only should social and behaviour change communication promote condoms, but it should also challenge gender stereotypes and position men as responsible partners.
 - "Culture that promotes sex specific roles" is seen by Sylvia Walby as one of the six patriarchal structures that undermine woman's position in society
- It's important to instil values like spousal communication and joint decision-making.
- Efforts should be made to close gender gaps in schooling and provide more employment opportunities for woman.
 - According to research done by Blood and Wolfe, the wife's power within the family tends to vary according to how closely her pay check matches her husband's.
- India's preparation for its ageing population will determine if the increase reflected by the demographic dividend will persist

Conclusion

- The NFHS is only second to the exhaustive data provided by the decennial population census. It should be regarded as a watershed moment in Indian policymaking.
- The larger idea is for states and the centre to recognise it as a matrix to work on and improve development indicators further.

Population Control

- Uttar Pradesh and Assam, two Indian state governments, have recently called for aggressive population control measures.
- This proposal is about pursuing a two-child policy for state government benefits eligibility.
- On current trends, India will surpass China as the world's most populous country by 2025, if not sooner.
- The massive population pressure is putting a strain on resources such as hospitals, food grains, housing, and employment.
- However, population control, which is based on traditional economic assumptions, has proven to be a two-edged sword.
- It has both advantages and costs.

Status of Population Growth in the India & World

- According to United Nations (UN) figures, population growth is falling behind replacement rates in more than half of the world's countries, and the global population growth rate is forecast to be zero by the end of the century, possibly for the first time.
- According to a recent Bloomberg article, the Covid-19 pandemic may have accelerated the approaching peak of a global population drop by at least a decade.
- Experts predict that the pandemic has slowed already-slowing worldwide birth rates, from the United States to China.
- Between 2021 and 2031, India's population is expected to increase by a factor of 1.09, according to UN forecasts.
- As per NFHS 5, the Total Fertility Rate (TFR) has been declining through time, and it is now slightly below the replacement rate of 2.1 (at 2.0).
 - India seems to be entering stage four of Demographic Transition as given by Warren Thompson in his Demographic Transition Theory.

Reasons for Rise in Population:

- Because child survival is low and son meta preference is high, poorer households tend to have more children.
- Children assist in economic activity and so support the family's economic as well as emotional needs.
- The health of a family, the survival of children, and the number of children a woman has are all linked to her degree of health and education.
- Those with limited access to health and education caught in a cycle of poverty, leading to an increase in the number of children. ➤ Nearly 27 per cent women were married before attaining 18 years of age.
- Not only does the early marriage increases the likelihood of more children but it also puts the woman health at risk.
 - Rita Wolfsohn – Women have unique healthcare problems leading to higher costs of health
- Nearly 75.4% of married men in India currently use no method of contraception as per NFHS.

- Female sterilisation is also on the rise, including in urban India as per NFHS 5)
 - Thus, burden of family planning largely falls on women.
- Only 18% women have a final say in family planning decision.
 - Tulsi Patel - Women consider it as sin to prohibit their husbands from sexuality leads to unwanted pregnancy.

Associated Issues with Population Control in India

- A large population is not always detrimental to the economy.
- There will simply not be enough individuals to work for the economy.
- There is a big unproductive ageing population to maintain, and the government may not have sufficient money to fund pensions. ➤ De-industrialisation would occur as a result of this.
 - John Maynard Keynes delivered a presentation titled "Some Economic Consequences of a Declining Population" in 1937.
 - His main concern was a lack of investment demand in areas where the population of consumers is dwindling.
- In the 1980s, China imposed a one-child policy, but as the population grew older, China abandoned the policy and encouraged couples to have more children.
- The religious polarisation surrounding population control in India makes it an even more difficult subject.
- In India, the bogey of population expansion is frequently utilised (directly or indirectly) to target a specific minority.
- Social harmony will be impacted by the population control measure.
- The impoverished have higher total fertility rates (TFR), which decrease as wealth rises.
- As a result, population control policies based on entitlements will disproportionately harm the poor, who require the most assistance.
- The patriarchy's desire for a male child is a major factor in higher fertility rates.
- The two-child policy is thought to have had a negative impact on the population's sex ratio due to practises such as female foeticide.
 - India a country of "missing women" - Nobel Laureate economist Amartya Sen in 1990

Why One-Child policy will not be effective in India

- People are quick to point out that India has a thriving technology industry but that is heavily dependent on young people.
- There is concern that child-bearing limitations would result in a shortage of educated young people needed to continue India's technological revolution.
- China's one-child policy has previously been linked to a number of issues. Worst of all, a gender imbalance exists as a result of a strong predilection for boys.
- There were also millions of undocumented infants born to parents who already had one child. With the implementation of a two-child policy, India may face these issues.
- Above all, there is growing evidence that India's birth rate is slowing to levels that are sustainable.

- Furthermore, in the years leading up to 2019, India's economy grew at a rate of 6% per year, more than enough to support modest population increase.

Population control measures in India:

Social Measures -

Population explosion is a social problem and it is deeply rooted in the society. So, efforts must be done to remove the social pressures in the country.

- Minimum Marriage Age:
 - Fertility is determined by the age at which a couple marries. Marriage should be restricted to people of a certain age.
 - The legal minimum age for marriage in India is 21 years for men and 18 years for women.
 - This rule should be strictly enforced, and people should be made aware of it through public awareness campaigns.
- Improving Women's Status:
 - Women continue to face prejudice. They're frequently restricted to their homes.
 - They are still limited to child rearing and childbearing.
 - Plato placed reproductive role of women higher than their productive roles.
 - As a result, women should be provided with opportunity to grow socially and economically.
 - Diane Pearce – Women represent disproportionate percentages of the world's poor
 - They should be provided with free schooling.
- Education's Spread:
 - Education's spread alters people's perspectives.
 - K. Ahmad (1974) -- formal education can play a vital role in 'ideational' change.
 - Educated males want to postpone marriage and adhere to small family norms.
 - Educated women are more health concerned and avoid having several pregnancies, which helps to reduce the birth rate.
- Social Security:
 - A larger number of people should be covered by social security plans.
 - With these facilities, parents will have less desire for additional children because they will not be reliant on others in the event of old age, sickness, unemployment, and so on.

Economic Measures -

- Agriculture and Industry Development:
 - If agriculture and industry are properly developed, a huge number of people will be able to find work.
 - People should be given more skill and training to increase their productivity
 - Policies favouring women's participation in labour force should be enforced.
 - They would enhance their standard of living and adopt small family norms if their money rose.

- Living Standards:
 - A higher standard of living serves as a disincentive to the large family norm.
 - People desire to have a small family in order to retain their higher standard of living.
- Urbanisation:
 - It is well documented that people in cities have a lower birth rate than persons in rural areas.
 - As a result, urbanisation should be encouraged.

Other Measures -

- Late Marriage:
 - This will shorten the reproductive period for females, lowering the birth rate.
- Family Planning:
 - This strategy suggests family by choice and not by coincidence.
 - People can control the birth rate by taking preventive measures. This approach is widely utilised; nevertheless, its efficacy is contingent on the availability of inexpensive contraceptive devices.
- Publicity:
 - Communication media such as television, radio, and newspapers are effective tools for disseminating the benefits of planned families to the uneducated and illiterate, particularly in rural and backward sections of the country.
- Incentives:
 - The government can provide a variety of incentives to encourage people to use birth control.
 - Working-class families who adhere to small-family norms can benefit from monetary incentives as well as other benefits such as leave and promotion.
- Women's Employment:
 - Another way to keep the population under control is to employ women.
 - As a result, their numbers in teaching, medicine, banking, and other fields will swiftly expand.
 - They will postpone having children due to job pressure and promotion.
 - According to a research done by Blood and Wolfe, the wife's power within the family tends to vary according to how closely her pay check matches her husband's.

Way Forward

- India is at a unique point in history, where it can take advantage of its population advantage to achieve its economic objectives.
- Rather than worrying about its demographic dividend, India should focus on maximising it.
- According to government estimates, 53.6 percent of India's population would be under the age of 29 in 2021.
- Over a quarter of India's population is under the age of 14.
- At the moment, India is still a long way from providing the finest potential chances for young Indians.

- Depending on the skill sets it obtains, this youthful population can become extraordinarily productive or extremely unproductive.
- More successful than coercive methods would be women's
- education, understanding of family planning, and easy access to contraception.
- Greater adolescent care and awareness, programmes to eliminate social and cultural taboos around contraception use, and behaviour change communication, particularly for men, would be better uses of the family planning budget.

Ageing's LASI Report

The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare recently published the Longitudinal Ageing Study of India (LASI) Wave-1 Report on the virtual platform.

Longitudinal Studies - Studying a group over an extended period, collecting data on them at intervals

- Used to measure health, cognitive abilities, education, employment, habits and change in attitude, etc.
- Generally involved following a sample.
- At times a particular age group is chosen.
- It is a full-scale national survey of the health, economic, and social determinants and consequences of population ageing in India.
- It was commissioned in 2016.
- The National Programme for Health Care of the Elderly, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, has undertaken the Longitudinal Ageing Study of India through International Institute for Population Sciences, (IIPS), Mumbai
- It is done in collaboration with Harvard School of Public Health, University of Southern California, USA, United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA), and National Institute on Ageing.

Key Findings of the Survey

Population

- According to the 2011 census, the 60+ population accounted for 8.6 percent of India's total population, or 103 million elderly people.
- The number of elderly people will reach 319 million by 2050, growing at a rate of around 3% per year.

Health

- 75% of the elderly have one or more chronic diseases.
- 40% of the elderly have one or other disabilities, and 20% have mental health issues.
- The prevalence of probable depression among the elderly aged 60 and up is 10 times higher than the self-reported prevalence of diagnosed depression, implying a greater burden of undiagnosed depression.
- Almost a 3rd of the population aged 60 and up exhibits depressive symptoms.

- The self-reported prevalence of diagnosed cardiovascular diseases (CVDs) among older adults aged 45 and up is 28%.
- With age, the prevalence of single morbidity and multi morbidity conditions rises.
- Comorbidity simply refers to the presence of more than one illness or disease in the same person at the same time, whereas multimorbidity refers to the presence of more than two illnesses or diseases in the same person at the same time.
- Diabetes is more common among senior citizens in urban India.
- Every fourth Indian over the age of 60, and every fifth over the age of 45, reported having poor health.
- Self-assessed health is a subjective component.

Miguel Faria, states that happiness and wisdom can be attained in old age in a large proportion of those who lead healthy lifestyles and remain intellectually active.

Diet

- Food insecurity is increasing among India's elderly.
- Almost 6% of people in India aged 45 and up studied ate smaller portions or skipped meals, and 5.3 percent did not eat even when they were hungry. Work
- Male senior citizens worked at a rate of approximately 50%, while female senior citizens worked at a rate of 22%.
- When compared to their urban counterparts, a greater proportion of senior citizens in India's villages work.

Ageing brings with it physical and psychological decline and that changing social roles have to take this decline into account, Hendricks 1992.

Abuse

- In 2020, at least 5% of India's elderly population (aged 60 and up) reported experiencing abuse.
- Abuse can be physical, sexual, psychological, or financial.
- Mistreatment is more common among elderly women and those living in rural areas.

This becomes more acute because, in India the longevity of female is greater than male. Besides the patriarchal nature of society and greater economic dependence their psychological problems get aggravated.

Pradeep Kumar Panda, in his study of Orissa found that increasing economic strains of family lead to poor care of adults in family.

LASI also offers interesting insights on contrasting the current elderly with the future elderly.

- The prospective elderly of the current age of 45–59 do display a clear advantage as the literacy gap is about 56.3% and 43.5%.
- Similar is the story of work features and occupation with possible protection that may accrue in later ages.
- In the health domain, especially in relation to health risk behaviour, there is a decline in the use of tobacco and smoking tobacco between the current elderly and the prospective ones.

- But there is marginally greater frequency of alcohol use among the prospective elderly that can be attributed to affordability rather than addiction.
- The prospective elderly seems to be fairly positive and distinctly having a higher intensity of physical activity.
- The chronic disease risk conditions too display a reasonably lower risk among the prospective elderly compared with the current group.
- Information from women in particular with regard to cancer prevention, with periodic prevention measures like mammography, and pap smear, etc., seem to be reasonably higher in the prospective elderly women than the elderly women.
- This gives hope as regards the reduced burden of such ailments in the prospective elderly as they adhere to a routine prevention measure.

This validates what Phil Mullan argued – ageing as a ticking bomb is not true.

Exceptions

- Age-related disabilities, both physical, and psychological needs redressal with suggestive interventions at the community level.
- When it comes to living arrangements, there is a systematic decline in the satisfaction level of the living arrangements with age.
- This decline is due to the fact that Indian households are under strict transformation with distinct features of nucleation, home-based care provisioning as well as accommodation of varied dependency that comes with age.

AM Shah – Household is under progression or regression in a developmental process.

State's Measures for Elderly

- Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Act (MWPSC) - makes the maintenance of parents or grandparents an obligation of the children who are entitled to receive the benefits of inheritance or succession, both either by the statutory law or personal law.
- Section 20 of Hindu marriage and adoption act, 1956 makes it obligatory provisions to maintain an aged parents.

Yogendra Singh - Parents are welcomed home for looking after the new-borns in urban nuclear families become unwanted guests when their service is no more needed. ➤ Indira Gandhi Widow Pension Scheme

- Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme
- Pradhan Mantri Vaya Vandana Yojana (PMVVY) a Pension Scheme for the senior citizens aged 60 years and above.
- Annapurna Scheme - provides food security requirement of those Senior Citizens who though eligible have remained uncovered under the National Old Age Pension Scheme
- National Programme for Health Care of Elderly - provides accessible, affordable, and high-quality long-term, comprehensive and dedicated care services to an Ageing population.
- Free, Specialized health care facilities exclusively for the elderly people through the State health delivery system.

Article 41 of the Constitution provides that “the State shall make effective provision of public assistance for the benefit of disadvantaged and weaker section including aged.

Challenges

- Only 11.7% of the elderly in India had any knowledge about the MWPSC Act, out of which 17.7% of the elderly belonged to urban areas and 9.2% to rural areas.
- Only 12% of the elderly have awareness about the Annapurna Scheme, 44% about the Indira Gandhi Widow Pension Scheme and 55% about the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme.
- A quarter of the elderly are still not utilising the scheme, and around two-fifths of them face various types of problems to receive the benefits.

This is also because of low literacy and lack of access to information.

- Since older people do not work, our society labels them as mildly deviant.

Steven Spitzer (1980) points out that a profit-oriented society devalues any category of people that is less productive.

- The impact of ageing differs depending on other factors such as class, caste, race, ethnicity, and gender.

Contribution of Elderly to the society

- Elderly people have a wealth of personal and professional experience.
- They can serve as a vital generational link for future generations.

As per disengagement theory (a functionalist theory) the disengagement of the elderly from their current roles can free up those roles for others who can perform them more efficiently.

- It gives families and society as a whole support and stability.
- Grandparents in joint families serve as an important link for passing on values and morals to the younger generation during their formative years, thereby contributing to the development of better human beings and responsible citizens.

George Murdock enlist Socialization of Children as universal function of family

- Recognizing seniors' contributions would contribute to our society becoming a more age-inclusive one that does not pit one generation against the other.
- Their deep cultural impressions and social experiences provide the necessary buffer against intolerance, violence, and hate crimes, providing stability in society, especially in an era of hate and crime.
- Through their insight and understanding, they can play a significant role in easing societal tensions, both within and outside of families.

Talcott Parsons argued that society need to find roles for older people consistent with advanced age.

Way Forward

- Raising the minimum monthly pension for elderly.
- Housing for the elderly, must be prioritised under the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana.
- Assisted living facilities for the poor elderly, particularly those suffering from age-related illnesses such as dementia, require policy attention.
- More tax breaks or, at the very least, the elimination of the tax on deposit interest for seniors.

- Improving the health infrastructure for geriatric care, particularly in rural areas.
- At both levels, a special budget for the elderly population should be set aside.
- At the panchayat level, entertainment facilities such as libraries and clubs should be built.
- Facilitating the elderly for their contribution at all levels.

Political Economy of Ageing - Carroll Estes According to her, political economy defines the roles which are given to the aged.

Conclusion

- The United Nations has designated the years 2021-2030 as the "Decade of Healthy Ageing," urging governments, civil society, international organisations, professionals, academia, the media, and the private sector to work together to achieve "ten years of concerted, catalytic, and collaborative action to improve the lives of older people, their families, and the communities in which they live."

Phenomena of ageing and old age are directly related to the larger society in which they are situated and cannot be considered in isolation from the other social forces, Estes and Minkler, 1991.

- This survey yielded a wealth of information that is quite timely for exploration in order to guide policy imperatives that may very well contest the common pessimism regarding the future of the elderly on the one hand and systems and mechanisms to be put in place to realise active and healthy ageing of the Indian population on the other.

C 7

Challenges of Social Transformation

Crises of Development

- Displacement
- Environmental problems and Sustainability
- Poverty, deprivation and inequalities
- Violence against women
- Caste Conflicts
- Ethnic Conflicts
- Communalism
- Religious revivalism
- Illiteracy and disparities in Education

The 20th century is generally regarded as the **century of development in science and technology** and advances in economic growth.

It was also a century of the destruction of the environment through the **overuse of the non-renewable as well as the renewable resources of the planet**, in the name of development and improvement in the standard of life-style of the human population.

Myth - That there was **no destruction** of the environment **before industrialisation**. In fact, human activities have resulted in changes in the environment since early times.

Issues related to development in India are similar to issues faced by other developing countries.

These are:

- Poverty
- Clean air
- Clean water for drinking and domestic use
- Education
- Malnutrition
- Health care and Sanitation
- Good soil to provide food and fodder to increasing human and livestock population
- Fuel for cooking and heating
- Shelter

Displacement

Displacement is not just migration.

It is **Forceful migration** which is **Permanent** in nature.

An important thing to note here is that, **Victims** of the displacement are **not the Beneficiaries** of the projects for which the displacement took place.

Thus, Development is often equated with **Neo-colonialism**.

- Development projects in India have always **hit hard the socially and economically marginalised groups** in general and **tribal** communities in particular.
- Beneficiaries of development stand distinctively opposite to the victims of the process.
- **Pathy writes:** Development is a **conscious neo- colonialist design of a capitalist state** that tries to **destroy the holistic linkage between the nature and the culture**.
- It **destroys the very existence of collective indigenous identities** .

Displacement **deprives people of many things**, some of which are **fundamental** to their lives:

- Including **homes**
- Productive assets
- Livelihoods
- Familiar environments to which skills and practices have been attuned to
- Community networks
- A sense of local belonging
- If development is one side of the coin, displacement is the other side

Displacement can be divided according to the following types

- Political
- Developmental
- Disasters

Displacement can also be divided according to the following types

Primary: due to **developmental** projects

Secondary: due to **war, violence**

Tertiary: the result of **inadequate adjustment** with the ecological conditions at **re-habilitation site**.

Stages of Development induced Displacement

M Areepa Rampil:

3 stages:

1. Land Alienation
2. Industrialisation
3. Urbanisation

Development induced displacement

Development-induced population displacement is the **upheaval of communities** to make way for:

- **Large dams**
- **Industrial zones**
- **Deforestation and commercial forestry**

It concerns the **balance between the benefits of infrastructural development and the costs and pains of being uprooted** and the risk of impoverishment carried by those forcibly displaced.

Development projects are **usually located in remote villages**, hills and forests means that **those displaced tend to be the indigenous, tribal people** who have been the **traditional agents of conservation**.

- Development gives way to **multiple forms of dispossession**.
- **Mining in Chotanagpur plateau** has made **indigenous people** **dipossessed of their ownership** over their conventional **Mode of Production, Political autonomy**.

Displacement – Views

Hansen and Oliver-Smith, 1982

- The **problems of people displaced by development projects** were **linked to** those of **people displaced by conflicts and natural disasters**.
- Due to **varied definition** of ‘displacement’ there is **no clear consensus on the estimate** number of displaces.
- In the **last 50 years**, the number varies from **14 million to 57 million** displaced persons, of which over **62%** belongs to **SCs and ST**.

Jean Drèze

- **Rehabilitation measures and policies** adopted by most state governments **based on the Land Acquisition Act** embraced a **very narrow approach to compensation only**.

Abhijit Banerjee

- Most **state level policies** or the national policies in the making, have provisions for land for land compensation.
- But due to **several loopholes**, affected people, in many cases, are just given **arbitrary cash compensation**.

Das and Tewari, 2014

- Approximately **66% population** are **displaced by dams** and it **submerges vast areas of agricultural lands**.
- It **triggers unemployment** and hence, **leads to social pressure** among the displacees in villages.
- It has also been observed that displacement of human population has always been **traumatic, dismantling the agricultural production system, loss of employment, disorganisation of social systems and breakdown of associations**.

Displacement – Consequences

Forced displacement has become a major challenge for displaced people. It:

- Affects their **Social links**

- **Limits Economic Opportunity**
- New social environment exerts **psychological pressure**
- Very difficult for displaced people to adjust to new environment with **socio-economic disturbances**
- Displaced people **changed their living arrangement, attitude, culture, and way of life.**

Displacement – Are there any Positives?

Sawhney and Malhotra highlighted positive change for **women**:

- Survey found that the **position of women** within family and kinship networks is **subject to change** as with the new living arrangement in the within host community, the **relationship of women with the wider society is bound to change.**
- It further, mentioned that **earlier women could not venture out freely** because of family obligations, but **after displacement women got greater opportunities to participate** in the work sphere and outer society.

Displacement – Negatives

Sawhney and Malhotra highlights Negatives

- Observed that most of the displaced women **faced lot of social problems at new location.**
- Displacement created new problems among the displaced women as they were **unable to find suitable alliance for their daughters within the locality.**
- They did **not want their daughter to get married outside their locality** as they were afraid that they may not be able to see them again.

Displacement – Protests Movements

People's Reaction to Development:

From resistance to organised movement:

- NBA
- Niyamgiri in Odisha

(Bauxite site mining by Vedanta. Community ownership. Gram Sabha rejected (12 GS's rejected). Both FRA & PESA applied by Supreme Court.)

Displacement – Constitutional Position

- **Article 19 (i)c** - To settle anywhere
- **Article 21**
- Various DPSPs

Addressing Development Induced Displacement

Vasudha Dhagamwar looks at the problem addressing following issues:

- There is **still no uniform law on rehabilitation**. Latest LARR is there but has **many loopholes and exceptions**. Though there is **a move towards Rehabilitation**.
- Affected people are mainly poor, uneducated, frequently tribals which have **no or little political participation**.
- People are **not informed properly** about their **displacement and resettlement**.
- **Compensation is cash-centric and inadequate** to offer alternate lifestyle.
- **Resettlement is at worst non-existent and at best unsatisfactory**, unimaginative and unsympathetic.
- **No attention to emotional trauma**.

Environmental Problems

Increasing use of natural resources by **unsustainable development** has resulted in **overexploitation of natural resources**.

The degradation of the environment from **overexploitation** has reached a level which is **threatening human well-being and survival**.

Consequences of such exploitation

The consequences of such exploitation are clearly seen in:

- **Climate change**
- **Soil erosion**
- **Loss of biodiversity**
- **Pollution of land, air and water bodies and**
- **Displacement of population** who are directly dependent on these resources.

Sustainable Development

DN Dhanagre → “Growth with Justice”

Challenges	Solution
Big dams cause deforestation	Plant trees along river channels
Loss of wetlands	Create artificial wetlands
GR related environmental concerns	GM crops, Drip irrigation, rain harvesting, recharging Aquifers, mixed cropping
Deforestation	Afforestation (CAMPA)
Industrialization	Cleaner alternate fuels, EVs

Post Modernists:

Ecological Modernization →

Over-emphasis on technological breakthroughs (**Technological Anarchism**)

Gender: Sustainable Dev. more important for **Gender Equity**.

Sustainable Development - Criticism

Sukhamoy Chakravorty and Anil Agarwal

- Criticised the **idea** of sustainable development as **vague and ambiguous** as the word '**sustainable**' can **mean different goals to different persons**, making everyone confused about the very concept.

V.Ratna Reddy

- He opined that it is **very difficult to assess the needs of future generations**.

William F.Fisher

- Took the example of **Sardar Sarovar Dam** on Narmada river to explain why the **idea of sustainable development is not perfect**.

Poverty, Deprivation, And Inequality

Poverty - Causes

Social causes of poverty:

1. **Disabilities on lower castes**
2. **Conspicuous spending**
3. **Social pressure** to spend on marriages

Political:

1. **Skewed policies**
2. **Lack of voice, accountability**

Globalisation:

1. **Sidelining of cottage industries**

Natural Causes:

1. **Disasters affect poor the most, most vulnerable**

Poverty - Consequences

- **Culture of poverty**
- **Dependency culture**
- **Malnutrition**
- **Population explosion**
- **Degradation** in morality
- **Illiteracy** (can't spend on education)

- Social **Deviance** (crimes corruption)
- **IMR, MMR**

All this leads to Persistence of Poverty.

Poverty – Eradication

PESTEL of above issues to be sorted.

Add **Constitutional** (DPSP) values.

Various govt. programs.

Contemporary: Greater awareness of being poor.

Causing **relative poverty** to rise.

“Poverty is more than an economic problem” – Amartya Sen

Poverty – Government Policies

4 ways Govt. Policies & Programs on Poverty work:

1. **Wage** employment
2. **Self**-employment
3. **Food** surety
4. **Social** security

Poverty – Government Programs

Two types of programmes were initiated at the time of Independence:

1. **Rural Dev prog**
2. **Urban Industrial prog**

Some people reacted to poverty violently like Naxalite movement and some blamed government or destiny for their poverty.

Benefits of development are not equally distributed among people.

Poverty – Sociological Dimensions

Deprivation – In case of India it exists in multiple forms.

- Ethnicity
- Religion
- Caste
- Gender as a form of deprivation.

Economic poverty is a western concept (Lack of money), whereas **in India** we need to be aware of **cultural poverty** (Oscar Lewis → contentment with poor state of affairs, No extra effort).

To eliminate poverty only govt's initiative is not sufficient rather people's participation is required.

- People think poverty is way of life.
- Needs to change

Attempts were made to **accelerate rain fed agriculture** to irrigation-based agri. Cooperative farming, modern Agri practices, Zamindari abolition act, Land ceiling act were introduced to bridge the gap between rich and poor.

Radha Krishna:

- **Poverty** in these areas has **given way to a situation** where **different strata are coming close** to each other.
- Highlighting the idea that **Poverty is good** (enforces solidarity).

The solidarity thesis has been **contradicted by Bhalla and Chadha:**

- A study in 200 villages in Punjab to find out that **after Green Revolution the per capita income of a rich farmer's family is 200 times higher** in comparison to a income of poor farmer.
- Therefore, **poverty leads to deprivation** and structured form of inequality.

Andre Beteille in his article "Pollution and Poverty" considers **poverty is more contagious than pollution**. Poverty pass through barriers of caste, religion, region.

- Therefore, **all poor people irrespective of state they belong to, the language they speak, suffer from equal discrimination.**
- **Amratya Sen & Jean Dreze** consider **poverty leads to a series of seclusion, deprivation & inequalities & hence it is can't just be seen as a form of economic problem only.**
- **Poverty in India includes caste, community, religion, children, families, gender groups.**
- Poverty leads to Seclusion
- Which in turn leads to **Multiple deprivations.**

Poverty, Deprivation and Inequality

Solutions:

1. **Multidimensional approach** to development
2. **Expansion of opportunities** through globalization
3. **Active civil society**
4. **Mass media** communication and self-assertion of people
5. **Dynamic health policy, child welfare policy, social welfare policies.**
6. **Agriculture, manufacturing industry, MSMEs, Credit growth, inclusive growth.**

Violence Against Women

Defining Violence Against Women (VAW)

A woman is **violated** because of being a woman, which means her gender is the reason why she is being violated. For example, if a woman faces domestic violence because she **does not follow the 'traditional' role** of a wife.

Forms of Violence Against Women (VAW)

- P - Psychological violence
- P - Physical violence
- S - Sexual violence
- F - Financial
- S - Spiritual

Remember the keyword: PPS FS

Types of Violence Against Women (VAW)

1. **Psychological violence:** Encompasses various **tactics to undermine a woman's self-confidence** such as yelling, insults, mockery, threats, abusive language, humiliation, harassment, contempt and deliberate deprivation of emotional care or isolation. Also, known as **Gaslighting**.
2. **Physical violence:** The most obvious ranges from **pushing and shoving** to **hitting, beating**, physical abuse with a **weapon, torture, mutilation and murder**.
3. **Sexual violence:** Any form of **non-consensual sexual activity** (i.e., forced on a person) ranging from **harassment, unwanted sexual touching**, to **rape**. This form of violence also includes **incest and marital rape**.
4. **Financial violence:** Encompasses various **tactics for total or partial control of a couple's finances, inheritance or employment income**. May also include **preventing a partner from taking employment outside** the home or engaging in other activities that would lead to financial independence.
5. **Spiritual abuse:** Works to **destroy an individual's cultural or religious beliefs** through ridicule or punishment, forbidding practise of a personal religion or **forcing women or children to adhere to religious practices** that are **not their own**, etc.

VAW manifests as

1. Rape
2. Outraging the modesty of a woman
3. Child sexual abuse
4. Sexual harassment in the workplace
5. Domestic violence

Causes - Rashida Manjoo, Special UN Rapporteur on VAW

The UN (Rashida Manjoo, Special Rapporteur on VAW), has identified **six underlying causes** of VAW:

- **H - Historically unequal**
- **C - Culture justifies**
- **S - Sexuality controlled**
- **P - Privacy doctrine** (it's a private matter)
- **W - War** (outraging enemy's civilian women's modesty)
- **G - Government Inaction**

Remember the keyword: HCS PWG

Violence Against Women - Reasons

1. **Historically unequal power relations** the political, economic and social processes that have evolved over many centuries have kept men in a position of power over women.
2. **Control of women's sexuality**-- Many societies use violence as a way to control a woman's sexuality, and likewise in many societies' violence is used to punish women who exhibit sexual behaviour, preferences and attitudes that violate cultural norms
3. **Cultural ideology**: Culture defines gender roles and some customs, traditions and religions are used to justify VAW when women transgress these culturally assigned roles.
4. **Doctrines of privacy**: The persistent belief in many societies that VAW is a private issue seriously impedes attempts to eradicate this violence.
5. **Patterns of conflict resolution**: Links have been identified between VAW in the home and community in areas that are in conflict or that are militarised. Often, heightened insecurity means that tensions within the home are more pronounced and can contribute to the perpetuation of VAW in the family. Equally, because eyes tend to be on the conflict, women's suffering is often overshadowed. VAW is also frequently used as a formal military tactic.
6. **Government inaction**: Government negligence in preventing and ending VAW establishes a tolerance of VAW throughout the community.

How Is Globalisation Affecting VAW

Capitalist globalisation with its **tools of development and progress**, some aspects of modern science and technology, **including free market, rational knowledge system** and the **militarised State** seems to be **intensifying existing violence and creating grotesque new forms** against the already vulnerable - particularly women.

- **Consumerism** - Dowry (**Dipankar Gupta**)
- **Technology** - Foeticide
- **Industrialising Agriculture** - Destroying Livelihood (**K. Somasekhara**)
- **Pink Collarisation** - Low Paid Low Status jobs (**Karuna Ahmed**)
- **Competitive markets** - Low wages, women agree
- **State** - It sponsored education, employment but not safe environment

- The growing number of **dowry murders**, that are a **direct outcome of increasing consumerism and devaluation of women**.
- Female **foeticide** that is fostered by new forms of **reproductive technology**
- The **total destruction of women's livelihoods** in the process of industrializing agriculture.
- **Exploitation of women's skills and labour in sweatshops** of the corporate free market.
- The **State has also become its violator** – both through **commission** of violence and through **omission** to stop or end violence.
- For example, while on the one hand globalisation has allowed a larger number of women to join the workforce, at the same time the State has not made enough effort to create enabling and safe working conditions for women at work

What Can An Individual Do To End This Violence?

- **Raise awareness** - It is important to continue to raise awareness about the impact of violence against women **so that more groups, communities and leaders prioritise** this as a programme of work that deserves attention and resources.
- Help to **empower women and girls to protect themselves** - it is essential to address the sources and perpetrators of violence, whether actual or potential.
- This **requires hands-on engagement with men** and boys to help shift attitudes about the use of violence and to empower (**HeForShe**).
- **Break the silence: Never condone VAW. Always raise your voice and report it.**
- **Know the law:** Gain basic awareness of the laws on VAW so that you are able to recognise when VAW is taking place and know what law to use when.
- **Build solidarity:** With a concerned and committed group of friends and colleagues build an informal solidarity group within your organisation or institution which can extend solidarity to victims of Gender Based Violence.
- **Connect with women's rights groups:** Get in touch with local women's rights groups if you hear of any VAW-related incident, or if you wish to attend or organise trainings on VAW for your colleagues, friends and peers.
- **Demand to know your rights as a woman:** Within an institution or organisation you have a right to find out the processes in place to combat VAW. For instance, you have a right to know whether your office or college has set up an anti-sexual harassment cell, and the right to demand that it is set up.

He for She

- It is created by **UN Women**, the United Nations Entity for Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women.
- **HeForShe** is a solidarity movement for gender equality that **invites men and boys to act for a more equal world**.
- HeForShe provides targeted platform where a global audience can engage and advocate for the achievement of **gender equality in our lifetime**.
- The **movement invites people around the world to stand together as equal partners** to craft a shared vision of a gender-equal world and implement specific, locally relevant solutions.
- **HeforShe includes Head of States, Eminent Personalities and other champions like Emma Watson.**

Recent Initiatives In India Against VAW

MAVA or Men Against Violence & Abuse is a voluntary social organisation.

- MAVA is India's first men's organization to directly intervene against violence on women in India.
- Its head-office is situated in Mumbai.
- As on date, MAVA has been able to reach out to over 3000 men and women facing various gender-related problems.
- **Bell Bajao** (Hindi for 'ring the bell') is an anti-domestic violence campaign that urges local residents to take a stand against physical abuse through simple acts meant to interrupt domestic violence.
- When resident, especially men, overhear violence against a woman taking place they are urged to ring the doorbell and ask a simple question - such as to borrow some tea, to use the phone, or to have a glass of water.
- This is meant to let the abuser know that others can hear them and will act to interrupt the violence.
- **Besharmi Morcha**, also known as "**Slutwalk** arthaat Besharmi Morcha", is the Indian equivalent of SlutWalk.
- **Christie Thompson**, writing for Ms. Magazine observed "...women aren't marching for the right to walk down the street dressed in barely-there clothes, as critics suggest.
- They're fighting for the right to walk down the street. Period.
- **Blank Noise** is a **community/public art project** that seeks to **confront street harassment**, commonly known as eve teasing, in India. Blank Noise seeks to trigger public dialogue on the issue of street sexual harassment.
- Conversations range from collectively building a definition of "eve-teasing" **to defining the boundaries of "teasing", "harassment", "flirting"**.
- The collective builds testimonials of street sexual violence, harassment and "eve-teasing" and disperses them back in public, thereby creating public debate.
- **The Gulabi gang** was founded in 2006 by **Sampat Pal Devi**, a mother of five and former government health worker (as well as a former child bride), as a response to widespread domestic abuse and other violence against women.
- **Gulabis visit abusive husbands and beat them up with laathis** (bamboo sticks) unless they stop abusing their wives.
- In 2008, they stormed an electricity office in Banda district and forced officials to turn back the power they had cut in order to extract bribes.
- They have **also stopped child marriages and protested dowry and female illiteracy**.

Veena Das in '*Mirrors of violence*' -

- *Atrocities against women are manifestation of culturally constructed boundaries/patriarchal construct.*
- Rape, sexual harassment, eve teasing, molestation limit women's freedom and perpetuate the **notion that women need male protection in various stages of life**.
- It substantiates - **Manu's code** "A women should never be independent. Her father has authority over her in childhood, her husband in youth and her son in old age".

Rape

Forms

- Within family
- As caste/class domination
- Rape of children, minors & unprotected
- Gangrapes during wars, riots
- Custodial rapes

Dowry

M.N. Srinivas in his book 'Some Reflections on Dowry' equates dowry deaths to inefficacy of modern state and its infrastructure.

Deepankar Gupta considers that dowry & its glorification as the manifestation of **consumerism**.

Bina Aggarwal consider dowry to be a result of **patriarchal society reflecting the worthlessness of women**.

V. Geetha: In the Book "Patriarchy" decrees that **Women have been denied inheritance because of dowry**.

Prostitution

- **Non voluntary but situational compulsions** give rise to prostitution.
- **Social outcastes and economic compulsions often come together to perpetuate prostitution** in the society.
- Need to **ensure safety and health requirements** of sex workers.

Latent Form of Violence

Discrimination in food, health, education, employment.

Solution:

- **Laws** by govt. like Dowry prohibition Act, DV act, Pre-natal sex determination etc.
- **Institutions:** NCW, MoW&CD
- Increased **awareness** with the efforts of govt and NGOs

Andre Beteille - puts it '**while law decides the direction in which the society ought to go, culture decides the way in which the society actually goes**.'

Caste Conflict

- **Caste has been a distinctive feature of the Indian society.**
- It characterizes the **structure of social stratification** in India.
- It has been viewed both as an **institution as well as an ideology**.
- Indian society has **system and design clash**-
 - System of caste and the design of democracy - justice, liberty, equality and fraternity

- Hence the conflict – Economical, Social and Political
- Caste conflict refers to conflict between two castes or group of castes on statues and privileges related issues.
- In general it is side effect of the problem of casteism.
- **Caste conflict arises when**
 - One caste dominates another,
 - Exploitation of lower caste/subordinate caste,
 - When one caste pose hinderance in another's social mobility or political power
 - When the economic opportunity is skewed in favour of few castes.



Caste Conflict – Factors



Social Factors

- Lack of equal opportunity
- Lack of social Justice
- Feudal and exploitative social structure
- Oppression by the higher caste – Untouchability, etc.
- Increasing caste consciousness with better education and communication.

Economic Factors

- Unequal distribution of wealth
- Skewed proportion of have and have-nots (majority of economically poor families are Dalit or from other lower caste)
- Lack of stable and alternate source of earning and livelihood.
- Fight for share in economic well being

Political Factors

Caste and politics have become inextricable elements of Indian politics.

- Theoretically, caste and democratic politics represent opposite value systems
- Unequal share in political power
- Growing political consciousness (**Dalit imagination – Pratap Bhanu Mehta**)
- Politicization of caste – **Rajni Kothari**
- Lack of representation (esp. SCs and STs) at higher levels of the government

Historical Factors

- Concept of purity and pollution (**Dual born castes**)
- Brahmanical hegemony
- Racial and linguistic difference (**Sanskrit was considered an elite language**)
- Ethnic difference



Caste Conflict – Different views

- Andre Beteille
 - In past caste conflict in India was identity centric conflict
 - Now it is slowly moving towards interest focused conflict
 - Oscar Louis
 - in his study found that in Western UP, Jats and Rajputs fought against each other in search of superiority and dominance.
 - Pratap Bhanu Mehta
 - Resurgence of Dalit Imagination



- S.C. Dube
 - green revolution and resultant economic affluence of farmers in Western Uttar Pradesh, Punjab and Haryana gave rise to consolidation of intermediary castes in North India
 - This consolidation of castes and their search for power led to caste conflict.
 - T.K. Oomen
 - points out that lower caste search for equality and higher caste challenge and protests to it When elements of justice, equality, democracy are injected in a traditional society

Consequences of Caste Conflict

- Resurgence of caste based identity, vote bank politics
- Caste based violence (Inter and Intra-caste conflict)
- Protest and demand for greater representation in public employment
- De - Sanskritisation
- The problem of casteism, It has crept into every sphere of our national life.
- Hindrance to the Developments of National Feeling
- Dangerous to Democracy

Caste Under Market Economy

- Market economy has changed the economic status of lower caste in the traditional social hierarchy
- Due to better access to education, representation of marginalized caste at higher levels in both public and private employment has increased.
- States with better economic performance, offers
- Caste, Class and Power (**Andre Beteille**) equations are constantly changing in society.

Ethnic Conflict

- Definition:
 - How an individual identifies itself with the group or society, based on
 - Language, region, religion, caste, history
 - Tradition when followed from generation to generation becomes ethnic identity.
 - Ethnicity creates a sense of ethnic consciousness among the members of an ethnic group and mobilizes the members
 - to articulate their economic and political interest

Types of Ethnic Conflict

- **Intra-ethnic –**
 - Different ethnic identity with an umbrella ethnic identity,
- **Inter-ethnic –**
 - Ethnic identity of one group is seen as completely different from others. Eg: Assamese against migrants.
- **Ethnic group Vs State –**
 - Ethnic group sees their identity as different from the larger state. E.g.: the Naga movement.

Causes of Ethnic Conflict

- Perceived differences or identity and status
- Stereotypes : US vs THEM
- Historical reasons – Colonialism
- Competition for resources
- Unequal economic and political opportunity
- Regional disparities
- Prioritising ethnic-interest instead of national interest.
- External provocation like funding for weapons and riots from outside.

Forms of Ethnic Conflict

- Autonomy Movement – Gorkhaland & Assamese son of the soil
- Secessionist – Khalistan and Dravid nationalism
- Insurgency – Kashmir and Naga insurgency
- Violent conflict based on Identity markers, such as
 - Language – Assamese vs Outsiders
 - Religion
 - Tribe

Sociological View on Ethnic conflict

- **Functionalist theory**
 - Argues that for race and ethnic relations to be functional and thus contribute to the harmonious conduct and stability of society, racial and ethnic minorities must assimilate into that society.
- **Assimilation perspective**
 - assumes that to become fully fledged members of society, minority groups must adopt as much of the dominant society's culture as possible, particularly its language, mannerisms, and goals for success, and thus give up much of its own culture.
- **Conflict Theorist**
 - Racial and ethnic conflict is tied to class conflict,
 - class inequality must be reduced to lessen racial and ethnic conflict in society.

Ethnic Cleansing

- **Ethnic cleansing**
 - Systematic forced removal of ethnic, racial, and religious groups from a given area, with the intent of making a region ethnically homogeneous.
 - The indigenous ethnic group launches an expulsion/atrocity campaign against the foreigners(

those who do not originally belong to that state)

- Ex: Rohingya Muslims from Myanmar,

Communalism

Definition

Using social traditions to mobilise people, generally to satisfy some vested interests.

1. India -> Religion
2. USA -> Race
3. West Asia -> Shia - Sunni (Sectarianism)
4. Africa -> Tribal

Bipin Chandra -> 3 types of communalism (Communal communalism), (Extreme Communalism)

1. **Liberal** communalism - Similar secular interests, different religions interests.
2. **Communal** Communalism - Different secular interests, different religions interests.
3. **Extreme** Communalism - Different secular interests, different religions interests but 2 communities cannot exist together.

Causes

1. Unhealthy Competition for opportunities
2. Different perception of history
3. Events in past -> Partition
4. Vested interests
5. Insecurity in religious minorities
6. Perception of threat even majority
7. International linkages

Consequences

1. Atmosphere of unrest
2. Violent clashes
3. Loss of life & property
4. Hindrance to social change
5. Continued distrust
6. Forced migration
7. Xenophobia
8. Ghettoization
9. Political Mobilisation

Religious Revivalism

Definition

- It means re-awakening of the beliefs and faith in religion in society.
 - Eg: Arya Samaj “Suddhi” Movement
 - Deoband movement
- Religious revivalism generally does not seek to restore the old order.

Sociological Views

- **August Comte**
 - Predicted that the increasing use of science in modern society would cause the decline of religion.
- **Peter Burger**
 - Rising importance of religion in politics as one of the factors driving revivalism
- **Malinowski**
 - While the social role of religion has been taken up by secular ideas, the importance of the psychological role of religion is ever increasing.

Causes of Religious Revivalism

- Reactionary response from orthodox section against Modernisation
- Religious sects and cults fuel revivalist tendencies, which serve their interest
- Spread of ideological institutions
- Igniting religious sentiments offers substance to vote bank politics.
- Poverty and unequal distribution of resources contributed in the growth of multitude of cult like institutions
- Communalism and Fundamentalism

Consequences

- Social tension and rise of communal tendencies
- Less inclination towards secularism
- Literal interpretation of religious text, more superstitious beliefs and practices
- Insecurity from other religion, tend to turn into religious revivalism.
- Distraction from more compelling social issues.
- Multitude of god-men and god-women exploit the masses

Illiteracy and disparity in Education

Definition

- **UNESCO**
 - An illiterate person is one who can not read and write in his/her everyday life.
- **As per 75th National Sample Survey report, 2018**
 - Literacy rate in India was about 77.7%, which means about 22% population is illiterate.
 - In rural areas, the literacy rate was 73.5% compared to 87.7% in urban areas
 - The male literacy rate is higher than the female literacy rate among all states.

Illiteracy - A social challenge

- Illiteracy effects an individual in all spheres of their life.
- It is a deep-rooted problem which despite huge investment by government, policies, etc, remains unsolved.
- India ranked 123 out of 135 countries in female literacy rate.



Causes of Illiteracy

- High rate of population growth in relation to low rate of adults population gaining literacy.
- High drop-out rates even in primary schools
- Parent's attitude towards education – using the services of their young children for supporting family for extra income or in household occupation
- Non-conducive school environment – specially for girls. (Separate toilets are not available)
- Early Marriage of girls in some section of the society (especially in backward areas)
- **At Societal Level**
 - Discrimination in society
 - Exploitation and harassment of illiterates
- **At Individual levels**
 - Low-self esteem
 - High Unemployment



- Limited economic opportunity and access to resources is restricted
- Low income and intergenerational transmission of low literacy or illiteracy.

Disparity in Education

Definition:

- Disparity in education means unequal distribution of academic resources, such as school funds, qualified teacher, book and modern technology.
- Socially and economically deprived communities are the first victim of this disparity
- This inequality leads to major difference in their educational and professional success.

There could be various reasons of educational disparity such as,

- Family of origin
- Gender
- Social Class
- Earning
- Health Status
- Government support/Funds

Consequences of Educational Disparity

- Low academic performance
- Inability to acquire desired skills and competencies
- Unsatisfaction with one's own socio-economic conditions
- Give birth to cycle of poverty.
- Non-literate families marry their girl child early in life,
 - Early pregnancy → Undernourishment of child
 - More incidences of domestic violence

Government Initiative

- **Saakshar Bharat** – revised version of National Literacy Mission
 - to create an increasingly literate society.
 - And to address the gender, social and regional disparities.
- The Constitution **86th amendment Act, 2002** inserted Article 21-A in the Constitution of India to provide free and compulsory education of all children in the age group of six to fourteen years as a Fundamental Right.
- **103rd Constitutional amendment Act, 2019** to empower Economically weaker section providing reservation in educational institutions.

- **National Education Policy, 2020:**
 - It aims at making “India a global knowledge superpower” by introducing several changes from the school to college level in the Indian education system.
- **Samagra Shiksha:**
 - It is an integrated scheme for school education extending from pre-school to class XII to ensure inclusive and equitable quality education at all levels of school education.
- **Mid Day Meal Scheme:**
 - It provides that every child within the age group of six to fourteen years studying in classes I to VIII who enrolls and attends the school, shall be provided hot cooked nutritional meals, free of charge every day except on school holidays.
- **Eklavya Model School and Rajiv Gandhi National Fellowship Scheme (RGNF):**
 - These aim to encourage the students belonging to Scheduled Tribes (ST) community to pursue higher education.

Digital Media: Its Rise and Related Issues

What is digital media?

- It is an internet-based software and interface that allows individuals to interact with one another, exchanging details about their lives such as biographical data, professional information, personal photos and up-to-the minute thoughts.

Global trends:

- The rise of digital media players such as Netflix, Hulu, Amazon, Apple TV, Roku, and Boxee, among others, is undermining the television's long-held dominance as the primary source of entertainment.

1. Mobile devices driving the digital consumption:

- The increase in the number of mobile devices is making it easier for consumers to access music and video content on the go.
- Data consumption has increased globally as a result of improved networks, coverage, and advanced technologies (3G, 4G / LTE, 5G).

2. Audio & Video drive the global digital media consumption:

- Over-the-top (OTT) service providers such as YouTube, as well as subscription-based digital content providers such as Spotify, NETFLIX, and Amazon, have aided the expansion of audio/video data streaming.

3. Marketers are shifting their advertising spends towards digital media:

- The growing popularity of digital media has resulted in a shift in worldwide advertising spending patterns.

Digital media landscape in India:

- The Indian consumer is rapidly consuming material on digital platforms, in line with worldwide trends.

- This pattern can be seen in all types of information, such as news (written), music (audio), and video.
- The major drivers of this trend are increasing internet penetration and mobile device proliferation, as well as the convenience of consuming information at any time and from any location.

1. Rapidly increasing internet users:

- Digital content consumption is expected to double, with over a billion of the population having a smartphone by the next decade.

2. India's Digital Demography:

- According to TRAI, 94% of the urban population in India has an internet subscription; which falls to a considerable low among the rural populace (only 24%).
- Nearly 30% of google search in India is voice-driven (Business Standard, 2019).

Voice assistance will lead to "linguistic democratization."

- In India, YouTube accounts for nearly 265 million unique, active users. 95% of these users watch videos in their regional languages (Economic Times, 2018).

3. New Trends in Digital Content Consumption:

- Today, video streaming services have more subscribers (613 million) than traditional cable connection (556 million), according to VentureBeat news.

Impacts of digital media:

1. Digital Media and Society:

- It enables unprecedented amounts of communication, social interaction, and community formation across time, space, and social context boundaries.

Virtual community as given by Howard Rheingold

- It has provided a new dimension to our lifestyle and has led to the worldwide accessibility.
- Digital media has provided a thousand more ways of entertainment and recreation.

2. Impact on Family and Relationships:

- It brings about a sense of security since everyone knows that they can get in touch with different people at any time if they need to.

Facilitate the 'protective' function of family (Ogburn and Nimkoff)

- The positive benefits of social media on marriage include the ability for couples who spend a lot of time apart to stay in touch and feel closer despite the distance.

Facilitate the 'affectional' function of family (Ogburn and Nimkoff)

- Families who have been through a divorce may find social media useful.

Facilitate the function of 'emotional support' of family

- Online dating apps such as Tinder has disrupted more traditional ways of meeting romantic partners.
- Its rise also comes at a time when norms and behaviours around marriage and cohabitation also are changing as more people delay marriage or choose to remain single.

- Previous Pew Research Center studies about online dating indicate that the share of Americans who have used these platforms – as well as the share who have found a spouse or partner through them – has risen over time.
- Some users – especially younger women – report being the target of rude or harassing behaviour while on these platforms

3. Digital Media as Platform for justice:

- During the 2011 Arab Spring, which was dubbed the 'Facebook Revolution' and the 'Twitter Uprising,' social media was used as a tool for activism.

Example of successful Social Movement without adequate resources. A Critique of Resource Mobilisation Theory.

- Since then, activists, protestors, and revolutionaries have utilised social media to mobilise global support for campaigns against a variety of injustices.

4. Digital Media as brand of new facet for women empowerment:

- It serves a platform to share, raise the voice of women when their voices are restricted.
- Thousands of men have joined cyber-hands to help women, share their voices in the protests, most recent example being #MeToo.

5. Digital Media and Politics:

- With the advent of digital media, there has been significant electoral shift and substantial swings in support between parties.
- It has been discovered that news consumption leads to political persuasion, therefore the more people utilise social media platforms for news, the more their political views would be influenced.

Jean Baudrillard - Mass media has reversed the Marxist idea that society is dominated by economic structure, rather it will now be increasingly controlled by the signs and images which are creation of mass media.

6. Digital Media in Education:

- It empowers individuals and accelerates knowledge democratisation.
- New modes of learning and working are possible, creating improved chances for people in underserved communities and regions.

7. Digital Democracy:

- When people have the freedom to express themselves, democratic values can evolve. Through these venues of openness, social media allows the concept of “digital democracy”. *term believed to have been coined by digital activist Steven Clift*
- Social media serves as a tool for questioning seemingly invincible administrations, holding them responsible, and bringing long-term change driven by people rather than a single vote every few years. *Illustrates that power is actually dispersed in society, a point made by Robert Dahl - in his 'Who Governs?'*

Downsides and risks:

- Watching every day social interactions one can gain insights about the perpetuation of gender disparity via digital media.

- A new study conducted by researchers from Higher School of Economics discovered 20% more posts on social media about boys than daughters, demonstrating a gender bias in sharing information about offspring.

It shows how patriarchy is indispensable for an analysis of gender inequality as said by Sylvia Walby in her work 'Theorizing Patriarchy'

- Digital media can be used by organizations and communities with harmful intentions to spread propaganda and to mobilize followers for E.g. - after the Pulwama attack, social media and messaging apps were flooded with false and misleading content to invoke hatred.
- Extremist/Fundamentalist groups can also use digital media to recruit and mobilise adherents.

Illustrates how technology can be used for religious revivalism

- Young adults and children are especially vulnerable if they do not have a stable social support network.
- Social media is the number one way in which teenagers spend their leisure time.
- According to the Pew Research Center, 92% of surveyed teenagers age 13 to 17 access the internet daily, and 24% reported being online "almost constantly."
- Social network addiction and internet gaming disorder were also positively, significantly correlated to depression, anxiety, and stress among the teenagers surveyed.
- Digital media consumption may facilitate bullying, harassment and social defamation.
- Excessive digital media consumption may increase vulnerability to addiction and harm mental and physical health.
- Rise in suicide among young people can be linked to insecurities developed as a result of excessive social media usage like Instagram Example of Durkheim's egoistic suicide.
- Ignorant marketers and their naive agencies pay tens of thousands of dollars for famous social media "influencers" with millions of "followers" to tweet about them.
- Except the "followers" are bots that the influencers buy for pennies from fraud houses.
- And the influencers are influencing nothing but the budgets of the marketers who fall for it.
- The use of social media in protests is both mobilising and polarising. E.g. - During nirbhaya protest, mobilisation took place through digital media. E.g. - Communal messages and fake news on social media causing riots and mob lynching
- It is a channel through which information and momentum, as well as disinformation and conflict, circulate at an unprecedented rate.
- By selecting what information reaches which users, digital media can alter human decisions and pose risks to civil society.

An indicator of Risk Society, concept given by Ulrich Beck.

- Many people restrain themselves from taking part in a dialogue with a fear of losing their privacy.
- Policymakers' perceptions of public opinion are likewise distorted by social media. This is because social media platforms are thought to represent people from various walks of life, but not everyone uses their voice equally.
- The transformation of work brought about by digital media may increase inequality.

- As digital media fragments work and demand for different skill sets grows and dips, the potential of rising inequality in the near future is very probable as the global economy adjusts to these new realities.
- Arrival of profit-driven corporations like Uber, Ola, ZOMATO, Airbnb have contributed to number of unresolved issues, including taxation and regulation.
- The platform workers like zomato delivery agents who could not afford the food they deliver feel alienated. *Marx's idea of alienation from product*
- There is presence of digital divide between established and developing countries, urban and rural populations, young and older, educated versus and less educated people, and men and women.
- Isolation, which can damage mental health, educational hurdles as higher education increasingly moves online, and rising gender discrimination are all effects of the digital divide.
- Digital divide adversely affected the poor, rural and especially girl child during the recent pandemic when studies were switched to online mode.

Way Forward

- The Indian government must develop fundamental capabilities in the fields of cyber security, data integrity, and data security.
- It should establish tough cyber security regulations to protect people from fraud on digital media.
- The government can bring together both the private and industry experts to address genuine concerns on digital platform. Fake news, phishing, and fraud can serve as a catalyst for further research into digital media literacy instruction outside of the classroom, which will be a crucial method for combatting such dangers.
- Instead of issuing IT standards, the government might enact a GDPR compliant data protection statute.
- The majority of the issues with the digital media platform will be resolved as a result of this.
- It will also go a step further and require social media platforms to store data in India.
- The inclusion of Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 9, which allows individual countries to coordinate their work toward ending digital discrimination, should be improved at the national level.
- One should learn to limit the amount of time that one spend on social media and make time to spend with the people who are physically present in front of us.
- There should be healthy balance between Social Networking - Family, personal and social Relationships.

Domestic Violence and Covid-19

- Although COVID-19 is a major worldwide health threat, there is another global public health emergency that is becoming a growing challenge. Domestic violence is a public health and human rights issue that primarily affects women and children worldwide.
- Several countries have reported a significant increase in domestic violence cases since the COVID-19-induced lockdowns and physical distancing measures were implemented.
- According to sociologist Marianne Hester, "domestic violence goes up whenever families spend more time together, such as the Christmas and summer vacations."

Defining Domestic Violence

- In The Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act (India, 2005) it is defined as “any act of commission or omission or conduct resulting in physical, verbal, emotional, sexual and economic abuse” and this can range from calling names, insulting, humiliating, controlling behaviour, physical violence to sexual violence.
- According to the World Health Organization, one in every three women across the globe experience physical and/or sexual violence in their lifetime; and at least 30 percent of all women in relationships have experienced physical and/or sexual violence by their partners.
- According to the United Nations Women policy brief, a significant increase in violence against women and children (VAWC) cases has been reported in several countries since the COVID-19-induced lockdown and physical distancing measures have been implemented (UN Women, 2020).
- This confirms that the risk of domestic violence is increased in the present context of confinement (UN Women, 2020).

REASONS

There can be multiple, interdependent causes for Domestic Violence during such a period, like stress due to physical confinement, economic disruption, slowed down businesses, possible unemployment, scarcity of basic provisions, limited social support.

- Difficulty in accessing protective resources - Victims of domestic violence might be quarantined with an abusive partner and disconnected from their usual support system, which makes it very difficult or impossible to ask for help and to escape from the abusive relationship.
- Employment - Loss of income, especially for males leads to lesser control over economic security and thereby making them exert more control on their partners, this scenario is worse if female spouse is employed and male is unemployed.
- Increased risk due to pandemic-related stressors and forced proximity Due to the implementation of confinement measures, the usual daily occupations of most people have changed. Spending more time in the same environment with close others might increase the risk of conflicts between family members and could be a triggering factor for violent behaviour.
- Domestic Labour -Another significant aspect responsible for this surge in domestic abuse is domestic labour. Gendered roles world over have placed domestic work on women's shoulders, which is socially and culturally often demarcated as “women's work.” Under lockdown conditions, domestic work has increased considerably and it can be especially taxing if it is not divided equitably.
- India being a patriarchal society, domestic work is primarily considered women's job. Absence of domestic help and people thrown into close quarters, increases workload, adding fuel to the ongoing friction between the couple and results in increased chances of Domestic violence.
- Substance abuse- If household members are consuming more alcohol than usual due to stressors, they might be at higher risk for acting out and causing physical harm to family members.
- The World Health Organization cites a strong correlation between alcohol and violence between intimate partners. They note that alcohol affects both body and mind, and can impair thinking and self-control. People who drink alcohol may be less capable of dealing with relationship conflicts without resorting to violence.

Problems In Reporting During A Lockdown:

- Restricted movement: The lockdown has prevented women from moving to safer places in cases of violence and abuse.
- Handicapped mediums of communication: Since only a portion of female population has phones in India, The Whatsapp number launched by the NCW had a limited reach and as fewer have an internet connection, making this platform inaccessible to majority of women in the country.
- Reduced contact with the natal family: Natal family is usually the first point of contact for the victim. They are not only essential in supporting the victim in filing a complaint but also facilitate filing of complaints to the police. The constant presence of the perpetrator made it difficult for the victims to contact their first respondent which ultimately deterred them from reporting to institutionalised channels.
- Unavailability of the formal support system: The machinery under the Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act had not been identified as an essential service during the lockdown.
- Hence, the protection officers were not able to visit households of victims, NGOs were not able to have physical interactions with them and the police officers being at the frontline in our effort to tackle COVID-19 were overstretched to help victims effectively

WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE:

Effective implementation of The Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, 2005, is the need of hour. This act mandates wide publicity through different media (print and broadcast), to create awareness in general public, which can include information about:

- Interpersonal Violence Cycle
- Measures of de-escalating a situation at home
- Helplines
- Shelter homes
- Legal assistance available for women.
- A makeshift arrangement of safe spaces (space away from the abuser) by creation of temporary shelter homes should also be considered.
- Educating and using available human resources like ASHA workers and other health workers, who are currently conducting door to door surveys about covid-19, in identifying subtle signs of Domestic violence would be prudent.
- Women's organisations need to amplify their efforts and publicise helplines. The "red dot" initiative by non-profit WEFT (Women's Entrepreneurs for Transformation) is one such initiative. Similar to the "mask19" campaign in France and Spain, victims are asked to draw a red dot on their palm to seek help and alert their neighbours and authorities.
- State governments must ensure that the 181 helpline services are up and running. Greater social awareness, better and more sensitive policing, improving early access to abortion and pregnancy testing, and providing safe shelters for victims of domestic violence can help deal with the silent epidemic of domestic violence.
- People should be made aware of the 'bell bajao' campaign and should be encouraged to intervene in cases of domestic violence in their neighbourhood.

- Essential services like hospitals, medical stores and grocery stores should be trained to help the victims who are not being able to file a complaint otherwise. For example, in France and Spain, pharmacies are being trained to identify people facing abuse through code words: asking for 'mask 19' is being used as a code for people who cannot speak openly, to indicate that they are being abused and are seeking help.

During this pandemic, the slogan 'Stay home, Stay safe' has been a life saver for a lot of people.

But for some, it has only created more problems as home is not the 'safe haven' for everyone as one expects it to be.



He's sure Sociology will be a life-changing experience for you as it has been for him.

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